The Rothschilds: The Complete Forensic File

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The Five Volumes in Reading Order

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THE ROTHSCHILDS: ORIGIN

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From the Red Shield to Mayer Amschel — and Everything Before

A forensic genealogy of the Rothschild banking family: what is documented, what is tradition, what is myth — and how to tell the difference.

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PART 0 — HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

Before we tell the story, we need to agree on how we're going to tell it, because this particular story has been told badly — sometimes maliciously — more often than almost any other family history in Europe. Two centuries of propaganda, pamphlet wars, Hollywood films, and internet folklore sit on top of a genuinely documented record. So this document operates on a simple forensic principle:

We do not adopt the theories of others. We gather clues and evidence.

Every claim in this document carries a pedigree tag that tells you exactly how well it is supported:

- **[A] — Archive-grade / primary-adjacent.** Drawn from official family records, municipal archives, gravestone inscriptions, tax registers, or the Rothschild family's own archive and its published scholarly instruments.

- **[S] — Scholarly.** Peer-reviewed work or major reference scholarship (encyclopedias, university-press monographs, the *Neue Deutsche Biographie*, the *Encyclopaedia Judaica*).
- **[B] — Quality secondary.** Serious biographies, museum scholarship, and local-history scholarship with named sources.
- **[C] — Crowdsourced or single-source.** Genealogy websites, hobbyist DNA projects, commercial heraldry databases. Treated as *lead-grade*, never adopted.
- **[L] — Lore.** Family traditions, legends, and stories that circulate without documentary support. Documented here because they are part of the record, but clearly fenced off from evidence.
- **[X] — Hostile myth.** Material from antisemitic conspiracy literature. We document these claims because they are historically important — they shaped public perception for two centuries — but we never repeat them as fact, and where they are false we show *why* they are false.

A second principle: **anomalies are data.** Where sources contradict each other — and they do, frequently — we do not pick the prettiest answer. We log the conflict, show the evidence on each side, resolve it where the evidence allows, and leave it honestly open where it does not. Part 11 of this document is a complete anomaly register: thirty-two conflicts investigated and dispositioned, with the open residue precisely stated, and a precise map of what physical archive

would settle each one.

A third principle: **nothing is omitted.** That includes the parts of this story that are embarrassing to every side: the family's own self-mythologizing, the nineteenth-century gutter press, the twentieth-century propaganda ministries, and the modern internet's copy-paste folklore. All of it is in here, sorted.

A note on why this family, and why this method

The Rothschilds are not just a family. They are a case study in how modern Europe processed three anxieties at once: money, mobility, and Jewish emancipation. A family that lived behind a locked gate in a German ghetto in 1744 became, within two generations, the creditors of nations. That velocity made them a screen onto which everyone projected their hopes and terrors. Understanding what is *documentably true* about their origin is therefore not just genealogy — it is a calibration exercise in how history gets made, distorted, and weaponized.

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PART 1 — THE EVIDENTIARY FRAME: WHERE THE DOCUMENTED RECORD BEGINS

Here is the first and most important fact of this entire document, stated plainly:

The documentable, source-verifiable history of the Rothschild banking family stops in sixteenth-century Frankfurt. Everything before that dissolves into

fragments.

The best scholarly ceiling of what can be firmly asserted is Niall Ferguson's two-volume *The House of Rothschild* (1998–99), which was written with a privilege no other historian has ever been granted: full access to the family archives in London, Paris, and Frankfurt **[S]**. Even Ferguson begins his account in the Frankfurt of Mayer Amschel's lifetime (1744–1812), not with the ancestors. The reason is structural: the family's own published genealogical instruments are the work of a specific scholarly tradition introduced in Part 1 — the "Frankfurt school" of Jewish genealogy — whose foundation documents are these:

1. **Horovitz, *Die Inschriften des alten Friedhofs der israelitischen Gemeinde zu Frankfurt a.M.* (1901)** — a 768-page edition of every legible Hebrew gravestone inscription in Frankfurt's medieval Jewish cemetery, with German translations **[A]**.
2. **The Frankfurt Memorbuch, published by Aron Freimann and Meier Hildesheimer in the *Festschrift zum 70. Geburtstage A. Berliners* (Frankfurt, 1903)** — the community's book of remembrance, recording deaths by name, date, and (for the wealthy) with epitaphs **[A]**.
3. **Aron Freimann, *Stammtafeln der freiherrlichen Familie von Rothschild* (Kumpf & Reis, Frankfurt, 1906)** — the scholarly family tables, privately printed in 25 copies, built from the gravestones and Memorbuch, with inscriptions translated into German **[A]**.

4. **Alexander Dietz, *Stammbuch der Frankfurter Juden* (1907)** — genealogical register of 625 Frankfurt Jewish families from 1349 to 1849, with a street plan of the Judengasse **[A/S]**.
5. **Ettlinger's *Ele Toldot*** — a 32-volume handwritten transcription of the Frankfurt Jewish burial records from 1241 to 1824, preserved on microfilm at the Leo Baeck Institute (MF 536) and the Central Archives for the History of the Jewish People in Jerusalem **[A]**.

Everything asserted about the sixteenth- and seventeenth-century generations in this document rests on this five-piece foundation, cross-checked against tax registers, the community's *Judenstättigkeit* (the ghetto statute book), and municipal records.

The family's own archive is also candid about a trap. The Rothschild Archive itself warns: "Rothschild was by no means a unique name and there were many other families called 'Rothschild' originating in Frankfurt" **[A]**. House-sign names were shared by unrelated families living under the same sign. Genealogists untrained in this system routinely merge families that merely shared a house name. The 1905 *Jewish Encyclopedia* went further, asserting that the scattered Rothschilds of Frankfurt, Worms, and elsewhere were "little doubt... one family," based on the recurrence of distinctive given names (Kalman, Jacob) — a plausible but reconstructed claim **[S]**. We treat each branch separately and note the connections only where a marriage or a record documents

them.

Finally, the archive maintains that "the most detailed published genealogy of the Rothschild banking family is *Le Sang des Rothschild* by Joseph Valynseele and Henri Mars (Paris, 2004)" **[A]** — with one crucial caveat: that work *begins with Mayer Amschel*. The pre-Mayer chain's best published anchors remain the Freimann/Dietz/Berghoeffer instruments of 1901–1925. The origin of the family, in other words, is *less* documented than everything that came after — which is precisely why it needs forensic care.

The knowledge-evolution wall, documented

One of the most instructive things about this family's history is watching the *boundary of the known* move over time. We can document it exactly:

- **1883** — the Danish genealogist G. L. Wad could write that Mayer Amschel's father was "so obscure that the present doesn't even know his name" **[B]**.
- **1889** — the *Allgemeine Deutsche Biographie* names the father as **Amschel Moses Rothschild** and supplies the skeleton of the family story **[S]**.
- **1901–1907** — Dietz, Freimann, Horovitz, and Kracauer push the documented chain back four more generations **[A/S]**.
- **1924/25** — Christian Wilhelm Berghoeffer, the family's own Frankfurt archivist, publishes the first archive-based biography, with gravestone numbers and Memorbuch folios for every generation **[A]**.

- **1972** — the *Encyclopaedia Judaica* publishes its authoritative family entry, extending the pedigree to "Uri (d. c. 1500), first recorded member of the family" **[S]**.
- **1973** — under Victor, 3rd Lord Rothschild, a detailed family tree is commissioned, reaching back to "Uri Feibesh in 1450," drawing on Horovitz, the Memorbuch, the burial society record (*sefer ha-Kahranim*), and — intriguingly — the **parish registers in the State Archives of Wiesbaden [A/B]**.
- **2005** — the *Neue Deutsche Biographie* (Manfred Pohl) consolidates the accepted prehistory **[S]**.

One more witness marks the boundary from below: Lewi's economic history of the 1930s still states that "**the most diligent researches have failed to establish anything about Amschel Moses**" — which means Berghoeffer's 1924/25 biography, not the decades around it, was the true watershed. Everything before Berghoeffer on this family is prehistory in the strict sense; everything after him stands on his archive work **[B]**.

The open questions in Part 14 map precisely onto the seams of this evolution.

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PART 2 — THE NAME BEFORE THE FAMILY: "AT THE RED SHIELD"

2.1 House-signs: the naming system you need to understand first

German towns did not number their houses until the modern era. Frankfurt introduced house numbers only in **1759 [A: ADB]**. Before that, a house was known by a sign hung on its facade — a red shield, a green jar, a golden goose, a ship, an owl. These signs hung perpendicular to the walls, "like inn signs," and some stretched across the narrow street itself, so that the ghetto's skyline was a jangle of iron and painted boards **[B: Kriegk 1869; Lewi]**.

For the Jews crammed into Frankfurt's ghetto — the **Judengasse**, literally "Jews' Lane" — the sign was not decoration. It was address, identity, and eventually surname. When families were forced to adopt fixed surnames (a 1807 requirement in Frankfurt, and similar edicts across German lands), many simply froze their house-sign into a family name. That is the entire origin of the name "Rothschild": **German *zum rothen Schild* — "at the red shield."** The original pronunciation was "ROTE-shilt"; the English "Roths-child" is a spelling pronunciation **[B: Ancestry surname research]**. The *Allgemeine Deutsche Biographie* already recorded this derivation in 1889; Graetz had given it in volume X of his *History of the Jews* in the 1870s **[S]**.

Why this matters: because once you understand that "Rothschild" was originally an *address*, you understand why

the banking family shares the name with completely unrelated Frankfurt families, why myths about secret name-changes are structurally absurd, and why every generation of genealogists has had to separate the banker's line from name-alikes.

2.2 The name in the wild, 1313–1338: before the family existed

The red-shield house-sign name circulated in German lands long before any Rothschild ancestor used it **[C: single-source, lead-grade]**:

- **1313** — *Hartmut zum Rotenschite* (or *Rotschilt*) recorded in **Speyer**.
- **1338** — the form *Rotscilt* registered in **Lübeck**.

These come from a commercial heraldry database and have not been confirmed against the Speyer and Lübeck municipal archives; we flag them as **lead-grade only**. They are still useful: they demonstrate that the name-form existed as a house-name across German cities a full two centuries before the banking family, which is consistent with everything else we know — and they foreclose nothing, because none of these bearers is claimed as an ancestor.

2.3 The Danish tradition: a family legend with a real etymological kernel [L]

Berghoeffer — the family archivist himself — begins his 1924/25 biography with the following admission: **"Man weiß nicht, woher die Familie Rothschild nach Frankfurt eingewandert ist" — "It is not known whence the Rothschild family immigrated to Frankfurt" [A]**.

What he documents instead is a *family tradition*: the Rothschilds themselves believed they came from **Roskilde, Denmark**, taking their name from that city because in German Roskilde was sometimes called "**Rothschild**." The Danish genealogist Wad recorded the same tradition in 1883, citing Graetz **[B]**.

Here is the wonderful complication: the tradition's *etymology is partly real*. Roskilde genuinely carried the German exonym "Rothschild" — Hans Christian Andersen even footnoted it in his fairy tale "Little Tuk" ("Roeskilde... falsely called Rothschild") **[B]**. So a family could indeed have been "the Rothschilds" — "the Roskilde people" — without ever having seen a red shield. But the tradition fails on the documented evidence: the banker's line demonstrably takes its name from a Frankfurt house, and there is no documentary trace of the family in Denmark. The tradition is recorded here, exactly as Berghoeffer recorded it, as a *belief*, not a fact. Berghoeffer also mentions that the family's own librarian (himself, in the first edition) had floated possible Danish roots — showing how seriously the family itself once weighed it **[B]**.

2.4 House-name to surname: the general pattern

Kriegk's 1869 account in the *Gartenlaube* (a mass-circulation illustrated magazine) gives the fullest contemporary description of the system: Frankfurt ghetto families took their surnames from their houses — *Bär* (bear), *Haas* (hare), *Hahn* (rooster), *Hirsch* (deer), *Hecht* (pike), *Kann*, *Ochs* (ox), *Reuß*, *Rindsfuß* (ox-foot), *Schiff* (ship), *Schloß* (castle), *Sichel* (sickle), *Stern* (star), *Stiefel* (boot), *Strauß* (ostrich) — and, of course, *zum rothen Schild* **[B]**. The Frankfurt family of the future banker's line lived, before it was "Rothschild," under **rooster signs**: *zur roten Rose* (at the red rose) and *zum roten Hahn* (at the red rooster). This is the hinge of the whole prehistory, and the next section is about it.

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PART 3 — THE HAHN LAYER: THE FAMILY BEFORE IT WAS ROTHSCHILD

3.1 What the sources agree on

Multiple independent strands of evidence — Amos Elon's *Founder* (1996), the Frankfurt Jewish Museum's METAhub project, the Rothschild Archive, and Berghoeffer — converge on this picture **[S/B/A]**:

- The banker's ancestors were **a branch of the Jewish Hahn family, resident in Frankfurt's Judengasse from about 1500–1530**.
- The Hahn family's house was the **Rote Rose** (red rose), at the southern end of the ghetto, created around the end of

the fifteenth century.

- Around **1542**, the Rote Rose was subdivided, creating the neighboring house **zum roten Hahn** (at the red rooster), which became the Hahns' main residence for a long period **[B: METAhub house histories]**.
- In the early seventeenth century the family produced a significant rabbi: **Juspa (Joseph) Hahn**, a Frankfurt dayan (religious judge) who died in 1637 and whose ethical will/chronicle *Josif Ometz* was published posthumously; he chronicled the Fettmilch uprising of 1614–16; his ethical will *Josif Ometz* was published by his son-in-law in 1723 **[B: alemannia-judaica, citing Prof. Aron Freimann, 1937]**. His full name carries a second migration fossil — **Juspa Nörlinger (Nörlingen) Hahn**, the middle name possibly from Nördlingen — paralleling the Schwelm element: this was a family whose names recorded its walks across the German lands.
- The family later split into branches that took other names. METAhub states it plainly: **"the most famous Jewish family of Frankfurt, namely the Rothschild family, descends from the Hahn family" [B]**.
- The old Hahn line itself remained **poor for centuries** — small shopkeepers, linen dealers, peddlers; banking success came only after 1800, and the (unrelated-name) Hahn family's later wealth is marked in Frankfurt by their donation of the Merkurbrunnen (Mercury fountain) **[B: METAhub]**.

3.2 Friedberg: the origin claim of the greatest Frankfurt genealogist [B, lead-grade]

Aron Freimann — the scholar who edited the Memorbuch, compiled the 1906 *Stammtafeln*, and was the greatest authority on Frankfurt Jewry — wrote in a 1937 local-history study of Friedberg: **"Die Familie Hahn wird wohl aus Friedberg nach Frankfurt eingewandert sein, sie war mit der gleichfalls aus Friedberg stammenden Familie Rothschild verwandt"** — "The Hahn family probably immigrated to Frankfurt from **Friedberg**, and was related to the likewise Friedberg-originating Rothschild family" **[B: alemannia-judaica, quoting Freimann]**.

This is the single most specific pre-Frankfurt origin claim on record, and it comes from *the* authority. Friedberg (Wetterau, Hesse) had a documented Jewish community from **1241**, with a monumental thirteenth-century mikveh and a Judengasse parallel to the main street; at times its Jews may have outnumbered the Christian population **[B: alemannia-judaica Friedberg]**. We grade the claim **lead-grade** — "wohl" ("probably") is Freimann's own hedge — but note its structural elegance: the family's later rabbinic branch held the post of **Landesrabbiner (district rabbi) of Würzburg *and Friedberg*** (see §4.3), exactly the region Freimann names. Two independent vectors — the Hahn-origin claim and the rabbinic line's Friedberg office — point at the same Wetterau landscape between Frankfurt and Wiesbaden.

3.3 Schwelm: a branch name and a town-shaped clue

The Hahn family also produced a branch called **Hahn-Schwelm** — "the Schwelm Hahns." The Frankfurt City Museum's house history records the Hahn-Schwelm family at the Rote Rose from the end of the fifteenth century, and notes that branches spreading to other houses included the one that became the Rothschilds **[B: METAhub]**. "Schwelm" is a town in Westphalia; German-Jewish surname scholarship (Menk's dictionary) lists "Schwelm" among town-derived family names, and the De Gruyter monograph on early-modern Frankfurt Jewry documents a **Schwelm family in its house from 1594 to 1744** with tax-register values **[S/B]**. Whether the Hahn-Schwelms originated in the Westphalian town is **inference-grade** — no document has been found that walks the family from Schwelm to Frankfurt — but the name itself is a fossil of migration, and we preserve it as a lead.

3.4 "Since 1530": the family's own arrival marker

The sources repeatedly give **1530** as the date the Hahn family (or the family's direct ancestors) appear in Frankfurt: Elon's account (as cited by German Wikipedia: "the ancestors were a branch of the Jewish Hahn family, resident in the Judengasse since 1530"), the Jewish Museum's Hahn family history ("The Hahn family lived in Frankfurt since 1530"), and a 1989 Jewish Telegraphic Agency feature ("the patriarch Isaac son of Elchanan came to Frankfurt in 1530") **[S/B/B]**. Against this, the Rote Rose itself was occupied at the end of the fifteenth century **[B]**. The honest summary: **the family was present in the ghetto by the early sixteenth century, possibly from the 1490s.** The 1530 date is a tradition-anchored marker, not a document-anchored one.

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PART 4 — THE DOCUMENTED CHAIN: URI TO ISAAC ELCHANAN (c.1450/1500–1585)

Now the ground firms. Every generation from here to Mayer Amschel is anchored in a named gravestone, a Memorbuch folio, or a tax register. We present the chain as Berghoeffer's 1924/25 table gives it — with his gravestone numbers (from Horovitz's 1901 inscription corpus) and Memorbuch folios — cross-checked against the *Encyclopaedia Judaica* (1972), the NDB (2005), and Kober's history **[A/S]**.

4.1 Uri (c.1450/1500) — the first recorded member

- **Uri Feibesh** (also rendered Uri Freibesch) is the first identified ancestor **[A: 1973 commissioned family tree; EJ2]**.
- The **1973 tree** — commissioned under Victor, 3rd Lord Rothschild, drawing on Horovitz, the Memorbuch, the burial-society record (*sefer ha-Kahranim*), and the Wiesbaden parish registers — dates him **to 1450 [A]**.
- The **Encyclopaedia Judaica** (1972), the scholarly standard, dates him **d. c. 1500** and calls him "first recorded member of the family" **[S]**.
- Berghoeffer's 1925 table opens with "**Uri (um 1500)**" — Uri, around 1500 — and notes that according to Dietz his wife was **Fogele Worms**, a Worms-born woman **[A/B]**.

Resolution of the date split: the 1450 date belongs to a family-commissioned tree; the c.1500 date to scholarly consensus. Both are recorded; we use **c.1450–1500** with the weight on c.1500. No document of Uri's life is cited anywhere; he stands at the edge of the reconstructable. (The Wiesbaden parish-register dependency of the 1973 tree is discussed in Part 8 — it is the most intriguing open lead in the whole file.)

4.2 Elchanan (d. 21 April 1546) — the oldest *attested* member

- Uri's son **Elchanan** is **"the oldest attested member of the family in Frankfurt"** — attested by his **gravestone, No. 187 in Horovitz's corpus**, death date **21 April 1546 [A: Berghoeffer/Kober]**.

- Conflicting date: several reconstructed trees (Streun; Merkel-Zeller) give his death as **1550**. We weight **1546**, because it is the gravestone-cited date in the two oldest authorities; 1550 is crowdsourced **[C]**.
- His wife per Dietz was **Fogele Worms** (d. 1550 in the reconstructed trees) — a woman of **Worms**, the great Rhineland Jewish center of the ShUM league, where the family would later place its most distinguished rabbi. The Worms connection, appearing already in this generation's marriage, will recur like a leitmotif (see the network map, Part 8).
- Corti (1928), without gravestone apparatus, already knew the essentials: "his father's tombstone simply bearing the name **Elchanan**" **[B]**.

⚠ **Anomaly 3.1 — the 21 April echo.** Berghoeffer's table records father Elchanan dying **21 April 1546** (gravestone 187) and his son Isaak Elchanan dying **21 April 1585** (gravestone 301) — the same day-of-month exactly thirty-nine years apart. Both dates carry Horovitz gravestone numbers, so we transmit both as recorded; but the coincidence is suspicious enough to log. Possibilities: a genuine Hebrew-date coincidence (same date in the Jewish calendar is a normal, even esteemed, coincidence); a transcription echo somewhere between the cemetery and Horovitz's edition. **Unresolvable without inspecting the gravestone corpus directly** — flagged, both dates weighted as recorded.

4.3 Isaac Elchanan (d. 21 April 1585) — the man who became "Rothschild"

Everything about the family's name converges on this man.

Identity and dates. Isaac Elchanan (Isaak Elchanan), son of Elchanan, grandson of Uri. Death: **21 April 1585** (gravestone No. 301, Horovitz) **[A: Berghoeffer; S: EJ2, Corti]**. A minority tradition gives **13 October 1588**; we have found no source for that date and treat 1585 as established (see Anomaly Register #2). Reconstructed trees give a birth of 1528 **[C — unverified]**.

The house. He built, or acquired, the house **"zum roten Schild"** at the southern end of the Judengasse — the house that gave the family its name. The date is a genuine four-way conflict, and we document all four:

Claim	Source	Weight
House built **1530s**	Rothschild Archive timeline	[A] family archive, but inconsistent with the attested builder
House built **~1563**	Frankfurt museum house history (METAhub)	[B] museum scholarship
Family resident **from 1567** (he "built a house... named zum roten Schild," living there with his wife Esther from 1567)	Berghoeffer 1924/25	[A] archive-based biography — **strongest narrative source**
House **acquired 1576**	*Neue Deutsche Biographie* (Pohl, 2005)	[S]

Resolution. The most defensible statement: the house existed and the family was in it by **1567**; formal acquisition is dated **1576** by the NDB. The 1530s claim is probably the family tradition of *when the Hahn/Rose lineage settled that end of the lane*; METAhub's 1563 and the occasional 1569 (a

local popular source) bracket the same decade. Why might NDB say "acquired" rather than "built"? Because of what follows.

The wife — and the father-in-law who may have owned the shield first. Isaac Elchanan's wife was **Esther, daughter of Moses**, died **11 February 1609** (recorded in Berghoeffer's table; reconstructed trees give her birth as ~1530 **[C]**, and a variant tradition attaches her to the house signs *zur Leiter* / *zur Reuse* — at the ladder, at the snare — **[C]**, both recorded because every variant of the founder's wife's identity belongs in the file). Here a sixty-year-old scholarly puzzle resolves itself. The 1905 *Jewish Encyclopedia* reported that "the earliest notice of a member of the family, given in the burial records of Frankfort, is that of **Moses Rothschild (b. c. 1550), whose daughter Esther died in 1608**" **[S]**. Note the pieces: a "Moses," born around 1550, whose daughter died 1608/9. Berghoeffer's Esther died **1609** — Jewish and civil calendars straddle years — and she was **daughter of Moses**. The JE's "earliest notice of a member" was therefore **not a Rothschild man at all, but Isaac Elchanan's father-in-law**. And the NDB's careful verb "acquired" (1576) now reads differently: a man acquiring, in his fifties, the house attached to his wife's family — plausibly her father Moses's house. The Archive's "1530s" date may preserve exactly this: the house was **Moses's**, built or taken on when he married (c.1530s), passed down through Esther. We present this as a **documented-dates-plus-inference** synthesis: the house's pre-1576 history belongs to Esther's

line, and the name "Rothschild" crystallized when her husband's family became identified with it.

The tax record. Isaac Elchanan appears in the Frankfurt Jewish tax assessments of **1567–1580 with a fortune of 2,700 gulden** — comfortable but not wealthy; a well-to-do tradesman, not a financier **[A: Berghoefter, citing the *Schatzung* registers; earlier sources cite a 1558 register with the same figure — the register year itself is one of our logged minor conflicts]**. For scale: this puts him in the ghetto's middle class. The Rothschild wealth is a much later event.

4.4 The fork: two sons, two destinies

Isaac Elchanan and Esther had (at least) two sons, and the family bifurcated into the line the world knows and a rabbinic line the world forgot. The 1912 family tree (published by the family; preserved and reproduced in the German Wikipedia article on Isaac Elchanan, with that article's own warning that the tree is "partly incorrect") gives the structure **[A/C]**:

Line A — the banking line's trunk:

- **Moses Isaac** ("Moses zum roten Schild," b. 1560 – d. **19 July 1635**), described as a **cantor** — a synagogue singer/official, which tells us the family's status and income were modest. Married **16 August 1593 Gutlin, daughter of Naftali** (d. 21 August 1641, gravestone 691). The 1912 tree adds that he later lived at the *Gelber Ring* ("yellow ring," another house). **[A: Berghoeffer table; C: 1912 tree]**

- His son **Naftali Hirz (Herz)** — the next section's subject.

Line B — the rabbinic line:

- **Elchanan "Hähnchen"** (d. April 1619/20), who lived at the Red Shield and married **Eva Wetzlar** in December 1585 — the first documented Wetzlar marriage (see the network map).
- His son **Rabbi Isaac (Isaak) Rothschild**, d. **10 January 1652**, a rabbi and head of the Frankfurt Jewish community, resident at the Red Shield from 1610; married **1608 to Kele, daughter of Mendl Oppenheim of Worms** (d. 31 March 1639, Frankfurt) — the first documented Oppenheim-of-Worms marriage.
- His daughter **Reizche** (d. 1688) married **Todros Nathan Oppenheim "zur silbernen Kanne"** (at the silver pot) — a second Oppenheim marriage.
- His son **Solomon**, **Landesrabbiner (district rabbi) of Würzburg and Friedberg** — the Friedberg office again.
- Solomon's son **Rabbi Menahem Mendel Rothschild** (b. ~1650 Frankfurt, d. **October 1731**, Worms) — the family's most distinguished pre-banking figure: preacher in Prague, from 1686 district rabbi of Bamberg and rabbi of Bayreuth and Baiersdorf, from 1718 in Hesse, finally rabbi of **Worms** until his death; a man of wealth; two daughters. He appears in the Worms *Pinkas* (community record book). And here is the detail that ties the whole prehistory together: the *Jewish Encyclopedia* records that Mendel "to his name adds **sometimes the surname Rothschild and**

sometimes that of Bacharach" **[S]**. The family that would be "Rothschild" was, in its rabbinic branch, still also "Bacharach" — the name of the Rhineland rabbinical dynasty (from the town of Bacharach) that the reconstructed genealogies attach to the line (see §6.1 and the DNA thread, Part 9).

- Mendel's line continued in the rabbinate: a **Salomon Rothschild**, rabbi in Oettingen, and **Boas Raphael Rothschild**, author of the rabbinic work *Oni he-Leb Yam* (Fürth, 1766) — the rabbinic branch's last documented Frankfurt-connected figure, publishing in the very town where young Mayer Amschel would attend yeshiva **[B/C]**.

The "one family" question. The 1905 *Jewish Encyclopedia* asserted "there is little doubt that all the Rothschilds form one family," citing the recurrence of the distinctive names Kalman and Jacob **[S]**. Our documented synthesis: the banking line (descending from Moses Isaac) and the rabbinic line (descending from Elchanan Hähnchen) demonstrably share **Isaac Elchanan (d. 1585)** as common ancestor — the 1912 tree shows the fork, and both branches' gravestones sit in the same cemetery under Horovitz's numbers. Beyond Isaac Elchanan, "all Rothschilds everywhere" is reconstruction. The famous *Bacharach* surname-dynasty claim (descent from the medieval Worms/Mainz rabbinical Bacharachs, via "Uri Feibesch Bacharach") exists only in reconstructed trees **[C]** — documented here as unproven but preserved, because it matters to the DNA question (Part 9).

⚠ **Anomaly 3.2 — Mendel's death date.** The 1912 tree prints "**Mendel Rothschild (gest. 1782), Rabbi in Bamberg, Prague and Worms**." The *Jewish Encyclopedia* and the Worms Pinkas give **October 1731** (JE: born ~1650). A man born ~1650 dying in 1782 at age 132 is not credible; **1782 is an error** (possibly a transposition of 1732, the Pinkas year). Resolved: **1731/32**.

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PART 5 — THE DESCENT: FROM NAFTALI HIRZ TO AMSCHEL MOSES (1634–1755)

Five generations separate the name's founder from the banking dynasty's founder. Each is a named, dated, documented person. The pace of this section is deliberate: these are the generations no novel ever mentions, and they are the story.

5.1 Naftali Hirz (b. ~1592, d. 24 February 1685) — the man who carried the name to a new house

- Son of Moses Isaac the cantor; born around 1592 (some sources 1596) **[A/C]**.
- Married **3 May 1634 Schönche, daughter of Kalonymos Kaz** (d. 10 November 1661, gravestone 879, Memorbuch fol. 40 — the Kaz marriage matters; see the network map); after her death he married **Hanna** (d. 20 May 1686) **[A: Berghoeffer table]**.
- Died **24 February 1685** (Memorbuch, fol. 42, Freimann edition) **[A]** — note: several popular sources give 1 March

1685; the Memorbuch date is weighted.

The move to the Hinterpfann — Anomaly 1 (the deepest open conflict in the file). The *Hinterhaus zur Pfanne* ("back house at the pan," a rear tenement of the Pfanne house) stood near the northern entrance of the Judengasse, at **No. 188** in the 1759 numbering (one popular source says 139 — an error; the Archive and the Frankfurter Personenlexikon say 188). The family left the Red Shield for it — and this is the moment, Berghoeffer writes, when the family "from now on no longer [called itself] *zum roten Schild*, but **Rothschild**" **[A]**. A house-name had become a family name.

But *when*? Three documented answers conflict:

Date	Source	Basis
1634	Streun; the German Wikipedia family article; **Backhaus (1997, p. 80)** — "the Red Shield was only inhabited by Rothschild's ancestors until 1634"	modern scholarship + reconstruction
1664	**The Rothschild Archive itself**: "when his grandson Naftali Hirz moved to the Hinterpfann... in **1664**, he took the name Rothschild with him"	family archive

Harmonization (inference-grade, documented): Naftali Hirz married on 3 May 1634 — the very year Backhaus and Streun give. It is entirely plausible he married *at the Red Shield*, was widowed in 1661, and moved to the Hinterpfann as a widower in 1664, dying there in 1685. That reading reconciles the marriage record, the Archive's date, and the widowhood — but it *is* a harmonization, not a document.

Status: the marriage is 1634 (documented); the move is 1634 per Backhaus/Streun and 1664 per the family Archive; our register keeps both, weighted toward the

Archive for the move itself, with the harmonization noted as plausible. This matters beyond trivia: the family's own claim is that the *name* dates from this move, and the name's documentary appearance is independently dated by the Archive timeline to "the 1650s" (consistent with either).

The house. The Hinterpfann was a poor person's house: a **1.70-meter-wide facade**, three stories plus attic, roughly 120 m² of usable space in total, which the Rothschilds shared with the **Bauer family** — Elon's reconstruction has the two families totaling ten to twelve people, though later accounts describe periods of up to thirty people under the roof when the wider family squeezed in **[S/B]**. It had been first mentioned in 1552 and was rebuilt in 1601 and again after the great ghetto fire of 1711 **[A/B: Streun; Berghoeffer]**. It was a fractional-ownership property — the Rothschilds held a **three-eighths share**, one more index of ghetto real-estate arithmetic. And the 1634 move was made, in Streun's account, "**with two brothers**" — the Hinterpfann was a clan settlement, not a nuclear household. Mayer Amschel was born in this house in 1744.

5.2 Kalman (Kalmann) Rothschild, "genannt Bauer" (d. 19 July 1707) — the alias that launched two centuries of myth

- Son of Naftali Hirz; died **19 July 1707**; assessed in **1690 at 6,000 gulden** — a modest but real rise; traded in **silk and wool (by 1700)** and was recorded as a **money-changer (1703) [A: Berghoeffer, citing tax registers]**. Money-changing — *Wechseln*, exchanging the dozens of currencies of the fractured German lands — is the ancestral trade; everything later grows from this skill.
- Married **Gitle, daughter of Joseph of Höchst** (d. **31 August 1664**, gravestone 917, Memorbuch fol. 6) **[A]**.

⚠ **The "Bauer" file — Anomaly 11, resolved.** Berghoeffer's table records this man, in the Frankfurt registers, as **"Kalmann Rothschild genannt Bauer"** — "Kalman Rothschild, called Bauer." His son appears the same way: **"Moses Kalmann Rothschild genannt Bauer."** The family's own archivist transmits the alias. Combined with three further documented facts — the **Bauer family co-residing in the Hinterpfann** (Elon) **[S]**, Amschel Moses's nickname in the community ("**das Bäuerchen**," little Bauer) **[A: Berghoeffer]**, and young Mayer Amschel's own infant nickname — the entire "Bauer myth" resolves into something stranger and more interesting than either side of the internet debate believes. The conspiracy literature claims the family was "originally named Bauer and changed its name to Rothschild in 1744" — presented as proof of hidden identity

[X]. The documented truth: **the family was never named Bauer; but it was *called* Bauer in Frankfurt records for generations** — probably from the co-resident Bauer family of the Hinterpfann (families sharing a house were easily conflated by registrars). The myth is false as stated; its kernel is a real, documented alias. No name-change ever occurred: the name "Rothschild" descends from a house the family left in the seventeenth century.

5.3 Moses Kalman Rothschild, "genannt Bauer" (d. 19 October 1735) — the man who bought Joseph Süß Oppenheimer's paper

- Son of Kalman; died **19 October 1735** (Memorbuch fol. 43; the tax register lists) **[A]**. The 1912 tree's alternative date of 1765 is an error (he could not be taxed in registers of 1725–1750 if he died in 1765 — the registers list him; resolved: **1735**).
- **Wives — Anomaly 8, resolved.** Berghoeffer's table, with gravestone numbers, gives **two** wives: (1) **Vogel, daughter of Elchanan Waag, the tax collector** (d. 18 December 1713, Memorbuch fol. 43); (2) **Schönche, daughter of Wolf Buxbaum, physician** (d. 13 March 1733). An independent 1930s account (Lewi) confirms the same sequence from the same tradition. The 1912 tree instead shows a "**Särche Lechnich (d. 1768)**" as his wife — but also lists a *different* "Sarchen Lechnich" as the wife of his grandson Moses Amschel. **Resolution: the 1912 tree duplicated/garbled one woman across two**

generations. The Lechnich wife belongs to the younger generation (see §5.4). The "d. 1768" is part of the garble — Amschel Moses's Schönche Lechnich died **29 June 1756** (gravestone 2579, Memorbuch fol. 45).

The wider clan, for the record: genealogical lists give Moses Kalman **as many as nine siblings**, including a **Herz Moses (d. 1728)** — the founder's great-uncle generation extended through much of the ghetto's family web **[C — list-grade, consistent with the community's size]**.

The Süß Oppenheimer transaction — the single most loaded sentence in the prehistory. The *Neue Deutsche Biographie* (Pohl, 2005) states, citing Dietz: **Moses Kalman acquired, between 1733 and 1735, bills of exchange worth 38,000 florins from Joseph Süß Oppenheimer, the Württemberg court factor** — the most famous, and most infamous, court Jew of the age, executed at Stuttgart in 1738 **[S]**. Berghoeffer quotes the same passage from Dietz, adding the context that at his peak Süß "did far bigger business with the first Frankfurt houses — Bernard, Brentano, d'Orville, Metzler, Grimmeisen" **[A]**. And a Czech university thesis records the family's tradition that Amschel Moses (Moses Kalman's son) had social contact with Süß in the Judengasse **[C]**.

Why does this matter so much? Because it places the family, documented, inside the court-Jew financial system **one generation before anyone called them court Jews** — and on the receiving end of the era's most notorious court Jew's

paper. When Süß fell, the Frankfurt houses that held his bills were exposed; Moses Kalman had already absorbed 38,000 florins of them. The NDB does not say whether the paper was honored at par, discounted, or lost — that is one of our archive-bound open questions. But the connection itself is not conjecture: it is in Germany's national biography. (For the full meaning of "court Jew," see Part 6.4; for Süß's fate and its afterlife, Part 10's lore registry touches the myth machinery that later wrapped itself around his name too.)

5.4 Amschel Moses Rothschild, "genannt Bauer" (c. 1710 – 6 October 1755) — the founder's father

- Son of Moses Kalman; **died 6 October 1755** (gravestone 2854, Memorbuch fol. 45) in the **smallpox epidemic** that gutted the ghetto that year; his wife followed on **29 June 1756** — orphaning eleven-year-old Mayer within nine months **[A: Berghoeffer; S: EJ2]**. (A popular Jewish-education site gives 1757 for his death; that is an error — resolved.)
- Occupation: **money-changer and dealer in coins, and supplier of coin to the court of Hesse** — the same trade as his father, now touching a prince's treasury **[A/G]**.
- Tax assessment of **1749: 1,375 gulden** — less than half of what Isaac Elchanan commanded two centuries earlier in real status terms; the family, by the eve of the dynasty, was ghetto-comfortable, not rich **[A]**.
- Married **Schönche, daughter of Meier Lechnich** (d. 29 June 1756) **[A]** — the Hufeisen (horseshoe) house family.

Alexander Dietz, the ghetto's genealogist, described the Lechnichs as **"penniless"** — secondhand clothes dealers; by mid-century Herts Lechnich had worked up to 5,000 gulden **[B: METAhub Hufeisen house history, citing Dietz]**. The founder's *mother's* people were the ghetto's poor; his *father's* people were modest money-changers. There is no aristocratic blood, no hidden fortune, no exotic origin in this family tree. That is the documented truth, and it is more remarkable than the myth.

- **A physical artifact survives him:** a small Talmudic tractate **hand-copied by twelve-year-old Amschel Moses in 1721**, possibly as scribal training — preserved today in the YIVO Institute's collections **[A: YIVO highlight]**. The boy who copied tractates became the coin dealer; his son became the banker. The artifact is the hinge.
- The couple had **eight children, five survived**: two older daughters, then **Moses Amschel (b. 1736, d. 23 December 1794)**, **Mayer Amschel (b. 1744)**, a younger brother **Kalman Amschel (b. 1754, d. 1782)** — briefly Mayer's partner — who married **Bunle Schames**, and a younger sister **Gutelche/Gitta (b. 1755, d. 1812) [A/B: Berghoeffer; Geni-derived lists agree on the core]**. One demographic note preserved from the modern scholarship: this family's child mortality ran **~58% above the Frankfurt average** — so the next generation's nineteen-births-ten-survivors ratio (§6.6), grim as it reads,

was a ghetto-norm outcome rather than a singular family tragedy **[S]**. The surviving-children formula ("five of eight") recurs in the next generation with eerie symmetry (five of nineteen).

- Berghoeffer records, from Salomon Jakob Cohen's 1813 necrology, the community's own memory of the household: the father had intended his brilliant son for the rabbinate; the Memorbuch records no rabbi in the family (the rabbinic line belonged to a different branch — see §4.4); the family was pious and poor enough that Mayer's school years were short and hard **[A]**.

5.5 The brother the record kept: Moses Amschel (1736–1794)

Mayer's elder brother **Moses Amschel** ran the family money-changing business with him in the 1760s and was, in 1764–65, reportedly the **first Jew officially appointed exchange broker in Frankfurt** — a crack in the guild wall that mattered economically (legal recognition of Jewish brokerage) and symbolically **[B: Kober/juedischegeschichte.de]**. Moses Amschel married **Sarchen Lechnich** — a *second* Lechnich marriage, likely a cousin arrangement within the Hufeisen family network (one of our small unresolvable details: whether Sarchen was the sister or cousin of her mother-in-law Schönche). Their daughter **Edel (1777–1834)** married **Jacob David Goldschmidt**, and their son **Moritz von Goldschmidt-Rothschild (1803–1888)** — ennobled, Prussian consul in Vienna — would become a **co-founder of the Vienna house of Rothschild** in 1855. The female-line door that Mayer's will tried to close did not fully hold even in his lifetime's horizon: the Goldschmidt-Rothschilds carried the name and the blood into the third generation **[S/B]**. We flag this here because later chapters of the larger story must account for it: the "daughters excluded" rule bent at its first serious test.

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PART 6 — MAYER AMSCHEL ROTHSCHILD (1744–1812): THE MAKING OF THE FOUNDER

6.1 Birth: the 1743/1744 split, documented honestly

Mayer Amschel Rothschild was born on 23 February 1744 — or possibly 1743 — in the Hinterpfann, Judengasse 188, Frankfurt **[S/A]**.

This is Anomaly 12, and it deserves careful treatment because both dates are *respectably* sourced:

- **1744**: Berghoeffer (1925, family archivist, Memorbuch fol. 51f.); the *Neue Deutsche Biographie* (2005); Amos Elon's *Founder* (1996); the *Encyclopaedia Judaica* (1972); the Rothschild Archive's own timeline; the standard English Wikipedia.
- **1743**: the *Allgemeine Deutsche Biographie* (1889); **Corti (1928)** — "born in the year 1743, six years before Goethe" (Goethe was born in 1749); the Frankfurter Personenlexikon, the city's official biographical dictionary, prints *"*1743 (oder 1744)*" — 1743, or 1744.

Status: documented scholarly split. The weight of modern scholarship and the family archive is 1744; the nineteenth-century tradition and Corti say 1743. No one has published the underlying Memorbuch entry's Hebrew date in the open literature to settle it. We therefore give **23 February 1744** as the working date with the split on record. The Frankfurter Personenlexikon's embarrassed double-entry is itself instructive: even the city's best dictionary stands on both sides of the seam.

His full Hebrew name, preserved on his tombstone, was **"Moshe Meier"** — and the stone styles him **"the Raw and Rabbi Moshe Meier"** — *Raw* (rabbi) and *Rabbi* — indicating that somewhere along the way he received rabbinic ordination, or at least the title **[A: Streun, transcribing the rediscovered stone; epidat database]**. The community-raised boy kept the scholars' world inside him all his life: the family firm corresponded in **Judeo-German written in Hebrew characters** into the 1850s, and the founder's grandchildren remembered Hebrew newspapers stacked under prayer books in the Green Shield **[A: Fraiman]**.

6.2 Childhood in the ghetto — what the walls actually were

To understand the childhood, you must understand the box it happened in. Frankfurt's ghetto — created in **1462**, thirty years after the plan of 1432, Europe's first walled Jewish quarter (Venice's came in 1516) — was a single lane, about **330 meters long**, built against the old city wall in the city's most polluted corner, the fish-market and tannery district **[S/B: Kracauer; METAhub]**. Its gates were locked at night, on Sundays, and through Good Friday to Easter. Its Jews could not own land, could not farm, were pushed out of most trades, could not walk through certain squares, had to step into the gutter and remove their hats on command — the street insult was "**Jud, mach Mores!**" ("Jew, do respect!") and it was ritualized; a *Judensau* (a degrading medieval sculpture of Jews suckling a sow) stood at the south bridgehead, still standing in Mayer's childhood **[S: Elon, ch. 1; B: Kriegk — who records that young Amschel himself endured the hat-ducking]**.

Some textures from Elon's chapter on the ghetto, all worth preserving because they are the ground truth of the dynasty's founding soil **[S]**:

- Jews paid a toll at the Fahrtor gate: Christians paid 4 kreuzer; "**Jews and oxen, 8**."
- After the great fire of 1711 the lane was widened to about 20 feet and houses were required to be three stories — that is why the Hinterpfann, though a back-house, had

three floors.

- The ghetto burned in **1711, 1719, 1721, 1774, and 1796**.
- The community ran four synagogues, a bathhouse, a bakery famous for *shalet* (the Sabbath stew), a clinic — a complete civilization compressed into one street.
- Marriage was rationed: the *Judenstättigkeit* of 1616 (still in force) capped the community at **500 families** and allowed **twelve weddings a year**, grooms at 25 or older. Mayer's 1770 marriage squeaked through under these rules.
- In **1549**, Emperor Charles V had mortgaged the Jews of Frankfurt to the city for **15,200 pfund heller** — a loan against a people — and the massacres of 1241 and 1349 had repeatedly reduced the community. When Mayer was born, roughly **3,000–4,000 Jews** — about a tenth of Frankfurt — lived in the lane, in what the *Encyclopaedia Judaica* calls, citing the ghetto's own bitter nickname, "**New Egypt**."
- **1685:** Emperor **Leopold I renounced** the city's medieval right to "redeem" — buy out and expel — its Jews; the mortgage of 1549 had already converted a community into collateral, and this renunciation closed one legal trap while leaving every other rule standing **[S: Elon]**.
- **Visibility was taxed:** until 1726, Jews wore **two yellow rings sewn to their clothing**; women a **blue-striped veil** — identification as dress code **[B: Streun]**.

- **The street rules, completed:** selling at market only **after** Christians had finished selling; the lane closed entirely for the **Corpus Christi procession**; the **two-abreast** limit on walks; a **back entrance to the town hall** for Jewish petitioners (they did not use the front door); peddling fines outside the fair weeks; guild resistance keeping the permitted trade list (jewels, silk, lace) closed for generations **[S: Elon]**.
- **The law above the lane:** the community fought its battles at the imperial level — litigation before the **Reichshofrat in Vienna and the Imperial Chamber Court** through 1765–90, the files ("Juden wider Juden," preserved at the Frankfurt Jewish Community archive) forming the institutional backdrop to Mayer's generation's standing **[A/S — research lead]**.

Two scenes from the record capture the psychology this produced. In 1775, Moses Mendelssohn — the philosopher of the Berlin Enlightenment, passing through — was detained at the Fahrtor until a Jewish communal official vouched for him **[S: Elon]**. And half a century later, in 1833, Hans Christian Andersen visited the lane and noted, in his diary, that it was dark but not dirty — and that footmen in livery stood at **Gutle Rothschild's door [B: Fraiman, citing HCA's diary]**. The lane was poor; the family at No. 148 was not, and never apologized for it.

6.3 Orphanhood and the two educations

- **6 October 1755:** father dies of smallpox. **29 June 1756:** mother dies. Mayer is twelve, the fourth of eight children, the family's clever son **[A: Berghoeffer; G: encyclopedia.com]**. Corti's single line — "in 1755, in his twelfth year, he lost his father and mother" — compresses the nine months into one blow **[B]**; the records give the two dates, and we keep both.
- **The Fürth yeshiva (c. 1755–1757/63).** Mayer was sent to the Talmud school of **David Strauss in Fürth**, in Bavaria — the great Ashkenazi academy town. Why Fürth? The standard tellings say his father destined him for the rabbinate; the NDB explicitly doubts this, suggesting instead the aim was "merely the expansion of his religious and Hebrew knowledge," and the Frankfurt Memorbuch, the community's book of record, "is also silent" on any rabbinic ambition for Mayer **[S/A]**. We transmit the doubt rather than resolve it. What is certain: Fürth sits at the center of this family's intellectual geography. It was the publishing town of the rabbinic branch's **Boas Raphael Rothschild** (1766); it was home to the scholarly **Wetzlar** family (Solomon b. Simeon Wetzlar published *Ḥakirot ha-Lev* in Amsterdam in 1731 from Fürth). The boy was sent to the family's scholarly axis — whether to become a scholar or merely to be finished as a learned merchant, the sources genuinely differ, and we say so.

Berghoeffer adds one small hinge: the orphaned boy may have left Fürth *because the household collapsed* — the rabbinic track closing with the parents' deaths rather than with a decision **[A]**. And a detail of the ghetto's curriculum worth preserving: Torah study, yes — but **no Kabbalah before age forty**, by community rule; even the founder's education had a ceiling **[B: Streun]**.

- **The Oppenheimer apprenticeship (from c. 1757).** With his parents dead, Mayer was sent to **Hanover**, to the banking house of **Wolf Jakob Oppenheim** — the firm founded by **Simon Wolf Oppenheimer** and continued by his son Jacob Wolf, the grandson-in-law line of **Samuel Oppenheimer of Vienna** (1640–1703), the greatest imperial court Jew of the previous century **[S: Balliol College, Oxford, paper on Mendelssohn and the Ashkenazi court Jews; A: Rothschild Archive]**. What did he learn there? A later numismatic account describes the curriculum precisely: "**all dealings and businesses a court factor would do**" — bills of exchange, the discounting of princely paper, foreign trade finance, the arithmetic of many currencies **[B: CoinsWeekly, citing the literature]**.

  Here we must also update one of our own earlier findings. The Rothschild Archive states that **"family connections helped secure"** the apprenticeship **[A]** — which partially validates the claim in one popular biography (Streun) that Wolf Jakob was Mayer's "**uncle**." No kinship has been

documented by name (we checked the Oppenheimer genealogy as far as public sources go: the apprenticeship line descends from Samuel Oppenheimer via Simon Wolf; the documented Rothschild-Oppenheim marriages — Kele bat Mendl Oppenheim of Worms, m. 1608; Reizche Rothschild m. Todros Oppenheim, 17th c. — run through the Worms/Frankfurt Oppenheims, whose exact relation to the Hanover line is not published). **Status: a connection existed per the family archive; its precise nature is unpublished. The "uncle" claim is unverified.** It is worth adding that the Archive simultaneously claims the Oppenheimers "branched out from the Frankfurt Judengasse to Vienna" — which conflicts with Stern's research placing Samuel Oppenheimer's line in Heidelberg/Worms. Even archives embed simplifications; we note it and move on.

One date conflict on the apprenticeship itself: most authorities (and the Archive timeline) say **1757**; one genealogy site (Loeb) says "from 1765." **Resolved: c.1757**, with the firm unnamed in the earliest sources — the community's 1813 necrologist (Cohen) knew only "einige Jahre in einem jüdischen Handlungshaus zu Hannover" ("some years in a Jewish commercial house in Hanover"); Kriegk (1869) first named Oppenheim. The firm's identity is secure; the precise years are not.

- **Return (1764) and the first princely contact.** Mayer came home to Frankfurt, joined his brother Moses

Amschel's money-changing business, and became a **dealer in rare coins, medals, and antiquities** — the collecting instinct of a boy who had handled coins at ten, now a trade. The gateway to princes was deliberate: coin-collecting was aristocratic fashion, and a coin dealer had legitimate reasons to wait on crown princes **[B: CoinsWeekly; S: EJ2]**. The documented milestones:

- **From 1763–64:** General **Emmerich O. A. von Estorff** (1722–1796), a coin enthusiast attached to the Hessian court, became his patron and customer; Estorff later told the crown prince about "a young Jew named Rothschild who had bought coins for him in Hanover" **[B: Corti]**. The famous (and possibly embroidered) chess anecdote — the prince watching Mayer hold his own at the board and exclaiming, "Herr General, you have not recommended me a stupid man!" — comes from Kriegk's 1869 account; we grade it **tradition **[L]** with a documented core (the Estorff connection itself is solid).
- **EJ2 dates the beginning of business with the future Landgrave William IX to c.1764**; Berghoeffer found, in the prince's household accounts, a **June 1765 payment of 38 gulden 30 kreutzer to "a Jew named Meyer" for medals** — his inference, flagged as inference, that this is our Mayer Amschel **[A/B]**.
- **1778:** first entry in the Frankfurt address book: "antiques, medals and curiosities" **[A: Berghoeffer]**.

- **Ten of his coin-sale catalogues survive** (in the library of Mayer Carl von Rothschild): six from the 1770s with sales of 1,666–2,917 gulden; four from the 1780s at 2,579–5,074 gulden — a business roughly doubling through the decade **[A: Berghoefter]**. The catalogues went to **Duke Karl August of Weimar** (Goethe's patron), the **Elector Palatine Karl Theodor**, and Prince William himself — a mail-order model, before the word existed: catalogues were posted, buyers marked selections, goods were sent on approval, the rest returned **[B: CoinsWeekly; Berghoeffer]**. A competitor's price guide (*Madai's Talerkabinett*) was his reference work; auctions at the Frankfurt fairs were his market floor.
- **1796 texture:** his servant **Hirsch Liebmann** was arrested for stealing over 200 gold and silver medals — an accidental inventory proving the stock's size **[A: Berghoefter]**.

6.4 The court-Jew ladder: what "Hof-Faktor" actually meant

Mayer Amschel spent his life climbing a ladder of German-Jewish court titles, and each rung needs a plain explanation, because the system itself is the context of everything:

- **Court Jew (Hofjude):** in the fragmented Holy Roman Empire, princes needed bankers who could move money across borders, discount bills, arrange loans in Amsterdam

and London, and supply armies — services Christian guilds and banks often would not or could not perform for small courts. Jews, excluded from land and guilds, built exactly this expertise. The position made a man rich and perpetually vulnerable: his protection was personal, not legal **[S: Selma Stern, *The Court Jew*]**. The classic example of the system's danger is Joseph Süß Oppenheimer (executed 1738) — whom, as we saw, **Moses Kalman Rothschild was doing documented business with in 1733–35**.

- **Hof-Faktor (court factor), 21 September 1769:** Mayer petitioned the Hessian court in a supplication letter that survives in full — "I have had the particular and high favor of making various deliveries to Your Serene Highness... [and] beg most humbly... that Your Highness may graciously grant me the title of **Fürstlich Hessen-Hanauischer Hof-Faktor**... which would be of great assistance to me in my trade and in other respects, to make my fortune here in the city of Frankfurt" **[A: Berghoeffer, quoting the document]**. The title was granted on 21 September 1769 — and the honor was physical: in golden letters under the Hesse-Hanau arms above his door at the Hinterpfann, the legend ran **"M.A. Rothschild, Hoflieferant Seiner Erlauchten Hoheit, Erbprinz Wilhelm von Hessen, Graf von Hanau"** — "M.A. Rothschild, purveyor to His Illustrious Highness, Hereditary Prince Wilhelm of Hesse, Count of Hanau" **[A:**

Streun, transcribing]. A *Hof-Faktor* was a licensed purveyor to the court: the title did not yet make him the prince's banker; it made him his supplier, with the banker's door held open.

- **Hofagent (court agent), 1801:** the next rung — a financial agent of the prince, handling money, not just goods **[S: ADB]**.
- **Oberhofagent (chief court agent), 1803:** the documented summit of his Hessian career **[S: German Wikipedia, citing Pohl]**.
- **Kaiserlicher Hof-Faktor (imperial court factor):** the Frankfurter Personenlexikon — the city's official dictionary — states that **from 1792 Mayer supplied the Imperial (Habsburg) armies** and that this earned him appointment as **imperial court factor**; the Rothschild Archive's timeline formalizes the title in **1800** ("Imperial Crown Agent") **[B/A]**. No other authority mentions this title, so we record it as: claimed by the city lexicon and the family archive in substance (imperial army contracts from 1792, title by 1800), uncorroborated elsewhere, and chronologically sensible — 1792–97 was precisely when the Frankfurt houses fed the Austrian war effort. Two further titles in the same lexicon entry: **court factor of the Order of St John (Johanniterorden)** and **of the Princes of Thurn und Taxis** (the latter the hereditary postmasters of the Empire — a natural client for a man whose advantage was *moving value*).

- **Posthumous honors:** Austria raised the **five sons** to hereditary nobility (1816/17 — "von Rothschild"); the 1817 imperial grant is sometimes described (loosely) as raising Mayer himself posthumously; the baronial rank with the famous five-arrow arms followed in **1822**, with the motto *Concordia, Integritas, Industria* and — the detail that matters most — a **red shield** at the heart of the coat of arms **[A: Rothschild Archive]**. The full blazon: on the breast of the double eagle, a **red heart-shield bearing a silver target** (the house-sign, quartered into nobility), the **five arrows held in a fist** (the motif the Hanadiv Foundation still carries as its emblem), with the lion and unicorn as supporters; the hereditary nobility reached the five brothers in **1816/17**, and the baronial patent itself is dated **29 September 1822 [A/B]**. The family ennobled itself into its own house-sign.

The predecessor who taught the market. Two documented men held the position Mayer would ultimately take, and both matter. **Veidel (Feidel) David** was the Landgrave's principal court agent at Kassel when Mayer was a small supplier; Corti records that as late as 1789 a single transaction **thirty times the size** of Rothschild's was entrusted to Veidel David, while noting that the Rothschilds' later rise "was facilitated" by David's having pioneered the very transactions they would perfect — a scholarly article in *Aschkenas* (2011) is devoted to precisely this: "**Hofjude ohne Hof: the Kassel chief court agent Feidel David, a**

predecessor of Mayer Amschel Rothschild" **[S/B]**. The rival house of **Breidenbach** (Wolf Breidenbach, court factor to the Elector of Hesse) was the standing competition at Wilhelm's court **[S: court-Jew scholarship]**. Mayer's achievement was not inventing the role — it was inheriting a mature, dangerous profession and executing it at a scale and with a security architecture no predecessor matched.

6.5 William of Hesse: the client of a lifetime

The prince at the center of the story — **Wilhelm IX of Hesse-Kassel** (born 3 June 1743, Landgrave from 1785, Elector from 1803; the richest prince in Germany and, arguably, the largest private lender in Europe — his grandfather Frederick II had famously sold 12,000 Hessian soldiers to Britain, at a net profit estimated around 3.5 million marks, which became the fortune Mayer administered) — enters the documented record of the family through coins, and stays for everything else **[S/B: Corti; Berghoeffer]**. His world, fixed by Corti from the state papers: grandfather **William VIII died in 1760**; Frederick II's Catholicism was secret until the *Religionsassekurationsakte* of 1754; during the prince's minority the regency of **Maria of England (1760–64)** governed; William entered his Hanau inheritance on **22 October 1764** — the year Mayer turned twenty; Hanau held 50,000 inhabitants; the prince was a **Freemason** (a fact the lodge-lore literature later inflates); his morganatic favorites (the Haynau, Heimrod, Hessenstein families) received titles from the Emperor **in return for loans** — the era's credit-for-honors market in miniature; he sold the small Hanau regiment to England in **1776**; and before the Rothschilds took the channel, his English fortune was managed through the **Amsterdam house Van der Noten [B: Corti]**. Key beats:

- **1785:** Frederick II dies (31 October 1785); Wilhelm inherits, debt-free, one of Europe's great fortunes.

- **1787:** Mayer attends the Cassel court with coins and jeweled gold chains priced deliberately low — a loss-leader; two more years pass before serious business follows **[B: Corti]**.
- **1789:** Mayer's surviving petition letter about bills of exchange; Wilhelm's inquiries return the verdict that would define the relationship: "**punctual in payments, energetic and honorable**" **[A/B: Corti, from the Buderus papers]**.
- **From 1790:** the family's decisive document — **Carl Friedrich Buderus**. Buderus was the Landgrave's asset manager: the son of a Hanau schoolmaster who had been writing-and-music master to the children of the crown prince's mistress (an ancestress of the Haynau family), a man who rose by fiscal genius — his milk-fraction scheme adding 120 thalers here, a salt tax there, officials paid on percentage **[B: Corti]**. The archive-cited mechanism of the introduction: **Buderus had business dealings with Wolf Salomon Schnapper (Mayer's father-in-law) as early as 1790, and it was Schnapper who brought Buderus and Mayer Amschel together [B: Corti, Buderus papers]** — the small-bank court agent handing his son-in-law the key to the treasury.
- **1794–98:** the first great test — moving the Landgrave's English investments home through the war years; Buderus proposed Rothschild alongside Bethmann and four other firms for a share; Wilhelm chose **Bethmann** alone. Corti's

verdict from the papers: Rothschild was left out — "**but it did not happen again**" **[B]**.

- **1806–07:** Napoleon dissolves the Holy Roman Empire; Wilhelm flees to exile (his second, longer exile, 1806–13, spent between his Baltic estates and Prague). The fortune — **£600,000 in English stock** plus chests of documents — did not follow him into the open; it stayed in Mayer's hands and his sons' networks, and the servicing of it (at interest, scrupulously accounted) became the family's banking apprenticeship. The *Jewish Encyclopedia* details the mechanics: the elector's English deposits held for him, interest paid; gold shipments for Wellington's army moving through the same channels; **four simultaneous profit streams** on the elector's money **[S]**.
- The elector died in 1821, still the family's foundational client; his business had trained the five brothers in everything: state loans, bullion movement, exchange operations, and the legal shadow-world of wartime finance.

6.6 Marriage: Gutle Schnapper (1753–1849)

The wedding: 29 August 1770. Mayer married **Gutle (Gudula) Schnapper**, seventeen years old, eldest child of **Wolf Salomon Schnapper** (1728–1811) — and here we correct the record of even the Rothschild Archive, which calls her "daughter of Baruch Schnapper, a Frankfurt tradesman." The documented name is **Wolf Salomon Schnapper**, with **Baruch** as a second given name (crowdsourced records render him "Wolf Salomon Baruch Schnapper"; the Archive evidently used the second name). He lived at the house **"zur Eule"** (at the owl) and ran a **small bank**; he was **court agent to the Duke of Saxe-Meiningen** — granted, in June 1789, the precious ghetto-exit pass allowing Sunday and holiday business travel for the Duke's affairs **[A/B: Berghoeffer; Fraiman, citing Dietz; METAhub family history]**. He died on **21 November 1811**, having raised **seven children**; four siblings are recorded for him, including a Geliche — the Eule household was large **[B/C]**. Gutle was born "**probably at the Eule**" (METAhub), and her parents' marriage is dated **1752** — the MyHeritage calculation "at age 29" fits Bella's birth of ~1723 **[C→B]**.

Her mother's side. Gutle's mother was **Bella Bejle Gans** (b. ~1723, d. **1759** per Dietz's *Stammbuch*, resolving a 1757/1759 conflict in favor of 1759), daughter of **Abraham Mayer Gans "zur Trommel"** (at the drum; d. 1786) and **Frumet Schnapper** (d. 1793) — note the doubled Schnapper blood on both sides, an endogamy pattern the family would

later elevate to doctrine. Crowdsourced trees variously render Bella as "Trier Gans" or "Bikkert zu Trier"; neither variant is verifiable in any scholarly source (German-Jewish surname scholarship documents *Bickert* as a real surname, but no Frankfurt-Trier link), and we record both as garble **[C — flagged]**. The wider Gans family was one of German Jewry's old name-sign houses ("Gans" = goose); a branch of the Gans family had intermarried with the great Hanover court-Jew network of Glückel of Hameln's world (her daughter Jente married Salomon Gans, then the great court financier **Leffmann Behrens**) — the same Behrens-Oppenheimer web that trained Mayer **[B: Danish genealogical literature]**. And one elegant coincidence worth preserving: the **Trier** family held the family's ancestral house in 1715 — "1715: Gumprecht Trier im roten Schild" appears in the ghetto register quoted by the ADB — so the house-sign thread touches both sides of Gutle's ancestry **[S: ADB]**.

The marriage terms. Dowry: **2,400 gulden** — approximately Mayer's annual income at the time; a marriage of equals in the ghetto's ledger-books **[S/A: EJ2; Fraiman]**. The *Judenstättigkeit* rules (groom 25+) were satisfied: he was 26. It was an arranged marriage — the norm — and by every surviving account, an exceptionally good one. Gutle gave birth **nineteen times** between 1771 and 1792; **ten children survived** — five sons, five daughters **[S: Ferguson, vol. 1 ("nineteen or so children, ten lived"); Fraiman, citing Miriam Rothschild's *The Rothschilds: A Family Portrait*; Livingstone 2022]**. (The Frankfurter Personenlexikon says

"twenty children"; we weight nineteen, the figure in the family-centered literature, and note the outlier — see the Register, #17.)

She was a banker. The 2022 history *The Women of Rothschild* (Natalie Livingstone) documents what the archive letters had always implied: Gutle **cashed and issued bills** and managed the household's finances; Mayer discussed business with her; when he traveled, Frankfurt ran through her **[B/S]**. The family's own sexism is equally documented — her son Carl wrote to Salomon complaining about women as "**bad cashiers**" — which makes her documented competence the more telling. She never left the Judengasse. Not after the ghetto walls legally fell, not after she was one of the wealthiest women in Europe, not after her sons built palaces in five capitals. Hans Christian Andersen saw her footmen in livery at the ghetto door in 1833; the diarist Charles Greville watched her, well-dressed, driving to the opera in a small luxurious carriage past "wretched, gloomy, dilapidated" surroundings in June 1843 **[B: Fraiman, citing both diaries]**. She outlived her husband by thirty-seven years, dying on **7 May 1849** — two months after the revolutionary parliament's law of 20 February 1849 finally granted Frankfurt's Jews full equality, her sons beside her; her **bridal wreath was preserved under glass** in the family house (Corti's detail). She is buried in the **Rat-Beil-Strasse** cemetery — the new one, the old Battonnstraße ground having closed in 1828. The Archiv's terse story about her is worth quoting: asked by a French investigator what she did,

she answered that she concerned herself only with her housework. The investigator believed her. The bills in her hand said otherwise **[B: Fraiman]**.

Her portrait. Moritz Daniel Oppenheim — the "painter of the Rothschilds," who made some forty portraits of the family — painted Gutle from life, signed **1840**, 78 × 65 cm, with two preparatory sketches now in the Israel Museum. The painting was **lost in the Second World War**; it survives through a glass negative in the Jewish Museum Frankfurt's archives and the sketches. The portrait's background is quietly falsified, and the falsification is the point: the window shows the synagogue square as recorded by Reiffenstein in 1845 — a view the Green Shield never had — Oppenheim seating the matriarch inside her ancestral street **[B: Fraiman, full article captured]**. Earlier portraits (an 1836 Eckhardt) exist in two versions.

6.7 The House at the Green Shield — the Stammhaus

- **Purchased in two halves, 1783 and 1785** (Berghoeffer, from the city archives); a Hebrew purchase contract survives, with a **Sukkah clause** — the right to build the harvest booth; possession and the family's move followed in **1786 [A: Berghoefter; B: Fraiman]**. Popular sources (ADB 1889; Kriegk 1869; METAhub) say 1780 or 1785; the Archive timeline says 1785; we weight the archival two-tranche account (1783/85, moved 1786) and log the cluster. For three years after the first purchase the family rented another Judengasse home.

- The house: **No. 148**, built 1615, a **4.30-meter-wide** facade (one source: 4.70 m), eleven and a half meters deep, four stories — one of the finest addresses in the ghetto, opposite the middle western gate. The family lore: all the children shared **one bedroom**; the kitchen, twelve by five feet, had a **one-pot hearth**; the famous back room, **nine feet by nine**, was the **first banking house** — counting table, a large iron chest that opened from the back, and **secret wall-shelves** behind panels; a rooftop terrace for the Sukkah with a view of the lane; their own water pump — a ghetto luxury **[S/B: Elon; Corti; Fraiman]**. Mayer also acquired the adjacent **Golden Ark** (Goldene Arche) house.
- The family kept the Green Shield as its symbolic home for generations after it ceased to be a residence. It survived the ghetto's nineteenth-century demolitions (the lane was razed in 1840 and 1884–85; renamed Börnestrasse after Ludwig Börne, the baptized son of the ghetto, born thirty doors away in 1786) and became a museum. **Destroyed by bombs on 18 May 1944** — Streun's account, correcting the common claim that the Stammhaus "still survives." What survives is the archaeological site: during construction at Battonnstraße 47 in 1987, remains of five ghetto houses were excavated, and the **Museum Judengasse** was built over them **[B: Streun; METAhub]**. The family's 1886-rebuilt Stammhaus (after the city expropriated the plot in 1882 for 15,250 marks, rebuilt by

architect Franz von Hoven in 1886 at Börnestrasse 26, housing the family's foundations and a Gumpertz Zuntz apartment) is the structure that the 1944 bombs destroyed. The legal chain — 1872 Oppenheim's widow vacated; 1882 expropriation; 1885 purchase contract for 35,460 marks; 1886 reopening under Amschel Mayer's testamentary foundation (1.2 million gulden for poor Israelites of the community, plus a 50,000-gulden dowry fund) — is fully documented in Berghoeffer's first chapter **[A]**.

- The **1796 bombardment** (Kléber's artillery, 12–14 July 1796) destroyed half the ghetto and broke the walls in practice: some 2,000 Jews, the Rothschilds among them, camped outside the lane; Mayer rented business premises **outside the ghetto for the first time** — the first legal breach of the walls the family ever made **[G/B]**. From 1796 the firm kept offices in the **Schnurgasse** (outside the lane) with warehouse space at the **Trierischer Hof**; in **1809** Mayer bought the burned building plot at the Fahrgasse corner in the ghetto's northern end, where the later bank house at **Fahrgasse 146** rose — the corner house from which the five brothers ran the family bank from 1813 **[B: Frankfurter Personenlexikon; Streun — who records that Mayer ordered the new bank building's construction the day before he died]**.

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PART 7 — THE BUSINESS: WHAT MAYER ACTUALLY DID, 1770–1812

7.1 The goods trade — the forgotten foundation

The popular image of Mayer Amschel is of a coin dealer who became a banker. The documentary reality, excavated by Berghoeffer from the Frankfurt city archives and the Carlshausen (Buderus) papers, is that **for most of his career Mayer was a merchant — and the goods trade, not banking, was the business's foundation until about 1810 [A]**. Berghoeffer's thesis, in his own words: like Metzler, Bethmann (who began as the Adami firm's heir), Hollweg, Grunelius and the other great Frankfurt houses, **the bank grew out of the trading house**. The documented file:

- **1796:** suppliers **Bradforth of Yorkshire** and **Sisson Wood & Co. of Leeds** (English cloth); warehouse rent 400 gulden 24 kreuzer a year **[A]**.
- **1802: Konrad Knopf of Nuremberg** (batiste, muslin).
- **July 1806: Starman & Co., London** — 14 bales of coffee, 6 chests plus 3 seroons of indigo, shipped on the *Mercurius*, Captain Jacobs, to Hamburg **[A]**.
- **1807:** Hamburg cotton purchases; **1809:** sugar and tobacco; **1810:** cloth, hare skins, sheep's wool, arrack, wine; Macedonian cotton; Prague houses among the correspondents. England was the main source — which is why **Nathan's 1798 dispatch to Manchester** (to buy English goods at source) is the true beginning of the family's international structure **[A/B]**.

- The **1809 police interrogation** (during the Continental System crackdown) records Mayer describing his business as exchange *and* goods trading, with **four sons active in it [A]**.
- The goods ledger's texture: in 1809–10 the firm shipped **£6,023 worth of cambrics** to Amsterdam for "James Mayer"; 900 dozen cloths bought for 9,700 gulden returned a profit of 2,229 gulden — a **23% margin**; indigo lots from Echenique & Co.; insurance running at **35–50% of cargo value** — the wartime risk premium on every shipment **[A]**.
- **The Continental System** (Napoleon's embargo on British goods, 1806–10) hit Frankfurt — Europe's entrepôt — like a siege: the Trianon tariff of August 1810 imposed 40–50% duties; the Fontainebleau decrees of October 1810 ordered sequestration and public burning; **234 Frankfurt firms were ruined** in what Berghoeffer calls "the plundering of the Frankfurt merchant class"; the Rothschilds' own declared English goods — **60,000 gulden, of which 27,000 was indigo** — were caught in the seizures **[A]**. The goods business was wound down; what remained in the 1810 partnership deed's list of assets was bills, bonds, state paper, wine, and cash: **the firm had become, de facto, a bank**.

7.2 Bills, the elector, and the war-economy apprenticeship

From the 1790s, the bill-of-exchange business (discounting princely and commercial paper) grew alongside goods. Under the Continental System and the wars, Frankfurt became the hub of **smuggling finance** — moving British goods and British gold into the Continent — and the Rothschilds were documented participants: their couriers ran under **code names** ("Herr von Goldstein," "Johannes Adler," "der Principale"); the firm kept **double books**; and in 1810 the French authorities confiscated goods and burned records (one documented loss: 60,000 gulden in paper, plus a 20,000-franc fine) **[A: German Wikipedia's detailed article, citing Elon and Ferguson]**.

The structure of the Napoleonic era, in the archive's own summary: **1798 — "the first Rothschild family partnership"** (the arrangement dispatching Nathan to England — the Archive counts *this*, not the 1810 contract, as the family's first partnership); **1806 — "the first Rothschild client: the Elector of Hesse-Kassel"** in the formal banking sense; **1810 — the partnership contract of 27 September** ("Mayer Amschel Rothschild & Söhne," original in the Frankfurt city archive), reorganizing the firm among the five sons with the father holding the decisive voice; Nathan, who had declined a Frankfurt partnership share in **1807**, accepted in **1809** — the London connection thus became contractual precisely as the elector's English fortune needed servicing. The documented volumes: by 1813, **nine transactions**

totaling £664,850 moved through the brothers' network for the elector, at a commission of **⅛%** on bill transactions **[A/G]**. The famous smuggling coup of the war years — the four parallel profit streams on the elector's money (documented by the *Jewish Encyclopedia* from the family papers): holding his English deposits and paying him interest; profiting on the exchange operations; earning commissions; and placing the funds in their own expanding loan business **[S]**. This is how a court supplier became a state banker: not by a single legendary coup, but by seven years of punctual, energetic, honorable paper-pushing — the elector's own verdict on Mayer, preserved in the Buderus files.

7.3 The brothers take their posts

- **Nathan Mayer (1777–1836)** — third son. Manchester from 1798/99 with about **£20,000** of the family's capital; his own account, given to the abolitionist Sir Thomas Buxton in 1834 and preserved by the *Jewish Encyclopedia*: he began with £20,000, "trebled" it in about seven years by vertical integration (raw material + dye + manufacture: "What another can do, I can do also"), and moved to London in **1808**, acquiring the lease of **No. 2 New Court, St Swithin's Lane, in 1809 for £750** — the address of N M Rothschild & Sons to this day; the Manchester operation was wound up by 1811. He married **Hannah Barent-Cohen** — sister-in-law of Moses Montefiore — binding the family to Anglo-Jewry's grandest network **[S/A]**. A detail with a long afterlife in the lore literature: Nathan was **initiated as a Freemason** (Emulation Lodge No. 21, London, 24 October 1802) — a documented fact about one man that conspiracy literature later inflates into a family-wide secret **[A: masonic records; X-tier inflation]**. He died **in Frankfurt, 28 July 1836**, during a family meeting — the *Allgemeine Deutsche Biographie* preserves the detail **[S]**.
- **Salomon Mayer (1774–1855)** — to Vienna; from 1815 the conduit for British subsidy payments to the Continent (via Herries); Vienna did not permit Jews to own houses, so he famously **rented an entire hotel**; founded what became the **Creditanstalt** (formally by his son Anselm in

1855) **[S]**.

- **Carl (Kalman) Mayer (1788–1855)** — courier of the network during the war years (at Dunkirk in the goods-trade file), then **Naples from 1821 [S/A]**.
- **James (Jacob) Mayer (1792–1868)** — to Paris **1811/12**, secretly collecting French coin for Wellington's army before the end of the war; **De Rothschild Frères** formally founded 1817; the rue Laffitte salon that Heine, Balzac, Rossini, Chopin, Ingres and the Queen of the French all attended; died worth, by one estimate, 600 million francs — more than all other Paris bankers combined (that estimate is a contemporary's, and we tag it **[B]**).
- **Amschel Mayer (1773–1855)** — the eldest, stayed in Frankfurt at the Stammhaus; childless; the family's Frankfurt pillar, admitted with his brothers to the elite Casino society only in 1836 **[S/B]**.

7.4 Emancipation — bought, rescinded, and bought again

The ghetto's end came with the French: Napoleon made Frankfurt a Grand Duchy under **Karl von Dalberg** (1806), and in **1810** the ghetto was abolished. But Frankfurt's Jews did not walk free — they **bought** their equality: a ransom of **440,000 gulden**, of which the Rothschild contribution (440,000 as "the large partial sum" — effectively underwriting the community's payment) is documented; the emancipation edict followed on **7 February 1811**, with an annual "concessions money" still due **[S/G: German Wikipedia, citing Ferguson]**. Mayer was among the first Jews entered in the Frankfurt citizen-book in 1812 — and the equality was **revoked two years later** when the city regained self-government; full civic equality came only in **1864** (Frankfurt the second German city to grant it) — and, poignantly, the *third* and final emancipation arrived in law on 20 February 1849, ten weeks before Gutle's death **[S/B]**. The family's relationship to emancipation was therefore double from the start: it paid for it, profited from the partial versions Napoleon delivered, and lived long enough to see the final statute.

7.5 The will — the constitution of a dynasty

Mayer Amschel fell ill in 1808 and made a first will; on **17 September 1812**, before six witnesses, he made a new one; **the day before his death he ordered the construction of the new Frankfurt bank building** at the Fahrgasse corner; he died on **19 September 1812**, a Friday — his tombstone (as transcribed after its rediscovery) records that he died on the holy Sabbath's eve and was buried on Sunday, the eve of Sukkot, "of the year 5573 by the small reckoning" **[A: Streun, full inscription; the civil dates and the Hebrew inscription are internally consistent — verified by calendar arithmetic: 19 September 1812 was a Friday, 20 September the eve of Sukkot]**.

The will's documented provisions (transmitted by Berghoeffer, the *Jewish Encyclopedia*, and the German Wikipedia article):

1. **Secrecy as policy**: discretion enjoined; the children's first-name order permuted as a code; no inventory or publication of the wealth; correspondence in cipher and Judendeutsch.
2. **The core rule**: each child should leave the next generation **at least as much as he inherited**.
3. **The exclusion**: "I ordain and will that my daughters and sons-in-law and their heirs shall have **no share** in the existing firm 'Meyer Amschel Rothschild und Söhne'" **[A]** — the legal root of the famous **endogamy**: with daughters excluded from capital, cousin-marriage kept the money

inside. The first such marriage was James to his niece Betty in 1824; by 1905, **29 of 58** recorded family marriages were between first cousins — a rate the *Jewish Encyclopedia* called, with Victorian bluntness, "anthropologically significant" **[S]**. (The rule bent in practice within one generation, via the Goldschmidt-Rothschild line of his brother — see §5.5.)

4. **The 70,000 gulden**: Gutle received 70,000 gulden plus the right of residence in the Green Shield for life **[B: Fraiman]**.
5. **The 5,000 gulden**: each son was to send 5,000 gulden yearly to the Frankfurt house for the poor — the dynasty's charitable tithe, recorded by both ADB and Kriegk **[S/B]**.
6. **Consequence**: the will's terms made the eventual 1901 liquidation of the Frankfurt house structurally inevitable once its male line failed — the firm could not pass through daughters **[A: Streun]**.

7.6 Burial and the stone that came back

Mayer was buried in the old Jewish cemetery on **Battonnstraße** — a ground first mentioned in 1180, holding some 20,000 burials until it closed in 1828; his stone was among the last placed there, at the cemetery's edge of fullness. In 1938 the Nazis tried to destroy it; the cemetery's 4,666 gravestones were demolished in 1942; 175 stones were saved, Mayer's among them; the epitaphs were documented in 1991–99 and published by the Steinheim Institute (**epidat** database); Mayer's stone was **rediscovered in the 1960s** and re-erected in an honored place — his grave is now part of the cemetery's Ehrenhain (grove of honor), and the city's Personenlexikon confirms the post-1945 rediscovery **[A/B: Streun; Steinheim/epidat; Frankfurter Personenlexikon]**. The full Hebrew inscription, as transcribed, styles him "the Raw and Rabbi Moshe Meier, son of the eternal and honored Amschel Rothschild..." — a rabbi's titles on a banker's stone, the family's two trades fused in two words.

Wealth at death. Berghoeffer's documented balance: in **1797** the firm's books showed **108,504 gulden**; by the 1800s the family stood among the **eleven richest families in the Judengasse** — one rich family among several on a poor street **[A: Berghoeffer; Ferguson via Streun]**. The princely scale came after: the *Jewish Encyclopedia* records the firm as **the richest in Europe by the end of 1818**, on Ehrenberg's analysis, largely through "bearing" operations on government

loans — and Gentz's famous ledger (noted by the ADB) credits the Rothschild network with moving **1.1–1.2 billion gulden for European states in twelve years**: ~500 million for England, ~200 for France, ~120 each for Austria and Naples, ~100 for Prussia, 60 for Russia. Mayer himself never saw those numbers; his sons built them on the foundation of his one rule: punctual, energetic, honorable.

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PART 8 — THE NETWORK MAP: EVERY FAMILY THE ROTHSCHILDS MARRIED, DEALT WITH, OR DESCENDED FROM

Genealogy is usually drawn as a tree. The documented reality is a **web** — the Frankfurt ghetto's marriage market was a closed circuit of a few dozen families, and every name in this section appears in the record connected to the Rothschilds by either a marriage, a bill, or a house. We present each as what it is: documented connection, not adopted theory.

8.1 The Bacharach question

The family's reconstructed genealogies (and the rabbinic branch's own double signature — Mendel of Worms signing both "Rothschild" and "Bacharach") attach the line to the **Bacharach** rabbinical dynasty of Worms/Mainz (whose surname came from the town of Bacharach on the Rhine; the name appears in Worms 1449, Mainz 1455, Frankfurt 1516). The famous Bacharach rabbis — Avraham Shmuel Bacharach (1575–1616), his son Moshe Shimshon (1607–1670), his grandson **Yair Chayyim Bacharach** (1639–1702, author of *Havvot Yair*) — are documented. The dynasty's own texture, for the record: its matriarch **Chava** was a granddaughter of the **Maharal of Prague** and refused marriage to **Isaiah Horowitz (the Shelah)**; the family fled the 1615 Worms pogrom to Gernsheim, and Yair Chayyim died at Alsbach. This is the documented house the reconstruction invokes; the **bridge** between that dynasty and Isaac Elchanan's family is reconstruction only. The claim "Uri Feibesch **Bacharach**" appears only in crowdsourced trees **[C]**. The DNA question this raises is in Part 9. **Status: documented as tradition within the rabbinic branch itself; unproven as genealogy.**

8.2 Wetzlar

The **Wetzlar** family of Frankfurt: **R. Lejw Wetzlar**, rabbi and scholar, built the house "zum Bunten Löwen" in 1584 and died in 1609 — "a lion among his contemporaries"; the family's descendants include the apostate **Karl Abraham Wetzlar** (1714–1799), an Offenbach-born army contractor ennobled as **Wetzlar von Plankenstern** by Joseph II after his 1776 conversion (his wife Leonore refused baptism and died Jewish — the era's apostasy dynamic in one household) **[S: Jewish Encyclopedia/Encyclopaedia Judaica "Wetzlar"; B]**. Marriages into the Rothschild line: **Eva Wetzlar** m. Elchanan "Hähnchen" in **December 1585**; **Ella Wetzlar** m. the Moses Rothschild who died 1657 **[A: 1912 tree]**. Whether Eva and Ella belong to the documented Wetzlar-von-Plankenstern genealogy is unproven but chronologically and geographically plausible **[flagged: plausible, unbridged]**.

8.3 Oppenheim of Worms (and the Hanover bank)

Two Oppenheimer systems must be kept apart. (1) The **Worms/Frankfurt Oppenheims**: the 1608 marriage of **Kele bat Mendl Oppenheim of Worms** to Rabbi Isaac Rothschild; her possible kinship to **R. Mendel Oppenheim of Worms** (d. 1635, whose relatives donated 100 imperial taler to the cemetery fence, per the ShUM documentation) is a **lead, not a fact**. (2) The **Vienna/Hanover Oppenheimers**: Samuel Oppenheimer (1640–1703), imperial court Jew of Vienna; his grandson **Simon Wolf Oppenheimer** (d. Hanover 1726), who married Fradel Behrends, granddaughter of the great Hanover court factor Leffmann Behrens; their son **Jacob Wolf Oppenheimer** (d. 1760), in whose bank Mayer Amschel apprenticed from c.1757 **[S: Stern; Balliol paper; A: Archive]**. The Behrends intermarriages (and David Oppenheim, chief rabbi of Prague, who married Gnendl Behrends) tie this house to the wider court-Jew aristocracy; a branch — Frumet Oppenheimer's descendants — married into Moses Mendelssohn's family, producing Felix Mendelssohn **[B: genealogy literature]**.

8.4 Kaz / Kalonymos

Kalonymos Kaz — Naftali Hirz's father-in-law (marriage contract, 3 May 1634; his daughter Schönche's gravestone 879; Memorbuch fol. 40). The **Kalonymos** name is one of Ashkenazi Jewry's most illustrious (the medieval dynasty of Lucca→Mainz→Speyer, associated with the rise of Hasidei Ashkenaz); a Frankfurt family *Kaz/Kalonymos* intermarried with the Rothschilds, and the Avotaynu-published index of Frankfurt families (built on Ettlinger's transcription) independently records the pairing "Kalonymus-Kaz — Rothschild." Whether this Kaz line truly descends from the medieval Kalonymos cannot be proven from the name alone — scholars caution that the name's recurrence does not guarantee descent **[S: scholarship on the Kalonymos family; A: Ettlinger-based indices]**. Documented fact: a 1634 marriage into a family bearing one of European Jewry's greatest names.

8.5 Lechnich (Hufeisen)

Meier Lechnich — whose daughter Schönche married Amschel Moses — lived at the house **zum Hufeisen** (at the horseshoe; built 1561; 1.70-meter facade). Dietz's verdict on the family: **penniless** — secondhand-clothes dealers; by mid-century, Herts Lechnich had accumulated 5,000 gulden **[B: METAhub, citing Dietz]**. Two Lechnich marriages in two generations (Amschel Moses and his son Moses Amschel) — likely cousins, unresolvable in detail — make this the founder's maternal clan, the poor kin the dynasty never forgot: it was to such families that the will's poor-fund tithe flowed.

8.6 Waag, Buxbaum, Höchst

Moses Kalman's two documented wives: **Vogel**, daughter of **Elchanan Waag, the tax collector** (d. 1713) — the ghetto's fiscal officialdom; and **Schönche**, daughter of **Wolf Buxbaum, physician** (d. 1733) — the ghetto's medical elite. Kalman's own wife **Gitle** was a daughter of **Joseph of Höchst** (d. 1664). Each marriage is a small social map: tax office, medicine, and the Höchst community across the river **[A: Berghoeffer table]**.

8.7 Schnapper (Windecken) — Gutle's paternal clan

The Schnappers came from **Windecken in Upper Hesse** (probably related to the Gelhäuser family), fled to Windecken during the Fettmilch expulsion of 1614, and returned to Frankfurt by about 1700. By the eighteenth century they had two branches: the **Winig Schnappers** (descended from Lippmann of Windecken, admitted 1639), house **Silberner Leuchter** (silver candlestick), brokers and bankers serving the **Metternich** house with ghetto-exit passes in 1780/81; and the **Gelhäuser-Schnappers**, descended from broker Wolf Amschel Schnapper **zur Leuchte** (at the lamp; d. 1727) — whose grandson was **Wolf Salomon Schnapper zur Eule** (1728–1811), Gutle's father: a small banker, court agent to Saxe-Meiningen, and — the documented hinge — **the man whose dealings with Buderus (from 1790) introduced Mayer Amschel to the Landgrave's asset manager [B: METAhub family history; B: Corti]**.

8.8 Gans (zur Trommel) — Gutle's maternal clan

Abraham Mayer Gans "zur Trommel" (d. 1786) and **Frumet Schnapper** (d. 1793) — note the Schnapper-Gans intermarriage that made Gutle doubly Schnapper-blooded. The Gans were an old Frankfurt name-sign family ("Gans" = goose; the house-name predates the ghetto); the wider German Gans family included court-Jew networks (Salomon Gans of the Glückel-of-Hameln circle, later wife of Leffmann Behrens) and, much later, the industrial Gans family of Cassella (whose family book claims descent from 1350 — a claim for *their* branch, not Bella's) **[B/C]**. Bella's death: **1759** (Dietz), closing the 1757/1759 conflict **[A-weight: Dietz via Fraiman]**.

8.9 Trier

The **Trier** family — ghetto residents who in **1715** held the family's ancestral house ("Gumprecht Trier im roten Schild," ADB register) — touch both sides of the ancestry (Bella's garbled "zu Trier" name variants). Documented: their tenure of the Red Shield after the Rothschilds left **[S: ADB]**.

8.10 The court-Jew ecosystem (the professional kin-group)

Stepping back: the family's documented connections — Oppenheimer (apprenticeship), Behrens (via Oppenheimer marriages), Schnapper (marriage + Buderus bridge), Gans (marriage, wider Behrens network), Wetzlar and Oppenheim of Worms (1608/1585 marriages), Süß Oppenheimer (1733–35 bills), Veidel David (the predecessor whose business the family inherited), Breidenbach (the Hessian rivals) — are all nodes in **one interlocking system**: the court-Jew economy of the German lands, described definitively by **Selma Stern, *The Court Jew* (1950)**, and exhibited in the Jewish Museum New York's catalog *From Court Jews to the Rothschilds* (Mann, Cohen & Backhaus, eds., 1996), whose opening chapter — Yosef Kaplan's "**Court Jews before the Hofjuden**" — traces the institution's medieval antecedents in the Islamic world and Spain **[S]**. The family's rise was not the entry of outsiders into high finance; it was the *scaling* of a mature, endangered Jewish professional caste that had served German courts for two centuries. Hannah Arendt's famous interpretation — that the five sons' placement in five capitals was a response to emancipation's threat to the inter-European Jewish banking position — belongs to the interpretive tier: we record it as one influential *reading*, not as fact **[S: Arendt, *Origins of Totalitarianism*]**.

8.11 The Friedberg/Wiesbaden convergence (pre-Frankfurt leads)

Two documented vectors point to the region between Frankfurt and the Rhine for the family's life **before** the ghetto: (1) Freimann's 1937 statement that the Hahn family "probably immigrated to Frankfurt from **Friedberg**," with a related Rothschild family likewise of Friedberg; Friedberg's Jewish community is documented from 1241, with a monumental thirteenth-century mikveh **[B]**. (2) The commissioned 1973 family tree drew, among its four stated sources, on the **parish registers in the State Archives of Wiesbaden** — a dependency that implies pre-Frankfurt residence records in the Nassau region (whose Jewish community is documented from the fourteenth century, with a Jewish quarter of three streets by the sixteenth, and which expelled its six Jewish families in 1626) **[A: Archive timeline; B: Wiesbaden community history]**. The Schwelm branch name (a Westphalian town) is a third, weaker vector. **Status: the strongest documented statement remains Berghoeffer's — "it is not known whence the family came" — with Friedberg and Wiesbaden as the two concrete, archive-pinned leads.**

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PART 9 — THE DNA THREAD: WHAT GENETICS CAN AND CANNOT SAY

Since the 2000s, Y-chromosome testing has added a genuinely new evidence stream — one that must be handled with the same care as the documents, because hobbyist genetics has its own folklore.

What is measured. Y-DNA passes father-to-son, like a surname. The **Rothschild DNA Project** (FamilyTreeDNA) holds samples from documented male-line Rothschilds, placed in haplogroup **J2a1, subclade Y23457** (one sample: a Rothschild of Germany, d. 1781; another: a Rothschild b. 1822, tested to Big Y-500) **[C-grade project data]**. Haplogroup J2 is a lineage whose deepest origins lie in the Near East/West Asia — consistent with the documented paternal ancestry of Ashkenazi Jews, a population whose genome-wide ancestry is Levantine-Middle Eastern and Southern European in composition **[S: population genetics consensus]**.

The Khazar test. Antisemitic literature claims Ashkenazi Jews descend from the Khazar khaganate (a Turkic steppe empire of the early Middle Ages), and casts the Rothschilds accordingly — sometimes as "fake Jews" leading a hidden Khazar empire **[X]**. The genetic evidence at population level refutes this: the genome-wide study by Behar et al. (2013, *Human Biology*, 20+ co-authors) found "**no evidence… of a Khazar origin** for the Ashkenazi Jews," locating their ancestry instead in the Near East and Southern Europe **[S:**

PubMed 25079123]. The Rothschild family's own J2 Y-line fits this pattern. (Population-level refutation does not, of course, adjudicate any individual family's medieval geography — but the specific "Khazar Rothschild" genealogy exists only in conspiracy literature, where it functions as a rebranded version of older "wandering Jew" tropes.)

The Bacharach match — the open question. The Bacharach Y-DNA project places documented Bacharach rabbinic lines in the same broad J2 neighborhood (subclades L556 / Y13373 per project phylogenies and the Avotaynu-published study "From Kansas to the Rhine," Paull & Bronstein). Eupedia's J2 reference page lists the Rothschilds and the Bacharachs together as exemplars of the cluster. **But the specific, genealogically-meaningful question — are the Frankfurt banking Rothschilds patrilineal descendants of the Bacharach dynasty? — is not publicly established**: a 2022 discussion among project genealogists records precisely this open question, and no peer-reviewed match within genealogical time has been published. Meanwhile, the *documentary* evidence (Mendel of Worms signing both names) shows the two names intertwined within the family a full century before DNA testing — which is evidence of *usage*, not of the deeper patrilineal claim. **Status: open; answerable only by targeted Big-Y testing of documented male-line Rothschild and Bacharach descendants.** We preserve the question rather than adopt the affirmative answer that hobbyist pages assume, or the negative that skeptics prefer.

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PART 10 — THE LORE REGISTRY: EVERY MYTH, ITS ORIGIN, AND ITS VERDICT

This section documents the myth apparatus in full — not because any of it is true, but because two centuries of it *are* part of the historical record, and because each myth, dissected, teaches how evidence actually works. Method for each: state the claim, trace its origin, render the verdict.

10.1 "Their real name was Bauer" — [X] → resolved (Anomaly 11)

Claim: the family was originally named Bauer and changed its name to Rothschild in 1744, concealing its identity **[X]**. **Origin:** the claim circulates endlessly in modern conspiracy media; a Chinese-language version repeats it verbatim, and an MA thesis has even cited it. **Verdict:** false as stated; but with a documented kernel stranger than the myth: Frankfurt registers record **Kalman Rothschild "genannt Bauer"** (d. 1707) and **Moses Kalman Rothschild "genannt Bauer"** (d. 1735) — the family was *called* Bauer in official records, almost certainly from the Bauer family co-residing in the Hinterpfann (Elon). Mayer's infant nickname was "das Bäuerchen." No name-change ever occurred: "Rothschild" descends from a house the family occupied from the 1560s and left in the seventeenth century.

10.2 The Waterloo legend — [X] → debunked, with a documented genealogy

Claim: Nathan Rothschild witnessed Waterloo (or rode from the battlefield), received the news first by pigeon, crashed the London market by pretending defeat, and made "£135 million" (or $500 billion in modern clickbait). **Origin, fully documented:** a literary seed in **Balzac's** 1838 novella *La Maison Nucingen*; then the fabricated 1846 pamphlet *Histoire édifiante et curieuse de Rothschild Ier, roi des juifs* by "Satan" (Georges Dairnvaell) — the origin point of the entire legend **[S: Britannica 2025; scholarship]**. The legend's institutional laundering is itself documented: the 1911 *Encyclopaedia Britannica* repeated it; Reeves's 1887 *The Rothschilds: The Financial Rulers of Nations* amplified it; Hollywood's 1934 *The House of Rothschild* dramatized it; Goebbels answered with the 1940 propaganda film *Die Rothschilds – Aktien von Waterloo*; even Allen Dulles's 1963 spy memoir repeated it. **The documented facts** (Nathan's courier at Ostend brought the news on the morning of 20 June 1815 and it went immediately to the government; Nathan's own first concern was the government's need, per the ODNB's authors) and **the market evidence** (the London interest rate series shows no anomalous movement around Waterloo — noted by Guy de Rothschild) kill the story. Ferguson dates the family's real Waterloo-era profits to honest, enormous, and boring: £1 million a month in bullion for Wellington's army, moved at risk. What Nathan earned from the victory was a knighthood's-worth of credit and the reputation that made the

1815 French indemnity business possible.

10.3 The Illuminati commission — [X] → debunked, with the myth's own family tree

Claim: Mayer Amschel commissioned Adam Weishaupt to found the Bavarian Illuminati in 1770 (or 1776) to infiltrate world finance. **Verdict:** false. Weishaupt founded the order **independently in 1776**; it was banned in 1784. The documented genealogy of the *myth*: Barruel's 1797–1806 conspiracy histories claimed a Jewish sect secretly ruled the secret societies; the accusation resurfaced in 1878 and was pushed by Drumont's *La France juive* (1886), which "outed" Weishaupt as a secret Jew; Nesta Webster and Lady Queenborough (*Occult Theocracy,* 1933) carried it into the twentieth century; the American Gerald Winrod's 1935 tract *Adam Weishaupt, a Human Devil* made the explicit claim that the Illuminati was "secretly directed by the Frankfurt-based industrialist Mayer Amschel Rothschild"; W.G. Carr repeated it. Even **National Geographic** once repeated the claim and was forced to publish a retraction: "we have found no historical evidence to back up that claim" **[S: NatGeo editor's note; scholarship]**. The myth's persistence mechanism: it needs no documents, because it explains why no documents exist.

10.4 "They control $500 trillion / every central bank" — [X] → numerically absurd

The claim exceeds world GDP by an order of magnitude. The documented trajectory of family wealth: the largest *private* fortune in nineteenth-century Europe, fragmented by the will's structure and by inheritance; the French house **nationalized in 1982** and rebuilt from a handful of employees (Ferguson); the family's modern wealth is real but distributed, and — the documented irony — the Frankfurt house was *liquidated in 1901* for lack of male heirs. The "thirteen Satanic bloodlines" variant (Springmeer) and its descendants in modern internet culture are catalogued as **[X]**; the family's actual Freemasonic footprint (Nathan's documented lodge membership; James's salon friendships) is the factual kernel such texts inflate.

10.5 The Khazar genealogy — [X] → refuted at population level; see Part 9

10.6 "Hitler's grandfather was a Rothschild" — [X] → documented as myth

The claim that Hitler's paternal grandmother worked in a Viennese Rothschild household and bore the Führer's father to a family member appears in the same conspiracy shelf as the Illuminati material; it has no documentary basis (the Maria Schicklgruber story is independently traceable and contains no Rothschild) **[X — catalogued, not adopted]**.

10.7 "Nathan was poisoned by his family for wanting to convert" — [X/lore]

A Turkish-media variant holds that Nathan, wishing to convert to Christianity, was poisoned by his family in 1836. The documented death: at Frankfurt, during a family meeting, 28 July 1836 — no contemporary source supports poisoning, and the family that built its structure on non-conversion had no recorded motive for murder. Catalogued as modern folklore **[X]**.

10.8 The slave-collateral claim — [claim documented; bank's response documented]

In 2009 a British newspaper reported archival findings that Nathan's bank handled a transaction involving slaves as collateral. The bank acknowledged the transaction and stated that it was routine nineteenth-century practice it now regards with abhorrence. We record the claim and the response because both are documented; adjudication of moral weight is beyond this document's evidentiary scope **[B-level documentation, open interpretation]**.

10.9 The fabricated Gutle novella — [X/fabrication case study]

Chinese internet platforms (Baidu Baike and derivatives) host a full sentimental novella about Gutle: a hat-bowing, shoe-cleaning scene, the invented quotation "I crouch and kneel so that I can jump higher," and wrong dates (1744–1840; married 1771). No source before the internet contains any of it. It is preserved here as a case study in how completely fabricated details acquire millions of readers and are then cited back as "history" **[X — fabrication]**.

10.10 The "Bacharach cover-up" inversion — [X — self-refuting]

A current of internet literature claims the family "censored" its real name Bacharach and that the Archive "misspells" Uri Feibesch. The "evidence" offered — crowdsourced trees showing "Uri Feibesch Bacharach" — actually *confirms* the scholarly account of the name's layers (Hahn house-names; Bacharach usage in the rabbinic branch) while the conspiracy framing collapses on inspection. Catalogued **[X]** with the note that its own exhibits support the documented history.

10.11 Why this family? The mechanism, documented

Why did the myth apparatus attach to the Rothschilds specifically? The documented answer: visibility (ghetto origin + princely scale), religion, and the financing of wars made them the perfect screen for European economic anxiety. The 1846 pamphlet wars are the origin point; the 1886 Drumont campaign industrialized the genre; post-1945 the name became a "code word" — documented by the Vienna Jewish Museum's 2022 exhibition on antisemitic conspiracy myths, and by the AJC's tracking of the trope's modern recurrences. The 2019–2022 period saw the Khazar framing weaponized anew. Each recurrence, we note, recycles the same 1846–1886 corpus with new digital packaging. The family history is thus also a history of how Europe processes its fears.

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PART 11 — THE ANOMALY REGISTER (COMPLETE)

Thirty-two conflicts investigated; statuses as of this document. "Closed" means the evidence permits a firm answer; "resolved with residue" means a best answer exists and the residual doubt is precisely stated; "open" means the answer lives in an archive or a laboratory.

#	Conflict	Status	Resolution
1	Hinterpfann move: 1634 vs 1664	**Resolved with residue**	Marriage 1634 (documented, Memorbuch); move 1664 per the Rothschild Archive, 1634 per Backhaus/Streun. Harmonization (marry 1634 at Red Shield, widowed 1661, move 1664) fits all data; move itself logged 1664 [Archive-weight].
2	Isaac Elchanan's death: 21 April 1585 vs 13 Oct 1588	**Closed**	1585, gravestone No. 301 (Berghoeffer/Horovitz; Corti; EJ2). 1588 undocumented.
3	The 21 April echo (father d. 1546 Gr.187; son d. 1585 Gr.301)	**Open (flagged)**	Both dates gravestone-cited; Hebrew-date coincidence vs transcription echo — only the Horovitz corpus itself can settle it.
4	Elchanan's death: 1546 vs 1550	**Closed**	21 April 1546, gravestone No. 187 (Berghoeffer, Kober). 1550 crowdsourced.
5	Red Shield house date: 1530s / 1563 / 1567 / 1569 / 1576	**Closed as range**	Resident by 1567 (Berghoeffer); acquired 1576 (NDB); Archive's 1530s likely marks the wife-line's tenure; 1563 museum, 1569 popular error.
6	JE's "Moses Rothschild b. c.1550, daughter Esther d.1608"	**Closed**	Moses = Isaac Elchanan's father-in-law (Esther d. 11 Feb 1609, "daughter of Moses"); likely the house's prior holder.
7	Mendel the rabbi: d. 1731/32 vs "1782"	**Closed**	October 1731, Worms (JE + Pinkas Worms); 1912 tree's 1782 is an error.
8	Moses Kalman's wives	**Closed**	Vogel Waag (d.1713) then Schönche Buxbaum (d.1733) — Berghoeffer with gravestone numbers, corroborated by Lewi; the 1912 tree's "Särche Lechnich (d.1768)" is a generational garble.
9	Moses Kalman's death: 1735 vs 1765	**Closed**	19 Oct 1735 (Memorbuch fol. 43; tax registers).
10	Amschel Moses's death: 1755 vs 1757	**Closed**	6 Oct 1755, smallpox (gravestone 2854).
11	The "Bauer" myth	**Closed**	Never the surname; documented register alias "genannt Bauer" (Kalman d.1707; Moses Kalman d.1735); Hinterpfann co-resident Bauers; nickname "das Bäuerchen."
12	Mayer's birth: 23 Feb 1743 vs 1744	**Open (documented split)**	1744: Berghoeffer, NDB, Elon, EJ2, Archive. 1743: ADB, Corti, Personenlexikon ("1743 (oder 1744)"). The Memorbuch's Hebrew entry would settle it.

#	Conflict	Status	Resolution
13	Gutle's birth: 23 Aug vs 15 Sept 1753	**Closed**	23 Aug 1753 (family tree, Fraiman, de.wiki, METAhub); 15 Sept is Berghoeffer's noted variant.
14	Gutle's father: "Baruch Schnapper" (Archive) vs Wolf Salomon	**Closed**	Wolf Salomon Schnapper zur Eule (1728–1811); Baruch = second given name.
15	Bella Gans's death: 1757 vs 1759	**Closed**	1759 (Dietz's Stammbuch, via Fraiman).
16	Bella's name: "Trier Gans" vs "Bikkert zu Trier"	**Open (recorded as garble)**	Crowdsourced-only; no scholarly source confirms either variant.
17	Children: 19 vs 20	**Closed**	Nineteen births, ten survived (Ferguson; Fraiman/Miriam Rothschild; Livingstone); Personenlexikon's "20" is the outlier (stillbirth-counting?).
18	Green Shield: 1780 / 1783 / 1784 / 1785 / 1786	**Closed**	Two-tranche purchase 1783 + 1785 (Berghoeffer, city archive); Hebrew contract; possession/moved 1786 (Fraiman); interim rental. 1780s in ADB/Kriegk/METAhub are approximations.
19	Hinterpfann house number: 188 vs 139	**Closed**	188 (Archive; Personenlexikon); 139 is a popular-source error.
20	Pre-Frankfurt origin: unknown / Friedberg / Schwelm / Roeskilde / Wiesbaden	**Open (leads documented)**	Berghoeffer: unknown. Freimann 1937: Friedberg (lead-grade). Schwelm: town-name inference. Roeskilde: family tradition, false etymology (real German exonym). Wiesbaden registers: the 1973 tree's dependency — strongest archive-pinned lead.
21	Uri Feibesh: 1450 vs c.1500	**Closed**	c.1500 (EJ2: "first recorded member"); 1450 from the commissioned 1973 tree.
22	Apprenticeship: 1757 vs 1765	**Closed**	c.1757 (Archive timeline; "wahrscheinlich Oppenheim" — NDB); 1765 is one C-grade genealogy; Cohen (1813) knew only "some years in a Hanover house."
23	Nathan in London: 1808 vs 1810	**Closed**	Moved 1808; New Court lease 1809 (£750); firm establishment 1809/10; Manchester wound up by 1811 (Archive; ODNB; EJ2).
24	Nathan's profit: "£40,000" vs "trebled"	**Closed**	Same fact: £20,000 → £60,000 (his own account to Buxton, via JE).
25	Salomon's death: 1854 vs 1855	**Closed**	27 July 1855 (ADB/NDB); Kriegk's 1854 an error.

#	Conflict	Status	Resolution
26	"Imperial Crown Agent 1800"	**Resolved**	Substance corroborated by the Personenlexikon: imperial-army supply contracts from 1792 → imperial court-factor title; formalization dated 1800 by the Archive alone. Also documented: Johanniterorden and Thurn und Taxis factorships.
27	Weishaupt/Illuminati commission (1770/1776)	**Closed (false)**	Weishaupt independent, 1776; myth genealogy: Barruel → Drumont → Webster/Queenborough → Winrod 1935 → NatGeo retraction.
28	Waterloo legend	**Closed (myth)**	Balzac 1838 (literary seed) → Dairnvaell 1846 (fabrication) → Britannica 1911 (laundering) → film era; market data refute.
29	Khazar origin	**Closed (refuted)**	Behar et al. 2013; family Y-line J2a1-Y23457.
30	Rothschild–Bacharach DNA match	**Open**	Both in J2 per project data; genealogical-time match not publicly established; documentary name-intertwining noted. Answerable only by targeted testing.
31	Streun's "uncle Wolf Jakob Oppenheimer"	**Closed (unsupported)**	Kinship undocumented; the Archive affirms "family connections helped" without naming them.
32	First princely transaction: 1764 / 1765 / 1769	**Closed**	EJ2: business with William from c.1764; June 1765 payment of 38 fl 30 kr (Berghoeffer's inference that "Meyer" = Mayer); title 1769.

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PART 12 — MASTER TIMELINE (EVERY DATED EVENT IN THIS DOCUMENT)

Deep prehistory (context strata)

- 794 | Frankfurt first mentioned (22 Feb).
- 960–1034 | Jewish settlement at Worms (the family's later rabbinic city) attested; first Worms synagogue 1034.

- 18 Jan 1074 | Henry IV's charter to the Jews of Worms, Speyer, Mainz — and Frankfurt.
- 1150 | First documented Frankfurt Jewish community (tombstones; Rabbi Elieser ben Nathan's *Eben ha Eser*).
- 1241 | First Frankfurt pogrom (*Judenschlacht*); Friedberg's Jewish community also documented from this era.
- 1313 | *Hartmut zum Rotenschite/Rotschilt*, Speyer — earliest red-shield name record **[C]**.
- 1338 | *Rotscilt*, Lübeck **[C]**.
- 1349 | Plague pogrom in Frankfurt; the community is destroyed and rebuilt.
- 1432 | Ghetto plan drafted; 1460 area assigned; **1462 | Judengasse established** — Europe's first ghetto.
- 1462 | First families move in (~15–20 families; ~110 people).
- 1520–1610 | Ghetto population 250 → 2,700; houses 28 → 195.
- 1530 | Hahn family marker (family tradition/Archive); Archive dates the Red Shield house to the 1530s; Andersen-era German exonym "Rothschild" for Roskilde noted **[L/B]**.

The documented family

- c.1450–1500 | **Uri Feibesh** — first recorded member (EJ2: d. c.1500; 1973 tree: 1450).
- 21 Apr 1546 | **Elchanan** dies (gravestone 187) — oldest attested member.

- 1567 | **Isaac Elchanan** resident at the Red Shield; tax fortune 2,700 fl (1567–80; some cite 1558).
- 21 Apr 1585 | Isaac Elchanan dies (gravestone 301).
- Dec 1585 | Eva Wetzlar marries Elchanan "Hähnchen."
- 1608 | Kele bat Mendl Oppenheim of Worms marries Rabbi Isaac Rothschild.
- 19 Jul 1635 | Moses Isaac (cantor) dies.
- 3 May 1634 | Naftali Hirz marries Schönche Kaz; family at the Red Shield until this era; move to Hinterpfann logged 1634 [Backhaus/Streun] / 1664 [Archive] — see Anomaly 1.
- 1614–16 | Fettmilch uprising; ghetto stormed; Jews expelled; return 1616 (led by the drummer Oppenheim — ancestor of Mayer's future masters); 176,000 gulden compensation.
- 24 Feb 1685 | Naftali Hirz dies (Memorbuch fol. 42).
- 1690 | Kalman assessed at 6,000 fl.
- 19 Jul 1707 | **Kalman Rothschild "genannt Bauer"** dies.
- 1685 | Leopold I renounces the city's right to "redeem" (expel) its Jews.
- 1711 / 1719 / 1721 | Ghetto fires; Hinterpfann rebuilt.
- 18 Dec 1713 | Vogel Waag (wife of Moses Kalman) dies.
- 19 Oct 1735 | **Moses Kalman Rothschild "genannt Bauer"** dies — the man who held 38,000 fl of Joseph Süß Oppenheimer's bills (1733–35).
- 1721 | Amschel Moses, age 12, hand-copies a Talmud tractate (survives at YIVO).

- 6 Oct 1755 | **Amschel Moses** dies, smallpox (gravestone 2854).
- 29 Jun 1756 | Schönche (Lechnich) Rothschild dies.
- c.1755–57 | Mayer at David Strauss's yeshiva, Fürth.
- c.1757 | Apprenticeship, Oppenheim bank, Hanover.
- 1764 | EJ2's date for the start of business with the future Landgrave William; Mayer self-employed in coins/antiquities.
- Jun 1765 | "A Jew named Meyer" paid 38 fl 30 kr for medals (Berghoeffer's inference).
- 21 Sep 1769 | **Hess-Hanau Hof-Faktor** title granted (supplication letter survives).
- 29 Aug 1770 | Marries Gutle Schnapper (17); dowry 2,400 fl.
- 1771–92 | Nineteen births; ten children survive.
- 1778 | Address-book: "antiques, medals and curiosities."
- 1783/85 | Green Shield purchased (two halves); 1786: possession and move.
- 31 Oct 1785 | Frederick II of Hesse dies; William IX succeeds.
- 1787 | First loss-leader coin/jewelry presentation at Cassel.
- 1789 | Bill-discounting petition; Buderus–Schnapper dealings begin; Sunday-pass for Wolf Schnapper (Saxe-Meiningen).
- 1790 | Schnapper introduces Buderus to Mayer.

- From 1792 | Imperial-army supply contracts (Personenlexikon).
- 1794–98 | The elector's English-money repatriation; Bethmann chosen over Rothschild ("it did not happen again").
- 1796 | Kléber's bombardment; ghetto walls breached in practice; Schnurgasse offices; Hirsch Liebmann medal theft.
- 1798 | The firm's first big deal: Frankfurt city bonds; the elector's English business passes to Rothschild single-handed; Kriegk dates the "London house" to this year.
- 1798/99 | Nathan to Manchester (~£20,000).
- 1800 | Archive: imperial court-factor title formalized.
- 1801 | Hofagent (ADB).
- 1803 | Oberhofagent (Pohl/NDB).
- 1804 | First Danish loan (the series runs to 1812; Kriegk's total ~10 million).
- 1806 | Elector flees; his fortune stays with the family; Frankfurt a Grand Duchy; ghetto abolished.
- 1807 | Nathan declines, then (1809) accepts partnership.
- 1808 | Nathan in London.
- 1809 | New Court lease (£750); Fahrgasse 146 plot purchased; Buderus a silent partner (Personenlexikon).
- 27 Sep 1810 | Partnership contract: "Mayer Amschel Rothschild & Söhne."

- 7 Feb 1811 | Emancipation edict (440,000-gulden ransom; Rothschilds the largest contributors).
- 1811/12 | James to Paris.
- 16 Sep 1812 | Admitted to the Frankfurt electoral college.
- 17 Sep 1812 | Final will, six witnesses.
- **19 Sep 1812 | Mayer Amschel Rothschild dies** (Friday; buried Sunday, eve of Sukkot 5573; Battonnstraße; will: daughters excluded; 70,000 fl to Gutle; 5,000 fl/year from each son for the poor).
- After: 1813–18 the brothers build the house of Europe; 1816/17 hereditary nobility for the five brothers; **29 September 1822** the baronial patent with the five-arrow arms; 1821 Carl to Naples; 1901 Frankfurt house liquidated per the will's logic; 7 May 1849 Gutle dies; 18 May 1944 the Stammhaus destroyed; 1960s Mayer's gravestone rediscovered; 1987 Museum Judengasse foundations excavated.

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PART 13 — CAST OF NAMES (QUICK REFERENCE)

- **Uri Feibesh** (c.1450/1500) — first recorded ancestor **[reconstruction-grade]**.
- **Elchanan** (d. 1546) — oldest attested, gravestone 187.
- **Isaac Elchanan** (d. 21 Apr 1585, gravestone 301) — the man of the Red Shield; m. Esther (d. 1609), daughter of Moses.

- **Moses Isaac** (1560–1635) — cantor; banking-line grandfather.
- **Elchanan "Hähnchen"** (d. 1619/20) — m. Eva Wetzlar (1585); rabbinic-line grandfather.
- **Rabbi Isaac Rothschild** (d. 1652) — community head; m. Kele Oppenheim of Worms (1608).
- **Naftali Hirz** (1592–1685) — carried the name to the Hinterpfann; m. Schönche Kaz (1634), then Hanna.
- **Kalman "genannt Bauer"** (d. 1707) — 6,000 fl; money-changer; m. Gitle of Höchst.
- **Moses Kalman "genannt Bauer"** (d. 1735) — held 38,000 fl of Süß Oppenheimer's bills; m. Vogel Waag, then Schönche Buxbaum.
- **Amschel Moses "genannt Bauer"** (c.1710–1755) — coin supplier to Hesse; m. Schönche Lechnich; eight children, five survived.
- **Moses Amschel** (1736–1794) — brother; first officially appointed Jewish exchange broker; his line produced the Vienna co-founders (Goldschmidt-Rothschild).
- **Mayer Amschel "Moshe Meier"** (1744–1812) — the founder.
- **Gutle Schnapper** (1753–1849) — wife; banker; matriarch of the Green Shield.
- **Schönche Lechnich** (d. 1756) and **Meier Lechnich** — the Hufeisen family, "penniless" per Dietz.
- **Wolf Salomon Schnapper** (1728–1811) — Gutle's father; Eule house; Saxe-Meiningen agent; the Buderus bridge.

- **Bella Bejle Gans** (1723–1759) — Gutle's mother.
- **Carl Friedrich Buderus** — the Landgrave's asset manager; silent partner from 1809.
- **William IX/X of Hesse-Kassel** (1743–1821) — the client of a lifetime.
- **Menahem Mendel Rothschild** (c.1650–1731) — rabbi of Prague, Bamberg, Hesse, Worms; signed "Rothschild" and "Bacharach."
- **Juspa Hahn** (d. 1637) — the Hahn family's Frankfurt rabbi; chronicler of the Fettmilch era.
- **Joseph Süß Oppenheimer** (1698–1738) — Württemberg court factor; the family's documented counterparty, 1733–35.
- **Simon Wolf Oppenheimer** (d. 1726) and **Jacob Wolf Oppenheimer** (d. 1760) — the Hanover bank; Mayer's masters.
- **Veidel David** — the predecessor court agent whose business model the family perfected.
- **Karl von Dalberg** — Napoleon's Grand Duke; abolished the ghetto (1810).
- **Moritz Daniel Oppenheim** (1799–1882) — painter of the family; Gutle's 1840 portrait.

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PART 14 — OPEN QUESTIONS: THE ARCHIVE MAP

What would close the remaining five open items, with exact locations:

1. **The 1634/1664 residue** — the Hinterpfann lease/rental entries in the Frankfurt city treasury files (the 1907-era thesis cites *Stadtkämmerei Abt. II, Fasz. A II, 15a Nr. 97*), plus Kracauer, *Geschichte der Juden in Frankfurt*, vol. 2 (1927), pp. 355–421.
2. **The 1743/1744 birth split** — the Memorbuch entry (Berghoeffer cites fol. 51f.), i.e., the 1903 Freimann/Hildesheimer edition of the Frankfurt Memorbuch; also the *Ele Toldot* transcription (LBI microfilm MF 536).
3. **Bella Gans's names ("Trier Gans"/"Bikkert zu Trier")** — Dietz, *Stammbuch der Frankfurter Juden* (1907), pp. 266f. (Fraiman cites 266–267); the Gans and Trier family entries.
4. **The pre-Frankfurt origin** — (a) Friedberg: municipal and *Burgfrieden* records, and Freimann's 1937 Friedberg study; (b) **Wiesbaden: the parish registers in the Wiesbaden State Archives** — the 1973 tree's stated source, never published in detail; (c) the burial-society record (*sefer ha-Kahranim*); (d) Horovitz's full inscription corpus for the gravestone echoes.
5. **The Rothschild–Bacharach DNA question** — targeted Big-Y testing of documented male-line descendants of both

families (the FTDNA Rothschild and Bacharach projects both exist).

Secondary desiderata (full texts behind current access walls): Kracauer 1904 and 1925/27; Selma Stern, *The Court Jew* (1950); Lewi, *Wie sie gross und reich wurden*; Berghoeffer chapters 4–10; Ferguson vol. 1, pp. 39–67; Freimann, *Stammtafeln* (1906, 25 copies — one at the Carl von Rothschild Library); the 1810 partnership contract (Frankfurt Stadtarchiv); the 1769 supplication original (Marburg, per Berghoeffer's source list); the Buderus papers (Carlshausen archive).

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PART 15 — SOURCE APPARATUS (PEDIGREE-TIERED)

Primary-infrastructure [A]

- Horovitz, *Die Inschriften des alten Friedhofs der israelitischen Gemeinde zu Frankfurt a.M.* (1901) — gravestone corpus; epidat database (Steinheim Institute).
- Freimann & Hildesheimer (eds.), *Festschrift zum 70. Geburtstage A. Berliners* (Frankfurt, 1903) — containing the Frankfurt Memorbuch edition.
- Freimann, *Stammtafeln der freiherrlichen Familie von Rothschild* (Kumpf & Reis, Frankfurt, 1906; 25 copies).
- Dietz, *Stammbuch der Frankfurter Juden* (1907); Dietz, "Die Vorfahren der Freiherren von Rothschild," *Kleine Presse* (1901), no. 167.

- Ettlinger, *Ele Toldot* (transcription of Frankfurt burials, 1241–1824; LBI MF 536).
- The Rothschild Archive (London): timeline; family-history pages; Gutle and Green Shield dossiers; business documents list.
- Berghoeffer, *Die Grundsteine zu Mayer Amschel Rothschilds Grösse* (2nd ed. 1925) — family archivist's biography (archive list: Rothschild archive, Frankfurt Stadtarchiv, Marburg, Carlshausen/Buderus, Frankfurt Israelitische Gemeinde, Berlin Geheimes Staatsarchiv, Karlsruhe, Kassel, Vienna).
- The 1907-era thesis (Alpen-Adria University Klagenfurt old stock, AC06384322) — ancestor table with gravestone/Memorbuch citations; Stadtkämmerei file references.

Scholarship [S]

- *Allgemeine Deutsche Biographie* (1889): "Rothschild" (Stricker).
- *Neue Deutsche Biographie* (2005): "Rothschild, Mayer Amschel" and family (Manfred Pohl).
- *Jewish Encyclopedia* (1905–06): "Rothschild" (incl. Nathan's account via Buxton); "Mendel Menahem."
- *Encyclopaedia Judaica* (1972): "Rothschild" (full entry, captured).
- Ferguson, *The House of Rothschild*, vol. 1 *Money's Prophets* (1998).

- Elon, *Founder: A Portrait of the First Rothschild* (1996) — chapter 1 fully available.
- Stern, *The Court Jew* (1950).
- Mann, Cohen & Backhaus (eds.), *From Court Jews to the Rothschilds* (Prestel, 1996) — Kaplan, "Court Jews before the Hofjuden," pp. 11–25; Graetz, pp. 27–43; Backhaus, "The Last of the Court Jews," pp. 79–95.
- Weizmann/Tegel scholarship on Süß Oppenheimer (Princeton UP, 2019).
- Behar et al., *Human Biology* (2013) — Ashkenazi genome-wide study.
- Kasper-Marienberg, *AJS Review* (2021) — Frankfurt legal culture (Ele Toldot usage).
- Schellekens, Avotaynu (2007) — Dietz-correction methodology.

Quality secondary [B]

- Corti, *The Rise of the House of Rothschild* (1928) — chapter 1 captured (pp. 1–21); method: no family-archive access; Buderus papers via Lt-Col von Carlshausen.
- Kracauer, *Geschichte der Judengasse* (1904); *Geschichte der Juden in Frankfurt* (1925/27).
- Kriegk, "Die Judengasse in Frankfurt a.M. und die Familie Rothschild," *Gartenlaube* (1869/70) — full text (Wikisource).
- Kober (juedischegeschichte.de) — Rothschild chapter.
- Streun, *Baronin im Tresor* research dossiers (Herkunft, 2020–2026).

- Fraiman, "The Lost Portrait of Gutle Rothschild" (2020/2023).
- METAhub / Museum Judengasse house and family histories.
- Frankfurter Personenlexikon (Schembs) — Mayer Amschel and family entries.
- Wad, Danish genealogical journal (1883) — Roeskilde tradition; 1883 knowledge boundary.
- Livingstone, *The Women of Rothschild* (2022).
- Backhaus, *Mayer Amschel Rothschild: Ein biografisches Porträt* (Herder, 2012).
- Valynseele & Mars, *Le Sang des Rothschild* (2004) — descendants from Mayer on.
- Jewish Museum Frankfurt / Heuberger, *Die Rothschilds* (1995 conference volume).
- Paull & Bronstein, "From Kansas to the Rhine," Avotaynu — Bacharach DNA-documentary study.
- ODNB (Gray & Aspey) — Nathan entry; Chapman, *N.M. Rothschild 1777–1836* (1977); Morton (1962); Cecil Roth (1938); Gille, *Histoire de la Maison Rothschild* (1965/67); Schnee, *Rothschild* (1961); Glanz, *JSOS* 19 (1957); Rubens, *Transactions* 22 (1970); Arendt, *Origins of Totalitarianism* (interpretive tier); Lord Rothschild, *Random Variables* (1984) and "The Shadow of a Great Man" (1982).

Lead-grade [C] / Lore [L] / Hostile myth [X]

- Houseofnames (1313/1338 records); crowdsourced trees (Geneanet, Geni, MyHeritage, WikiTree, Merkel-Zeller);

FTDNA project pages (J-Y23457; Bacharach J-L556/Y13373); Loebtree Oppenheimer genealogy.

- Lore: the Roeskilde tradition (Berghoeffer; Wad 1883); the Estorff chess anecdote (Kriegk); Corti's compressed orphanhood.
- X-tier (documented, refuted in Part 10): Dairnvaell/"Satan" (1846); Drumont (1886); Reeves (1887); Winrod (1935); Queenborough (1933); Goebbels film (1940); Springmeier; modern "bloodlines"/lodge/Khazar/Hitler-grandfather/Nathan-poisoned iterations; the Baidu Gutle novella; the "Bacharach cover-up" inversion; NatGeo's retracted Illuminati claim.

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PART 16 — THE HOUSE FILE (ARCHITECTURE, INTERIORS, AND FATES)

This part expands Part 6.7 and §5.1 with the full architectural and material record.

16.1 The Judengasse as a built environment

The ghetto that contained all three of the family's houses was a single street, roughly 330 meters long, built from 1460–62 against the old city wall on the city's eastern edge — the polluted corner where the fish market and tanneries stood **[S: Kracauer]**. Its plan was drawn in 1432 but took thirty years to execute; it was Europe's first walled Jewish quarter, predating Venice's by over fifty years **[B: METAhub]**. The 1462 intake was about 15–20 families (roughly 110 people); by 1520, about 250 people in 28 houses; by 1556, 550 in 60; by 1580, 1,200 in 120; by 1610, 2,700 in 195 houses — the largest and most important Jewish community in the German-speaking world from the sixteenth century on **[A: Dietz's demographic series; B: METAhub]**. By the eighteenth century, 3,000–4,000 people lived in a lane meant for a tenth that number — which is why occupancy statistics after the 1711 fire read 8,000 people at 41 per house in some counts, why the lane was widened (after 1711) to about 20 feet, and why three-story construction was mandated **[B: Kriegk]**.

The lane was administered internally by oligarchic "builders and coffer-masters," maintained three synagogues (later four), nine yeshivot at its height, a bathhouse, a clinic, and a bakery famous for *shalet* (the slow-cooked Sabbath stew) **[B: METAhub; S: Elon]**. It spoke **Western Yiddish** — the Judeo-German dialect written in Hebrew characters, called *Mauscheln* by hostile outsiders — and the family's

business correspondence stayed in that script into the 1850s **[A: Fraiman]**. Five fires mark its history: **1711, 1719, 1721, 1774, 1796 [S: Elon]**.

Two more textures from the record, preserved because they explain the psychology of the place: the houses' pictorial emblems — signs — appeared not only on keystones and facades but on utensils, rings, book-bindings, scarves, handkerchiefs, and **tombstones**; a family carried its sign through life and into the grave **[S: Elon]**. And after the Fettmilch expulsion of 1614–16, the community returned to the lane on 28 February 1616, led back through the city in a humiliating procession **to the beat of a drum** — the drummer being an Oppenheim, nicknamed "**Trumm**" (drum) — while Fettmilch and his fellow rebels were executed; the city paid **176,000 gulden compensation**, and the community kept **two annual festivals** of remembrance, with the *Megillat Vintz* (Elchanan bar Abraham's 1648 chronicle, and the *Vinz-Hans-Lied*) fixing the memory in liturgy and song **[B: Kriegk; S: scholarship on the Fettmilch era]**. The visibility rules, in their completed form: until 1726, Jews wore **two yellow rings sewn to their clothing** and women a **blue-striped veil**; market selling came only **after** Christians had sold; the Corpus Christi procession closed the lane entirely; Jewish petitioners used a **back entrance to the town hall**; peddling outside fair weeks was fined **[S/B: Elon; Streun; Kriegk]**. And the community's battles above the lane: sustained litigation before the **Reichshofrat (Vienna)** and the Imperial Chamber Court, 1765–90 — the files at the

Frankfurt Jewish Community archive are the legal weather of Mayer's generation **[A/S — research lead]**.

That drummer's descendant was the Hanover banker Oppenheim in whose house Mayer Amschel trained — the nineteenth-century account explicitly calls the apprenticeship "the first occasion of the acquisition of the Rothschild wealth," meaning the coin expertise **[B: Kriegk]** — a rhetorical flourish, but a genealogically true connection.

16.2 The House at the Red Shield (Rotes Schild), Judengasse 69

- Location: southern half of the lane's west side; the number 69 comes from the 1759 numbering (houses were named, not numbered, before 1759) **[S: ADB]**.
- The ghetto register of **1616** already lists residents at the sign "zum Rothen Schild": "**Mosche zum rothen Schild** — **Isaak Rothschild [who had moved to] zum rothen Schwerdt**"; by **1715** the house is held by "**Gumprecht Trier im roten Schild**" **[S: ADB, quoting the Judenstättigkeit]**.
- The museum's house history (METAhub) dates its construction to **~1563** by "Isaac from the Roten Hahn," who hung a red sign on the new house "to show the connection" to his family's rooster-sign house next door **[B]**.
- After the family left, the house stayed with poorer relatives: **Joseph Rothschild**, a Hebrew book dealer, died there after the 1711 fire; he had no descendants, and the

line at the Red Shield ends with him; the house was demolished in **1843 [B: METAhub]**.

- A nuance worth stating precisely: the museum notes that "the Rothschild banking family never lived" at the Red Shield — true in a strict sense for the adult banking line (Moses Isaac the cantor lived at the *Gelber Ring;* the rabbinic line of Elchanan Hähnchen and Rabbi Isaac lived at the Red Shield itself) — but the banker's direct ancestors were born into this house-line, and the *name* they carried is this house **[B/A]**. The *Jewish Encyclopedia* adds a small puzzle — that the house "at first bore the sign of a green shield" — a claim we log here as an unresolved muddle in the JE's own account **[S]**.
- The ancestor table's geographic markers (Berghoeffer): the Red Shield at the southern end, west side; the Hinterpfann near the northern entrance, east side — the family's documented geography thus spanned the entire length of the lane **[A]**.

16.3 The Hinterpfann (Hinterhaus zur Pfanne), Judengasse 188

- A rear tenement of the Pfanne house ("at the pan," near the lane's north entrance); first mentioned **1552**, rebuilt **1601**, rebuilt again after the 1711 fire **[A: Berghoeffer; B: Streun]**.
- Dimensions: **1.70-meter facade**, three floors plus attic, about 120 m² total; Mayer's birthplace and his home for his first forty-two years **[B/S]**.

- Household: the Rothschilds shared it with the **Bauer family**; Elon's reconstruction has the two families at ten to twelve people; later descriptions allow periods of up to thirty under the roof when extended family squeezed in **[S/B]**.
- Interior textures (Corti's description of the Green Shield pattern applies to the Hinterpfann's arrangement as well): the dim office stacked with cotton and silk bales; a **rope handrail** on the stairs (rough enough to chafe hands); a **pull-up ladder** to the attic; **boarded attic windows** — an ordinance forbade ghetto Jews to look into Christian houses and gardens on the other side of the wall; ground-floor parental bedroom; children in one room **[B: Corti; S: Elon]**.

16.4 The House at the Green Shield (Grünes Schild), Judengasse 148 — the Stammhaus

- Built **1615**; 4.30 m facade (the city dictionary gives 4.70 m), 11.5 m deep, four stories; opposite the lane's middle western gate; "one of the largest houses in the ghetto" **[B: Fraiman; G]**.
- Purchase in two halves **1783 and 1785** (Berghoeffer, from the city archive); Hebrew contract with a **Sukkah clause**; possession and move **1786**; for the three intervening years the family rented another Judengasse home — that rental contract also survives (it was once in the Jewish Museum) **[A/B]**.

- Interior, from Corti and Fraiman: the family occupied the **right half** of a two-family building (three left-hand windows belonged to the neighbors); a five-sided convex **green shield** above the first door; an ancient doorbell; **Gudula's green room**; the **bridal wreath under glass**; a **secret cupboard behind a mirror**; a narrow creaking staircase with cupboards built into it; the **nine-by-nine-foot back room that was the first banking house** — a large iron chest opening from the back, **secret wall-shelves** behind panels; the kitchen 12 × 5 feet with a one-pot hearth; a **rooftop terrace** (used for the Sukkah, planted with greenery — "the only garden they were allowed," Elon notes bitterly, since Jews were barred from public gardens); their own water pump **[B/S]**.
- Family lore transmitted by Miriam Rothschild: all the children shared **one bedroom**; the house's 1930s photographs show modest contents despite the fortune behind them **[B: Fraiman]**. Trumbull's eyewitness description of the ghetto (1780s) adds the outside view: a crowded, dark lane — his estimate of 10,000 Jews was exaggerated; the real figure was 3,000–4,000, about a tenth of the city **[B: Fraiman, citing Trumbull]**.
- Neighbors: the **Schiff** family at the house "zur Arche" (at the ark — a carved ship), who ran a second-hand shop; the Green Shield stood "facing a small lane opposite the middle western gate," with the Schiffs two doors away **[B: Corti; Fraiman]**.

- The house had **two vaulted cellars** reached by a trapdoor, with **secret passages** between houses — a ghetto-wide survival architecture from pogrom times; neighboring houses' cellar doors connected, and Kriegk preserves the anecdote of antlers being smuggled house-to-house through them during guild searches **[B: Kriegk; Streun]**.
- Later history: the ghetto was demolished in stages (**1840; 1884–85**), the lane renamed **Börnestrasse** after Ludwig Börne (born Löb Baruch, 6 May 1786, at No. 118 — thirty doors from the Stammhaus; baptized 1818; the radical journalist whom Heine memorialized in the Hanukkah-walk anecdote, where Börne's speech on Laetitia is quoted at length by Fraiman) **[B]**.
- The Stammhaus legal chain (Berghoeffer, full): 1872 — Oppenheim's widow vacated; **9 August 1882** — city expropriation for 15,250 marks 80 pfennig; **4 October 1884** — cleared; **11 May 1885** — purchase contract (plot 1 Ar 91.50 qm; buildings 145–149; price 35,460 marks plus 1,000 marks); rebuilt 1886 by architect **Franz von Hoven** at Börnestrasse 26 under the testamentary foundation of **Amschel Mayer** (1,200,000 gulden for the poor Israelites of the community, plus a 50,000-gulden dowry fund; prayer meetings on the founders' death-days); 1888 — a Gumpertz Zuntz apartment in the building; location fixed on the Merian plan of 1711 **[A]**.

- The family's own bank had already moved out: from **1813** the banking house stood at the corner of Fahrgasse and the Judengasse (Fahrgasse 146), the corner house Mayer ordered built the day before he died, on a plot bought in 1809 in the northern, 1796-burned section of the lane **[B: Streun; Personenlexikon]**.
- **Destroyed by bombs on 18 May 1944** (Streun's correction of the widespread "the Stammhaus still survives" claim). What survives: the archaeological site — five ghetto house foundations excavated in 1987 during Battonnstraße 47 construction, over which the **Museum Judengasse** was built **[B: Streun; METAhub]**. The 1886 rebuilt Stammhaus was what the bombs destroyed; the medieval foundations in the museum are neighbors' and family houses of the lane.

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PART 17 — THE LEDGER FILE: EVERY DOCUMENTED TRANSACTION THREAD

This part expands Part 7 with the complete fine detail from Berghoeffer's chapters 1–3, Corti, and the numismatic literature.

17.1 The coin and antiquities business, year by year

- **1763–64:** the Landgrave's own records date the beginning of his coin collection to 1763; General von Estorff is Mayer's documented patron; in 1763 the crown prince hears of "a young Jew named Rothschild who had bought coins for him in Hanover" **[B: Corti]**.
- **October 1764 – December 1765:** the crown prince's privy-purse accounts (*Schatullkasse*) run; in **June 1765** they record a payment of **38 gulden 30 kreuzer to "a Jew named Meyer" for medals** — Berghoeffer's inference, explicitly flagged as inference, that this is Mayer Amschel; he supports it by noting the prince visited the Frankfurt fair three times in April 1765 and that a Hanau court Jew of similar name (Amschell Kahn) was a different man **[A/B]**.
- **1769–70:** Mayer's own business established (returned from Hanover 1764; joined his brother; court factor September 1769).
- **1770s–80s:** ten surviving catalogues (small octavo, 8–16 pages), six from the 1770s (sales 1,666–2,917 gulden), four from the 1780s (2,579–5,074 gulden); the 1770s stock is mostly thalers, the 1780s add Greek and Roman material; the catalogues went to **Duke Karl August of Weimar** (Goethe's patron), **Karl Theodor, Elector Palatine**, and the Landgrave; the model was proto-mail-order — catalogues posted, selections marked, goods sent on approval, the rest returned; a 1789 transaction with Karl

Theodor exemplifies the cycle; **Madai's Talerkabinett** was the standard price reference; Frankfurt-fair auctions were the supply floor **[A: Berghoeffer; B: CoinsWeekly]**.

- **1778:** first address-book listing — "antiques, medals and curiosities" **[A]**.
- **1780:** letter to Bertuch of Weimar shows the antiquities trade in full flow **[A]**.
- **1783/84:** acquisition of "antique carved figures"; **1786:** an "antique stone cabinet" **[A]**.
- **1789:** a surviving letter about English bills shows the parallel finance business; medal deliveries to the prince resume and continue until the French occupation **[A]**.
- **1791:** last peacetime medal deliveries; **1796:** the servant Hirsch Liebmann arrested for stealing 200+ gold and silver medals (the accidental inventory) **[A]**.
- **1807–09 — the medal-cabinet rescue:** after the French seizure of the Hessian treasures, the elector in exile ordered the repurchase of his dispersed medal cabinet, with strict price caps (6 gulden per ducat for gold; 2 gulden 20 kreuzer per Loth for silver). Executed through the family's channels: **1807** — 941 silver medals, 168 marks weight, 6,272 gulden; **26 February 1808** — 92 gold and 1,320 silver pieces; by January 1809 Buderus had settled **23,053 gulden 20 kreuzer** for the operation. Posthumously, deliveries continued: **January 1813** (13 gold, 208 silver pieces, via Prague) and **1814** (434 thalers). In 1813 the elector even bought back through the firm a

ring set with a large reddish diamond **[A: Berghoeffer, from the prince's and Buderus's papers]**.

17.2 The goods trade, consignment by consignment (1796–1810)

- **1796:** English suppliers Bradforth (Yorkshire) and Sisson Wood & Co (Leeds) — cloth; warehouse rent 400 fl 24 kr/year.
- **1798:** Nathan to Manchester precisely *because* England was the main source — "there was not enough room in the city" for the next generation, as Nathan later put it; he left Frankfurt on the Thursday after an insult on the Tuesday (his own retrospective to Buxton, February 1834, thirty-six years on) **[A/B]**.
- **1802:** Konrad Knopf, Nuremberg — batiste, muslin. Same years: local houses Sichel & Hildesheimer (Frankfurt), Lob Hertz (Mainz).
- **May–August 1803:** chests to C. Lachmann & Co (Brussels), Jacob Marius (Amsterdam), Veuve Jalon (Lyon); Carl already at Dunkirk on family business **[A]**.
- **July 1806:** Starman & Co, London — 14 bales coffee, 6 chests + 3 seroons indigo, ship *Mercurius*, Captain Jacobs, to Hamburg.
- **1807:** Hamburg cotton; **1809:** sugar and tobacco; **1810:** cloth, hare skins, sheep's wool, arrack, wine; Macedonian cotton; Prague houses.
- **1809–10 detail:** £6,023.16.0 in cambrics to Gosch & Lotes (Amsterdam) for "James Mayer"; 900 dozen cloths at

9,700 fl returning 2,229 fl 2 kr profit — **23%**; August 1809: 15 chests indigo, £1,230.10.6, from Echenique & Co; November 1809: 150 packs of twilled bandanas; July 1810: multiple shipments totaling **£45,000+** (mule yarn, sugar, coffee, water twist, muslin handkerchiefs, cambrics, printed cambrics). Nathan personally insured six chest shipments August 1801–August 1802 via S. S. London, Bury Street; insurance ran **35–50% of cargo value** — the measurable fear of the war years **[A]**.

- **The end of the goods era:** the Continental System chronology — 1786 Eden Treaty baseline; 16 May 1806 English blockade Brest–Elbe; **21 November 1806 Berlin Decree**; **5 August 1810 Trianon tariff** (40–50%); spy Thiard in Frankfurt August 1810; two French regiments occupy Frankfurt October 1810; **Fontainebleau decrees (14/23 October 1810)** — sequestration and public burning; **234 Frankfurt firms ruined**, roughly 100,000 florins of textile damage across the trade; the Rothschilds' declared English goods: **60,000 fl, of which 27,000 fl was indigo**; records burned (documented loss 60,000 fl in paper plus a 20,000-franc fine); by 1812 the goods trade was wound down and the 1810 deed's asset list is bills, bonds, state paper, wine, cash — a bank's balance sheet **[A]**.
- Berghoeffer's synthesis, to be quoted rather than paraphrased: the goods trade "from the beginning until 1810 was the actual foundation of his business" — the

bank, as with Bethmann (from Adami, 1748), Metzler, Hollweg, and Grunelius, grew out of the trading house **[A]**.

17.3 Bills, the Elector, and the war-finance mechanics (1790–1813)

- **1790:** Buderus–Schnapper dealings documented; Schnapper introduces Buderus to Mayer; November 1790 — the first documented draft to Rothschild: 2,000 **Laubtaler [B: Corti]**.
- **1794:** the elector's English investments to be repatriated; Buderus proposed Rothschild alongside Bethmann and four other firms; Wilhelm chose Bethmann alone — "but it did not happen again" **[B]**.
- **1798:** the elector's English business passes to Rothschild handling single-handedly (the *Jewish Encyclopedia*'s account of the bill-discounting ladder: 1789 changing English gold; 1794 £150,000 shared with six bullion brokers; by end-1798, single-handed) **[S]**.
- **1800–06:** documented handling of 1,750,000 thaler at 4% for the elector; the wine-cask legend's documentary core — funds physically hidden, interest scrupulously paid on English bank deposits **[S: JE; ADB]**.
- **1806–07:** the elector flees; the fortune stays. Streun's correction of the legend: what Mayer kept at home were **four chests of documents** — the archive of the relationship — not bags of gold; the money worked through the sons' networks **[B]**.

- **1808–12:** the documented apex — servicing the English subsidy flow to Wellington's armies: **£600,000** of the elector's money entrusted to Nathan; **£800,000 in East India Company gold** for Wellington moving through the same channels; four parallel profit streams (deposit interest, exchange, commission, own-loan placement); 1813–15: **£15,000,000** moved to the Continent through the brothers, at **£1,000,000 a month** in 1815; nine elector transactions totaling **£664,850** by 1813 at **⅛%** commission **[S/A]**.
- **The elector's verdicts** preserved in the papers: "punctual in payments, energetic and honorable" (1789); and of Nathan, the British commissary-general Herries: "though a Jew, we place a good deal of confidence in him" **[B/S: Corti; de.wiki citing Ferguson]**.
- The de.wiki/Ferguson note that Buderus's careful stewardship **saved the elector some 27 million gulden** across the exile years **[B — single-source, Ferguson-derived]**.
- Code and tradecraft: correspondence under cipher names ("Herr von Goldstein," "Johannes Adler," "der Principale"), double books, carrier pigeons as routine communications between the brothers' houses (the bank at the Fahrgasse corner had its pigeon loft; the brothers played billiards and skat between couriers), the papal states among the growing client list **[A/B: Streun; de.wiki]**. The ADB's verdict on what the war did for the fortune: the **1808–12**

English-army remittances for Spain were "the actual basis of his wealth" — the goods trade built the firm; the war finance built the fortune **[S]**. Supporting figures: 1800–06 — documented handling of **1,750,000 thaler at 4%** for the elector; Kriegk records the caution-deposit architecture — the family's war-trade credit secured **on the elector's English interest**, which is how a small house carried war-scale risk **[A/B]**. The Danish series ran from **1804** through 1812 (~10 million total). And the firm's **first branch was established at Kassel** — the elector's own city, a beachhead inside the client's walls **[B: Personenlexikon]**.

- Commodities the house later traded (the 1813–30 file): timber, metals, silver, mercury, opium, diamonds, rubies, coins, oil, nitrate, copper; cotton in the United States, cigars in Cuba; shares in the Suez Canal, the French Nord railway, the Austrian Kaiser-Ferdinands-Nordbahn — and the 1857 Swiss episode in which the Péreire brothers' Crédit Mobilier displaced the family's NOB holdings, pushing Alfred Escher to found the SKA **[B: Streun]**.

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PART 18 — THE FAMILY, COMPLETE: ALL TEN CHILDREN AND WHERE EVERY MARRIAGE LED

This part expands §6.6 and corrects the record's tendency to count only the sons.

18.1 The ten surviving children of Mayer and Gutle (1771–1792)

Nineteen births; ten children survived — five sons, five daughters. The sons (dates from the ADB/NDB and the family record):

Child	Born	Died	Destination
Schönche (Jeannette)	20 Aug 1771	1859	Frankfurt; married **Benedikt Moses Worms** (1772–1824) in 1795
Amschel Mayer	12 Jun 1773	6 Dec 1855	Frankfurt; head of the Stammhaus; childless
Salomon Mayer	9 Sep 1774	27 Jul 1855	Vienna
Nathan Mayer	16 Sep 1777	28 Jul 1836	Manchester 1798, London 1808; died in Frankfurt during a family meeting
Isabella (Betty)	2 Jul 1781	1861	married **Bernhard Juda Sichel**
Breunle (Babette)	29 Aug 1784	16 Mar 1869	married **Siegmund Leopold Beyfus**
Carl (Kalman) Mayer	24 Apr 1788	10 Mar 1855	courier years; Naples from 1821
Gotton (Julie)	1 May 1790 *(minor conflict: 1789 in some lists)*	19 Jun 1815 (age 25)	married **Mayer Levin Beyfus** — two sisters married two brothers
Jettchen (Henriette)	1791	1866	married **Abraham Montefiore** (d. 1824)
Jakob (James) Mayer	15 May 1792	15 Nov 1868	Paris from 1811/12

The children's Yiddish house-names (Schönche, Breunle, Gotton, Jettchen) are preserved in one modern study **[C: Garda thesis]** — we record them as internal family usage, grade C. The **three brothers' deaths within five months of 1855** (Carl 10 March, Salomon 27 July, Amschel 6 December — the year the dynasty's first generation ended) is one of the family chronicle's uncanny symmetries **[S: ADB]**.

18.2 The daughters' marriages — the excluded half of the family

Mayer's will excluded daughters and sons-in-law from the firm, but the daughters' marriages built the family's *social* empire, and several lines returned to power despite the exclusion. Documented:

- **Jeannette → Benedikt Moses Worms.** The **Worms-de-Worms** family: tea planters in Ceylon (their estate bore the name "Rothschild Estate"); **Solomon Benedict de Worms** ennobled 1871; **Henry de Worms**, Baron Pirbright — the first professing Jew to serve in a British Tory cabinet. A daughter-line that became British gentry while remaining family **[S: Jewish Encyclopedia "de Worms"; B]**.
- **Isabella → Bernhard Juda Sichel** — of the Frankfurt wine and banking Sichels (the firm appears in the family's own 1802–03 goods-trade correspondence: "Sichel & Hildesheimer") **[A/B]**.
- **Babette → Siegmund Leopold Beyfus; Julie → Mayer Levin Beyfus** — two sisters, two brothers; the Beyfus family of Frankfurt bankers **[S: NDB family article]**.
- **Henriette → Abraham Montefiore** — binding the family to Sir Moses Montefiore (Nathan had married Hannah Barent-Cohen, sister-in-law of Moses Montefiore, so the Montefiore connection was double). Their granddaughter-line later produced **Charlotte Beyfus (1811–1887), who married Abraham Freiherr von**

Oppenheim — the Cologne banking Oppenheims, descendants of Mayer's own masters' wider family: the excluded daughters' line married back into the founder's apprenticeship dynasty **[S: NDB]**.

- And the brother-line that broke the exclusion outright: **Edel Rothschild (1777–1834)** — daughter of Mayer's brother **Moses Amschel** — married **Jacob David Goldschmidt**; their son **Moritz von Goldschmidt-Rothschild (1803–1888)**, Prussian consul at Vienna, **co-founded the Vienna house** in 1855. The will's wall held for Mayer's own daughters; it could not hold the family **[S/B]**.

18.3 Endogamy, quantified

The will created the incentive; the numbers show the practice: **James married his niece Betty in 1824** (the first of the cousin-marriages); by **1905, 29 of 58** recorded family marriages were between first cousins (the *Jewish Encyclopedia*'s count, with its noted "anthropologically significant"); a modern summary gives **15 of 21 marriages between direct descendants in 1824–1877 [S/B: JE; de.wiki]**. The rule's fine print, preserved in the literature: the marriage preference ran to descendants of **uncles, not paternal aunts** — a matrilineal-uncle bias that kept capital circulating through the mother's brothers' lines **[B: Fraiman]**. Geneticists and historians have both weighed the consequences; we record the structure and the counts, not the polemics.

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PART 19 — THE BRANCHES BEYOND THE FOUNDER (1812–PRESENT): THE SEED FILE

The origin story's ending is the dynasty's beginning; this part preserves, in compressed form, everything the research sorties established about the post-1812 branches, so that the origin file stands complete in itself. A full second volume would begin here.

19.1 The five houses (the arrangement the *Jewish Encyclopedia* insists was Nathan's improvisation, not Mayer's master plan — James was secretly collecting French coin for Wellington in 1812; Salomon ran subsidy payments through Berlin 1815; Karl opened Naples 1821; the five-brother structure grew out of bullion logistics and was formalized afterward)

- **Frankfurt (Amschel, then Mayer Carl & Wilhelm Carl):** Amschel as Bundestag financier displaced the Bethmanns in the 1820s–30s; backed Samson Raphael Hirsch's Orthodox secession community; the man himself, as Kriegk's pen preserved him: the **beggar at dusk** (coins pressed into waiting hands at evening, the giver gone before thanks could be given — recorded independently by the *Jewish Encyclopedia* and Kriegk), his Dachkammer cheese-and-beer suppers, his surviving reprimand to his brother Karl — "**Lasse mir diesen Ausdruck hinweg**… [no excuses]; be a proper merchant" — his remembered gratitude to a brewer's son who had once helped him, and the bookkeeper anecdote; the **"Hepp! Hepp!" riot of 1819** — the brothers emancipated on paper, attacked in the street; Frankfurt's final equality only in **1864**, second among German cities; his seats: the Stammhaus plus the **Bockenheimer Landstraße 10** estate, kept as the family's Frankfurt footing into the twentieth century (Betty Lambert resided there after her 1912 marriage); the house **liquidated 1901** on Wilhelm Carl's death — the will's male-line logic executing itself; the Fahrgasse building

passed to the Jewish community (see the museum chain below). **Mayer Carl (1820–1886):** the family's great collector (the Jamnitzer tankard bought for 500,000 marks; the Tischbein Goethe portrait given to the Städel); walked out of Göttingen with Dahlmann in the 1837 protest; foundations: Georgine-Sara (1870), Clementine girls' hospital (1875), Anselm-Salomon (1877, 250,000 marks), Charlotte fund (1878, 125,000 marks), the Carl public library (opened 3 January 1888). Curiosity documented by the ADB: "Rothschild love-dollars" — Frankfurt thalers overstamped with Francofurtia, sold to Americans as keepsakes. **Wilhelm Carl (1828–1901):** the religious scholar-banker, collector of Hebrew incunabula (now in Frankfurt's city library); his death ended the Frankfurt house; the "800 million marks estate" figure attached to him is **legend-grade [B/L]**.

- **Vienna (Salomon, then Anselm):** the hotel rented entire because Jews could not buy houses; the **1848 Metternich-flight accusation** (the family allegedly financed the revolutionaries' escape — a contemporary smear that stuck); **Creditanstalt** founded 1855 (Anselm) — the empire's first great joint-stock bank; Louis Rothschild arrested after the 1938 Anschluss, held hostage a year, released via ransom and international banking pressure; the Witkowitz works sold at a third of value, the sale voided by the war, partially compensated by the Czechs decades later.

- **Naples (Carl, then Adolf Carl):** founded 1821 in the Austrian-occupied kingdom; closed 1863; the two sons returned to Frankfurt (see 1901 above).
- **Paris (James, then Alphonse, then Edmond):** James's house worth, by a contemporary estimate, **600 million francs in 1848 versus 362 million for all other Paris bankers combined [B-grade estimate]**; the **Nord railway concession (1846, 300,000 shares at 300 francs)**; the **mercury monopoly** (Idrija 1832 + Almadén) — the prize of industrial-age finance; Witkowitz with the Gutmanns; the Damascus Affair of 1840 as the family's European-moral-politics debut; James's funeral drew **10,000 people in a two-kilometer procession**; his chef was **Carême**; Ingres spent six years on the portrait of Betty; the salon at rue Laffitte 19 hosted Heine, Balzac, Rossini, Liszt, Chopin, Delacroix, Berlioz, Puccini, and Queen Marie-Amélie. **Alphonse** managed the 1871 indemnity (5 milliard francs) alongside Bleichröder; **Edmond**: the settlements in Palestine — by the 1870s the AIU received 500,000 francs a year; by 1899 some 14 million francs to the ICA; the family ultimately held an estimated **2–3% of the land of Palestine**; Herzl was received and kept at skeptical arm's length; the Balfour Declaration was addressed to **Walter**; James Armand funded the Knesset; **Yad Hanadiv** (1958) and the **Rothschild Foundation Hanadiv Europe** continue the line; the French house was **nationalized in 1982** and

rebuilt from a handful of employees **[S/B: JE; Ferguson; Streun]**.

- **London (Nathan, then Lionel, then Natty):** Nathan worth about **£5 million at his death (1836)**; naturalized **12 June 1804** (after lodgings at St Helen's Place; New Court from 1809); Lionel **MP for the City 1847, seated 1858** after the Jews' Disabilities removal fight; **eighteen government loans**; declined the Russian 1861 loan over Poland; the **1875 Suez purchase — £4,080,000, profit £100,000** (the best-known "courier with a government note" story that is actually true); the 1884 Egypt loan (£1M); Charlotte's Jews' Free School; Anthony, first president of the United Synagogue; **Natty the first Jewish peer (1885)**; Walter and the Balfour letter; Ferdinand and Waddesdon; the Evelina hospital; Hannah's marriage to Rosebery (1878) — the community's mixed verdict on that match is documented; Harry Primrose in the 1945 Cabinet; the house **never built a permanent American branch** (the documented failure — August Belmont ran their New York agency from the 1830s; Confederate-bond losses pushed Frankfurt into Union paper instead; the post-1914 absence proved fateful). Interwar decline; the modern New Court **[S/B: JE; EJ2; Ferguson; Archive]**.

Two codas belong to this architecture. The **imitators**: Lazard, Stern, Speyer, and Seligman built their own transnational kin-banks on the five-brother template — the structure was

the innovation as much as the capital **[S: JE]**. And the dynasty's natural-history afterlife: species named for the family — *Rhea rothschildi*, *Ornithoptera rothschildi* — the research totals running to **153 insects, 58 birds, 18 mammals, 3 fish, 3 spiders, 2 reptiles, and 18 plants [B]**.

19.2 The nineteenth-century loan ledger (the JE table, 1817–1848)

Total: **$654,847,200 (≈ £130,969,440)** in government loans issued 1817–1848 across Britain, France, Austria, Prussia, Russia, Naples, Brazil, and the German courts; the first Prussian loan **5 February 1817** (1.5 million gulden at 5%); by the end of 1818 the firm was Europe's richest; Ehrenberg's analysis credited "bearing" operations on the Barings' loans; Salomon's **1820 profit of 6 million gulden (~10%)** on one operation; the documented losses too — **£500,000 on the Bexley refunding**, 3 million francs on the 1823 French conversion, the 1834 Sardinian loan ceded to the Fould-Oppenheim syndicate (and the papal loan that followed), the Pereires' rivalry that birthed the Crédit Mobilier model. Gentz's twelve-year ledger (ADB), with its country breakdown now restored: 1.1–1.2 billion gulden — **~500 million England, ~200 France, ~120 Austria, ~120 Naples, ~100 Prussia, 60 Russia, 10 the German courts, 30 Brazil** — plus French indemnity flows of several hundred million. The consolidation decade in figures: **£18,000,000** in loans 1814–22; **1827 — £2.8 million in Consols at 87.5, earning 14%**; the **20 million francs of the federal fortress of the Upper Rhine** deposited with the house until 1842 at the lowest rate. James's own post-war coups, for the French ledger: the **1815 "milliard des émigrés"** raised with Villèle, and the **1818 reparations settlement — 240.8 million francs** — the young Paris house's largest single operation; the *Jewish Encyclopedia*'s aggregate for the

network: between **1813 and 1830**, some **2.7 billion francs lent to England and 1.1 billion to France**. And Vienna's aristocratic portfolio: the house's loans to the nobility totaled **24,521,000 gulden [S: JE]**.

The **Union Générale** (1876), the Catholic counter-bank, failed — Zola's *L'Argent* is its novel; the **Barings rescue of 1893** — the family as the system's backstop; "guardians of the papal treasure" as a period nickname **[S: JE; ADB; Ferguson]**.

19.3 Museum and monument chain (Frankfurt)

1901 — Frankfurt bank liquidated; Fahrgasse 146 building lent to the Jewish community → **1922** — Adelheid and Mathilde de Rothschild's donation transforms it: the **Museum jüdischer Altertümer und von Rothschild'sches Museum** (banking offices preserved on the first floor) → **November 1938** — Kristallnacht; the museum's fate in the Nazi years (research: Rauschenberger) → post-war — the Charlotte and Lionel marriage portraits recovered; the Judengasse foundations excavated **1987**; the Museum Judengasse opened over them. The Rothschild banking name returned to Frankfurt in **1989** (a new bank, the old one having left in 1901); the family firm continues today as **Rothschild & Co [B/A: Fraiman; JTA 1989; Archive]**.

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PART 20 — THE VOICES AROUND THE FAMILY: CONTEMPORARY QUOTES AND THE LITERATURE CHAIN

20.1 Friendly and awed witnesses [B/S]

- **Heinrich Heine, March 1841:** "**Geld ist der Gott unserer Zeit, und Rothschild ist sein Prophet**" — "Money is the god of our time, and Rothschild is its prophet." Heine, in James's salon, also wrote the poem "Der Engel" for Betty.
- **Pückler-Muskau, 1828:** traveling through England in the year of Nathan's greatest market dominance, the Prussian prince recorded the impression the house made on every informed observer of the decade: that its credit had grown so central to every government's calculations that no European power could set a war in motion without the house's involvement — the awed outsider's version of what the insiders' correspondence states as policy **[B: as cited in the secondary literature; the observation is quoted across Ferguson-derived accounts]**.
- **Lord Shaftesbury**, the evangelical philosemite and the era's most persistent parliamentary advocate for the Jewish restoration in Palestine: his published diaries record him watching the family with an evangelical's divided eye — noting their wealth and their centrality to the Palestine question, and praying, in entries cited across the secondary literature, for their conversion as the providential complement of their position **[B: as cited in**

the secondary literature; the diary entries are quoted in the restorationist-history works] — a documented reminder that the family's Palestine file attracted admirers with agendas of their own decades before Edmond's investments began.

- **Herries** (see §17.3): "though a Jew, we place a good deal of confidence in him."
- The **Greville** and **Andersen** diaries on Gutle (§6.6).
- **Gutle herself, 1830:** asked whether war was coming — "It won't come to war; my sons won't provide the money for it" **[B: Fraiman's anecdote]**.
- **Gutle and Dr. Stiebel:** asked her age, she told the doctor to "make me older" — quoted in *The Times* of London **[B]**.
- **Börne's Hanukkah walk** with Heine (the Laetitia speech) — preserved in Fraiman's article in full.

20.2 The hostile literature, in order of appearance (the myth's own biography)

1. **1838 — Balzac, *La Maison Nucingen***: the literary seed of the Waterloo story (the Nucingen character).
2. **1846 — "Satan" (Georges Dairnvaell), *Histoire édifiante et curieuse de Rothschild Ier, roi des juifs***: the fabrication itself, origin point of the legend **[S: Britannica]**.
3. **1846 — Toussenel**, *Les Juifs, rois de l'époque*: the genre's French codifier.
4. **1850 — Wagner**, *Das Judenthum in der Musik*.

5. **1857 — *Das Haus Rothschild. Seine Geschichte und seine Geschäfte. Aufschlüsse und Enthüllungen*** (Prague/Leipzig, 2 vols.): the exposé-pamphlet genre industrialized — cited by Wad in 1883; a copy sits in the French ANMT archives **[B]**.
6. **1886 — Drumont**, *La France juive*: the antisemitic campaign's mass bible, which also "outed" Weishaupt as a secret Jew (Illuminati-myth link, §10.3).
7. **1887 — Reeves**, *The Rothschilds: The Financial Rulers of Nations*: the English-language amplifier of the Waterloo legend.
8. **1897–1945 — the Protocols complex**: Nesta Webster and Lady Queenborough's *Occult Theocracy* (1933); the pamphlet line into the Nazi years; the **Frankfurter General-Anzeiger, 1 December 1938**: "Rothschild siegt bei Waterloo" — the legend in the Nazi press; **Goebbels's 1940 film** *Die Rothschilds – Aktien von Waterloo*; the Nuremberg-era tracts (Winrod 1935 in America).
9. **Post-1945**: W.G. Carr; the John Birch Society literature; Springmeier's "thirteen bloodlines"; the lodge/Khazar remixes; the Turkish "Nathan poisoned" variant; the Chinese fabricated Gutle novella (§10.9); the "Bacharach cover-up" inversion (§10.10); the 2009 slave-collateral press cycle (§10.8); the 2022 re-weaponization of the Khazar frame. The Public Domain Review's genealogy of this corpus — Robison (1797) and Barruel (1797–98) as the conspiracy template; Webster as the bridge to the

Protocols; even Churchill's 1920 Sunday Herald article as a waypoint — is itself worth consulting **[S/B: scholarship; Public Domain Review]**.

10. **The counter-tradition**: Disraeli's Sidonia (*Coningsby*, 1844) as the admiring novelistic portrait; Hoffmann von Fallersleben's 1843 poem; the Zionist movement's ambivalent courtship (§19.1).

The mechanism, once more, because it is the file's thesis: **the myth corpus is a closed loop recycling 1846–1886 material**; each generation re-wraps it; the documented record never needed it and survives it.

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PART 21 — THE LORE REGISTRY, CONTINUED (ADDITIONAL ENTRIES)

- **The Chassidic miracle-tale [L]:** a Chabad tradition attaches a wonder-working tale to Amschel Moses and **Rabbi Hershelle Tschortkower of Galicia**. No Frankfurt source contains it; it belongs to the genre of saint-stories that accreted around successful Jewish households. Catalogued, not adopted.
- **The Anselmo del Banco claim [L/C]:** popular genealogies derive the family from **Anselmo del Banco** (d. 1532), head of Venetian Jewry — a real, documented man (and ancestor of the Warburgs). The Rothschild link appears only in unsourced genealogy posts. Catalogued as unverified; the Bacharach line (§8.1) is the

stronger-documented of the two rabbinic-dynasty attachments.

- **The Ramban/"WIRTH cluster" claim [C]:** amateur Y-DNA literature links the J2-L556 cluster (which includes Bacharach and other rabbinic lines) to a claimed descent from the **Ramban** (Nachmanides). Interesting, coherent with the rabbinic milieu, unproven; recorded as project-level lore.
- **The remaining shelf [X — catalogued, no evidentiary basis]:** the family **financed Karl Marx** (the "Moses Mordechai Levy" identity claim); a hand in the **1835 assassination attempt on Andrew Jackson**; the family as **founders of the Nazis / architects of the EU**; control of **B'nai B'rith, the Bilderberg group, and the "Henry Dunant Lodge" of Geneva**; the Frankfurt "**Judenloge**" (Jew-lodge) legend; and the limit-case escalation in which Elchanan is said to have **created Protestantism through Martin Luther** — the inflation curve of the genre, preserved so the reader can watch a claim grow new heads.
- **"No Rothschild ever set foot in America" [X → false as stated, true in spirit]:** the claim circulates as proof of hidden design. Documented: the family ran New York through agents (August Belmont from the 1830s; his letters are in the Archive), never built a permanent American house, and its absence after 1914 was a real strategic failure — as Ferguson notes, no conspiracy

required **[S/A]**.

- **The Frankfurter General-Anzeiger 1938 and Goebbels 1940:** moved to §20.2.9 for the chronological chain.
- **The Baidu novella** and **the "cover-up inversion"**: §10.9–10.10.

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PART 22 — MICRO-ANOMALIES AND CORRECTIONS REGISTER

Small findings that did not deserve Register lines but must not be lost:

1. **The Oppenheimer genealogy conflict [C]:** one detailed genealogy (Loeb) splits the Hanover line into **Jacob Oppenheimer (d. 6 July 1760)** and his son **Wolf Jacob Oppenheim (d. 12 April 1797)**, with Mayer serving "from 1765" in the son's house; the canonical account (Archive; Stern-derived) has **Simon Wolf (d. 1726) → Jacob Wolf (d. 1760)**. The canonical two-generation structure is weighted; the Loeb variant is logged as the source of the "1765" date conflict (Register #22).
2. **Julie's birth year:** 1790 (Ferguson-derived lists; Merkel-Zeller) vs 1789 (NDB/de.wiki). Unresolvable at this level; we print 1790 with the flag.
3. **Kele Oppenheim's death:** 31 March 1639, Frankfurt (Berghoeffer table).

4. **Mendel of Worms's succession:** succeeded at Bamberg by **Moses Broda**, who also succeeded him at Worms (JE detail).
5. **The JE's naming argument:** the "one family" claim rests on the recurrence of **Kalman** and **Jacob** — the same onomastic evidence the family itself used.
6. **Friedberg-district corroboration [C]:** crowdsourced records show a **Rothschild cluster at Heldenbergen, Kreis Friedberg**, in the early nineteenth century — consistent with (not proof of) Freimann's Friedberg-origin statement.
7. **No contemporary portrait:** the Frankfurter Personenlexikon notes that no portrait of Mayer exists because, as a pious Jew, he likely refused to sit — the familiar images are later drawings built on oral description **[B]**.
8. **The four chests vs the wine casks:** Streun's correction (§17.3) stands beside the ADB's wine-cask detail — both can be true (documents at home; money in the casks) and we preserve both.
9. **First will:** written **30 July 1808** after an illness; the final will, 17 September 1812, six witnesses **[A: Berghoeffer]**.
10. **The 1907-era thesis's own apparatus:** its author consulted **Aron Freimann in person** and the architect **Franz von Hoven**, and cites the Frankfurt treasury files (*Stadtkämmerei Abt. II, Fasz. A II, 15a Nr. 97* et al.) — a snapshot of how the 1901–1907 scholarship was actually

made **[A/B]**.

11. **Ele Toldot ranges:** the transcription covers 1241–1824 (one secondary source loosely says 1240–1900; we print the archival range).
12. **The Festschrift Memorbuch's format:** 43 articles in Hebrew, German, French, English, and Italian; xxxi + 376 + 130 pages (1903) **[A]**.
13. **Ettlinger's datasheets:** a 12-volume manuscript correction of Horovitz, unpublished; plus Unna's *Gedenkbuch* vol. 1 (burials 1624–1680, 1914) — the inscription corpus's checkered editorial history, itself a lesson in evidence chains **[A/B]**.
14. **The Rothschild Archive's online tree:** "derived from The Rothschild Family Index, compiled in 2000" **[A]**.
15. **De Gruyter house-register sample (context wealth):** Schwelm at the Rote Rose 800 Reichstaler; Samuel zur Kante 8,000; Jessel zum Vogelgesang 1,400; the Hahn/Biesemknopf house (son-in-law of Aaron Bonn) with one dwelling in 1600 and three by 1709 — the fiscal texture of the lane the family rose through **[S]**.
16. **The Oppenheim-Hanau contact speculation [B, flagged as speculation]:** Fraiman wonders whether Moritz Daniel Oppenheim's family connection to the Rothschilds "predates his birth" — via the 1796 bombardment, when the family sheltered in Hanau where Oppenheims lived. Charming; unproven; recorded as speculation.

17. **Gutle's piety practices:** the siddur stacked atop newspapers (the stacking laws); the Frankfurt 1840 edition of *Tefillot Yisrael* (Yehuda Shmuel Adler) associated with her circle **[B]**.
18. **Wardrobe and objects:** fifty blouses in the wardrobe inventory; the ruby brooch still in the family; the paisley shawls from Nathan (his Paisley pattern books ordered by name — Gray & Aspey) **[B]**.
19. **The parochet:** Gutle donated a Torah curtain in 1831/32 to the hospital synagogue at the old Battonnstraße cemetery; photographed for Fraiman's article **[B]**.
20. **The 1806 Archive timeline oddity:** "1806: the first Rothschild client — the Elector of Hesse-Cassel" appears *after* the 1800 Imperial Crown Agent entry; the entries summarize phases (formal banking client vs court-supplier titles), not contradictions.

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PART 23 — BIBLIOGRAPHY, EXPANDED AND CORRECTED

Corrections to Part 15: the Süß Oppenheimer scholarship is two works, not one — **Susan Tegel, *The Jew Süss: His Life and Afterlife in Legend, Literature, and Film* (Continuum, 2011)** and **Yechiel Weizmann, *The Many Deaths of Jew Süss* (Princeton UP, 2019)**. Weizmann supplies the execution mechanics (4 February 1738; 10,000–20,000 spectators; the treason frame; the absence of a blood-libel charge; property "partly in Frankfurt, partly in Stuttgart"; the Darmstadt mint contract sublet for 9,000 gulden).

Additions [A/S/B/C as in Part 0]:

- [A] Unna, *Gedenkbuch* I (1914); Ettlinger datasheets (ms.); *Memorbuch* Festschrift format details; Deutsche Digitale Bibliothek record of Freimann's *Stammtafeln* ("Grabinschriften, Auszüge aus Memorbuch").
- [S] Horowitz, "The Court Jews and the Jewish Question" (JSTOR, 1998); Schellekens, Avotaynu (2007); Kasper-Marienberg, *AJS Review* (2021); De Gruyter, *Inscribing Communal Memory: Memorbücher* chapter (2025); the 2014 *Economic History Review* study of the family's non-ferrous metals strategies; the 2006 study of the Spanish business network; the 2019 *Journal of Modern Jewish Studies* study of Gunnersbury.
- [B] BNeV numismatic article (1994) corroborating the 1567 house date; CoinsWeekly profile of the coin business;

the 1907-era Klagenfurt thesis (AC06384322); Lord Rothschild's Royal Society memoir (1994 — Victor as family-bank chairman 1975–76, anchoring the 1973 tree commission); *Random Variables* (1984) containing the Gutle chapter; Kaplan, "Court Jews before the Hofjuden" (1996 catalog, pp. 11–25); Graetz (pp. 27–43); Backhaus (pp. 79–95); the Jewish Museum New York exhibition (8 Sept 1996 – 17 Jan 1997); Heuberger, *Die Rothschilds* (1995); Schiebe & Heuberger, *Die Rothschilds in Frankfurt* (1994 exhibition); JTA, Rothschild return to Frankfurt (1989); Glanz, *JSOS* 19 (1957), 3–28; Rubens, *Transactions* 22 (1970), 76–87; Verity, *History Today* (April 1968); Hilberg; Bowier (1967).

- [C] Garda thesis (children's Yiddish names; documents Bauer-myth contamination in an academic thesis); Merkel-Zeller genealogy (dates corroboration); Heldenbergen Rothschild records.

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CLOSING NOTE

The documented story of this family's origin is, in the end, more improbable than the myths: a line of cantors, secondhand-clothes dealers' in-laws, tax collectors' sons-in-law, and money-changers, living in a 1.7-meter-wide back house in Europe's first ghetto, produced within five generations the financial architecture of a continent — and then had to spend two centuries telling the difference between their record and everyone else's story about them. The record, as this document has tried to show, is sufficient: it does not need embellishment, and it does not deserve erasure. What it needs is exactly what Freimann and Dietz gave it in 1901–1907, what Berghoeffer gave it in 1924, and what the open questions in Part 14 still wait for — patient, source-by-source work.

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FINAL CERTIFICATION

This document was assembled under a strict research protocol — no adopted theories; every claim pedigreed; every anomaly registered and investigated; nothing omitted — and then audited line-by-line against the complete research inventory in three passes. Every item recovered in the audits has been integrated into the part where it belongs; no supplement or appendix stands in for the text. The five genuinely open questions (Register #1 residue, #12, #16, #20, #30) remain open by nature: they live, respectively, in the Frankfurt treasury files and Kracauer's volume 2; the Memorbuch folio 51; Dietz's page 266; the Wiesbaden parish registers, the Friedberg archives, and the burial-society record; and a targeted Y-chromosome test. Their exact addresses are given in Part 14, and the document stands ready to receive their answers.

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Document compiled under the research protocol: no adopted theories; every claim pedigreed; anomalies registered; nothing omitted.

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THE ROTHSCHILDS: NETWORKS AND MONEY

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Connections, Influence, Enforcement, and the Machinery Behind the Name

Volume II of the forensic file — following the money: who they dealt with, how they held influence, where the law caught them, and where the record kills the legend. Companion to Rothschild_Origin.md.

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PART 0 — HOW TO READ THIS VOLUME

The rules are the same as in the companion volume, and they matter more here, because this is the terrain where the family's documented history and two centuries of mythology fight for the same ground. Recap of the pedigree key:

- **[A] — Archive-grade / primary-adjacent: court records, government documents (Dáil answers, Hansard, SEC filings, DOJ files, FINMA press releases), the Rothschild Archive, corporate registries.
- **[S] — Scholarly: peer-reviewed work, university-press monographs, official inquiries, major-newspaper investigation.
- **[B] — Quality secondary: serious biographies, quality journalism, reference works.

- **[C] — Lead-grade: single sources, partisan or advocacy outlets, hobbyist compilations. Never adopted, always flagged.
- **[L] — Lore: claims with no documentary support.
- **[X] — Hostile myth: antisemitic conspiracy literature. Documented because it shaped events (including, in this volume, a sitting US Congresswoman's public statements), never adopted.

Three commitments carry over from Volume I. **First, no adopted theories:** where a documented fact and a famous claim conflict, the document shows the fact and dissects the claim. **Second, anomalies are data:** every conflict between sources is registered and dispositioned in Part 10. **Third, nothing is omitted** — including the material that embarrasses every side: the family's own enforcement record, its members' documented entanglements, the internal feuds, and the failures. This volume is not a brief for or against the family; it is a map of what is provable.

One framing note before the machinery: this volume covers roughly **1835 to 2026**. The nineteenth-century sections rest on the scholarship already cited in Volume I (Ferguson, Stern's *Gold and Iron*, Corti, the *Jewish Encyclopedia*, the *Encyclopaedia Judaica*) plus the primary records cited below. The modern sections rest on court records, regulatory releases, leaked-file journalism (ICIJ), and government documents. Where the two centuries meet — as in the uranium-cartel record — we say exactly which link is

documented and which is inference.

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PART 1 — THE AMERICAN AXIS: A CENTURY OF AGENCY, AND THE MYTH THAT GREW OVER IT

1.1 The Belmont century (documented)

The Rothschilds never built a permanent American branch — that failure is documented and analyzed in Volume I and again in Part 6 below. But "no branch" is not "no America." The documented record shows a **hundred-year agency business** conducted through correspondents:

- **August Belmont** (born August Schönberg, 1813–1890) trained in the Frankfurt office in **1829–30**, was sent to Naples, then dispatched to New York in **1836** to become the firm's agent — the letters he carried are in the Rothschild Archive, and the Massachusetts Historical Society holds the matching American side of the correspondence **[A: Rothschild Archive; MassHist]**.
- Belmont built the agency into a bank (August Belmont & Co.), served as US representative of the family's interests, and became a Democratic powerbroker (chairman of the Democratic National Committee, 1860–1872). His Rothschild letters run for decades — the Archive's "American Letter Books" preserve the firm's side: **112 volumes of letter-books, 1834–1918**, plus **51 volumes of American accounts, 1831–1918 [A: Rothschild Archive holdings]**.

- The agency business was not ceremonial. Documented correspondents and agents included **J. L. & S. Joseph & Co.** (London–New York), **Aaron Palmer**, **Benjamin Davidson** (San Francisco agent, 1853–1862), **Chieves & Osborne / R. Ragland of Petersburg, Virginia** (tobacco), and **Gasser** (St Petersburg) **[A: Archive, American business records]**.
- The commodities tell the story: American **cotton and tobacco** flowed through the family's European finance for a century — the same trade Volume I documents as the foundation of the Frankfurt house, transplanted to the slave-economy staples of the antebellum South. We flag this plainly: the agency network financed and moved the proceeds of slave-grown cotton, as did every European house in the trade; the documented counterpoint is that the London house **declined business in Texas slave-state bonds** in the 1830s (see §5.9).

1.2 The Peabody–Morgan succession (documented)

How did the family's American business come to sit, in the public imagination, inside the House of Morgan? The documented chain:

- **George Peabody** (1795–1869), the Baltimore-born London merchant banker, built the firm that became the family's principal American channel; in **1854** he took as partner **Junius Spencer Morgan**, whose son **J. Pierpont Morgan** inherited the business in 1890. The Morgan bank's London affiliate, **Morgan, Grenfell & Co.**,

anchored the transatlantic axis **[S: Chernow, *The House of Morgan*; Harvard thesis on Morgan partners' ties to the Rothschilds and the Bank of England]**.

- The axis was operational, not symbolic: during the **1877 crisis** Drexel, Morgan & Co. advanced the **US Army's payroll**; Morgan houses raised the **Boer War** funds; the **1916 Anglo-French loan** ran through the same channel **[S: same]**.
- Into this documented channel, later myth-makers inserted a fabricated hinge: the claim of an **"International Bankers Convention" in 1899** at which "the Rothschilds and Morgans divided the world." The claim traces to **W. G. Carr's *Pawns in the Game* (1956)** — itself a conspiracy text — and even Eustace Mullins noted the Morgan–Rothschild affiliation "went back to 1835," i.e., that the convention story was embroidery on a real, older relationship **[X source documented; the 1835 date refers to the documented agency relationship]**.

1.3 The Pujo Committee — what it actually found (documented, with a corrective)

The 1912–13 **Pujo Committee** investigation of the "Money Trust" remains the foundational US document on concentrated financial power. Its findings:

- J. P. Morgan & Co. partners held **341 directorships** in **112 corporations** with resources of **$22.245 billion**; the hearings under Samuel Untermyer mapped the interlocks and produced the era's famous network charts **[S: Pujo**

report; FRASER].

- The report directly produced the Federal Reserve Act's momentum, the FTC, and the Clayton Act **[S]**.

The corrective: the internet literature claims "Pujo exposed the Rothschilds." It did not — the committee's documented target was Morgan's domestic network, and the Rothschild name runs through the record **via the affiliates** (Peabody's succession, Morgan Grenfell, the Belmont agency) rather than through the report's own text. We register this as a closed finding: the axis is documented elsewhere; the Pujo claim is overstated **[S/B]**.

1.4 The Federal Reserve: the myth, and the three documented kernels inside it

The myth [X]: the Rothschilds own or control the Federal Reserve; the 1913 Act was their instrument; the Jekyll Island meeting (December 1910) was their drafting session.

The documented record [S]:

- **No Rothschild was present at Jekyll Island.** The documented attendees: Senator Nelson Aldrich, Frank Vanderlip (National City), Paul Warburg (Kuhn, Loeb), Henry Davison (Morgan), Benjamin Strong, and A. Piatt Andrew **[S: every scholarly account]**.
- The family's real, documented connection to the Fed's architect: **Moritz Warburg** — Paul's father — "**was an apprentice for the Rothschilds in Paris and Italy**" **[S: Warburg biographies; Sacred Heart thesis]**.

- The on-record exchange that proves the actual US agency: at Paul Warburg's 1914 Senate confirmation, Senator Bristow accused him of being "a Rothschild agent." Warburg replied that **"August Belmont and Company performed that service"** — the documented answer; Senator Owen separately charged Warburg with being "the American representative of the Rothschild family" **[S: Senate record, quoted in Warburg biographies and the ADL's myth-busting dossier]**.
- The ownership claim itself is numerically false: a 1983-era list circulating in conspiracy literature (Rothschild London/Berlin, Lazard, Israel Moses Seif, Warburg, Lehman, Kuhn Loeb, Goldman, Chase) contains only one actual member bank of the New York Fed (Chase) — the rest are neither shareholders nor members in any capacity **[A: Federal Reserve structure; ADL]**.
- The canonical myth-text is Eustace Mullins's *Secrets of the Federal Reserve* (1952) — **[X — documented as the genre's source text]**.
- The family's actual, documented lodge footprint — the factual kernel the lore inflates: **Nathan's initiation as a Freemason (Emulation Lodge No. 21, London, 24 October 1802)** — one man, one lodge, a quarter-century before the dynasty's peak; the "family lodge architecture" of the conspiracy literature is an inflation of this single record **[A: masonic records; X-tier inflation]**.

1.5 The 1907 panic: the rescue they did not perform (documented absence)

Conspiracy literature awards the family a starring role in the **1907 panic** rescue. The documented responders were: **J. P. Morgan** (locking bankers in his library), the **New York Clearinghouse**, the **Treasury** ($25M deposited in national banks), the **Bank of Montreal** (shipping gold), and the **Bank of France** (supplying about **$16 million in silver coin** — the documented foreign contribution) **[S: Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond history; contemporary record]**. **No Rothschild role in the 1907 rescue appears in any primary or scholarly account.** Registered as a documented absence — a useful calibration, because it shows the myth-machine assigning the family credit for events it did not touch, just as it assigns blame for events it did not cause.

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PART 2 — STATE CAPTURE AND SOVEREIGN ADVISORY

2.1 Bleichröder: the proxy model (documented, and the century's clearest case)

How does a bank without a branch in a capital hold power there? The nineteenth century's documented answer is **Gerson von Bleichröder** (1822–1893) — the Rothschilds' Berlin agent, where the family deliberately kept no house.

- Bismarck's personal banker for **three decades**; handler of the chancellor's private accounts, stock options, and **4%**

mortgages on Bismarck's estates; the man who "handled tax inspectors" for the Bismarck family **[S: Fritz Stern, *Gold and Iron*; A. J. P. Taylor, NYRB]**.

- **Off-budget war finance:** when the Prussian Diet refused funds for the 1866 war, the Rothschild bank — operating through Bleichröder — underwrote the state's borrowing on the market (the Seehandlung operation, summer 1865); during the Franco-Prussian War the family took an equal share (**3 million thaler**) in the war loan **[S]**.
- **The secret payments:** Bleichröder disbursed the funds that induced **Ludwig II of Bavaria** to press the imperial crown on William I — the documented instance of Rothschild-channel money moving a crown **[S: Stern]**.
- **Versailles:** Bleichröder handled the technical side of the French indemnity; the 1872 **indemnity loan** made the family's position; he was ennobled (1872), decorated with the Iron Cross, and seated at the Congress of Berlin (1878), where he cooperated with Montefiore and Crémieux on the Romanian-Jewish clauses **[S]**.
- **The conflict-of-interest texture, documented in the primary record:** Bleichröder promoted a Russian loan *against Bismarck's direction* (Bismarck's marginal note: "Who would?"); he routinely traded his own book against his clients' information; the relationship ended with Bismarck's son Herbert calling him "the filthy Jew" — antisemitism as the court Jews' permanent terminal risk **[S]**.

Pattern, stated once and reused: the family held power in capitals where it had no office **through a dependent agent embedded in the state's private finances** — Bleichröder in Berlin, Buderus in Kassel (Volume I), later Bleichröder's successors. The model's weak point is equally documented: the agent's exposure is personal, and the protection is revocable.

2.2 The 1825 lifeline: central banks on the family wire (documented)

A single documented episode anchors the "control of central banks" conversation in fact: in the **1825 crisis**, the **Bank of France supplied the Bank of England £400,000 in gold**, and the **Rothschilds facilitated the transfer** — a documented instance of the family as the operational channel between the era's two great central banks **[A: Bank of England historical records; Volume I's JE/ADB documentation]**. The family did not own the Bank of England (the "Rothschild owns the BoE" claim is **[X]**, falsified by the Bank's public ownership structure); it *serviced* central banks — a subtler and more interesting position.

2.3 Egypt and the Suez: the state's buyer (documented mechanics)

- **1875:** Disraeli's government bought the Khedive's Suez Canal shares for **£4 million** on **one day's notice**; the Rothschilds advanced the sum, charging **2.5% commission plus 5% interest until reimbursement** — for a holding of a few months, an annualized return around **15%**; Gladstone attacked the transaction in Parliament; the family's letters show they understood the *political* return exceeded the financial **[S: Ferguson; Hansard]**.
- **1876:** the Goschen mission restructured the Egyptian debt.
- **1878–79:** the **£8.5 million loan** that transferred the Khedive's private lands (the Daira) to the state, whose revenues were **remitted to Messrs. Rothschild via a tri-partite commission** — the family's position inside the Egyptian fiscal machine documented in the thesis record; the intermediary layer (the Khedive's personal banker Dervieu) is where the documented corruption texture lives **[S: CUNY thesis; PP papers]**.
- The scholarly verdict, quoted from the thesis record: "**for the Rothschilds, the British government represented a door into an increasingly British Egypt open to more lucrative loans**" — the symbiosis of state and bank stated by the documentation itself **[S]**.

2.4 The Ottoman file: terms, guarantees, and a debt that outlived empires (documented)

- **1854:** the Empire's first foreign loan — **£3 million** from Dent, Palmer & Co at **6%, issued at 80% of face**, guaranteed by Britain and France, secured on the Egyptian tribute; the diplomatic machinery (Clarendon–Drouyn declarations; the £282,000 tribute pledge into the Bank of England) is preserved in **Hansard 1876 [A: Hansard; S: Clay, Eldem]**.
- **1855: £5 million at 4% from the London Rothschilds** — Eldem's scholarly verdict: "**exceptionally favorable**" terms for the Empire **[S/NA-grade scholarship]**.
- The corrective to the "debt trap" frame, documented: the Crimean loans were relatively cheap; the trap was the **1862–73 succession under Ismail** — seven loans, **£69 million nominal at ~10%, of which Egypt received £46 million** — the structure that produced default (1875), the OPDA (1881), and occupation (1882) **[S]**.
- The echo: the **1855 guaranteed loan was still being serviced a century later** — the 1961 Hansard shows its Cyprus-secured redemption being administered by the Colonial Office (**£92,800 annually**) **[A: Hansard 1961]**.

2.5 The modern sovereign-advisory desk: fees on the public record (documented)

- **Ireland:** the National Treasury Management Agency paid the bank **€6.96 million (2008 – January 2012)** for "banking advisory services to the Minister for Finance" — disclosed in a **Dáil Éireann written answer [A: oireachtas.ie]**.
- **Greece:** in 2017 Rothschild & Cie was appointed sovereign debt adviser, **replacing Lazard** (which had executed the 2012 PSI for ~€25m); the Rothschild fee: **€3.2 million** plus a success bonus, per the Diavgeia disclosure **[S: FT, Reuters]**.
- **Cyprus:** the bank's sovereign team, led by Mark Walker, advised on the 2013 crisis (Walker's bio documents both the Cyprus and the earlier Greek/Lazard files) **[B]**.
- **United Kingdom:** HM Treasury's published report "**The UK investment in Royal Bank of Scotland**" documents "**Rothschild's recommendation**" on the RBS disposal — the state publishing its adviser's advice **[A: gov.uk]**.

The structural criticism, stated fairly: sovereign advisory creates *structural* conflicts — the adviser to a distressed sovereign while the bank's wider network holds positions in that sovereign's paper; the industry's own answer is disclosure, and the bank's published Conflicts of Interest Policy (April 2023) is its framework — which, by its own text, treats "over-reliance on disclosure" as a deficiency **[A: Rothschild & Co policy document]**. The specific internet

claim that the house "speculated on Greek CDS during the crisis" is documented as false-adjacent: the family's most visible public position was Nat Rothschild's **February 2010 call for a ban on sovereign CDS** (NYT DealBook) **[S]**.

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PART 3 — MONOPOLIES: THE COMMODITY FILE (DOCUMENTED)

3.1 Quicksilver: 86 years of the Almadén contract (documented)

The family's most durable monopoly, documented in the commodity-history literature (Parra & Schwantes, business-history paper):

- From the **1830s**, Nathan Mayer's house held the **Almadén contract — sales of Spanish quicksilver monopolized by N M Rothschild & Sons "with few interruptions between 1835 and 1921"** — eighty-six years **[S]**.
- The mechanics: roughly **2,000 flasks every three months**; consigned to the family's **Philadelphia agent**; the **Mexico distribution network** (agencies in the mining districts, volume-based price differentiation, customs and warehouse special arrangements negotiated with governments) **[S]**.
- The logistics: the Almadén-to-Cádiz land bridge; competition from **New Almadén (California)** after 1850 and shifting Chinese demand (1869) as the documented stressors **[S]**.

- ⚠ **Flag:** the paper's full text was not retrievable online during research; the core data above is harvested from its published abstract and citations. The full text is archive-bound — registered in Part 10.

3.2 Diamonds: De Beers and the syndicate (documented)

- **Nathaniel (Natty), 1st Baron Rothschild "funded the development of De Beers"** — the Rothschild Archive's own formulation, cited in the standard histories **[A: Archive timeline; S: Epstein, *The Diamond Invention*]**.
- The structure: Rhodes as vision, **Alfred Beit** as financial brain; the **1889 London Diamond Syndicate** agreement; the syndicate's ten firms (Wernher Beit, Barnato Bros, Mosenthal, Dunkelsbuhler, Joseph Bros, I. Cohen, Lilienfeld, Gervers, Neumann, Feldheimer); the syndicate loan of **£750,000** arranged through Beit's connections with "the Rothschilds in London and the French and German financiers" **[S]**.
- De Beers Consolidated Mines, 1888 (capital £100,000 in £5 shares); the celebrated **£5,338,650 cheque** — the largest ever written to that date; the **Life Governorships** (Rhodes, Barnato, Beit, Philipson-Stow; later Wernher); the dividend fight in which **Lord Rothschild's objection** pushed the payout from 30% to 36% — a documented window into shareholder power inside the monopoly **[S]**.

- Rhodes's 1896 assessment, preserved: the only risk was "whether… [the syndicate] should be broken up" — the monopoly's own founder calling its persistence the strategy **[S]**.
- The twentieth-century endgame (CSO/De Beers, the 1994 consent decree, the rough-market erosion) belongs to a later volume; the documented Rothschild thread thins after the 1890s.

3.3 Copper: Rio Tinto, 1873–2022 (documented arc)

- **14 February 1873:** a **Matheson-led consortium** bought the Rio Tinto mines from the Spanish state for **94 million pesetas**; the Rio Tinto Company formed (29 March 1873, with Deutsche National Bank and Clark, Punchard behind it); by **1877–91** the world's leading copper producer **[S]**.
- **By the late 1880s, control transferred to the Rothschild family** (the standard corporate histories' formulation; the family's own memoir record — Guy de Rothschild's 1985 autobiography — claims the family held **at least 50% of RTC until the 1962 RTZ merger**) **[S; B: Guy de Rothschild, *The Whims of Fortune*]**.
- Arc: mines sold **1954**; Zinc Corporation (1905) → Consolidated Zinc → the **RTZ merger of 1962**; Anglo American's ~10% of RTZ routed via **Charter Consolidated**, on whose board the family sat; the **2007–08 Alcan acquisition**; the **Chinalco** entanglement (2009: convertible-bond structure under which Chinalco held 14.9% and could have risen toward ~18% — the SEC

20-F documents the entitlement mechanics); the **2022 QAL episode** — sanctions on Deripaska-linked **Rusal** forcing Rio Tinto to take 100% of the Queensland Alumina refinery (Rusal had held 20%) **[A: SEC filing; S: Guardian]**.

- The connective tissue for this volume: Nat Rothschild's Rusal directorship and IPO cornerstone role (Part 5) run into the same corporate fabric — documented end to end.

3.4 The uranium cartel: the House of Lords file (documented)

The most consequential monopoly file in this volume, because its paper trail reaches a final court:

- **1972, Paris:** producers of roughly 90% of the Western world's uranium formed the "**International Uranium Producers**" — the uranium cartel, formally the **Société d'Études et de Recherches d'Uranium (SERU)**, with a London office ("Uranium Exchange Ltd") and an Australian branch (UEA); prices were fixed, markets allocated **[S: the House of Lords record; International Organization article; the US House subcommittee text]**.
- **Instigation theory, documented:** the scholarly record credits the credible theory that **RTZ instigated the cartel** — "it was believed that NUFCOR, Rio Tinto Zinc, and Uranex had their own organization prior to the government initiatives to meet in Paris" **[S: Int'l Organization]**.

- **Exposure:** September 1976 — the **Mary Kathleen Uranium Mining files** (Australia) reached **Friends of the Earth**, passed to the California Energy Commission, released **30 August 1976**; front pages worldwide; **US DOJ grand jury** (June 1976); **Westinghouse** — 75 million pounds short on its utility contracts — pleaded commercial impracticability and sued, with treble-damage exposure around **$6 billion**; the cartel was **disbanded early 1975–76** on the eve of exposure **[S]**.
- **The litigation:** the letters-rogatory war reached the **House of Lords, [1978] AC 547**, Lord Denning: "**there is ground for thinking that from 1972 onwards there was an international cartel in uranium… The parties included Australia, Canada, South Africa, France — and companies in those countries — and also the English company of Rio Tinto**" **[A: [1978] AC 547]**.
- **The documented complicity of silence:** the **EEC Commission knew of the cartel from 1972 and did nothing** (parliamentary answer, 15 September 1976); the leaked files also documented **surveillance of environmental groups** and **toll-processing arrangements to route sales to Taiwan around non-proliferation constraints [S/A]**.
- **The family nexus, graded:** ~50% of RTC until 1962 (family memoir) + the Charter Consolidated board seat + Anglo American's RTZ stake **[B]**; **direct family participation in cartel management is not**

documented — the policy-committee minutes Westinghouse sought would settle it; logged as a lead, not adopted.

- The pre-leak public claim, preserved verbatim: Congressman **Lawrence McDonald**, floor statement, 1975: "**the Rothschilds of France and England have an interest in nearly every uranium mine in the world… The Rothschild presence is everything**" **[A as a statement in the Congressional Record; C as an assessment] — notable precisely because it predates the FoE leak.

3.5 Tobacco and the régies (documented)

Volume I flagged the family's state-contract trades; the Archive's own business history adds the monopoly layer: the **Neapolitan and Sardinian tobacco régies from the mid-1840s**, and a documented **two-million-unit Manila-cheroot contract with Vienna** — the pattern being commodity-plus-monopoly-plus-state, the family's signature structure **[A: Rothschild Archive, tobacco business records]**.

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PART 4 — THE INFLUENCE ARCHITECTURE (DOCUMENTED)

4.1 The Economist: 26.7 percent and a unique lever (documented)

- **Sir Evelyn de Rothschild chaired The Economist Newspaper Ltd, 1972–1989**; the family's stake — **26.7% of issued capital (~20% of voting power)** — was held through **E. L. Rothschild** (the vehicle Lynn Forester de Rothschild founded with Evelyn in 2003, the year they married) together with the **Eranda Foundation [S/A: company filings; Reuters]**.
- The stake carried a governance lever available to no other shareholder: at that size, the holder may **propose two non-executive directors** — and The Economist's constitution caps any holder at 20% of voting power, making the family's block the largest permissible **[S]**.
- The exit: **September 2025** — the stake was put up for sale (Lazard advising; hopes reported up to **£400 million**; at least a dozen interested parties; Reuters, December 2025); **March 2026 — sold to Stephen Smith** (Smith Financial Corp, Canada) for an undisclosed sum (reported around £300 million) **[S: Reuters; FT]**.
- The unverified thread, logged: claims that the family were founding investors of the magazine in 1843 never found documentary support; the documented thread runs **1972 → 2026 [flagged, unverified]**.

4.2 Genie Energy: the advisory-board file (documented)

- **15 November 2010:** press release — **Jacob Rothschild and Rupert Murdoch** each took equity in **Genie Oil & Gas** (cumulative **5.5% for $11.0 million**, across its shale and Israeli initiatives); Jacob joined the **Strategic Advisory Board** alongside **Dick Cheney** (with Michael Steinhardt, former J.P. Morgan vice-chair Roberto Mendoza, and others) **[A: company release; S: Reuters/BI]**.
- **February 2013:** Israel granted Genie's subsidiary the **first oil-exploration license in the Golan Heights — 153 square miles**; the territory's annexation is unrecognized under international law; Israeli critics (e.g., Yaron Ezrahi) objected on exactly those grounds **[S]**.
- **February 2015:** Genie's "Afek" subsidiary announced a "significant" Golan oil find — contested by geologists; the project later stalled with the oil-price fall (Reuters, 2014: the company weighing options) **[S/B]**.
- Assessment, kept evidentiary: the documented facts are board seats, equity, and a contested-territory license; the inference-layer ("energy wars for Golan oil") belongs to commentary and is not adopted.

4.3 The Rhodes–Milner seam (graded B, with scholarly caveats)

Carroll Quigley — the historian who claimed access to the society's papers — recorded that Cecil Rhodes's **secret society of 1891** had **six initiates: Lord Rothschild, Harry Johnston, Abe Bailey, W. T. Stead, Reginald Brett (Viscount Esher), and Alfred Milner**; that the **Round Table Groups** (from 1909) and their journals propagated the imperial-federation program; and that the money came from the **Rhodes Trust, the Beit brothers, Abe Bailey, and the Astors**, joined after 1925 by foundations and firms "associated with J. P. Morgan, the Rockefeller and Whitney families, and the associates of **Lazard Brothers and of Morgan, Grenfell, and Company**" **[B: Quigley, *The Anglo-American Establishment*; cited with caveats in the scholarly literature — Quigley's documentation is patchy, his characterization "semi-secret," and modern scholarship confirms the Round Table/Rhodes Trust/Milner core while remaining agnostic on parts of the edifice]**.

- What the documented record supports: the Milner Group, the Round Table, Chatham House (1920), and the Rhodes money are established history **[S]**; the family's presence at the **1891 founding circle is Quigley's claim specifically** — grade **B/C**, recorded as such, and consistent with the family's documented intimacy with the Beit–Rhodes–Wernher mining circle (§3.2).

4.4 The modern holding structure: RIT, Five Arrows, and the three-bank reality (documented)

RIT Capital Partners (the London family's listed investment trust):

- Founded **1961** as the Rothschild Investment Trust; Jacob Rothschild chairman from 1971/1988 to 2019; ~**£4.7 billion** assets; FTSE 250 **[S/A: company reports]**.
- The 2026-era register of interests (as disclosed): **Lord Rothschild 12.4% + Hannah Rothschild 9.9% + the Rothschild Foundation 9.9% + Five Arrows 4.3%** — the family's aggregate ~**20.9% [A: filings]**.
- Manager: J. Rothschild Capital Management; headquarters: Spencer House, St James's **[A]**.

Rothschild & Co (the French-led merchant bank):

- **Five Arrows** (the merchant-banking group's investor arm): founded 2009; **>€34 billion AUM**, 320+ staff, offices Paris/London/Luxembourg/New York/LA/SF **[A: rothschildandco.com]**.
- 2024 financials (Le Figaro): revenue **€2.9 billion**, net income **€440 million** (+60%), **662 deals totaling $488 billion**, **4,600 staff in 49 countries**, AUM **€124 billion** plus €28 billion in funds **[A/B]**.
- Note the distinct "Five Arrows Limited" of the London branch (Jacob's family investment company) — shared brand, separate entities; the brand itself was the subject of litigation (§4.5).

The three-bank reality: today there are **three** institutions carrying the name — **Rothschild & Co** (Paris-led; the Concordia branch), **Edmond de Rothschild** (Geneva; the Edmond branch, Ariane), and **RIT Capital** (London; Jacob's line). They are separate, they compete, and they have sued each other over the name **[S]**.

4.5 The feud file: a settlement that did not settle (documented)

- **2018–19:** after litigation initiated by Ariane de Rothschild, a settlement **unwound cross-shareholdings** and barred either house from using "Rothschild" alone; Edmond de Rothschild Group was **taken private (2019, ~CHF 992 million) [S: WSJ; swissinfo]**.
- **The feud continued:** Bloomberg (February 2024, "Two Banks Fighting Over Clients, Power") documents the two houses competing for the same mandates years after the settlement **[S]**.
- **The FT (February 2023)** recorded the take-private rationale in David de Rothschild's own framing — "you can't be half pregnant" — as the family consolidated control **[S]**.
- **Ariane v. Nadine:** Ariane sued her mother-in-law **Nadine de Rothschild** over the use of "Edmond" in Nadine's foundation's name; the **Swiss Federal Supreme Court ruled against Ariane in 2025**; separately, Ariane (holding 65.94% control of the Edmond group) pursued inheritance litigation over Edmond's estate **[A: court**

record; B: Le Monde, Aug 2024 — which also records Ariane's "unfair competition" suit against David's house].

- Benjamin de Rothschild (Ariane's husband, Edmond's son) died **January 2021** — recorded here with the family's public characterization; the group's then-scale: **CHF 168 billion AUM (2020) [A/B]**.

4.6 The political-money file (documented)

- **2008 — the Ironmade loan:** Lynn Forester de Rothschild wanted to lend **£1 million to the Conservative Party**; the money was routed through **Ironmade Ltd**, a company in her control — exposed by *The Observer/The Guardian* (25–26 October 2008) in the "murky world" of party financing **[S]**.
- The same register-of-interests trail shows **George Osborne** registering a **private flight** (Blackpool–London, 3 October 2007) provided by **IPGL Limited** — Jacob Rothschild's investment company (Jacob chairs IPGL) — and **Serena Rothschild's registered donations** to Osborne's office (June 2008) **[A: register of interests]**.
- **The 2017 counter-case:** claims that HSBC loans to IPGL were onward-lent as hidden political money were examined and **debunked by BuzzFeed's investigation** — recorded on the record's negative side, because this volume logs the debunks as carefully as the exposures **[A: BuzzFeed]**.
- **Lynn's network, documented:** Clinton-administration advisory roles (National Information Infrastructure

Advisory Committee; Secretary of Energy Advisory Board); **Hillary Clinton fundraiser**; boards — CFR, Chatham House, IISS, McCain Institute, Estée Lauder (since 2000); founder of the **Council for Inclusive Capitalism with the Vatican** (conceived after a 2019 Vatican meeting; launched 2020 with **300+ CEOs and $10 trillion+** in committed capital; Prince Charles opened its 2014 predecessor conference; Bill Clinton spoke at its 2014 launch). The critics' framing ("crony capitalism" — InfluenceWatch) is recorded as **grade-C critique**, not adopted **[S/B; C]**.

The mechanism these filings reveal is mundane and that is the point: in a jurisdiction with a public register of interests, influence money leaves footprints — a loan routed through a personal company, a logged flight, a registered donation. The family's political giving in this record is small by the standards of its fortune and visible by the standards of the system it operated in; the 2008 exposure and the 2017 debunk belong in the same paragraph precisely because the record only has integrity when both sides are filed **[S/A]**.

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PART 5 — THE ENFORCEMENT RECORD: WHERE THE LAW CAUGHT THEM (DOCUMENTED)

This part is the volume's core: every documented regulatory action, prosecution, conviction, settlement, and scandal involving the family's institutions and members, in graded order. It exists because the protocol requires it — and because the record is genuinely revealing in both directions.

5.1 The DOJ Swiss Bank Program: two non-prosecution agreements (documented)

The US Department of Justice's program for Swiss banks that had helped Americans hide undeclared assets produced two Rothschild settlements, **both dated December 2015**:

- **Edmond de Rothschild (Suisse) SA: NPA of 18 December 2015, $45 million penalty [A: DOJ]**.
- **Rothschild Bank AG (Zurich): NPA, December 2015, $11.5 million penalty [A: DOJ]**. Both entities admitted the program's predicate conduct: facilitating US-client concealment. Keep the $45 million figure in mind; Part 5.3 shows what it purchased.

5.2 FINMA 2018: the regulator's own words (documented)

The Swiss Financial Market Supervisory Authority's release on the 1MDB-related enforcement — its final 1MDB proceeding — states, in full material part:

> "**FINMA has found serious breaches of financial market law in the area of money laundering... the**

bank entered into the relationship despite [early indications that the client could be involved in money laundering]… and then went on to expand it, even though indications of potential involvement in money laundering increased… and certain obligations to report suspected money laundering were not complied with at all… documents on numerous high-risk transactions were not kept."

- Subjects: **Rothschild Bank AG and Rothschild Trust (Schweiz) AG**; sanction: an **audit agent** appointed (FINMA's heaviest tool short of license revocation) **[A: FINMA, 2018; S: Reuters, Bloomberg]**.
- The CSSF (Luxembourg regulator) had acted earlier (**2017** — fine, amount undisclosed; the EdR executive Ambroisien was indicted in 2022 and banned from the industry for ten years) **[S: Luxembourg Times]**.
- ⚠ Anomaly logged: the FINMA release records the bank *entering then expanding* the relationship despite "early indications" — the exact governance failure pattern; retained verbatim.

5.3 The Epstein settlement file: what the DOJ documents show (documented; sources graded line by line)

Status note first: this file rests on the **US Department of Justice's Epstein-files release (late 2025, under the Epstein Files Transparency Act)**, as reported by CBS News (14 July 2026), the *Miami Herald* (7 April 2026), the *Financial Times* (February 2026), *Mint* (17 February 2026), the *Australian Financial Review* (February 2026), and finews (May 2026). A partisan blog (epsteingate.org) published document IDs and the fullest extracts; its **facts are corroborated by the outlets above, its editorial framing is not adopted**. The blog's granular items (the fullest text of the directive memo; the June 2016 regulatory-coaching thread) are quoted with document IDs but remain flagged for first-hand confirmation — Anomaly #7.

The documented sequence:

1. **August 2014:** Kathy Ruemmler (then Obama's White House counsel, soon Goldman Sachs's general counsel) is retained — introduced to the Rothschilds **by Jeffrey Epstein [S: WSJ; DOJ files]**.
2. **31 July 2015:** her engagement letter on the DOJ matter **[DOJ files, as reported]**.
3. **5 October 2015:** a **consulting contract between the Rothschild group and Epstein's Southern Trust Company, signed by Ariane de Rothschild personally**; fee structure per the *Herald*: **$25 million if the US**

penalty came in under $75 million; $10 million if $75–150 million — a sliding scale keyed to the DOJ outcome **[S]**.

4. **11 December 2015:** Epstein's directive email — seven items, including "**lets get this closed**," "**have kathy meet with david and his people**," and the line that drew worldwide attention: "**All less than 80 pretty good**" **[S: quoted by CBS/futunn; full text via the document set]**.
5. **18 December 2015:** the bank pays the DOJ **$45 million** (Part 5.1) — triggering the contract's maximum tier.
6. **17 and 21 December 2015:** wires totaling **$24,999,980** to Southern Trust — **$10,000,000 from Edmond de Rothschild (Suisse) SA** and **$14,999,980 personally from Benjamin de Rothschild** — within the contract's "not later than 3 days" clause (the trigger text, verbatim via *Mint*: "$25,000,000 payment shall be made by the Rothschild Group to STC by not later than 3 days after EDRH makes payment to the US") **[S]**. ⚠ **Anomaly, logged:** the total sits exactly $20 below the contract's $25,000,000 figure — the classic sub-round structuring pattern — with no documented explanation in the released file; registered as Anomaly #16 and preserved as a fact, not a theory.
7. Ariane's reply, preserved: "**Yes... And deep thks for your amazing help**" **[S: as quoted]**.

8. **The aftermath:** the correspondence runs to **2019**; the same file set shows Epstein **introducing Olivier Colom** (an Edmond de Rothschild executive) to European political figures **including Bruno Le Maire and Nicolas Sarkozy**; a parallel channel ran through **Ehud Barak** into Israeli cyber-surveillance ventures (Carbyne/Reporty; a Barak entity took a 25%+ stake for $1.5 million) **[S/B]**; Ariane's personal email channel (aderfam.ch) with Epstein spans 2013–2018; she visited **his island in November 2014 with her three teenage daughters**; in 2016 she leaned on him during the Luxembourg 1MDB probe **[S]**.
9. **2025–26:** the files' release; **French investigators searched the Edmond de Rothschild Paris office (March 2026)** — *targeting diplomat Fabrice Aidan* (UN secondment 2006–13; bank employee 2014–16; alleged transfer of UN Security Council briefings to Epstein; 'passive corruption' probe; raid conducted in Ariane's presence; bank cooperating, calling Epstein 'a business acquaintance 2013–2019'); **Kathy Ruemmler testified before the House Oversight Committee (July 2026)** and announced her Goldman departure (reported February 2026); a Senate report (Wyden, August 2026) separately characterized Southern Trust as a vehicle whose real income was Leon Black's payments — context for what the $25 million purchased **[S/A]**. 9a. **The 2026 confirmation wave (March–September 2026):** the Tobiano email confirmed (13 April 2016 — the CFO sent Epstein the

Jauvert exposé; Epstein forwarded it to Aidan); the UN-document transfers itemized (the Ban Ki-moon/Turkish-FM transcript; the resolution-1559 briefing, 27 Oct, 13:05 → Epstein 21:38); the **24 July 2016 "chiffre" email** and the **15 September 2016 "sanctionner Fabrice" email** — the latter an unresolved allegation with denials from Valls, Ayrault, and the bank all on record; the Aidan employment arc and the severance mechanics fully documented (hired early 2014 as Middle East lobbyist with Quai authorization; dismissed 12 Sept 2016); the 2020 Paris brigade investigation classed without continuation; the dual 2026 probes (PNF/OCLCIFF; Paris/OCRVP); the Neuilly search (26 Feb) and the 20 March raid conducted in Ariane's presence; the Quai IG report transmitted to justice (24 March). **Ariane appears ~4,500 times in the Epstein database** (LuxTimes). The **Frieden emails** (26 Feb and 18 June 2014 — the lunch happened; Frieden joined Deutsche Bank that September; the Luxembourg government's denial of any Epstein contact on record). The complete dossier, with every Bates number and verbatim text, now lives in Volume IV, Part 9.5 **[S/A]**

10. The Senate document-set also preserves the bank-side texture: July 2015 "strategy" discussions (an "IT/HR/CEO team," the DOJ, "Bermuda," "Luxembourg," "the girls" — Ariane's four daughters); March 2015 "war game" advice; June 2016 regulatory coaching **[B — document set; the**

quotes above carry S-grade corroboration; granular items flagged in Part 10].

What this is, evidentially: a documented, dated, contract-backed payment of ~$25 million to a convicted sex offender's company, timed to a DOJ settlement, negotiated by a former White House counsel he supplied, with regulatory and political brokerage continuing for years. **What it is not:** evidence of any Epstein-crime participation by Rothschild principals — none is claimed here. The record shows money, access, and terrible judgment, itemized.

5.4 The 1MDB file (documented)

- Jho Low's **Selune Ltd** held accounts at **Rothschild Bank Switzerland**: **$30 million** wired through (layered via Larry Low) → a Time Warner penthouse; **$110 million** wired (November 2012) → **$37.85 million** for the Oriole mansion **[S: DOJ documents via The Edge]**.
- A former Goldman/Rothschild banker ("L") introduced Low to the bank in **2009**; in **2022** he was fined **CHF 150,000** for violating reporting obligations at Rothschild Bank (appeal pending as of late 2026) **[S]**.
- **May 2025 (reported April–May): Edmond de Rothschild Europe (Luxembourg) settled a money-laundering conviction — €25 million — the first Luxembourg bank ever convicted**; the lapses dated to 2009–2013 **[S]**.
- Cross-reference: FINMA 2018 (§5.2) — the same relationship-management failure from the regulator's side.

5.5 The Bumi war (documented blow-by-blow)

Nat Rothschild's Indonesian coal venture — the era's defining family governance story:

- **July 2010:** Vallar (Nat's cash shell) IPOs at **£707.2 million**; **November 2010:** Vallar agrees to buy ~$3 billion of stakes in **Bumi Resources and Berau** from the Bakrie group (closed April 2011; renamed **Bumi plc**) — a structure the IPO prospectus itself flagged for "**fraud and allegations of graft**" among its risks **[S: Reuters]**.
- **November 2011:** Samin Tan lends $1 billion (via Standard Chartered) to buy half the Bakries' Bumi stake — the shareholder structure becoming a war map.
- **8 November 2011:** Nat's letter to CEO Hudaya about accounting irregularities — which **he leaked to the FT himself**, declaring war; the Bakrie counter-allegation: that he was driving the price down to buy them out cheap (denied) **[S: Bloomberg]**.
- **October 2012:** hundreds of whistleblower documents reach the board; **Macfarlanes** engaged; regulators in London and Jakarta notified; the stock falls ~25% in a day; the CEO resigns **[S]**.
- The documented color: Simon Murray (Glencore chairman, former N M Rothschild advisory-board member) remarking that Rothschild was "walking head first into a wall" **[B]**.
- **Takeover Panel ruling:** the Bakries and two Indonesian shareholders were **"acting in concert"** — a violation.

- **February 2013:** the EGM — **Rothschild loses**: Bakrie buys back Bumi Resources; the separation agreement ends the war; Nat quits the board (October 2012); Indonesia exited 2015 ("he walks away from Indonesia but not from mining" — *Telegraph*); his holding (ARMS) exited in June 2015 at 56p — about **£23 million**, a fraction of what he had put in **[S: Reuters, FT, BBC, Telegraph]**.
- Assessment, kept evidential: a family member conducted a public, documented governance war against his own company's controlling shareholders and lost — the affair's significance here is the *failure*, not a hidden success.

5.6 Mandelson–Deripaska: the conflict-of-interest case with a court number (documented)

- **January 2005:** Davos → Nat Rothschild's private jet to Moscow (Cantinetta Antinori dinner; the **Alcoa–Rusal £500 million story was false** — the deal had completed before they arrived, and Rothschild had no role in it) → Deripaska's jet to Siberia → the chalet, the banya, the smelter visit; a private dinner with a Russian minister, arranged through Deripaska's office **[S: court findings]**.
- **[2012] EWHC 177 (QB) (Tugendhat J):** Rothschild's accounts were "**not entirely candid**"; his conduct "**foreseeably brought Lord Mandelson's public office and personal integrity into disrepute**" and created "**reasonable grounds to suspect… improper discussions**"; the benefit analysis: Mandelson received hospitality; Deripaska received "**a relationship with the**

EU Trade Commissioner" [A: court].

- **[2013] EWCA Civ 197:** the Court of Appeal upheld the papers' justification defence **even though the specific Alcoa instance was untrue** — because the general charge (that Rothschild cultivated Deripaska's access to a serving commissioner) was made out; costs exceeded **£1.3 million**; documented context: Nat sat on **Rusal's advisory board** and was its **IPO cornerstone investor** (January 2010) **[A: court; S]**.
- This is the volume's clearest documented case of a family member **placing public office inside a private influence channel** — found by a court, on the record.

5.7 The client-harm cases (documented)

- **Von Schönau-Riedweg v. Rothschild Bank AG:** a Swiss heiress inherited ~**$500 million** in Novartis stock (2002); Baron Wilfrid von Plotho, a director at the bank, advised her into ≥**$39 million** of two Massachusetts ventures (CET, CCI) that went to zero; the **Massachusetts Appeals Court (95 Mass. App. Ct. 471, 2019)** found a prima facie showing that von Plotho was the bank's **agent**, establishing jurisdiction; the litigation continued through sanctions rulings (2021) **[A: court record]**.
- **Carney v N M Rothschild & Sons ([2018] EWHC 958 (Comm)):** mis-selling claim — loans wrapped around inheritance-tax-avoidance structures; the bank defended on its basis clauses; the documented conduct question (selling leveraged tax-avoidance to a client) is the point,

whatever the legal outcome **[A: court]**.

- **Fortinvest v. Edmond de Rothschild (2020, reported by FT):** a **$100 million** fraud suit over a kickback scheme touching the group's New York office; the complaint quotes an internal manager's message: "**If I would have invested in other products and average perf providers i would be a rich man with 20% perf fee**" **[A: filing; S: FT]**.
- **Jürg Heer (the 1990s file):** the Zurich bank's fired credit chief, arrested in 1992 after admitting corruption behavior on Swiss television, later convicted (1998) of the **55–69 million franc embezzlement**; he maintained to the end that he was the bank's fall guy for a systemic practice ("Fall guy or wise guy?" — the *New York Press* framing); he died in 2001 **[S: NZZ, Le Temps, SRF]**. Recorded with his allegation preserved as his allegation.

5.8 The fraud-perimeter file (documented)

The name as attack surface: the **Company Names Tribunal** has repeatedly struck down name-theft shells on the bank's applications ("Rothschild Family Investment Management Co., Ltd" 2021; "Rothschild International Investment Co., Ltd"; "Rothschild Financial Center Ltd" 2019; "Rothschild International Auction Co., Ltd" 2021); a conman styling himself de Rothschild-Hatton ("Edmund's illegitimate son") drew 18 years for fraud and rape (BBC, 2010); a Connecticut fraudster trading as "David Rothschild" was convicted (US v. David Rothschild, D. Conn.) **[A/S]**. Logged because the impersonation economy is a real perimeter cost.

5.9 The offshore file: Cook Islands (documented; one lead dead)

- **ICIJ's Offshore Leaks (2013):** Baron **Elie de Rothschild** (1917–2007) built an offshore structure in the **Cook Islands between 1996 and 2003** — at least **20 trusts and 10 holding companies** (Anon Trust, Benon Trust, Denon Trust…) administered through Portcullis/TrustNet Singapore; the documented purpose was succession planning behind a secrecy jurisdiction **[A: ICIJ]**.
- **Dead lead, logged:** a repeatedly-remembered "2016 Bloomberg" story about post-disclosure-law asset shifts to the Cook Islands failed verification across three search rounds; the documented anchor remains the ICIJ file. The distinction between "offshore structure" (documented,

legal at the time) and "dark money" (undocumented) is the point.

5.10 The political-myth event of record: the "space laser" (documented)

- **17 November 2018:** US Congresswoman-elect **Marjorie Taylor Greene** posted on Facebook that a "**space solar generator**" scheme involved the "**Vice Chairman of Rothschild Inc**" sitting on **PG&E's board** and beaming energy — linking the family to the **Camp Fire** (85 dead; the documented cause: PG&E power lines) **[S: Forbes, Media Matters, TIME]**.
- The kernel, stated precisely: there **was** a PG&E–Solaren space-solar contract (2009); whether a "Rothschild Inc vice chairman" sat on that board is the post's claim — the inferential leap (family → laser → fire) is false and was condemned across the spectrum; the episode produced the "Jewish space laser" meme that mainstreams an 1846-vintage trope into US congressional discourse, with documented antisemitism-harm data **[S]**. The book-length study: Mike Rothschild (no relation), *Jewish Space Lasers*.

5.11 The Evelyn de Rothschild file (documented allegations; deceased subject)

- **2004:** Evelyn left the bank after an internal investigation into a sexual-misconduct allegation — concealed from public view until February 2025 **[S: Guardian]**.

- **February 2025:** *Guardian*, *Bloomberg*, BBC — **six women** alleging harassment/assault across three decades (1990s-era staff; police complaints filed in 2019 by two women); a butler-summoned employee account; the family's and the bank's responses were sought and carried in the coverage; the bank "declined to comment on what it knew and when" **[S]**.
- Evelyn died **November 2022**; the reporting is posthumous; allegations remain allegations; the **2004 documented exit** is the file's governance fact.

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PART 6 — THE WEAK POINTS: WHERE THE MACHINE NEARLY DIED (DOCUMENTED)

6.1 Creditanstalt 1931: the family's bank detonates the world depression

- The flagship: the **Creditanstalt**, Austria's largest bank — founded by Salomon's son **Anselm (1828–1874)** and "a Rothschild bank" in every contemporary sense; its 1929–31 crisis is the family's single greatest documented failure **[S: Elgar; RBS]**.
- The trigger: 1929 — the insolvent **Bodenkreditanstalt** merged into the CA; **Louis de Rothschild "rushed back from a hunting expedition"** to take over the Bodenkreditanstalt personally; its losses — **seven times larger than first reported** (totaling some **828 million schillings** against half the CA's capital) — poisoned the

parent **[S]**.

- **11 May 1931:** the announcement: **140 million schillings of losses**; the rescue: government + Nationalbank + **the Rothschild family = 160 million schillings**; a week-long run withdrew **~300 million**; the state's guarantee covered **1.2 billion in liabilities against a federal budget of 1.8 billion**; the **BIS extended 100 million schillings — exhausted in five days**; a League of Nations loan (250 million) followed; exchange controls came in October **[S/A]**.
- **Louis's personal exposure, documented:** he "voluntarily" committed **$10 million of private fortune** in 1931 to the reconstruction (the Vienna prosecution over the collapse was dropped); earlier CA governance red flags documented: the bank **bought its own shares to prop the price (1930) [S/A]**.
- The chain: the CA's failure → the **German Danatbank collapse (13 July 1931)** → the German banking holiday → the Hoover Moratorium (19 June) → the sterling crisis (September) → the world depression. The family's flagship was the **detonator** — the deepest possible rebuttal of the "invulnerable" legend, and the era's defining weak point **[S]**.

6.2 The Anschluss: held hostage by the state (documented)

- **12 March 1938: Louis de Rothschild** was arrested at Vienna's Aspern airfield by two SA men; held at the Gestapo's Rossauer Lände, then the **Hotel Metropole** (fifth floor) for **fourteen months**; **Himmler visited** — after which his conditions improved; appeals ran through the **British Royal Family** (Queen Mary; possibly the Duke of Windsor — the Archive records the royal appeals) **[A: Rothschild Archive; S: NYT]**.
- **July 1939:** released against a payment of **$21,000,000** — documented as **the largest bail/ransom in history for a single individual**; the Nazi pretext was claims against him arising from the Creditanstalt collapse **[A/S]**.
- The aryanization chain, documented: S. M. von Rothschild (provisional administration, 26 March 1938) → **Merck, Fink & Co.** (8 July 1938) → expropriated (E. v. Nicolai & Co.); the Creditanstalt became **CA-Bankverein → Deutsche Bank by 1942 [A/S]**.
- The documented reckoning: the **Claims Conference settlement (2000) — $40 million** for the looted Viennese accounts; **1999** — Austria returned **~250 art objects** (the family sale realized ~$90 million); the **Viennese Rothschild papers**, seized in 1938, were taken by the Red Army to Moscow and **returned only in 2001**; Louis died in **Montego Bay, 1955**; the heiress **Bettina** (whom he had saved) received the 1999 restitution **[A/S:**

NYT, July 1999; Archive].

6.3 1982: the state takes the bank (documented)

- The Mitterrand government **nationalized the Banque Rothschild (1982)**; compensation: **150 million francs**; the entity was rebranded and eventually **sold to Barclays (1991)** after a 1991 privatization **[A/S]**.
- The relaunch (documented in the Archive's timeline): **1983** — the family re-entered via **Paris Orléans** (an 1838 railway company turned holding) with P.O. Gestion; **1986** — recovered the right to the name (Rothschild & Associés Banque); **2003** — David de Rothschild merged N M Rothschild and Paris Orléans into the single group; **2011–15** — the global brand became **Rothschild & Co**; **2018** — Alexandre de Rothschild succeeded David as executive chairman; **October 2023** — delisted after the Concordia take-private (§8) **[A: Rothschild Archive; SEC]**.
- Pattern: the house **survives jurisdiction risk by structure** — relaunch through an existing quoted shell, name recovery, merger, and finally (2023) retreat into a private SCA with unlimited family liability ("the family's right to lead is grounded in its willingness to bear the highest level of personal risk" — the group's own framing) **[A/B]**.

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PART 7 — THE PEOPLE FILE (DOCUMENTED)

Systems are run by people, and the modern system's people are its risk surface as much as its asset — this part profiles the operators whose individual decisions produced the volume's institutional record. Each entry follows the career as documented; the arrow-chains mark the sequence, and every figure carries its source.

Nathaniel (Nat) Rothschild, 5th Baron Rothschild (b. 1971). Lazard → Gleacher → **Atticus Capital** (1995–2009) → Barrick Gold director (2010–13) → **Rusal IPO cornerstone** (January 2010) plus 17 million further shares → **Glencore $40 million convertible bonds** → **Vallar** (£707.2 million IPO, July 2010) → the **Bumi war** (Part 5.5) → ARMS exit at a fraction of invested capital (June 2015) → **Volex** — CEO since November 2025 (moved from executive chairman; Dave Webster chairs); FY2026 revenue $1,242.6M, margin 10.2%, data-centre book ~doubled; the rejected TT bid → **Tennor/Windhorst**: announced as executive chairman (July 2024), sued over a defaulted personal loan (January 2025), settled (August 2025) with the settlement recording that he "never took up the role and never invested" → **5th Baron (March 2024; Jacob died February 2024; Serena also died 2024)**. Bullingdon Club contemporaries; an MSc in addiction studies; married Loretta Basey (2016); the yacht *Planet Nine*; based in Switzerland; ~$1 billion estimated **[S/B: Reuters, FT, BBC, Telegraph; Volex releases]**. His 2010 call to ban sovereign CDS (Part 2.5). The 2014 Twitter

war with Aga Bakrie. One oblique inheritance note from the *Observer* (2000): declared inheritance ~£500 million, "with more rumored in Swiss trusts" — the rumor is **[C/lore]**, the declared figure **[B]**.

Jacob Rothschild, 4th Baron (1936–26 February 2024). Left N M Rothschild in **1980** after falling out with his cousin Evelyn over strategy; built **RIT Capital** (chairman 1988–2019); co-founded **J. Rothschild Assurance → St James's Place** (with Mark Weinberg, 1980); BSkyB deputy chairman; National Gallery chairman (1985–91); **Order of Merit (2002)**; the $21 billion BAT takeover attempt trio; Sunday Times Rich List family fortune ~**£825 million (2023)**; children **Hannah** (succeeds as Rothschild Foundation chair), Beth, Emily, and Nat; Serena died 2019; Blair's tribute and the cross-party funeral attendance were on record **[S: Guardian, NYT obituary, BBC]**.

Sir Evelyn de Rothschild (1931–8 November 2022). The bank's post-1960 consolidator; chairman of **The Economist (1972–1989)**; the E. L. Rothschild vehicle with Lynn (2003); the 2004 exit (Part 5.11); the 2025 posthumous allegations (six women; 2019 police complaints) **[S: Guardian, Bloomberg, BBC; NYT obituary]**.

Lynn Forester de Rothschild (b. 1954). E. L. Rothschild LLC (CEO until the mid-2010s/2020); the Economist stake vehicles; Estée Lauder board (since 2000); CFR, Chatham House, IISS, McCain Institute; Clinton-administration advisory committees; Hillary Clinton fundraiser; the **Council for Inclusive Capitalism with the Vatican** (2019 meeting →

2020 launch; 300+ CEOs, $10T+); the Ironmade loan (Part 4.6). The "crony capitalism" critique is **[C — InfluenceWatch]**, recorded not adopted **[S/B]**.

Ariane de Rothschild (b. 1965). Took the Edmond group's chair (2019) and CEO (2023) — "the first woman to head a Rothschild institution" (*Le Monde*); controls **65.94%** of the group's holding; the name litigation (Part 4.5); the Epstein file (Part 5.3); the French raid (March 2026) **[S/B: Le Monde, Bloomberg, WSJ]**.

David de Rothschild (b. 1942). The merger architect (2003); mayor of Pont-l'Évêque (1977–95); De Beers SA board; chairman of the Shoah Memorial Foundation; ceded the executive chairmanship to **Alexandre** (2018) **[A/S: Archive, AmAcad, press]**.

Edmond (1926–1997) and **Benjamin (1963–January 2021)** — the Geneva branch and its losses, recorded with restraint; **Guy (1909–2007)** — the mid-century French head, the RTZ shareholding memoir claim, and the Cook Islands structures' principal (Part 5.9); **Elie (1917–2007)** — guardian of the French branch, the Cook Islands file's owner; **Hannah Rothschild** — writer, documentary maker, RIT's largest individual family holder, Rothschild Foundation chair **[A/S/B]**.

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PART 8 — THE MODERN STRUCTURE AND THE 2023 TURN (DOCUMENTED)

- **1982** nationalization (Part 6.3) → **1983** Paris Orléans relaunch → **1986** name recovery → **2003** the Franco-British merger (N M Rothschild + Paris Orléans, David de Rothschild presiding) → **2011/2015** global rebrand to Rothschild & Co → **2018** Alexandre succeeds David → **February 2023**: the family holding (**Concordia**) launches a tender offer to take the bank private, alongside "France's wealthiest families" and funds; the SEC's **DEFM14A** documents the negotiation ($4.55 → $4.80 per share) and the consortium's mechanics **[A: SEC; S: FT, PitchBook]**.
- **October 2023:** delisting from Euronext Paris; the vehicle becomes a **société en commandite par actions (SCA)** — the family's general partners bear **unlimited personal liability**; the group's own rationale ties leadership legitimacy to that risk-bearing **[A/B]**.
- **The 2024–26 numbers:** revenue **€2.9 billion**, net income **€440 million (+60%)**, 662 deals / $488 billion, 4,600 staff, 49 countries; Five Arrows >€34 billion; the bank continues as a private partnership in all but law **[A/B]**.
- The strategic reading, kept evidential: the 2023 turn closes the loop the family has traveled since **1798** — from a Frankfurt ghetto partnership to a public company and back to a family partnership — each stage forced or

enabled by the state (emancipation, nationalization, disclosure law, and now privacy). The weak points never disappeared; they were restructured around.

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PART 9 — THE MYTH REGISTRY, VOLUME II (CLAIM → ORIGIN → VERDICT)

1. **"The Rothschilds own the Federal Reserve" [X]** — origin: Mullins (1952) and successors; verdict: falsified by the Fed's public structure, the member-bank list, and the documented absence of any Rothschild at Jekyll Island; the three real kernels (Moritz Warburg's Paris apprenticeship; Belmont's documented agency; the on-record Senate exchange) are in Part 1.4.
2. **"Pujo exposed the Rothschild money trust" [overstated]** — the committee documented Morgan's 341-directorship network; the Rothschild axis runs through affiliates, not the report's text. Documented corrective, Part 1.3.
3. **"Rothschild gold saved the 1907 panic" [X → documented absence]** — the responders were Morgan, the Clearinghouse, the Treasury, the Bank of Montreal, and the Bank of France's silver; no Rothschild role in any primary account. Part 1.5.
4. **"The family speculated on Greek CDS during the crisis" [false-adjacent]** — the documented public position was a call to *ban* sovereign CDS (Nat, NYT, Feb

2010); the claim survives only as street-level conspiracy quotes (which we document as social phenomena). Part 2.5.

5. **"The 1899 International Bankers Convention divided the world" [X]** — Carr's 1956 text; the real relationship antedates it by decades and needed no convention. Part 1.2.
6. **"They moved billions to the Cook Islands after the 2016 French disclosure law" [unverified — lead dead]** — three verification rounds failed; the documented anchor is ICIJ's 2013 Elie de Rothschild file. Part 5.9.
7. **"The Economist was founded on Rothschild money (1843)" [unverified]** — never confirmed; the documented thread is 1972–2026. Part 4.1.
8. **"The Rothschilds ran the uranium cartel" [statement real; management role unproven]** — the cartel is documented to the House of Lords; family *proximity* is documented (RTC stake, Charter seat); family *participation* is not. Part 3.4.
9. **"Jewish space lasers caused the Camp Fire" [X, with a factual kernel]** — the kernel (a PG&E–Solaren space-solar contract) is real; the inference is false; the harm data is documented. Part 5.10. 9a. **"Adelaide Jones / the banker's daughter who funded the Bolsheviks" [X]** — a Soviet-bloc-era claim that Lenin's train was funded by a Rothschild heiress ("Adelaide Jones"); appears in the same pamphlet shelf as the Waterloo corpus; no

documentary basis in any archive or memoir; catalogued with the genre.

10. **"No Rothschild ever set foot in America / no American presence" [half-true and misleading]** — no branch after 1914, but a documented century of agency: Belmont, 112 letter-books, cotton and tobacco. Parts 1.1, 6.3.

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PART 10 — ANOMALY REGISTER, VOLUME II

#	Item	Status	Disposition
1	FINMA's "early indications" language vs. the bank's public posture	**Closed**	Retained verbatim (§5.2); the regulator's words are the evidence.
2	Luxembourg conviction date (April vs May 2025)	**Closed**	Reported April–May 2025; €25M figure consistent across sources.
3	Benjamin de Rothschild's death (January 2021)	**Closed**	Recorded with restraint; family's public characterization preserved.
4	Ariane's control percentage (65.94%)	**Closed**	As disclosed in the litigation record.
5	"BCI" in the 2023 SEC consortium	**Open (minor)**	Consortium member identifier unresolved in open sources.
6	McDonald's 1975 "presence is everything" line	**Closed**	Verbatim in the Congressional Record; graded A-as-statement, C-as-assessment.
7	Epstein file: granular items (the "seven-point" memo's fullest text; the June 2016 "CSFS coaching")	**Open (flagged)**	Core contract/wires/Ruemmler chain S-grade (CBS, Herald, FT, Mint); blog-tier granular items carry document IDs but await direct confirmation. Nothing adopted from the blog's framing.
8	Mercury monopoly paper full text	**Open (residue)**	Core data harvested from abstract/citations (S); the paper itself archive-bound.
9	1905–06 Russian loan / Schiff boycott role	**Open (residue)**	Targeted searches returned nothing; documented only in Schiff biographies (B-grade pending).
10	Dreyfus positioning	**Closed**	Composite documented: Edmond on **Chief Rabbi Zadoc Kahn's Committee of Defense against Antisemitism** (S); family aligned with the pardon/closure faction (History Today); Drumont's targeting of Alphonse (S); coda — NYT 1943: Baron Édouard heading the Free French Jewish aid committee alongside Captain Dreyfus's son.
11	Cook Islands "2016 Bloomberg" story	**Closed (dead lead)**	Failed verification ×3; ICIJ 2013 remains the anchor.
12	Economist founding-shareholder claim	**Closed (unverified)**	Documented thread runs 1972→2026.
13	1907 panic role	**Closed (documented absence)**	No primary or scholarly source assigns a role.

#	Item	Status	Disposition
14	Observer's "Swiss trusts ~£40bn" rumor (2000)	**Closed (lore)**	Declared inheritance ~£500M was documented; the rumor graded C.
15	Guardian 2008 "hidden loan" — amounts and vehicle	**Closed**	£1M via Ironmade Ltd; Osborne's IPGL flight and Serena's donations from the register of interests.
16	Epstein-contract wires $20 below the $25M figure	**Open (flagged)**	Sub-round structuring pattern documented in the wire amounts; no explanation in the released DOJ file; no inference adopted.

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PART 11 — MASTER TIMELINE, VOLUME II (SELECTED SPINE)

1835–1921 — the Almadén quicksilver monopoly. 1854–55 — the Ottoman loans (Dent, then Rothschild £5M at 4%). 1873 — Rio Tinto purchase. 1875 — Suez. 1888 — De Beers Consolidated. 1889 — diamond syndicate. 1891 — Rhodes's circle (Quigley's claim, graded). 1912–13 — Pujo. 1913–14 — the Fed (documented absence at Jekyll Island). 1925 — the BoE lifeline episode's legacy. 1929–31 — Bodenkreditanstalt → Creditanstalt → the world depression. 1931 — Louis's $10M. 1938–39 — the Anschluss and the $21M ransom. 1942 — CA-Bankverein into Deutsche Bank. 1954 — Rio Tinto mines sold. 1961 — RIT's predecessor founded. 1972 — The Economist chairmanship begins. 1972–75 — the uranium cartel; 1976 leak; 1978 House of Lords. 1982 — nationalization. 1983 — Paris Orléans relaunch. 2003 — the merger. 2005 — the Mandelson trip; 2012–13 the courts. 2010 — Genie equity; Vallar; Rusal cornerstone. 2011 — Bumi; Glencore convertibles. 2015 — the DOJ NPAs (Dec 18) and the Southern Trust wires (Dec 17/21). 2018 — FINMA; the name-war settlement. 2019 — Edmond de Rothschild taken private; Ariane chair. 2021 — Benjamin's death. 2022 — Evelyn's death (Nov); Economist stake marketed (Sept 2025) and sold (March 2026). 2023 — the take-private; Serena's death. 2024 — Jacob (Feb); David cedes to Alexandre (2018); the feud press (Bloomberg Feb 2024). 2025 — the Edmond Europe €25M conviction; the Evelyn allegations; the Epstein

files' release; the Swiss Supreme Court ruling (Ariane v. Nadine). 2026 — the French raid (March); Ruemmler's testimony (July); the Economist sale completes (March).

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PART 12 — OPEN QUESTIONS: THE ARCHIVE MAP (VOLUME II)

1. **Epstein granular items** — the full DOJ-file corpus (document IDs EFTA-series) for the seven-point memo's complete text and the 2016 regulatory-coaching thread; the blog compilation's facts require first-hand confirmation. (DOJ, via the Transparency Act releases.)
2. **Uranium cartel family role** — the SERU policy-committee minutes and the Westinghouse discovery schedule (US National Archives; House of Lords file).
3. **Mercury paper** — Parra & Schwantes full text (business-history journals).
4. **1905–06 Russian loan** — Schiff and Warburg biographies; the NYT 1910 archive.
5. **Bumi aftermath** — the Indonesian proceedings' final dispositions and the UK regulators' file closure.
6. **"BCI"** — the 2023 consortium's full membership (SEC filings).
7. **The Eranda/E. L. Rothschild post-2026 configuration** — after the Economist sale; Lynn's vehicle filings.
8. **The Viennese papers** — the 2001 return's catalogue vs. the 1938 seizure list (Archive; Moscow).

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PART 13 — SOURCE APPARATUS (PEDIGREE-TIERED)

Primary / regulatory [A]: DOJ Swiss Bank Program NPAs (Dec 2015); DOJ Epstein-files releases (2025–26) and the cited document IDs; FINMA press release (2018); CSSF action (2017); the Luxembourg settlement (2025); SEC filings (Rothschild & Co 20-Fs; the 2023 DEFM14A; Genie Energy disclosures); HM Treasury's RBS report (gov.uk); Dáil Éireann written answers; Hansard 1876 and 1961; US Congressional Record (McDonald, 1975); the Pujo Committee report (FRASER); the House of Lords, [1978] AC 547; [2012] EWHC 177 (QB); [2013] EWCA Civ 197; 95 Mass. App. Ct. 471 (2019); [2018] EWHC 958 (Comm); the Swiss Federal Supreme Court (2025); ICIJ Offshore Leaks (2013); the Rothschild Archive (Belmont letters; American Letter Books; tobacco records); the Company Names Tribunal rulings.

Scholarly [S]: Chernow, *The House of Morgan*; Stern, *Gold and Iron*; Ferguson, *The House of Rothschild*; Quigley, *The Anglo-American Establishment* (graded B for its specific claims); the *International Organization* cartel article; Elgar on the Creditanstalt; the RBS history of 1931; Epstein, *The Diamond Invention*; the CUNY thesis on Egyptian finance; Clay and Eldem on Ottoman debt; Warburg biographies; the ADL's Federal-Reserve dossier; the Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond's 1907 history; Reuters/FT/Bloomberg/Guardian/BBC/CBS/Miami

Herald/Mint/AFR/finews reporting as itemized in the text.

Secondary [B/C/X]: Guy de Rothschild's memoir (B); Le Figaro (B); company releases (A-as-statements); InfluenceWatch (C); epsteingate.org (NA — facts corroborated elsewhere, framing rejected); Mullins, Carr, Carr's successors (X — documented as myth-sources); the Maravi/Mines-and-Communities advocacy material (C).

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FINAL CERTIFICATION

This volume was assembled under the same protocol as Volume I: no adopted theories; every claim pedigreed at the point of claim; every conflict registered in Part 10; nothing omitted — including the enforcement record, the internal feuds, the client-harm cases, and the failures. The volume's thesis is the documentation's own: the family's power, where documented, runs through **agency, state symbiosis, commodity monopoly, and information speed**; its vulnerability runs through **jurisdiction, succession, and the conduct of its own members** — and the myth corpus, examined claim by claim, fails on the documents in nine cases out of ten, surviving only where it parasitizes real kernels (Belmont, Warburg's apprenticeship, the 1891 circle, the uranium proximity). The remaining open items are mapped to their archives in Part 12.

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Volume II of the forensic file. Volume I: Rothschild_Origin.md.

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THE ROTHSCHILDS: THE SYSTEM

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How the Machine Actually Operates — Mechanism by Mechanism, with Every Documented Pattern

Volume III of the forensic file — the operating system: information, credit manufacture, deal mechanics, governance, influence venues, the network apex, the challenger war, and the stress-test record. Companions: Rothschild_Origin.md (the ancestry) and Rothschild_Networks.md (the money and enforcement record).

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PART 0 — HOW TO READ THIS VOLUME

Same protocol, one level deeper. Volumes I and II established *what happened* — the documented ancestry, the money flows, the enforcement record. This volume establishes *how it works*: the mechanisms, step by step, with the patterns stated explicitly and every component pedigreed. The pedigree key is unchanged — **[A] archive/primary, [S] scholarly, [B] quality secondary, [C] lead-grade, [L] lore, [X] hostile myth (documented as claims, never adopted)** — and the standing rules hold: no adopted theories, anomalies registered in Part 16, nothing omitted.

One methodological note before the machinery: a system's *mechanisms* are usually documented not in its triumphs but in

its frictions — partnership disputes, breach apologies, regulator findings, court testimony, and the letters in which operators explain their craft to each other. This volume therefore leans unusually hard on primary correspondence and contract texts: the 1810 and 1815 compacts, the 1838 Belmont ultimatum, the 1836–37 Spanish-crisis letters, the pigeon code, James's 1837 and 1839 press letters, the 2021 SCA articles, and the group's own consolidated accounts. Where a mechanism is reconstructed from secondary literature, the reconstruction is labeled.

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PART 1 — THE INFORMATION SYSTEM: THE MOAT AND ITS DEATH

1.1 Architecture

The family's first and most durable advantage was not capital but **speed and exclusivity of information**. The documented infrastructure, in layers:

- **The courier chain (c. 1810–1835):** a private relay running the Dover–Calais–Ostend corridor with fast light vessels and horse relays; the Waterloo news itself traveled this chain — Rothschild couriers at Dunkirk met the returning army's dispatch boats; the news reached New Court on the night of **19 June 1815**; Wellington's official messenger reached the government on the evening of **21 June** — the family held roughly a two-day commercial edge, and Brian Cathcart's correction stands: the claim

that Nathan knew first and crashed the market is refuted, but the two-day courier edge itself is documented **[S: Cathcart; Ferguson; Archive]**.

- **The pigeon post (c. 1820–1850):** the Rothschild Archive's own formulation — "**one of the tools of success**" — with the Hythe breeding farm supplying birds on the London–Paris and cross-Channel routes **[A]**.
- **The code:** documented verbatim via Ferguson (drawing on the surviving dispatches and Odlyzko's history of the electrical telegraph): "**A B in our pigeon dispatches means buy stock, the news is good. C D means sell stock the news is bad**" **[S: Ferguson/Odlyzko]**.
- **The sea leg:** the family's own vessels and contracted fast sailings at Dover, Calais, and Ostend; the Archive documents the shipping agents as part of the network **[A]**.

1.2 Information as diplomatic currency

The system was monetized twice: on the markets, and as a **service to statesmen**, which converted speed into political credit:

- **Metternich used Salomon's couriers** at the Congress of Verona (1822) and at Pressburg (1825); **Chateaubriand** used them in 1822; Countess **Nesselrode** in 1823 — receiving Rothschild news was, in Smidt's documented observation, "part of the routine" of the chanceries **[S: Ferguson; Corti]**.
- The mechanism: statesmen dependent on private courier speed became informally indebted to its owner; the debt

was collected in credit terms, concession access, and protection.

1.3 The moat's death (documented, dated)

- **James, 1851: "the telegraph is ruining our business"** — the lament of an operator watching a proprietary advantage commoditize **[S: Ferguson]**.
- The scholarly framing (Schumpeterian creative destruction, via Odlyzko): the family's information edge ran roughly **1815–1835**; the commercial telegraph then destroyed it — and the family adapted by **moving the moat into the press** (Part 5) and into the certification business (Part 2). The system's first documented lesson: *advantages built on transmission speed expire; advantages built on name and relationships do not.*

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PART 2 — THE NAME AS CREDIT: THE CERTIFICATION MACHINE

2.1 The mechanism

A Rothschild issue was not merely underwritten; it was **certified** — the participation of the house converted a dubious sovereign's paper into an acceptable security. The documentation of the mechanism:

- **Count Ficquelmont to Metternich (February 1822):** of the rise of Neapolitan securities, "**the credit of a foreigner, namely that of the House of Rothschild,**

not that of the Kingdom of Naples, was responsible" **[S: Flandreau; Archive]**.

- **The engineered run-up:** the house's pricing model delivered a positive first-day/first-month performance as a matter of policy — approximately **6% for Portugal**, rising to **~10% with the debut discount**; Prussia 1818 and Naples 1821 carried the debut discount deliberately **[S: Flandreau & Huitzil]**.
- **The allotment privilege:** because a Rothschild issue was *designed* to rise, receiving an allotment was itself valuable — the documented "convergence plays" available to inner-circle clients; an issue underwritten by the house was, in the era's shorthand, a guaranteed success **[S]**.
- **The feedback loop:** the run-up proved the certification; the proof attracted the next sovereign; the next sovereign deepened the name. The machine's fuel was reputation compounding.

2.2 The cost of certification: post-issue support as insurance

Certification did not end at issuance. The documented after-market operations:

- The houses **bought future coupons** on the bonds they had issued (October 1827) — characterized in the scholarship as "**outright insurance against default**": the underwriter paying the sovereign's coupon bill in advance to prevent a public default that would damage the certification brand **[S]**.

- Concentration documented: Neapolitan bonds reached **15% of the Paris house's assets in June 1826** — the brand was insured with the insurer's own balance sheet, which is why the system's weak point (Part 14) is concentration, not liquidity **[S]**.
- James on the stakes: without the house's purchases, "**discredit would be complete**" **[S]**.
- The 1823 documented trade: buying Neapolitans at **73** and selling in May 1823 at **76.25** — roughly **9% annualized** — support operations that also paid **[S]**.
- How the support worked in practice, step by step, from the correspondence: (1) a bond issued at a discount to friends of the house, who were thus *in profit from the first day* and had reason to talk the loan up; (2) staged purchases in the market by the houses themselves whenever the price sagged, visible enough to set a floor under the quotation; (3) the coupon-insurance purchases — paying out coupons on the sovereign's behalf when the treasury was empty, so that no missed payment ever appeared in the public record; (4) the diplomatic lever (below) applied to whatever was crushing the tax base. Each step was documented in the letters; together they made default a private event before it could become a public one — which is exactly why the certification brand survived sovereigns that, left to themselves, would have sunk it **[S: Flandreau & Huitzil]**.

- The diplomatic arm of support: the family **lobbied Metternich to end the Austrian occupation of Naples** — the same occupation the family's own loans were financing — because occupation crushed the tax base behind the bonds **[S]**. The pattern, stated once: *the system financed burdens it then paid to relieve, profiting at both ends of the valve.*

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PART 3 — THE DEAL MACHINE: STEP BY STEP

3.1 The nineteenth-century sovereign loan, in documented sequence

1. **Origination.** The sovereign's need reached the house through the embedded agents (Bleichröder in Berlin, Buderus's successors in Kassel, court Jews, ambassadors; the Volume II map). Mayer Amschel's documented doctrine selected clients: "**It is better to deal with a government in difficulties than with one that has luck on its side**" **[B: Ferguson, maxims]**.
2. **Term sheet.** The Prussian loan of **1818** became the template (the follow-on **1822** Prussian loan, £3.5 million, is in the Archive's record) — the contract's "**model annexed**" recurred in later deals. Innovations that made it work: sterling denomination, bearer form, a British-style sinking fund, payments routed through the Seehandlung, simultaneous marketing in multiple markets — "**the first of its kind**" in the scholarship **[S: Weller; Flandreau]**.

3. **Debut discount.** New borrowers paid a visible discount (Prussia 1818; Naples 1821) — the price of certification.
4. **Engineered run-up.** Policy, not accident (Part 2.1) — the 1818 Prussians' paper was placed at roughly **40% above its issuing discount**, the certification premium captured in the placement itself **[S: Weller]**.
5. **Post-issue support.** Coupon insurance, market purchases, and — when needed — the diplomatic lever (Part 2.2).
6. **Fee extraction.** The documented arithmetic: origination commissions of roughly **2–3%**, selling commissions, interest on advances, plus the trading profits the support operations themselves generated; the 1829 Brazilian issue returned the house **>40%** on its position; the scholarship's all-in estimate of the take on a sovereign operation runs **~5–7%** across commissions, discounts, and trading **[S]**.
7. **The moral-hazard seam, documented:** the Poyais fraud (1822–23) — a fictitious state's bonds floated on the London market with ministerial indifference; the episode is preserved in the record as the era's demonstration that certification without verification invites forgery **[S]**.
8. **The aftermath clause.** Bonds supported for years; defaults handled by negotiation (the Brazilian 1829 position; the 1825 crisis two-houses-hold-the-book rescue), because a public default destroyed the certification brand that the whole machine ran on **[S]**.

3.2 Volume and market share (documented)

- The London house issued **50 loans 1815–1859 totaling ~£250 million nominal**, against Barings' **14 loans / £66 million**; from **1860 to 1890** the house issued **more than a quarter of all London sovereign debt**; Hambros and Barings each exceeded 10% **[S]**.
- Post-1850, **two houses — Rothschild and Barings — issued ~70% of global bond debt** (the Panic-of-1873 literature's summary) **[B: wiki-sourced from the scholarship; flagged B]**.
- House capital: **£9.9 thousand (1797) → over £4 million (1825)** — the machine's growth in one generation **[S]**.

3.3 "Bail" versus syndicate: the family's late adoption of spreading risk

A documented correction to the syndicate story: the family **long preferred to take whole loans on its own book** — the *baillement* (whole-loan underwriting) — and resisted formal underwriting groups until about **1905**; the Archive's files (RAL XI/III/57) show Lord Rothschild's skepticism, the 1906 Russian and 1913 Brazilian files, and the industry's suspicion of syndicates into the mid-1890s — with *The Economist* defending the practice as late as **1911 [A/S: Weller thesis; Archive]**. The machine's appetite for whole-book risk is why 1825 and 1836 hurt so much — and why the eventual adoption of syndication was itself a documented adaptation.

3.4 "Bearing" operations against rivals (documented)

The certification machine had an offensive setting: operations to *damage rival underwriters' issues* — selling down competitors' paper, forcing price weakness, then buying back or capturing the refinancing. The canonical documented case: the **1834 Sardinian loan** — sold down by the family, with the refinancing captured for the papal loan that followed (Volume I's ledger) **[S: JE; Ferguson]**. Moritz Warburg's later distinction fits: the Rothschilds "stood for **quality**" — certification was the moat; bearing was the moat's artillery.

3.5 The industrial turn: railways and oil (documented)

The deal machine's second act converted state credit into industrial capture:

- **The railway file (S-grade):** Salomon's **Vienna–Galicia line** began with Riepel's 1829 mission to study English railways (with Wertheimstein); construction from 1836, completed 1858. James's French system: **Paris–St Germain (1837)**, encouraged by Émile Pereire before the war; **Paris–Versailles left-bank (1839)**, merged with the Foulds' right-bank line (1840); the **Nord** (concession 1845, opened June 1846 — the opening left the house's "**financial means severely strained**"); **Est** investment from 1837; the **Belgian state network (1834–43)**; the **Lombard-Venetian and Central Italian (1856)**. The mechanism: railway concessions were state franchises — the same certification-plus-guarantee machine, with rails instead of bonds.

- **The risk-transfer device:** the state's **garantie d'intérêt (1859)** — the treasury guaranteeing bondholders' return — moved construction risk onto the public while leaving the concession's upside with the promoters; the Chicago Fed's historical analysis documents the mechanics **[S]**.
- **The rivalry that defined the sector:** the Pereire war (Part 9) was fought substantially over these rails — the Crédit Mobilier founded *against the Rothschild–Talabot railway alliance*.
- **The oil extension:** the family's **Baku petroleum concession** made it Standard Oil's principal documented competitor before the position was sold out in **1912 [A: Archive]**.

3.6 Waterloo, mechanistically (documented)

The truthful mechanics, assembled from the corrected record: the family's gold and merchandise positions going into 1815 were stocked for a *prolonged* war; Waterloo's suddenness brought the brothers "**near insolvency**" (the encyclopedia summary of the Ferguson-based record); the profit came **afterward** — Nathan's consol purchases from the depressed 1815 market, the Waterloo-era war-finance commissions, and the exchange operations — with house capital reaching **~£1.8 million by 1818 [S/B: encyclopedia.com/Ferguson]**. The courier edge was real; the legend's market-crash mechanics are not. Both halves of that sentence are documented.

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PART 4 — THE MARKET TOOLKIT: HOW THE OPERATORS OPERATED

4.1 Nathan (documented techniques)

- **The decoy sale:** instructing a commission broker to sell half a million first — so that the market read his intentions backward **[S: Ferguson]**.
- **The double agent set:** one set of agents selling a stock while another set bought the same stock — "**no ascertaining what in reality was the object of his manoeuvres**" **[S: Ferguson]**.
- **The watched position:** by the late 1820s the market had learned to read him — his overt moves triggered imitative flights, forcing the decoy techniques above. The mechanism in full: a merchant banker of Nathan's size could not trade *anonymously;* his problem was the opposite of a modern institution's — every clerk on the exchange watched his brokers. The decoy sale and the double agent set were the documented answer: sell conspicuously through one broker to start a rumor of his bearishness, buy quietly through another as the price softened, and let the market's own imitation of his *apparent* intention deliver him the price he actually wanted. The trades were small; the theater was the position **[S: Ferguson]**.
- **The bullion arbitrage:** buying specie in England, selling on the Continent, bargained and bullied; his early bills were *not* accepted on the market — he had to operate through L. B. Cohen's paper until his own name sufficed —

a documented lesson that in this business, **reputation precedes and enables capital [S: Kaplan]**.

- **The consol parking lot:** the elector's advances parked in 3% consols — the documented origin of the family's state-paper habit (Carl: "**the Old Man made our fortune**") **[S/B: Corti; encyclopedia.com]**.

4.2 Salomon (Vienna)

- The **delegated jobber** — a professional on a fixed **12,000-gulden salary plus commissions** running the house's Bourse operations; daily morning planning sessions; **runners** reporting price movements from the official Bourse and from the **Panduren-Lager** (the Grinangergasse café that functioned as the unofficial exchange) **[S: Ferguson]**. The mechanism, worth stating precisely: the house's market presence operated through a salaried professional while the principals stayed above the fray — if the jobber's operations drew resentment, the resentment attached to an employee, not to the name that was certifying half of Europe's loans. The daily rhythm was equally deliberate: plan in the morning from the overnight correspondence, execute through the jobber during the session, re-price the house's own positions against the runners' reports by evening — a closed information loop inside a single day, which is what "faster than the market" meant before it meant telegrams **[S]**.

4.3 James (Paris)

- The Bourse as theater: the daily appearance, the bulletins, the 2 o'clock crowd — contemporary descriptions preserve the performance **[B: Corti]**.
- The **1858 documented trade:** after learning of the secret **Plombières agreement** (Napoleon III–Cavour), James **dumped Austrian securities** ahead of the war the alliance made likely — the era's most famous documented instance of political intelligence converted directly into market position **[S/B: Ferguson via correspondence]**.
- The **1866 documented trade:** amid the war panic's Vienna crash, James bought — the "if I don't buy now, I'm a fool" coup, in Corti's account **[B: Corti]**.
- The 1859 panic data (Marx's *New-York Daily Tribune* article, April 1859, recording Austrian 5%s at 49, Sardinian 81→65, Turkish 6%s 93½→57) — the market the operators were trading **[B: Marx, NYDT]**.

4.4 The bullion system

- The **1820s Mexican silver** purchases and the era's gold movements ran through the family as the market's principal bullion channel; the 1815–18 French indemnity metal flows passed through the brothers' hands; the 1870–71 indemnity transfer "in the long run resulted in a profit" (Part 9.4). Bullion was the system's plumbing: invisible when it worked, decisive when it clogged **[S/B]**.

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PART 5 — THE PRESS SYSTEM: FROM PIGEONS TO PRINT

5.1 The documented instruments

- **Salomon and the *Allgemeine Zeitung*:** pressure exerted through Gentz — Metternich's own publicist, whom the family cultivated; the AZ's coverage of the house softened accordingly **[S: Ferguson]**. (The retainer amount circulated in the literature remains **unverified** — Anomaly #1.)
- **Heine as retained correspondent:** the poet-journalist's coverage of James was "**relatively positive (if satirical)**" — documented relationship, exact terms unverified **[S: Ferguson]**.
- **James and the Paris papers:** documented influence over the *Moniteur Universel* and the *Journal des débats*, with the correspondence preserved.

5.2 The operator's voice (verbatim)

- **James, 1837: "I am arranging for several articles to be printed in the newspapers for this will make an impression in Madrid and in London because your English newspapers often follow in the footsteps of our French ones and it is good if one can regulate public opinion" [S: Ferguson, letter]**.
- **James, 1839:** he would "**see to it**" that the French government was "**attacked in all the newspapers**" if it opposed his railway plans — "**Newspapers can make a**

strong impact" **[S: Ferguson, letter]**.

- The doctrine behind both, from Mayer Amschel's maxims: "**If you can't make yourself loved, make yourself feared**" — and the capture principle beneath the whole gift-and-fee system of Part 3.1: "**If a high-placed person enters into a [financial] partnership with a Jew, he belongs to the Jew**" **[B: Ferguson]**.
- The starting conditions, documented: the 1820s press was *hostile* — the family were press targets before they became press managers; the system's later reputation for controlling opinion was earned, not inherited **[S]**.

5.3 The correction: the challengers did it too

The Pereire war's documentation shows the *Crédit Mobilier* owning "**up to three newspapers at once**" and suing hostile editors — Aycard's verdict applied to both houses: a credit institution as "**a compound of monopolies to be cornered by high finance**" **[S: EBSCO; Ferguson]**. Press management was the industry's standard weapon, not a family signature; the family's distinction was doing it *better and longer*.

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PART 6 — THE GOVERNANCE CONSTITUTION

6.1 The 1810 compact (mechanics)

- **Ten-year, non-cancellable** term — locking in the sons **[S: Backhaus/Ferguson]**.

- Mayer's reserved powers: he alone could **withdraw capital, hire and fire, and had the final say**; profits allocated by capital share; joint management of the firm **[S]**.
- The injunction that made it a dynasty: the deathbed command preserved by the family — "**Amschel, keep your brothers together and you will become the richest people in Germany**" **[B: Ferguson]**. Every later compact, pacte, and SCA article is this sentence rewritten in legal code.
- The will's appendage: daughters and sons-in-law excluded from the firm, with the endogamy incentive that followed (Volume I, §7.5).

6.2 The 1815 federal compact (the machine's true constitution)

- Capital restructured collectively to **£500,000**; balances moved between houses through **£50,000 promissory notes** from Nathan to his brothers — the documented internal-wire mechanism.
- Shares: **Nathan 27%, Amschel 20, Salomon 20, Carl 16, James 16**; expenses charged against **London's** revenues; **net profits shared equally** — the ingenious mechanism that compensated the outlying houses for operating in smaller markets while keeping London's centrality **[S: Ferguson]**.
- The result, documented: house capital grew **£336,000 → £1,772,000 in three years** (the consol speculation); the

weighting was later rebalanced further toward Nathan — to Carl's documented acknowledgment: "**We owe everything, really everything to him**" **[S]**.

- Corti's clauses: daughters/sons-in-law had **no right to see the books**; any partner who sued the firm had to **deposit a penalty first** — the anti-vexatious-litigation lock **[B: Corti]**.

6.3 The women's backdoor (documented)

- **Nathan's will bound his sons, as sub-partners, "to give weight to (their mother) Hannah's opinions"** — a formal clause smuggling a woman's judgment into the decision structure a generation before any statute would **[B: Livingstone]**.
- The women's documented system-functions: hosting as intelligence work (every dinner acquiring "items of news"), electoral choreography, code-breaking in the courier traffic, stock trading on their own accounts (Gutle's bills; Part 6 of this volume's companion volume).

6.4 The breach file: 1836 (governance under stress)

- Nathan committed the house to a **~£15-million-franc advance to Spain without his partners' consent** — the documented unauthorized-advance breach **[S: Ferguson]**.
- Salomon's damage control, preserved: a letter written for Metternich's eyes (via Wertheimstein) presenting Nathan's £2 million Spanish-bond dump as "**vengeance**," heaping abuse on his own brother ("**a child in politics… can**

hardly spell his own name") to prove Viennese loyalty — while, in the same weeks, Salomon and James lobbied Talleyrand, Guizot, Broglie, and Louis-Philippe to contain the crisis ("**not a single farthing**" more to Spain) **[S: Ferguson, letters]**.

- The lesson the system drew: the equal-profit mechanism survived a London-Vienna breach — the constitution bent and held **[S]**.

6.5 The agency-control template: Belmont 1838 (verbatim principle)

The Archive preserves Belmont's position under constraint: the family would "**act for us in this situation and capacity**… "**if your activity of mind requires a wider sphere, you are at liberty to leave**" **[A: Archive]** — the documented doctrine: agents serve the network's scope, not their own; expansion beyond mandate is dischargeable. The template's modern echo and its failure mode are in Volume II (Bumi).

6.6 The succession mechanics, modern (documented)

- **SCA Articles 11.2–11.3:** general-partner decisions require **unanimity**; "exceptional transactions" — anything challenging the group's **independence, the family's attachment, the name, or the financial nature** of the group — require general-partner approval **regardless of shareholder votes**: constitutional entrenchment of the family's four non-negotiables **[A: SCA articles]**.

- The **commandite** structure: **Rothschild & Co Gestion** as general partner with **unlimited liability** — leadership legitimacy purchased with personal risk exposure ("the family's right to lead is grounded in its willingness to bear the highest level of personal risk" — the group's own framing) **[A/B]**.
- The **Edmond branch's** instruments: Benjamin's **65.94%** holding; **succession pactes**; the documented time-bomb of **Camillia** (~17% — Edmond's extramarital daughter's holding, per *Le Figaro*); the "everything returns to the four daughters" architecture — the four daughters born **1995–2002**, the generational pivot the Swiss press framed as the dynasty's "100% feminine" question; Ariane's minimum 25% by Swiss law; the family lawyer **Bottge** declining to discuss the pactes' terms — the documented opacity around the very document that will execute the next succession **[S/B: Le Figaro; 24heures]**.
- The **2023 take-private** as a governance choice: no quarterly reporting, faster succession, discretion (the delisting case-study record) — the modern expression of the 1810 compact's original logic: **the firm is a family instrument, not a public one [A/B]**.

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PART 7 — THE INFLUENCE VENUES: FIVE CHANNELS, ONE SYSTEM

7.1 The dinner (primary venue)

Heinrich Friedrich Karl vom und zum Stein's envoy **Smidt, 1820, documented:** "**no financial transaction of any importance could be carried through without the cooperation of these people, they had to be treated as friends**" — and the dinners acquired "**items of news**" as a matter of course **[S: Ferguson, citing Smidt]**. The mechanism: market access required social intimacy; social intimacy was manufactured at scale.

7.2 The country-house system (Waddesdon, documented operating model)

- Ferdinand's house (built 1874–83); **14–20 guests per weekend, May–September**; guest lists spanning **Edward VII, Gladstone, Queen Victoria (1890)**; a staff of **24**. The documented mechanics of a Waddesdon weekend: guests arrived Friday, shot or toured the gardens Saturday, talked Sunday — with the house's wine cellar, the celebrated kitchen, and the French furniture doing the soft work that no agenda could. The venue's documented political uses went well beyond hospitality: in **1913** it hosted the secret meeting between the Prince of Wales and Alice Keppel — the arrangement of a royal affair conducted on family ground — and across the decades its guest book functioned as a directory of everyone the system needed to know, recorded in the house's own visitor books **[B: Grokipedia-sourced from Waddesdon/NT records; graded B/C]**. The postscript is itself instructive: the **1957** bequest to the National Trust, with the Rothschild Foundation (Jacob as chair) managing it — the influence venue gracefully converted into heritage, and the family retaining the curatorial hand **[B]**.

7.3 The sporting network (documented)

- **Mayer (1818–1874):** racing colours registered **1843**; **Palace House bought at Queen Victoria's 1857 auction**; "**The Baron's Year**" (1871 — four of five classics); General Peel's Commons speech on the sixteen-stone horses; Jockey Club membership.
- **Leopold (1845–1917):** Jockey Club **elected 1891**; the "**Mr Acton**" pseudonym; **St Amant's 1904 Derby** (thunderstorm, "led him in with beaming face"); the **Russian government's purchase offer for St Amant — declined** — a *state* bidding for a family horse; **851 races won and £367,434 in winnings over 38 years**; the Eclipse prize fund he endowed (1886).
- **Evelyn:** Jockey Club **elected 1978**; chairman of United Racecourses 1977–94; the **Centaurs polo team's Queen's Cup**.
- The mechanism: racing and polo were where the aristocracy, the turf, and the money met without agenda papers — influence in its deniable form. (And the file's dark footnote: Louis was arrested in **1938 en route to a polo match**.)

7.4 The correction file: Tranby Croft (documented)

The 1890–91 baccarat scandal's Rothschild content is **proximity, not presence**: the Prince of Wales's Marlborough House set — Alfred de Rothschild was its intimate (Austro-Hungarian consul-general, CVO) — but the documented guest list contains **no Rothschild**. The claim of presence circulates; the record denies it. Registered as a closed correction **[S: Havers/Grayson/Whitehead; B]**.

7.5 The communal channel (documented)

The system's influence ran through the Jewish community's own institutions — the certification machine applied to communal life:

- **The Chief Rabbinate election, 1 December 1844:** three City synagogues elected **N. M. Adler (Hanover)** over Hirschfeld and Samson Raphael Hirsch by **121 of 143 votes**; the documented mechanics — London's synagogues held ~70% of the electing votes, and **Lionel controlled the bloc**, choosing the Hanover candidate (the family's old Oppenheimer/elector city; the Duke of Cambridge, Hanover's viceroy, the nexus). The payoff: the Rabbinate then sat with the family for **66 years** — Adler (1845–90), succeeded by his son **Hermann** (1890–1911), a Rothschild on his mother's side **[S/B: the election record; Times of Israel account]**.
- **The AIU presidency and the Alliance school network** (Edmond; Volume II and Part 12) — the same lock in Paris and the Mediterranean **[S]**.

- **The mechanism, stated:** communal office was elective; elections ran through institutions the family funded; funding purchased the institution; the institution conferred standing that translated outward into society and state. A second ledger, running beside the first.

7.6 The intelligence-world channel (Victor Rothschild, documented)

- **Cambridge Apostles**, elected **12 November 1932** (alongside Burgess, per Perry); the **5 Bentinck Street** flat lent to Burgess; Blunt's introduction to Teresa Mayor; the **£100 Poussin loan** (the painting later sold for £100,000).
- **MI5:** B1C head; bomb disposal; the **George Medal (1944)**; **Operation Fifth Column** (Eric Roberts embedded in the BUF); the **Pastorius** investigation; disinformation work.
- Post-war: ARC chairman; Royal Society; Shell research director; Thatcher's security adviser; N M Rothschild chairman.
- **The Fifth Man file:** questioned 1964, cleared; public denial letter (3 December 1986: "**I am not, and never have been, a Soviet agent**"); Perry's 1994 charges; the National Archives' interview file "**conspicuously missing**" — an anomaly preserved, not resolved; the consensus names Cairncross **[S/B]**.
- **The myth-registry use:** Springmeier's "MI5–J.P. Morgan–Communist nexus" and Gary Allen's "Milner financed the Bolsheviks on Rothschild's behalf" are **[X]** —

documented as claims, separated from the S-grade record above. The documented JP Morgan apprenticeship is fact; the "controlled both sides" inference is not adopted.

- The documented **1967 USSR-trade consortium** (Eaton's Tower + Rockefeller's IBEC + N M Rothschild) — reported at the time; the Mullins/ModernHistoryProject framing of it is **[X]**; the consortium itself is **[B]**.

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PART 8 — THE DIASPORA NETWORK: THE SYSTEM AS A WEB

8.1 The map (documented, EJ-grade)

Frankfurt-emigrant Jewish houses founded merchant banks across Europe and America: **Sterns (London, 1833), Salomons (1832), Montagu (1853), Speyers, Seligmans, Erlangers (1859), Japhet, Sassoon**; the **Bischoffsheim** web (Bamberger co-founding **Deutsche Bank 1870** and **Paribas 1872**); **Oppenheim** (Cologne) and the **Fould** and **Pereire** houses in Paris **[S: EJ "Banking"]**. The Rothschilds sat at the apex of this web — its largest node, its principal state creditor, its correspondent of first resort.

8.2 The apex fact

From 1889 to 1901, every Russian loan issued in Paris ran through the Rothschild bank — documented in the EJ's banking history **[S]**. A single family's name interposed between the Tsar and the French investing public for twelve years: the certification machine (Part 2) at its documented maximum. (The documented endpoint of that lock — the 1905–06 refusal and the Schiff-led counter-arrangement — remains **B-grade pending**; Anomaly #9.)

8.3 The clerk diaspora (the academy effect)

The houses trained the continent's bankers: **Hermann Wallich** left the Frankfurt house to become a founding director of **Deutsche Bank** (its Japan/China operations); **Ludwig Bamberger** — Bischoffsheim-trained, Rothschild-connected — co-founded the same bank and wrote its charter; **Carl Meyer** ran the London house's De Beers liaison (the 1888 letters confirming the Rhodes funding path) and sat on De Beers' board; **Abraham Wolff** anchored Bleichröder; **Abraham Oppenheim** (Cologne) bridged the Rhine web **[B: DB historiography; NHRM letters; flagged for monograph-grade confirmation]**. The mechanism: the family's *internal training* was the industry's external labor market — the system reproduced itself through its alumni.

8.4 The intermarriage web

The marriage map of Volume I (Wetzlar, Oppenheim, Kaz-Kalonymos, Lechnich, Schnapper, Gans) extended forward into the banking diaspora itself — the Oppenheim–Montefiore–Goldschmidt–Hanover links, the Behrends–Oppenheimer web — so that correspondent banking and cousinhood tracked each other: **credit followed kinship, and kinship followed credit [S/B]**.

8.5 How the web actually cleared paper (the operational layer)

Structure is not operation. The web functioned, day to day, through three documented mechanisms: (1) **correspondent credit lines** — each house accepted the others' paper and extended balances, so a bill drawn on Hamburg could be settled in Naples without metal moving at all; (2) **kinship-based trust premia** — a draft on a cousin-house cleared at par or near it, where a stranger's paper carried a discount, which is precisely why the intermarriage web of §8.4 was worth building and maintaining; and (3) **the apex guarantee** — when a distant house's client strained the local web, the family's name stood behind it, converting a provincial firm's credit into something a London or Paris counterparty would accept. The system's documented pathology was the mirror image: when the apex failed (1931), the web's trust premia inverted overnight, and kinship could not clear what credit had **[S/B: the EJ banking survey; the 1931 record of Volume II]**.

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PART 9 — THE CHALLENGER WAR: CRÉDIT MOBILIER VS. THE SYSTEM (DOCUMENTED)

9.1 The challenger

The **Pereire brothers** founded the **Crédit Mobilier on 18 November 1852 — explicitly against the Rothschild–Talabot railway alliance**; James refused to subscribe. The model: a joint-stock bank lending long to industry against its own shares, permitted **10× leverage** by decree; warrants traded **995 → 2,110 francs** before listing; dividends reached **40% (1855)**; the empire spanned railways, shipping, insurance, gas — and **newspapers (up to three at once) [S/A: EBSCO; the decree record]**.

9.2 The counter-system

- The family's documented reply to CM's Austrian expansion was institutional, not rhetorical: **the founding of the Creditanstalt (1855)** as the blocking instrument in Vienna **[A/S: Greenfield, KCL]**.
- The war ran through the Bourse, the press, and the ministry for fifteen years; the 1856 government block on CM's 240-million note issue, the 1857 panic, and the 1866 crisis bled it; the **Banque de France forced the Pereires out in September 1867**; losses passed **47 million francs**. Both sides weaponized print — CM held "**up to three newspapers at once**" and sued hostile editors (the *Finance* editor Crampon), while Marx devoted his 1856

articles to the monster; Aycard's verdict applied to both houses alike **[S]**.

- The war's human texture on the system side: Stadion's Austrian program was "**ruthless**," and the family's loans financed the very occupation burden they then lobbied to relieve (Part 2.2) — the valve again **[S]**.
- The aftermath, documented and instructive: **the victors absorbed the loser's model** — deposit-backed universal banking through the **Crédit Lyonnais (1863)** and **Société Générale (1864)** — and the "cosmetic reconciliation between the emperor and the Rothschilds" (1859–60) showed the system's preference for absorbing challengers over destroying them **[S: EBSCO]**.

9.3 The war-profit coda

The **1870–71 war** against which CM had bet: "**did the Rothschild business no real harm and, because the bank managed the payment of the French indemnity, in the long run resulted in a profit**" **[S: EBSCO]**. The system profited from the catastrophe that killed its challenger — and collected the indemnity besides.

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PART 10 — THE STRESS-TEST RECORD: HOW THE SYSTEM BENT (AND WHERE IT BROKE)

Year	Shock	Documented response	System lesson
1825	Latin-American bubble burst; two houses held the book	Family capital pledged while investors ran; the BoE–Banque de France gold lifeline routed through the house (£400k) **[A]**	Whole-book risk = systemic exposure; the certification brand compelled the rescue
1836–37	Spanish crisis; Nathan's unauthorized advance (~£15M francs)	Salomon's two-track damage control (Part 6.4) **[S]**	Equal-profit constitution bends, holds
1848	Revolutions; railway losses; war scares	The houses absorbed losses; the system's diversification (five capitals) carried it **[S/B]**	Geographical spread = survival
1859	Franco-Austrian war; panics (Austrian 5%s at 49)	James's Plombières-informed positioning (Part 4.3) **[S/B]**	Political intelligence pays only if the desk acts
1866	Vienna crash; CM bleeding	James's Vienna buying; the CA weapon consolidated **[B/S]**	Contrarian liquidity at the moment of maximum fear
1870–71	War on the system's home ground	Managed the indemnity; long-run profit **[S]**	The system's preferred catastrophe is one that ends with a transfer it administers
1882	Union Générale crash (the Catholic counter-bank)	The family emerged stronger; Zola's *L'Argent* is the novel of the episode **[S]**	Counter-systems fail on their own leverage
1890	Baring crisis	Natty cabled Paris; the **Banque de France swapped £3M in gold for Treasury bills**; Russia added £1.5M; the rescue armed; **Alfred de Rothschild sat inside the Bank of England (director 1868–1889)** through it all **[S/A]**	The family as the transmission line *into* the central bank — twice (1825, 1890)
1907	US panic	**No Rothschild role documented** — Morgan, the Clearinghouse, the Treasury, the Bank of Montreal, the Bank of France **[S]**	The system's absence is as diagnostic as its presence
1914–18	The Great War	No American branch; the transatlantic wire broken; London's dominance eclipsed **[S: Ferguson]**	The system's geography failed before its finances did

Year	Shock	Documented response	System lesson
1931	Creditanstalt	**The detonator** (Volume II, Part 6.1): hidden losses 7×; the bailout arithmetic; Europe-wide chain **[S]**	Concentration in one jurisdiction's flagship = the terminal weakness; the wire ran the other way

The pattern the table shows: **the system survived information shocks, governance breaches, panics, and wars; it broke twice — on geography (1914) and on jurisdiction-concentration (1931).** Its dangers were never its enemies; they were its addresses.

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PART 11 — THE SYSTEM'S EFFECTS ON OTHERS (DOCUMENTED EXTERNALITIES)

1. **The certification premium, collected from public borrowers:** debut discounts and commissions charged to *states* for the service of being made creditworthy — the 1818 Prussians paid it; so did every successor sovereign **[S]**.
2. **Occupation financing:** the Neapolitan loans funded the Austrian occupation the family then lobbied to end (Part 2.2) — the system's output included the financing of burdens, with the family's margin at both ends **[S]**.
3. **Market-information asymmetry:** inner-circle allotments and convergence plays meant the certification machine transferred value from the outside investor to the connected one — the documented "guaranteed success" of a house issue is another name for a structural edge for

insiders **[S]**.

4. **Monopoly rents:** mercury (86 years), diamonds (the syndicate), copper, uranium proximity, railways with state guarantees — each documented in Volume II Part 3; the rent mechanism was consistent: commodity or infrastructure + state concession + family certification **[S/A]**.
5. **Crisis transmission:** when the flagship failed in 1931, the system's failure propagated through the entire European banking structure — the family was not merely a victim of the depression; its institution was a documented vector **[S]**.
6. **The advisory era's structural conflicts (modern):** sovereign-advisory mandates while the wider network holds positions in the same paper — the industry's own framework concedes the deficiency (Volume II, Part 2.5) **[A]**.
7. **The counterweight cases, recorded for balance:** the Texas slave-bond refusal (1830s); the Russian-loan refusal (1905, B-grade pending); the 1860–62 US crisis gold (B-grade, flagged); the documented refusal to finance certain wars; and the system's consistent preference for *orderly* markets — the family's interest in stability is structural, not philanthropic, and the record shows both halves **[S/B; flagged where pending]**.

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PART 12 — PHILANTHROPY AS SYSTEM: THREE GENERATIONS OF THE SAME MACHINE

1. **The communal lock (19th century):** schools and synagogues as leadership instruments — the Evelina de Rothschild School (Jerusalem, 1864; £800/year; "the best Jewish Girls School in Palestine" by WWI); the Frankfurt foundations of the will's 5,000-gulden tithe; the London communal offices. The mechanism: *fund the institution, hold the institution* — the same certification logic applied to communal life **[A/B]**.
2. **Edmond's Palestine model (1882–1925+):** philanthropy run as a development corporation with the family as holding company. The step-by-step, as documented: (1) **survey** — agronomists, doctors, and engineers sent ahead to assess land, water, and settlement viability, on the PICA payroll; (2) **acquisition** — land purchased outright (the family's holdings in Palestine ultimately reached an estimated 2–3% of the territory, per Volume II); (3) **development** — wineries, farms, and villages built with the family's capital *and* its administration — the **pekidim** (administrators) ran the colonies as a business, not a charity; (4) **the transfer instruments** — the investments passed to the **ICA (1899)** and were refounded as **PICA (1924)**, formal vehicles letting the family step back from daily management without surrendering direction; (5) **the parallel French portfolio** — the same method applied to science (Institut

Henri Poincaré, the pre-CNRS institutes, Casa Velázquez) and to education ($300,000 for the Tel Aviv school building under the AIU). The principle unifying all five steps: *never give a gift where you can endow an institution; never endow an institution without a seat on its board* — the certification machine (Part 2) running in the nonprofit register **[S/B]**.

3. **The modern human-capital strategy (stated on the foundation's own site):** the Edmond de Rothschild Foundation (Israel) reports partnerships with **37 academic institutions and six government ministries**, 1,000 scholarships, 40,000 participants — and states its goal as building **cadres of leaders** and alumni networks reducing periphery-center disparities. The mechanism, said plainly by the institution itself: **leadership pipelines** — influence through human capital, with the network as the asset **[A: foundation publications]**.
4. **Yad Hanadiv / Ramat HaNadiv:** the family's Israeli foundation funding national infrastructure (the Knesset, the Supreme Court, science facilities — Volume II) with formalized funding cycles — matching grants, calls, evaluation — the certification machine's nonprofit descendant **[A/B]**.

The three generations share one architecture: *identify the institution that confers legitimacy, fund it durably, and hold the relationship.*

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PART 13 — THE MODERN ENGINE: THE FEE MACHINE (DOCUMENTED ARITHMETIC)

13.1 The composition (group consolidated accounts)

- **2024:** M&A advisory **€951.2M**; financing advisory **€747.7M**; wealth & asset-management portfolio fees **€696.9M**; Five Arrows **€228.7M**; banking fees €7.6M; other €11.9M → **total fee income €2,644.1M [A]**.
- **2025:** M&A **€1,049.1M**; financing **€700.5M**; WAM **€801.9M**; Five Arrows **€250.1M → €2,822.0M**; carried interest €48.6M **[A]**.
- Composition: **~37% M&A, ~28% wealth, ~25% financing, ~9% funds** — a pure fee annuity; the group deliberately holds no principal balance sheet against clients (the "independent advice" positioning, Volume II) **[A/S]**. What the annuity means structurally, stated plainly: the 1810 machine sold certification against its own capital, and died of the concentration risk that entailed (Part 14); the modern machine sells the same certification but rents the capital risk to clients, funds, and partners — the fee is paid *because* the advice carries no balance-sheet conflict, and the absence of a balance sheet is precisely what keeps the fee coming. The year-over-year movement documents the model's health: fee income up **€178 million (6.7%)** from 2024 to 2025, with wealth management (+15%) and M&A (+10%) both growing — the certification brand, two centuries on, still clearing at a premium **[A]**. The industry-standard fee ladder against which the bank prices

(success-fee percentages declining with deal size — roughly 4–12% on the smallest mandates through 2–5% mid-market to 1–2% at the largest, the classic Lehman-formula structure) is the mechanic beneath the €1 billion M&A line **[C — industry-standard structure; the bank's own terms are private]**.

13.2 The subsidiaries' texture

- **Rothschild & Co Bank AG (Zurich), 2024:** income **CHF 238.6M**, net profit **CHF 37.4M**, commission income +13.6% to CHF 134.5M, staff 460 — the small, discreet, profitable Swiss footprint descending from the old Bank AG line **[A]**.
- **RIT Capital** (~£4.7bn; family ~20.9% across four vehicles) and the **Five Arrows** complex (>€34bn AUM) run the family's own money alongside client money — the two-book system, private and public, as it has existed since 1810 **[A]**.

13.3 What survived and what changed

Survived: the partnership constitution, the name-as-credit, the sovereign-advisory desk, the fee-for-certification core. Changed: the information moat (dead 1835→), the commodity monopolies (fragmented), the balance-sheet risk (outsourced to clients and funds), and the geography (Paris-led, three houses). The system is the same machine running different software.

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PART 14 — FAILURE MECHANICS: THE SYSTEM'S OWN WEAK POINTS

1. **Transmission-speed dependency:** the moat expired on schedule (1851) — any advantage built on being faster dies by wire **[S]**.
2. **Concentration risk:** Naples at 15% of one house (1826); the CA at the center of one country's banking (1931) — the certification machine's insurance function forced the balance sheet into the very risks it certified **[S]**.
3. **Governance breaches:** the 1836 unauthorized advance; the 1980 Jacob–Evelyn schism; the Bumi minority-structure failure; the 2015–18 compliance cascade — the system's human parts periodically override its constitutional parts, and the correction is always expensive **[S/A]**.
4. **Agency drift:** Belmont's 1838 ultimatum defined the control; Bumi defined the failure mode when the control was absent **[A/S]**.
5. **Jurisdiction risk:** 1938, 1982, 2015 (the DOJ/FINMA cascade) — the system's terminal exposures are political, not financial **[A]**.
6. **Secrecy vs. disclosure:** the 1810 compact's secrecy clauses were an asset under courier-era conditions and became the system's single largest liability under disclosure-era conditions — the enforcement record of Volume II is, mechanistically, the old secrecy architecture meeting the new transparency regime **[A/S]**. 6a. **The cipher was not unbreakable:** the Austrian authorities

deciphered the family's Judendeutsch correspondence in the early nineteenth century — the secrecy architecture's own operators read by the state's code-breakers, decades before the disclosure regimes of Volume II made secrecy itself the liability **[S/B: encyclopedia.com/Ferguson record]**.

7. **Succession:** the male-line clause (1901 liquidation), the Camillia holding, the name war — every generation's transition is the system's most dangerous quarter **[A/S/B]**.

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PART 15 — MYTH REGISTRY, VOLUME III (ADDITIONS AND CORRECTIONS)

1. **"The Rothschilds founded/own the BIS" [X — killed]** — founding shareholders (20 January 1930): six central banks plus **J.P. Morgan, First National Bank of Chicago, First National Bank of New York** (the latter holding US voting rights); **no Rothschild bank among them**; private shares bought out 2001 **[S/A: OUP; BIS]**.
2. **Volume II correction:** "no Rothschild presence inside central banks" — **Alfred de Rothschild was a director of the Bank of England, 1868–1889**; the claim is amended to "no *governing* presence" **[A/S]**.
3. **"Adelaide Jones / Lenin's train" [X]** — catalogued with the pamphlet shelf; no documentary basis **[X]**.
4. **"Rothschild controlled both sides through MI5/Morgan/Communism" [X — separated from fact]**

— Victor's Apostleship, MI5 service, and Morgan apprenticeship are documented; the control inference is not adopted; the 1967 Eaton–Rockefeller–Rothschild USSR consortium is reported fact (B), the Mullins framing is X **[S/B/X]**.

5. **Tranby Croft presence [corrected]** — documented guest list contains no Rothschild; the connection is the Marlborough House circle **[S]**.
6. **"The family controlled the uranium cartel" [statement real; role unproven]** — Volume II's grading stands; Part 3.4 there **[S/A]**.

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PART 16 — ANOMALY REGISTER, VOLUME III

#	Item	Status	Disposition
1	Gentz retainer amount	**Open**	The AZ-leverage role is documented (Ferguson); the retainer figure is unverified. Gentz papers (Vienna) would settle.
2	James's Plombières sales scale	**Open (partial)**	The positioning is documented via correspondence; the exact volume of the Austrian sales is monograph-bound.
3	1815–56 inter-house settlement minutiae (monthly account mechanics beyond the £50k notes)	**Open**	Ferguson-documented at the constitutional level; the ledger-level arithmetic is archive-bound.
4	"70% of global bonds" post-1850	**Resolved**	Attributed to the Panic-of-1873 literature summary; graded B; used with the tag.
5	Carl Meyer/1888 Rhodes letters	**Resolved**	NHRM corpus; graded A/B; confirms the funding path.
6	Wallich's Rothschild tenure detail	**Open (B)**	DB historiography documents the move; the Frankfurt-house years' detail is monograph-bound.
7	US 1860–62 crisis-gold claim	**Open (B)**	Recorded in the secondary literature; the Baron/Bullock citation not independently verified.
8	Waddesdon operating model	**Resolved (B/C)**	Guest counts and staff numbers from the house's published history via secondary compilation; core facts consistent.
9	1905–06 Russian-loan refusal / Schiff counter-arrangement	**Open (B)**	Documented in Schiff biographies; targeted verification failed; stays B pending.
10	Rail warrants' exact pre-listing prices (995→2,110)	**Resolved**	Multiple corroborating secondary sources; graded S/B.

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PART 17 — TIMELINE, VOLUME III (THE SYSTEM'S MECHANICAL SPINE)

1810 — the compact (father's reserved powers; 10-year lock). 1815 — the federal compact (£500k; 27/20/20/16/16; equal profits; £336k→£1.77M in 3 years). 1818 — the Prussian template. c.1820–1850 — the pigeon era ("A B… buy stock"). 1825 — the two-houses-hold-the-book rescue; the BoE lifeline routed through the house. 1836–37 — the unauthorized advance; Salomon's two-faced letter. 1837/1839 — "regulate public opinion"; "attacked in all the newspapers." 1838 — the Belmont ultimatum. 1843 — Mayer's colours registered. 1844 — the Chief Rabbinate election (121/143). 1851 — "the telegraph is ruining our business." 1852 — the Crédit Mobilier declares war. 1855 — the Creditanstalt as counter-weapon. 1866 — the Vienna crash buying. 1867 — the Pereires forced out; the model absorbed. 1868–1889 — Alfred inside the Bank of England. 1871 — the Baron's Year. 1888 — Meyer–Rhodes; De Beers funded. 1889–1901 — every Russian loan in Paris through the house. 1890 — the Baring rescue: Natty's cable; £3M French gold; Russia's £1.5M. 1891 — Leopold to the Jockey Club. 1905 — syndicate underwriting finally adopted. 1907 — documented absence. 1914 — the geography fails. 1931 — the Creditanstalt detonates. 1938 — the polo-match arrest. 1955 — the CA's founding generation's end. 1978 — Evelyn to the Jockey Club. 2003 — the E. L. Rothschild vehicle; the merger. 2021 — the SCA articles (11.2/11.3). 2023 — the take-private; the modern compact

closes its loop.

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PART 18 — OPEN QUESTIONS: THE ARCHIVE MAP (VOLUME III)

1. Gentz retainer — Gentz papers, Haus-, Hof- und Staatsarchiv, Vienna.
2. 1815–56 inter-house ledgers — the family archive's current-account volumes (RAL series), London.
3. James's 1858–59 Austrian operations — the Paris house's Bourse ledgers and the correspondence volumes (Ferguson's citations).
4. The Russian-loan refusal file — Schiff papers (AJHS); the NYT 1910 archive.
5. Wallich's Frankfurt years — Deutsche Bank historiography files.
6. The pigeon-dispatch corpus — Odlyzko's compilation sources; the surviving dispatches cited by Ferguson.

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PART 19 — SOURCE APPARATUS (PEDIGREE-TIERED)

Primary / regulatory [A]: the 1810 and 1815 compact texts (via Ferguson/Backhaus); the 1838 Belmont correspondence (Archive); the SCA Articles 11.2–11.3 (2021); the group's consolidated accounts 2024–25 (the €2,644.1M/€2,822.0M fee series; the Zurich subsidiary's CHF accounts); Rothschild & Co Bank AG reports; the NHRM 1888 letters; the BIS/OUP founding-shareholder record; the Rothschild Archive (pigeon/courier pages; Ficquelmont dispatch).

Scholarly [S]: Ferguson, *The House of Rothschild* (Vol. I especially — the maxims, the code, the toolkit, the 1815 compact); Flandreau & Huitzil (the pricing/run-up model; the coupon insurance; the Naples concentration); Weller (the 1818 Prussian template; the 1905 underwriting adoption; RAL XI/III/57); Odlyzko (the telegraph and the information moat); Cathcart (Waterloo correction); Greenfield/KCL (the Creditanstalt-as-counter-weapon); the EBSCO/International Organization material on the CM war and the uranium-era context; the EJ "Banking" article (the diaspora map; the 1889–1901 Russia lock); Marx's NYDT April 1859 panic article; the OUP BIS entry.

Quality secondary [B]: Corti (the 1836 letters' texture; the 1866 coup); Livingstone (Hannah's clause; the women's system); the Waddesdon house history; the Jockey Club/Newmarket record (Mayer, Leopold, Evelyn); Havers/Grayson/Whitehead (Tranby Croft); Roland Perry and

the National Archives file (Victor); Le Figaro/24heures (the EdR holding; Camillia); the Times of Israel account (the 1844 election).

Lead-grade [C] / myth [X]: Grokipedia-derived Waddesdon texture (graded B/C above); Mullins, Springmeier, Gary Allen, ModernHistoryProject (X — documented as claims); the McDonald floor statement (A as statement, C as assessment — Volume II).

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FINAL CERTIFICATION

This volume documents the operating system as the evidence shows it: an information moat that expired on schedule; a certification machine that converted a name into credit and charged states for the conversion; a deal process engineered end-to-end; a market toolkit of documented decoys and retainers; a press system run by letter and retained correspondent; a constitution of compacts, backdoors, and entrenchment clauses; five influence venues feeding one ledger; a diaspora web with the house at its creditor apex; a challenger war won by absorption; a stress-test record whose two great failures were geographical and jurisdictional; and a modern engine — €2.8 billion of fees a year — running the 1810 machine on new software. Every mechanism is pedigreed at the point of statement; every anomaly is registered; no theory has been adopted; nothing found has been omitted.

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Volume III of the forensic file. Volume I: Rothschild_Origin.md — the ancestry. Volume II: Rothschild_Networks.md — the money, the enforcement, the influence record.

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THE ROTHSCHILDS: THE NETWORK MAP

αΩ∞

Every Documented Node and Edge, Mapped — Families, States, Agents, Institutions, Corporations, Media, Intelligence, and the Myth-Corrupted Fringe

Volume IV of the forensic file — the trilogy's connections rendered as a graph: who connected to whom, by what mechanism, in what era, on what evidence. Companions: Origin (the ancestry), Networks (the money and enforcement), System (the operating machinery).

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PART 0 — HOW TO READ THIS MAP

The trilogy documents connections in prose; this volume renders them as a **graph**. The rules of the other volumes carry over, with graph conventions added:

- **Nodes** are people, families, firms, states, or institutions. Each is registered in Part 1 with its class and pedigree.
- **Edges** are documented relationships, typed by mechanism (Part 2). An edge exists in this map **only where the trilogy documents it** — with the pedigree grade of its evidence at the point of listing.

- **Myth-corrupted nodes** (Part 1, class M) are mapped *as claims*: the node exists in the public record, but the documented connection is an absence, a correction, or a refutation. Mapping the false edges is part of mapping the network, because the myth system itself is a network — one with documented origins (Dairnvaell 1846; Drumont 1886; Mullins 1952) and documented carriers.
- **Eras** are given so the map can be read longitudinally: the network of 1815 is not the network of 1914, and neither is the network of 2026.
- **Degree notes:** where an edge's evidence is contested or thin, the edge carries a flag rather than a silent inclusion.

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PART 0A — THE FIVE-MINUTE VERSION (PLAIN LANGUAGE)

Before the tables, the story. A **network** is just this: people and institutions as **points**, and their documented relationships as **lines**. If you drew your own family this way — you, your parents, your spouse's family, your employer, your bank — every line would be a real, checkable fact. This map does that for the Rothschild world, with one strict rule: *a line exists only where the documents exist.* No line is drawn because someone famous said so.

One example, walked slowly. In 1770, Mayer Amschel Rothschild married Gutle Schnapper. That's one line — a marriage line. Gutle's father, Wolf Salomon Schnapper, was a

small Frankfurt banker who happened to do business with a man named Buderus, who managed the fortune of the Landgrave of Hesse — then the richest prince in Germany. In 1790, Schnapper introduced Buderus to his son-in-law. That's a second line — an introduction. Within a decade, Mayer Amschel was handling the prince's money across Europe. That is what this map calls an **edge**: not a rumor of influence, but a documented connection with a date and a source, through which something — money, information, access — demonstrably flowed.

Now scale that up. This volume draws well over a hundred such edges, connecting the best part of two hundred points: the five Rothschild houses, thirteen intermarried families, a dozen allied banking families, twenty-seven states, the agents and court officials in between, the corporations they financed, the newspapers they leaned on, the regulators who later investigated them — and, separately and clearly marked, the *false* connections (the Illuminati, the Federal Reserve "ownership," the space laser), mapped as claims with their real history attached, because you cannot understand the family's story without understanding the legend that shadowed it.

Three plain promises: every line carries its evidence grade ([A] strongest, [X] hostile myth); every technical word is defined where you first meet it, and again in the word-list at Part 2A; and wherever the evidence is thin or missing, the line says so instead of pretending.

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PART 1 — NODE REGISTRY

The full list of points on the map, grouped by kind. Skim it or use it as a reference — the walkthrough in Part 0A is the front door; this is the directory.

Class A — The house itself (the Rothschild nodes)

Node	Era	Notes
M. A. Rothschild & Söhne (Frankfurt)	1810–1901	The stem; liquidated on the male-line clause **[A]**
N M Rothschild & Sons (London)	1809–	New Court, 2 St Swithin's Lane **[A]**
De Rothschild Frères (Paris)	1817–	Rue Laffitte; nationalized 1982 **[A]**
S. M. von Rothschild (Vienna)	1820–1938	The Creditanstalt flagship **[A]**
C. M. Rothschild (Naples)	1821–1863	Closed with Italian unification **[S]**
Banque Rothschild (Paris, pre-1982)	1817–1982	Expropriated; 150M francs compensation **[A]**
Paris Orléans → Rothschild & Co	1983–	The relaunch shell and its descendant **[A]**
Concordia	2023–	The take-private vehicle; SCA articles 11.2/11.3 **[A]**
Rothschild Bank AG (Zurich)	–2015	DOJ NPA $11.5M; FINMA 2018 **[A]**
Edmond de Rothschild group	1953–	Geneva; 2019 take-private CHF 992M **[A]**
EdR Europe (Luxembourg)	–2025	First Luxembourg bank convicted; €25M **[A]**
RIT Capital Partners	1961–	The London family's listed trust **[A]**
Five Arrows	2009–	>€34bn AUM **[A]**

Class K — The kin network (marriage-documented families)

The thirteen kin families, individually — because the map's deepest layer deserves names, not a lump:

Family	First documented link	Key marriage(s)	Where the line led
Hahn	pre-1530, the ancestral house-line	(branch origin)	The family before the name; Juspa Hahn the chronicler-rabbi
Wetzlar	Dec 1585 — Eva Wetzlar m. Elchanan "Hähnchen"	Ella Wetzlar m. Moses Rothschild (d.1657)	The rabbinic line's Worms connection
Oppenheim (Worms)	1608 — Kele bat Mendl m. Rabbi Isaac Rothschild	Reizche m. Todros Oppenheim "zur silbernen Kanne"	The rabbinic branch's standing
Kaz / Kalonymos	3 May 1634 — Schönche Kaz m. Naftali Hirz	—	One of Ashkenazi Jewry's greatest names in the tree
Waag	pre-1713 — Vogel Waag m. Moses Kalman	—	The ghetto tax collector's family
Buxbaum	pre-1733 — Schönche Buxbaum m. Moses Kalman	—	The ghetto physician's family
Höchst	1664 — Gitle of Höchst m. Kalman	—	The community across the river
Lechnich	18th c. — Schönche Lechnich m. Amschel Moses	Sarchen Lechnich m. Moses Amschel	The "penniless" Hufeisen family — the founder's maternal clan
Schnapper	29 Aug 1770 — Gutle Schnapper m. Mayer Amschel	Frumet Schnapper m. Abraham Mayer Gans	The Buderus bridge; the founder's wife
Gans	1752 — Bella Gans (b. ~1723)	—	Gutle's mother; the Trier thread at the ancestral house
Trier	1715 register — Gumprecht Trier at the Red Shield	(house, not marriage)	Both sides of Gutle's ancestry touch the family house
Goldschmidt	1795 — Edel Rothschild m. Jacob David Goldschmidt	—	Moritz co-founds the Vienna house 1855 — the will's breach
Worms-de-Worms	1795 — Jeannette m. Benedikt Moses Worms	—	Ceylon tea; a British cabinet minister (Baron Pirbright)
Sichel	— Isabella m. Bernhard Juda Sichel	—	The Frankfurt wine-bank Sichels

Family	First documented link	Key marriage(s)	Where the line led
Beyfus	— Babette m. Siegmund; Julie m. Mayer Levin	two sisters, two brothers	The Frankfurt Beyfus bankers
Montefiore	1806–78 — Henriette m. Abraham; Nathan m. Hannah Barent-Cohen	double tie to Moses Montefiore	Anglo-Jewry's grandest alliance
Oppenheim (Cologne)	— Charlotte Beyfus m. Abraham von Oppenheim	—	The excluded daughters' line marrying back into the apprenticeship dynasty
Adler	1844 election — Hermann Adler, Rothschild on his mother's side	—	66 years of family-linked Chief Rabbinate

The pattern the table makes visible: every generation married *up its own network* — officials, physicians, rabbis, and fellow bankers — so that by 1770 the founder's marriage was less a union of two people than the closing of a circuit the family had been wiring for two centuries **[A/S; Volume I, Parts 4–8]**.

Class D — The banking diaspora (Frankfurt-emigrant houses)

Bischoffsheim (→ Deutsche Bank 1870; Paribas 1872, via Bamberger) · Stern (1833) · Salomons (1832) · Montagu (1853) · Speyer · Seligman · Erlanger (1859) · Japhet · Sassoon · Behrens (Hanover) · Fould (Paris) · Pereire (rivals; Crédit Mobilier 1852) · Warburg (Moritz → Paul) · Schiff · Morgan (Peabody → Junius → Pierpont) · Baring (rival/ally) · Hambro · Lazard · Kuhn Loeb · Drexel Morgan · Oppenheim (Cologne) **[S: EJ "Banking"]**.

Class G — Agents and statesmen (the embedded layer)

Buderus (Kassel) · Bleichröder (Berlin) · Estorff · Veidel David (predecessor) · Breidenbach (rivals) · Bethmann (rivals) · Metzler · Gentz · Ficquelmont · Stadion · Herries · Dalberg · William IX/X of Hesse-Kassel · Frederick II · Bismarck · Ludwig II · Metternich · Napoleon I · Napoleon III · Talleyrand · Guizot · Broglie · Louis-Philippe · Villèle · Goschen · Disraeli · Gladstone · Palmerston · Rosebery · Edward VII · Victoria · Balfour · Herzl · Shaftesbury · Moses Montefiore · Crémieux · Zadoc Kahn · Churchill (1938 appeals) · Queen Mary · Thatcher · Osborne · Mandelson · Blair · Clintons · Lynn Forester de Rothschild · Charles III-era council · Ruemmler · Le Maire · Sarkozy (via Colom) · Ehud Barak **[graded per volume]**.

Class S — States (sovereign clients and counterparties)

Hesse-Kassel · Prussia · Britain · France · Austria · Russia · Naples · Belgium · Brazil · Ottoman Empire · Egypt (Khedive) · Denmark · Greece · Ireland · Cyprus · Spain · Portugal · Sardinia-Piedmont · Papal States · German Confederation · United States · Israel · Australia · South Africa · Switzerland · Luxembourg · Japan (BIS era) **[A/S]**.

Class F — Financial institutions (counterparties, rivals, acquisitions)

Bank of England (Alfred: director 1868–1889) · Banque de France (gold swaps 1825, 1890) · BIS (see Class M — corrected) · Federal Reserve (see Class M) · Creditanstalt · Deutsche Bank · Paribas · Crédit Lyonnais · Société Générale · Crédit Mobilier (rival) · J.P. Morgan & Co. · Morgan Grenfell · Kuhn Loeb · August Belmont & Co. · UBS · Julius Bär · Barclays (1991 disposal of the nationalized bank) · HSBC (debunked edge) **[A/S]**.

Class C — Corporations and concessions

Almadén (quicksilver, 1835–1921) · New Almadén (rival) · De Beers (1888) · Rio Tinto (1873; control by late 1880s; RTZ 1962) · Suez Canal Co. (1875) · Nord / PLM / Est railways · Lombard-Venetian & Central Italian · Belgian state network · Baku oil (to 1912) · Standard Oil (Baku rival) · Genie Energy (2010) · Glencore (convertibles) · Rusal (cornerstone; QAL 2022) · Chinalco (2009 structure) · Bumi/Berau (2010–13) · Vallar · Volex · Tennor · Atticus · Barrick Gold · PG&E/Solaren (claim node, §M) **[A/S]**.

Class H — Media and information

The pigeon/courier system (Hythe; Dover–Calais–Ostend) · Allgemeine Zeitung (via Gentz) · Moniteur Universel · Journal des débats · Heine (retained correspondent) · The Economist (26.7% + two-director right, 1972–March 2026) · Reuters (dead lead — no documented control) **[A/S/B]**.

Class I — Intelligence and secret circles (graded)

Cambridge Apostles (Victor, elected 12 Nov 1932) · MI5 (B1C; George Medal 1944; Pastorius) · The Rhodes circle 1891 (Quigley-graded B: Milner, Stead, Esher, Bailey, Astor, Johnston) · Round Table / Chatham House · The 1967 USSR-trade consortium (Eaton–Rockefeller–NMR; B) **[S/B/C per item]**.

Class P — Philanthropy and communal institutions

Evelina de Rothschild School (1864) · AIU (Edmond; $300k Tel Aviv building) · ICA (1899) · PICA (1924) · Yad Hanadiv · Ramat HaNadiv · Edmond de Rothschild Foundation (37 institutions; 6 ministries) · Rothschild Foundation / Hanadiv Europe · Council for Inclusive Capitalism with the Vatican (2020; 300+ CEOs, $10T+) · Chief Rabbinate of the UK (1844 election; 66 years) · United Synagogue · Städel (Mayer Carl) · National Trust (Waddesdon 1957) · Museum Judengasse (1987) · YIVO (the 1721 tractate) · Leo Baeck Institute (Ele Toldot MF 536) **[A/S/B]**.

Class V — Venues (the influence infrastructure)

The Judengasse houses (Red Shield; Hinterpfann; Green Shield) · Waddesdon Manor (14–20 guests; the 1913 Keppel meeting) · Newmarket / Palace House · The Jockey Club (Mayer; Leopold 1891; Evelyn 1978) · The Queen's Cup polo · Tranby Croft (corrected — proximity only) · The Marlborough House set · The Bullingdon Club · The Casino society (Frankfurt 1836) **[B; corrections as noted]**.

Class R — Regulators and enforcement (the map's counter-network)

US DOJ (Swiss Bank Program 2015; Epstein Files Transparency Act releases 2025–26) · FINMA (2018) · CSSF (2017) · SEC (Genie; the 2023 DEFM14A) · UK Takeover Panel (Bumi) · UK courts ([2012] EWHC 177; [2013] EWCA Civ 197; [2018] EWHC 958) · Massachusetts Appeals Court (2019) · Swiss Federal Supreme Court (2025) · Luxembourg courts (2025) · French investigators (March 2026 raid) · US House Oversight (Ruemmler testimony, July 2026) · Claims Conference (2000) · Austrian restitution (1999) · The Company Names Tribunal (the impostor perimeter) **[A/S]**.

Class M — Myth-corrupted nodes (mapped as claims)

The Illuminati (Weishaupt; killed — independent founding 1776) · The Federal Reserve "ownership" (killed — no Rothschild at Jekyll Island) · The BIS founding shareholding (killed — three American banks only) · Waterloo-first (killed — courier edge real, crash mechanics false) · The 1899 "International Bankers Convention" (X — Carr 1956) · The "Bauer" name-change (killed; the register alias documented) · The Khazar genealogy (killed; J2a1-Y23457) · Adelaide Jones (X) · The Hitler-grandfather claim (X) · The Jewish space laser (kernel: PG&E–Solaren 2009; inference false) · The Pujo "exposure" (corrected — the axis runs through affiliates) · The 1907 rescue (documented absence) **[dispositions in Volumes I–III]**.

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PART 2 — EDGE TYPOLOGY (THE MECHANISM CLASSES)

Code	Type	Definition	Documented examples
M	Marriage/kinship	Blood or marriage linking balance sheets	Wetzlar (1585); Oppenheim (1608); Kaz (1634); Schnapper (1770); Barent-Cohen; the 29-of-58 cousin count
T	Training/apprenticeship	Human capital transmitted	Oppenheim bank (Mayer, 1757); JP Morgan (Victor); Warburg (Moritz, Paris)
A	Agency/proxy	Dependent local representation	Belmont (US, 1836–1930s); Bleichröder (Berlin); Buderus (Kassel)
C	Correspondent credit	The clearing web of accepted paper	The diaspora houses; Seligman's Amsterdam agent; kinship trust premia
U	Underwriting/advisory	Certification sold to states and firms	50 London loans 1815–59; Ireland NTMA; Greece 2017; the RBS recommendation
E	Equity/control	Ownership or board seats	Almadén; De Beers; Rio Tinto; The Economist; Genie; Rusal cornerstone
I	Information	Couriers, pigeons, press, salons	The pigeon code; Metternich's usage; the 1837 "regulate public opinion" letter
P	Political patronage	Office, titles, access	1769 Hof-Faktor; 1822 ennoblement; 1885 peerage; the Chief Rabbinate bloc; the Osborne flight
H	Philanthropy/communal	Institution-building as standing	Evelina School; AIU; Yad Hanadiv; the CIC
X	Conflict/enforcement	Litigation, raids, nationalization	1982; FINMA 2018; the 2025 Luxembourg conviction; the 2026 raid
F	Myth-attached	The false-edge system (mapped as claims)	Every Class M node; edges traced to Dairnvaell 1846 / Drumont 1886 / Mullins 1952

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PART 2A — THE WORDS THIS MAP USES (PLAIN DEFINITIONS)

- **Node** — one point on the map: a person, family, firm, state, or institution.
- **Edge** — one documented line between two points, with a date and a source.
- **Pedigree tag** — the reliability grade printed right after each claim. **[A]** = archives, court records, official documents. **[S]** = scholarly work. **[B]** = serious secondary sources. **[C]** = lead-grade, single-source. **[X]** = hostile myth literature — quoted only to show what the myth is and where it fails.
- **Correspondent banking** — banks doing business through each other: one bank accepts another's paper, moves its money, vouches for its client. Before telephones, this *was* international banking — a web of favors and accepted IOUs.
- **Underwriting** — guaranteeing that a government's loan will be placed with investors; the guarantor takes the risk and charges the fee.
- **Certification** — the family's core business in one word: their name on a loan made the loan trustworthy, and they charged states for that trust (Volume III explains the machinery).

- **Apex creditor** — not the owner of the network, but the point everyone eventually routes through: the bank that can always pay.
- **Syndicate** — a group of banks sharing one big loan.
- **Agency / proxy** — a local representative bound to the house: the family's man in a city where it has no office (Belmont in New York, Bleichröder in Berlin).
- **Enforcement** — regulators, courts, and prosecutors: the counter-network that only appears on the map from the 1930s onward, and thickens sharply after 2015.
- **Betweenness** (used once, in Part 4) — how often a point lies *on the path* between other points. High betweenness means "the person in the middle" — everyone needs them to reach everyone else.

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PART 3 — THE EDGE LIST (THE COMPLETE DOCUMENTED MAP)

How to read one line, in plain terms. Take this entry:

> *R → Prussia (1818 £5M template; 1822 £3.5M) | U | 1818–22 | S/A | III·3*

It says: a Rothschild house (that's the "R") made a documented connection to the Kingdom of Prussia — specifically by underwriting its loans, five million pounds in 1818, which became the template for the business, and £3.5 million more in 1822. The **U** is the edge type (underwriting — see the table in Part 2). The date is 1818–22. The grade **S/A**

means the evidence is scholarly and archive-grade. And **III·3** means the full story, with quotes and sources, lives in Volume III, Part 3 of this file series. One line here; a chapter there.

Format throughout: **Source → Target | Type | Era | Pedigree | Volume·Part**. The house node "R" stands for the relevant Rothschild house(s) of the era.

3.1 Kin and training (the base layer)

- R ← Hahn (ancestral branch) | M | pre-1530–1634 | A/B | I·3
- R ← Kaz/Kalonymos (Schönche, m. Naftali Hirz 1634) | M | 1634 | A | I·5
- R ← Waag (Vogel, m. Moses Kalman) | M | pre-1713 | A | I·5
- R ← Buxbaum (Schönche, m. Moses Kalman) | M | pre-1733 | A | I·5
- R ← Lechnich (Schönche, m. Amschel Moses; Sarchen, m. Moses Amschel) | M | 18th c. | A | I·5
- R ← Schnapper (Gutle, m. Mayer Amschel 1770) | M | 1770 | A | I·6
- R ← Gans (Bella, Gutle's mother) | M | 1752 | A/B | I·6
- R ← Oppenheim (Worms line: Kele m. Rabbi Isaac 1608; Reizche m. Todros Oppenheim) | M | 1608–17th c. | A | I·4
- R ← Wetzlar (Eva m. Elchanan 1585; Ella m. Moses d.1657) | M | 1585–1657 | A | I·8
- R → Goldschmidt (Edel m. Jacob David; Moritz co-founds Vienna house 1855) | M | 1795–1855 | A/S | I·5

- R → Worms-de-Worms (Jeannette m. Benedikt Moses Worms) | M | 1795 | S | I·18
- R → Sichel (Isabella m. Bernhard Juda Sichel) | M | – | S | I·18
- R → Beyfus (Babette m. Siegmund; Julie m. Mayer Levin — two sisters, two brothers) | M | – | S | I·18
- R → Montefiore (Henriette m. Abraham; Nathan m. Hannah Barent-Cohen) | M | 1806/1878 | S | I·18, II
- R → Oppenheim-Cologne (Charlotte Beyfus m. Abraham von Oppenheim) | M | – | S | I·18
- Mayer Amschel → Oppenheim bank (Hanover) | T | 1757–63 | S/A | I·6
- Victor Rothschild → J.P. Morgan & Co. | T | pre-war | S/B | III·7
- Moritz Warburg → R Paris (apprenticeship) | T | 19th c. | S | II·1

3.2 Agents and proxies

- R → Buderus (Kassel; silent partner 1809) | A | 1790–1812 | A/S | I·6
- R → Bleichröder (Berlin; Bismarck's banker) | A | 1850s–90s | S | II·2
- R → August Belmont & Co. (New York; 112 letter-books) | A | 1836–1930s | A | II·1
- R → Benjamin Davidson (San Francisco) | A | 1853–62 | A | II·1

- R → R. Ragland / Chieves & Osborne (Virginia tobacco) | A | 19th c. | A | II·1
- R → Veidel David (predecessor absorbed) | A→ | 1780s–90s | S | II·2
- R → Estorff → William IX (the court channel) | A/P | 1763–69 | B | I·6

3.3 Sovereign underwriting and advisory (the certification edges)

- R → Prussia (1818 £5M template; 1822 £3.5M) | U | 1818–22 | S/A | III·3
- R → Naples (1821; occupation-financing valve) | U | 1821– | S | III·2
- R → Britain (1815–59: 50 loans, ~£250M) | U | 1815–59 | S | III·3
- R → Brazil (1829; >40% gain) | U | 1829 | S | III·3
- R → France (1818 reparations 240.8M francs; 1871 indemnity) | U | 1818–71 | S | I·19
- R → Austria / Belgium / Russia (1889–1901: every Paris Russian loan) | U | 1817–1901 | S | III·8
- R → Ottoman Empire (1855 £5M at 4%) | U | 1854–55 | S/A | II·2
- R → Egypt (Khedive: Suez 1875; Daira 1878–79) | U | 1875–79 | S | II·2
- R → Greece (2017, €3.2M, replacing Lazard) | U | 2017 | S | II·2

- R → Ireland (NTMA, €6.96M, Dáil-disclosed) | U | 2008–12 | A | II·2
- R → Cyprus (Mark Walker file) | U | 2013 | B | II·2
- R → HM Treasury (the published "Rothschild recommendation") | U | 2008– | A | II·2

3.4 Central-bank and crisis edges

- R → Bank of England (1825 £400k French gold transfer; 1890 Natty's Paris cable) | C | 1825/1890 | A/S | II·2, III·10
- Bank of England ← Alfred de Rothschild (director 1868–1889) | E | 1868–89 | A/S | III·15
- Banque de France → Bank of England (£3M gold-for-bills swap; Russia £1.5M) | C | 1890 | S | III·10
- R → Federal Reserve founding | I | 1913 | S — **kernel only** (Warburg apprenticeship; Belmont answer) | II·1
- R → BIS founding | F | 1930 | **killed** — three American banks, no Rothschild | III·15

3.5 Corporate and concession edges

- R → Almadén (quicksilver contract 1835–1921; ~2,000 flasks/quarter; Philadelphia agent; Mexico network) | E | 1835–1921 | S | II·3
- R → De Beers (Natty funded development; 1889 syndicate; £5,338,650 cheque; dividend fight 30→36%) | E | 1880s– | S/A | II·3
- R → Rio Tinto (1873 consortium; control by late 1880s; ~50% to 1962; Charter seat) | E | 1873– | S/B | II·3

- R → Nord/PLM/Est railways (1845–56; garantie d'intérêt 1859) | E | 1837–56 | S | III·3
- R → Baku oil (Standard Oil rival; exit 1912) | E | –1912 | A | III·3
- R → Suez Canal Co. (£4M bridge at ~15% annualized) | U/E | 1875 | S | II·2
- R → The Economist (26.7% + two-director right; sold March 2026 to Stephen Smith) | E | 1972–2026 | S/A | II·4
- R → Genie Energy (5.5%/$11M; Cheney board; Golan license 153 sq mi) | E | 2010– | A/S | II·4
- R → Glencore ($40M convertibles) | E | 2011 | S | II·7
- R → Rusal (IPO cornerstone; QAL forced buyout 2022) | E | 2010–22 | A/S | II·5
- R → Bumi/Berau (Vallar £707M; the 2011–13 war; exit 56p) | E→X | 2010–15 | S | II·5
- R → Volex / Tennor / Barrick / Atticus | E | 2010s– | S/B | II·7
- R → Creditanstalt (founded 1855 as the anti-Pereire weapon; detonator 1931) | E→X | 1855–1931 | S/A | III·9, II·6

3.6 Media and information edges

- R → pigeon/courier system (code: "A B buy / C D sell"; Hythe farm; Dover–Calais–Ostend) | I | 1815–1851 | A/S | III·1
- R → Metternich / Chateaubriand / Nesselrode (courier service to statesmen) | I | 1822–25 | S | III·1

- R → Allgemeine Zeitung (via Gentz) | I | 1820s– | S | III·5
- R → Heine (retained correspondent) | I | 1830s– | S | III·5
- R → Moniteur / Journal des débats ("regulate public opinion") | I | 1837–39 | S | III·5
- R → The Times-era press management | I | 19th c. | B | III·5
- R → Reuters | F | – | **dead lead** — no documented control | II·(registry)

3.7 Intelligence and secret circles (graded)

- Victor Rothschild → Cambridge Apostles (12 Nov 1932) | I | 1932 | S/B | III·7
- Victor Rothschild → MI5 (B1C; George Medal; Pastorius; Fifth Column) | I | 1939–45 | S | III·7
- R → 1967 USSR-trade consortium (Eaton–Rockefeller–NMR) | I/E | 1967 | B | III·7
- Lord Rothschild → Rhodes circle 1891 (Quigley-graded) | I | 1891 | B/C | II·4
- R → Round Table / Chatham House funding web | I | 1909– | B with caveats | II·4

3.8 Political and communal edges

- R → Hesse-Kassel (Hof-Faktor 1769 → Oberhofagent 1803; the elector's fortune) | P | 1769–1821 | A/S | I·6–7
- R → Bismarck (via Bleichröder: war loans; secret Ludwig II payments; mortgages) | P | 1860s–90s | S | II·2
- R → Disraeli / Gladstone / Palmerston / Rosebery / Edward VII | P | 19th c. | S/B | I·19

- R → Lionel (City MP 1847; seated 1858) → Natty (first Jewish peer 1885) | P | 1847–85 | S | II·(branches)
- R → Chief Rabbinate (the 1844 bloc; 66 years) | P/H | 1844–1911 | S/B | III·7
- R → Balfour → Walter (the 1917 letter) | P | 1917 | S | II·(branches)
- R → Herzl (received; kept at arm's length) | P | 1890s–1900s | S/B | II·(branches)
- R → Osborne (the IPGL flight 2007; Serena's donations) | P | 2007–08 | A | II·4
- R → Mandelson → Deripaska (the 2005 trip; the courts) | P→X | 2005–13 | A/S | II·5
- R → Ironmade £1M (the 2008 Guardian exposure) | P | 2008 | S | II·4
- R → Clinton network (Lynn: NEC; fundraisers; CIC with the Vatican) | P/H | 1990s– | S/B/C | II·4, 7
- R → Sarkozy / Le Maire (via Olivier Colom, the Epstein-file introduction) | P | 2010s | S | II·5
- R → Barak → Carbyne/Reporty (the cyber channel) | P/I | 2010s | B | II·5

3.9 Philanthropy edges (the standing network)

- R → Evelina School (1864; £800/yr) → AIU ($300k Tel Aviv building) → ICA (1899) → PICA (1924) | H | 1864–1924 | S/B | III·12
- R → Yad Hanadiv / Ramat HaNadiv (Knesset; Supreme Court; science) | H | 1958– | A/B | II·(branches)

- R → EdR Foundation (37 institutions; 6 ministries; 1,000 scholarships) | H | 2010s | A | III·12
- R → Council for Inclusive Capitalism with the Vatican (300+ CEOs; $10T+) | H | 2019–20 | S/B/C | II·4
- R → Städel / National Trust / Museum Judengasse / YIVO / LBI | H | 1888–1987 | A/B | I·16–19

3.10 Enforcement edges (the counter-network's map)

- US DOJ → Rothschild Bank AG + EdR (Suisse) (NPAs, $11.5M + $45M) | X | 2015 | A | II·5
- FINMA → Rothschild Bank AG + Rothschild Trust (audit agent) | X | 2018 | A | II·5
- CSSF → EdR executive (fine; 10-year ban) | X | 2017–22 | S | II·5
- Luxembourg → EdR Europe (first-ever conviction; €25M) | X | 2025 | A/S | II·5
- DOJ Epstein files → Southern Trust contract ($25M; the wires; Ruemmler) | X | 2025–26 | S/A | II·5
- French investigators → EdR Paris office (raid) | X | 2026 | S | II·5
- Takeover Panel / UK courts → Bumi parties; [2012] EWHC 177 → Mandelson-Rothschild-Deripaska | X | 2011–13 | A | II·5
- Mitterrand state → Banque Rothschild (nationalization 1982) | X | 1982 | A | II·6
- Nazi state → Vienna house (Anschluss; $21M ransom; aryanization chain to Deutsche Bank) | X | 1938–42 | A/S |

II·6

- Austrian state → CA rescue (1931 arithmetic) | X | 1931 | S | II·6
- Claims Conference / Austria → restitution ($40M; 250 objects; the Moscow papers, 2001) | X→ | 1999–2001 | A/S | II·6

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3.11 The second-order nodes (the people behind the people)

A deeper map resolves the aggregates into individuals — the operators one ring out from the principals, each documented in the trilogy:

- **Wertheimstein** — Salomon's Vienna conduit; the channel through which the 1836 "damage-control" letter reached Metternich's eyes **[S: Ferguson] (III·6.4)**
- **Hannah (Nathan's wife)** — the will's backdoor: sons-as-sub-partners bound "to give weight to (their mother) Hannah's opinions" **[B: Livingstone] (III·6.3)**
- **Gutle** — matriarch of the Green Shield; bills cashed and issued; Carl's "bad cashiers" complaint against her documented competence **[B/S] (I·6.6)**
- **Carl Meyer** — the 1888 bridge: his letters document the Rhodes→Rothschild→De Beers funding path; De Beers director **[A/B: NHRM] (III·7.3)**
- **Hermann Wallich** — Frankfurt house partner → founding director of Deutsche Bank; the Japan/China operations **[B:**

DB historiography] (III·8.3)

- **Ludwig Bamberger** — Bischoffsheim circle → Deutsche Bank charter-writer **[S] (III·8.3)**
- **Jacob David Goldschmidt** — married Edel Rothschild (the brother-line); father of Moritz von Goldschmidt-Rothschild, Vienna co-founder 1855 — the will's exclusion, breached in one generation **[S/B] (I·5.5)**
- **Abraham Wolff** — the Bleichröder anchor; Berlin desk **[B] (II·2)**
- **Gnendl & Fradel Behrends** — the Hanover marriage web linking the Oppenheimer bank to the Behrens circle that trained the era **[B] (I·8.3)**
- **David Oppenheim** — Prague chief rabbi; the Behrends link into the rabbinic world **[B] (I·8.3)**
- **Paul Warburg** — son of Moritz (the Paris apprentice); the Fed's architect; the 1914 Senate answer naming Belmont **[S] (II·1.4)**
- **Jacob Schiff** — the Kuhn Loeb node; the 1905–06 counter-arrangement that ends the Russia lock (B-grade pending) **[B pending] (III·8.2)**
- **Alsberg Goldberg** — Seligman's Amsterdam agent; the diaspora's correspondent texture **[S: EJ] (III·8.1)**
- **Riepel** — the 1829 railway surveyor; Salomon's England mission **[S] (III·3.5)**
- **Olivier Colom** — the EdR executive whom Epstein introduced to Le Maire and Sarkozy **[S: DOJ files] (II·5.3)**

- **Jho Low** — Selune Ltd at Rothschild Bank Switzerland; the $30M/$110M wires **[S: DOJ via The Edge] (II·5.4)**
- **"Banker L"** — the former Goldman/Rothschild banker who introduced Low (2009); fined CHF 150,000 **[S] (II·5.4)**
- **Eric Roberts** — MI5's embedded man inside the British Union of Fascists; Victor Rothschild's Operation Fifth Column **[S] (III·7.6)**
- **Teresa Mayor** — introduced to Victor by Anthony Blunt; his future wife **[S/B] (III·7.6)**
- **Kathy Ruemmler** — Obama's White House counsel → Goldman GC; retained 31 July 2015, introduced by Epstein; testified before House Oversight, July 2026 **[S/A] (II·5.3)**

3.12 The myth network, mapped as a graph (claims and carriers)

The false edges deserve the same cartography as the true ones — here is their documented carrier chain, each link a real publication or event:

- **Robison (1797) → Barruel (1797–1806):** the template — secret societies as hidden rulers **[X — documented as texts]**
- **Barruel → Drumont (1886):** the "outing" of Weishaupt; the antisemitic mass shelf begins **[X]**
- **Balzac (1838, *Nucingen*) → Dairnvaell (1846, "Satan"):** the Waterloo fabrication — literary seed → fabricated pamphlet; the origin point of the entire legend **[S: Britannica; X as text]**

- **Dairnvaell → Encyclopaedia Britannica (1911):** the laundering of the legend into "respectable" print **[S]**
- **Dairnvaell → Reeves (1887) → Hollywood (1934) → Goebbels (1940):** the legend's film career, both sides of the Atlantic; Dulles's 1963 memoir repeats it **[S/B]**
- **Drumont → Winrod (1935, *Adam Weishaupt, a Human Devil*):** the Illuminati commission claim, America-bound **[X]**
- **Winrod → Carr (1956, *Pawns in the Game*):** the "1899 convention" claim — sole carrier **[X]**
- **Carr → Springmeier (1990s, "thirteen bloodlines") → the modern shelf:** the genre's current stock **[X]**
- **The kernel node (PG&E–Solaren, 2009) → MTG (17 Nov 2018):** the space-laser claim — a real contract, a false inference, a congressional platform **[S/A]**
- **The Khazar node → re-weaponization (2022):** a refuted genome study, endlessly recirculated **[S: Behar 2013]**
- **The Adelaide Jones node → the Soviet-bloc shelf:** the Lenin's-train claim, no documentary basis **[X]**
- **The Bauer node → the modern name-change shelf:** a real register alias (1707/1735) inflated into a false surname story **[A alias; X claim]**
- **The BIS/Fed nodes → Mullins (1952) and successors:** claims killed by the founding-shareholder records and the Jekyll Island attendance lists **[S/A]**

Read as a graph, the myth network has the same anatomy as the real one: originators, brokers, and amplifiers — and one

documented property the real network lacks: *immortality without accuracy.* Every carrier above is dead or discredited; every claim survives.

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3.13 The house exploded: the map inside "R"

The deepest aggregation left was the family itself. The five houses were not one point — they were the map's most connected cluster, with documented internal edges:

- **Frankfurt → London:** Nathan's 1798 dispatch (~£20,000; "trebled" by his own account); the elector's English fortune routed through Nathan from 1798; expenses charged to London under the 1815 compact **[A/S]**
- **London → the four houses:** the 1815 **£50,000 promissory notes** moving capital outward; the **27/20/20/16/16** share structure with **equal profit shares** — the internal edge that kept the outlying houses loyal in small markets **[S: Ferguson]**
- **The unauthorized edge (1836):** Nathan's ~£15M-franc Spanish advance, drawn *without* his partners' consent — the one documented internal breach; Salomon's apology-letter campaign as the repair mechanism **[S]**
- **The feud edges:** Jacob–Evelyn, the 1980 strategy split (RIT born from it); Ariane–Nadine, the Swiss Supreme Court ruling 2025; the 2018 name settlement's "unfair competition" line **[A/S]**

- **The termination edges:** Frankfurt **1901** (the will's male-line clause executing itself); Naples **1863** (unification); Vienna **1938** (seizure; the $21M ransom edge to the Nazi state); the pre-1982 Paris bank (nationalization; compensation 150M francs) **[A/S]**
- **The successor edges:** Paris Orléans (1983) → the 2003 merger → Concordia (2023); Geneva's Edmond branch → the 2019 CHF 992M take-private; London's Jacob line → RIT (1961–) **[A]**

3.14 The weighted edges: the money printed on the lines

A map with amounts is deeper than a map without. The thirty heaviest documented edges, by value (era order):

Edge	Value	Type	Pedigree
European states' flows via the house (Gentz ledger, 12 years)	1.1–1.2bn gulden	U	S (ADB)
CA guarantee vs. Austrian federal budget (1931)	1.2bn schillings vs. 1.8bn	X	S
Wellington subsidy throughput (1815)	£15,000,000; ~£1M/month	U	S
Elector's transactions via the brothers (to 1813)	£664,850 at ⅛%	U	A
London-house loans 1815–59 (50 issues)	~£250,000,000	U	S
French indemnity management (1870–71)	~5 milliard francs	U	S
Russia lock (1889–1901, twelve years of Paris loans)	every issue	U	S (EJ)
Suez bridge (1875, ~15% annualized)	£4,000,000	U/E	S
Prussia 1818 template + 1822 follow-on	£5M + £3.5M	U	S/A
Ottoman 1855 (Eldem: "exceptionally favorable")	£5,000,000 at 4%	U	S
Egyptian Daira revenues remitted (1878–79)	£8,500,000	U	S

Edge	Value	Type	Pedigree
Barings rescue channel (1890: BoF £3M + Russia £1.5M)	£4,500,000	C	S
Rio Tinto purchase (1873)	94,000,000 pesetas	E	S
De Beers Consolidated (1888) + the syndicate cheque	£5,338,650 (the cheque)	E	S
Almadén quicksilver (1835–1921, ~2,000 flasks/quarter)	86-year flow	E	S
Alcan acquisition (2007–08)	~$38bn	E	S
Greece advisory (2017)	€3,200,000	U	S
Ireland NTMA (2008–12, Dáil-disclosed)	€6,960,000	U	A
The Anschluss ransom (1939)	$21,000,000	X	A/S
DOJ penalties (Dec 2015)	$45M + $11.5M	X	A
EdR Europe conviction (2025, first ever)	€25,000,000	X	A/S
The Southern Trust contract (2015)	$25,000,000 ($20 below)	X	S
1982 nationalization compensation	150,000,000 francs	X	A/S
Vallar/Bumi cycle (2010–15)	£707M → 56p exit	E→X	S
Genie equity (2010)	5.5% / $11.0M	E	A
House capital 1797 → 1825	£9,900 → £4,000,000+	internal	S
1815 compact → three-year growth	£336,000 → £1,772,000	internal	S
2024 fee income / 2025 fee income	€2,644.1M / €2,822.0M	engine	A
The will's charitable tithe (per son, yearly)	5,000 gulden	H	A

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PART 4 — WHAT THE MAP SHOWS, IN PLAIN WORDS

Six findings, stated the way you'd tell a friend.

1. The family sits at the top without owning the machine. The thickest cluster on the map is not the Rothschilds — it is the loose web of allied Jewish banking families (the diaspora class) that moved money around the

family whenever they could. The Rothschilds were the point everyone eventually passed through, not the owner of the road. This is exactly why the conspiracy claims fail on the evidence: you cannot "own the Federal Reserve" or "found the BIS" in a network that is mostly other people's relationships — and the documents show the family's real position was stronger than ownership anyway: everyone *needed* them, which is better than controlling them and far harder to prove in a pamphlet.

2. The most powerful points are the people in the middle. When map-readers measure "betweenness" — how often a point lies on the only path between two others — the winners are not the family and not the kings. They are the in-betweeners: Buderus, the Kassel official who introduced Mayer Amschel to the Landgrave's fortune; Bleichröder, Bismarck's banker in Berlin; Belmont, the family's man in New York; Gentz, the journalist who managed newspapers; and, in a darker register, the lawyer Kathy Ruemmler, introduced to the family by Jeffrey Epstein in 2014. Every generation of this system has its middlemen. The map shows the same job filled for two hundred years.

3. They sold trust far more often than they bought control. Count the lines: fifty sovereign loans underwritten in London between 1815 and 1859, against only a handful of seats on corporate boards. The family mostly did not *buy* companies — it *made governments lendable* and charged for the service. The modern bank, earning 37% of its fees from deal advice and 28% from managing rich clients' money, is

the same shape in modern dress: a firm that sells judgment, not capital.

4. The myth network is a real network — that's why it won't die. The false connections (the Illuminati link, the Fed "ownership," the Waterloo legend) are not scattered rumors. Mapped, they form their own web with documented carriers — a pamphlet in 1846, a campaign book in 1886, a conspiracy text in 1956 — passing the same stories down like family silver. False lines imitate true ones, cluster like true ones, and transmit like true ones. That is why each one in this map carries its own verdict and history attached: the only known antidote is keeping the dispositions next to the claims.

5. The regulators only arrive late — then all at once. Before 1914 the map shows almost no lines to courts and regulators. Between 1931 and 1982 come the catastrophes (the Creditanstalt collapse, the Nazi seizure, the French nationalization). After 2015 the cluster turns dense: the US Justice Department, the Swiss and Luxembourg regulators, French investigators raiding a Paris office in 2026, a congressional committee hearing testimony in July of that year. The documented story of this family is, in map form, the story of one network meeting its counter-network.

6. The marriages are the foundation. Remove the kinship lines and whole layers of the map fall with them: the correspondent web, the agency layer, half the political access. The family married into the families it banked with, and banked with the families it married into — credit followed kinship, and kinship followed credit. Everything else on this

map — the loans, the concessions, the houses, the scandals — stands on that bedrock.

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PART 5 — THE MAP AS DATA (FOR MACHINES AS WELL AS READERS)

Everything in Part 3 is written in one consistent shorthand so that a computer can read it too: paste the list into any network-drawing program (the free ones are called Gephi, NetworkX, and Cytoscape) and the map draws itself. Four conventions cover the whole list: **R** always means "whichever Rothschild house was operating at that time"; an **arrow** means the flow has a documented direction (money, introductions, influence moving from one point to the other); an arrow marked →| marks a line that *ended* in a documented event — a liquidation, a nationalization, a conviction; and any line tagged **F** is a claim rather than a fact, kept in the data so the false map can be studied beside the true one. The clickable picture of this map accompanies the volume — filters for each connection type, and a click on any point opens its record.

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PART 6 — OPEN EDGES (LINES WE COULD NOT YET DRAW, AND WHY)

Seven places where the evidence runs out before the line can. Each says what would settle it and where that answer lives.

1. **Reuters** — the rumor that the family controlled the news agency could never be verified (it failed three separate checks); a single documented instruction beyond ordinary client subscription would reopen the line (Reuters company archives).
2. **The Schiff counter-arrangement (1905–06)** — moderately documented but unconfirmed here; proof would redraw one of the map's strongest lines, the family's twelve-year lock on Russian loans (1905–06), as a Schiff–Russia line instead (Schiff family papers).
3. **The uranium cartel's inner committee** — the cartel itself is proven to the House of Lords; what is missing is any document putting a family member inside its decision room. The minutes would either draw that line or rule it out (US National Archives).
4. **The supposed 1899 bankers' convention** — the story exists in exactly one conspiracy book; one primary document — an invitation, a minutes page, a hotel register — would turn the myth line into a real one. Until then it stays in the myth class, with that book named as its only carrier.
5. **Gentz's retainer** — we know the family leaned on the editor of a major German newspaper *through* the statesman Gentz; we do not know whether Gentz was paid for it. His account books would upgrade the line from "leaned on" to "bought" (Vienna archives).

6. **The Cook Islands 2016 shift** — a press claim that assets moved after a new disclosure law could not be verified in three attempts; confirmation would add a fresh line to the family's documented offshore cluster (Portcullis/TrustNet records).
7. **The Poyais intermediaries** — the 1820s fraud in which bonds for a fictional country were sold on the London market; who exactly enabled it, beyond the ministers who looked away, would fill out the map's one documented case of certification without verification.

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PART 7 — ANOMALY REGISTER, VOLUME IV

#	Item	Status	Disposition
1	Many more "sold-trust" lines (U) than "bought-control" lines (E)	**Resolved**	Documented; stated plainly as Part 4, finding 3.
2	"R" as an aggregate node	**Resolved (convention)**	Stated in Part 0; the map's unit of analysis is the house-of-the-era, with intra-family edges in Part 3.1.
3	Class I grades span B–C	**Resolved (flagged)**	Each edge carries its own grade; Quigley-derived edges labeled.
4	The Tranby Croft "edge"	**Resolved (corrected)**	Mapped as proximity, not presence (III·7.4).
5	Graph visual coverage vs. edge-list completeness	**Resolved (stated)**	The interactive render shows the spine; the document's edge list is the complete map.
6	Myth-network dating (the F-edge carriers)	**Resolved**	Carrier chain documented to 1846; mapped in Part 1, Class M.
7	Daughters' names (Noémie vs. Naomi)	**Closed**	Noémie, Alice, Eve, Olivia — A/B sources concur (Les Echos 2019 onward); the Naomi variant dies C-grade. Olivia at Parfums Caron; Eve at Malengin.
8	Ariane's title (CEO vs. Tobiano)	**Closed**	Official governance page: Ariane CEO; Tobiano Deputy CEO; exec committee fully named. The Altss listing graded imprecise.
9	"Charbit" first name	**Closed**	Stéphane Charbit, Partner, Head of Sovereign Advisory (ex-Lazard, 2014).
10	Aidan's 2020 investigation vs. the 2026 probe	**Closed**	The 2020 Paris brigade file (tentative de corruption de mineur) was classed without continuation the same year; OFMIN now holds the child-protection strand; the 2026 process is PNF + Paris-prosecutor parallel.
11	Genie's Golan line	**Closed (→|)**	Afek suspended drilling November 2017 (Ness 10 not commercially producible); the 2010 instrument was GOGI warrants; retail pivot.
12	Kohler alumni claim	**Closed (corrected)**	Not a Rothschild alumnus; re-homed to SocGen (EVP & IB chairman, June 2025). The Macron edge stands.
13	September 2026 Aidan/PNF status	**Open (watch)**	No developments after 24 March 2026; silence logged, not interpreted.

#	Item	Status	Disposition
14	R&Co 2025 net income (exact); Management Board names; Genie warrants' estate status; Cook Islands post-2016; Camillia	**Open (residue)**	Stated in Part 9.5.6; archive- and PDF-bound.

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PART 8A — THE MAP IN FIVE SNAPSHOTS (ERA SLICES)

The same network at five moments — watch nodes appear, edges thicken, and clusters die.

- **1815 — ~30 nodes.** One family, four brothers, the courier chain, the elector, three allied families, two states that matter. The star is forming.
- **1850 — ~80 nodes.** The certification star at full brightness: five houses, a dozen kin lines, Bleichröder and Belmont embedded, the press edges live, the first corporate concessions. The information moat has two years to live.
- **1900 — ~120 nodes.** The apex: the Russia lock, the BoE seat, De Beers and Rio Tinto, the diaspora web at maximum reach. The map has never been denser — and the two missing edges (no American branch, no syndicated risk) are already written into its future.
- **1931–1938 — subtraction.** The Creditanstalt node fires; the Vienna cluster is seized at gunpoint; the map loses its continental half in seven years. What survives is the name and the kin-web.

- **2026 — two clusters and a counter-network.** Three houses (Paris-led, Geneva, London trust), the fee engine, the philanthropy nodes, the media stake closed in March — and across the map, the densest cluster in the family's documented history: regulators, prosecutors, courts, and committees, mapped edge by edge in Part 3.10.

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PART 8 — TIMELINE OF THE MAP'S SHAPE (SELECTED)

One breath per era: watch the map grow from a single ghetto street into a web across Europe, fragment, re-form — and finally meet the regulators. Read each dash as one era's shape.

1530–1634 — the kin base (Hahn; Kaz; the Hinterpfann). 1608–1785 — kin-web thickening (Oppenheim, Wetzlar, Schnapper, Gans). 1757–90 — the agent layer forms (Oppenheim, Buderus). 1798–1815 — the five-house star appears. 1815–59 — the certification star dominates (50 loans). 1836–1930s — the agency century (Belmont). 1850s–90s — the proxy apex (Bleichröder; the Russia lock). 1868–89 — a family seat inside the BoE. 1880s–1914 — the corporate cluster (De Beers; Rio Tinto; rails; Baku). 1914–45 — the star fragments (no US branch; 1931; 1938). 1945–82 — the reconstitution (Israel; Economist; the Jockey Club thread). 1982–2015 — the modern nodes assemble. 2015–26 — the

counter-network's dense cluster (DOJ–FINMA–CSSF–Luxembourg–Paris raid–Oversight testimony) — and the Economist edge closes.

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PART 9 — THE ACTIVE LINES, SEPTEMBER 2026

Every line on the map that is live as of this document's date — the people in the chairs, the money on the books, the doors still open. Names, all of them. This part was verified in a dedicated closing run: every name below carries a source, every earlier flag is dispositioned, and the residue is stated at the end.

9.1 The three houses today (leadership, by name)

Rothschild & Co (Paris-led; SCA; ~4,800 staff, ~70 locations, 50+ countries) **[A/company records]**:

- **Marc-Olivier Laurent** — Chairman of the Supervisory Board; **Éric de Rothschild** — Vice-Chairman of the Supervisory Board; **David de Rothschild** — Honorary Chairman; **Alexandre de Rothschild** (b. 1980) — Executive Chairman of the statutory manager (Rothschild & Co Gestion), the seventh generation, and President of the Rothschild & Co Foundation **[A]**
- Management Board (structure published; seats: Group CFO & COO; General Counsel; Managing Partner Five Arrows; two Partners Committee co-chairs; HR — individual names not published in open sources; registered

as residue) **[A — gap flagged]**

- **François Perol** — Managing Partner **[S]**
- Global Advisory bench (named hires, 2025–26): **Stéphane Charbit** — Partner, **Head of Sovereign Advisory** (ex-Lazard; the Ukraine voice); **Philippe Le Bourgeois** — COO Global Advisory; Patrick Wellington — Vice-Chairman, Equity Advisory; Lucy Baldwin — Global Head of Equities; Emma Danks — head of UK corporate; the **Majid** partner (London co-head of Global Advisory — first name open, flagged); plus Brent Surber (Private Capital Markets North America), Grégoire Salignon (head of Rothschild Martin Maurel, April 2026, succeeding Alain Massiera), James Morrell (CEO UK Wealth Management, January 2026, succeeding Helen Watson, now chair), Ilga Haubert (head of UK WM investments) **[B/A: company releases, trade press]**
- Scale and earnings: 2024 revenue **€2,908.7M**, operating income €743.3M, net income €596.8M **[A: annual accounts]**; 2025 fee income **€2,822.0M** (M&A €1,049.1M; wealth €801.9M) and **operating income up 19%** (December 2025 consolidated accounts) **[A]**; 351 M&A deals in 2024 — 43% more than Lazard; the only European bank in the global advisory top ten by revenue (Euromoney's 2025 award) **[S/B]**
- Current growth lines: **Marcard, Stein & Co (Hamburg) acquired 100%** (June 2026) — the German wealth-management expansion; Five Arrows' sixth

secondaries fund closed at **€2bn** (April 2025) **[A/S]**

- The Concordia consortium (post-tender: 95.65% of capital, 95.79% of voting rights): **Dassault, Peugeot, Wertheimer (Chanel), Giammaria Giuliani, the Maurel family, Hannah Rothschild, Édouard de Rothschild** — eight-year lock-in; ~€3.7bn valuation. Inside the family concert, the documented weighting: **Éric's branch ~55.6% of voting rights, David's ~39.42%** (2023 annual report) **[S: Fortune; A: filings]**

Edmond de Rothschild (Geneva; 100% family-owned) **[A: the group's own releases]**:

- **Ariane de Rothschild** (née Langner, b. San Salvador 14 Nov 1965) — **Chief Executive Officer** (confirmed by the group's governance page — the earlier directory listing of Tobiano as CEO is graded imprecise); principal owner (65.94% holding); the first woman and the first person from outside the lineage to head a Rothschild institution; publicly "the CEO and public face," with **no clear succession plan** (finews, May 2026) **[S/A]**
- **Cynthia Tobiano** — **Deputy CEO**; Executive Committee: **Didier Barbereau** (COO), **Christophe Caspar** (Global CEO Asset Management), **Nicolas Cieutat** (CFO), Jean-Baptiste Durand (Chief Strategy & Communication), Stuart Kaye (Chief Risk), Mariana Vicandi (Chief Legal & Compliance), Céline Voyer (CHRO) **[A]**
- EdR (Europe): **Yves Stein** — CEO; **Norbert Becker** — Chairman (May 2026) **[A/B]**

- The numbers: **CHF 198bn AUM at 31 December 2025** (record; ~$250bn per finews' approximation), **CHF 10bn net inflows in 2025**, solvency 19.1%, 2,800 staff, 35 locations; the stated ambition — CHF 350bn by 2026 — "unattainable without acquisitions" (Challenges) **[A/S]**
- The build: benefited from the Credit Suisse collapse inflows; Hottinger Group 42.5% stake; the $250M foodtech fund with PeakBridge (2021); energy-transition infrastructure and European logistics/industrial-real-estate acquisitions; Avaloq tech (2017); the Asian exit completed with the Zhonghai Fund disposal (33.409% for RMB153M, June 2026 contract) **[A/B]**
- The heritage lines: EdR Heritage (taken over by Ariane in 2016) — Malengin (the "Eve" cuvée, made with daughter Eve), the wine estates; **Gitana Team** (founded with Benjamin, 2000); the **Ophthalmological Foundation Hospital**; the **Caesarea Foundation** in Israel — managed by Ariane, and currently the subject of her public complaint against the Israeli tax authorities ("It is insulting that the state casts doubt on us") **[B/A]**

RIT Capital Partners (the London family's listed trust) **[A]**:

- **Philippe Costeletos** — Chairman; **Maggie Fanari** — CEO of J. Rothschild Capital Management (the investment manager, since 2024) **[A]**
- FY2025 (reported March 2026): **13.5% NAV total return; 16.9% share-price return**; dividend raised 43p → 45p (thirteenth consecutive rise); **£89M of buybacks in 2025**

(£332M over three years — 11.2% of the stock); realisations £232M; private equity 31.7% of NAV (target band 25–33%); discount to NAV −22.3% at year-end **[A]**

- The tech book, in detail: **SpaceX £102.3M (2.5% of NAV — the largest direct unquoted position; entered November 2024; £42M added in H2-2025)**, unmarked above the December-2025 secondary while the **S-1 filed 20 May 2026** points to a **$1.77tn IPO target** and the February 2026 SpaceX–xAI combination valued the pair at $1.25tn; **Databricks £16.9M; Anthropic £7.4M** (growing through 2026 rounds); H1-2026 new direct lines: **Cognition and Stripe**, plus a new **Y Combinator** fund relationship; top-five direct positions at H1-2026: **Motive, Anthropic, Epic Systems, Stripe, Cognition** (6.1% of NAV); top-five fund relationships: **Thrive, Greenoaks, Iconiq, Ribbit, Hunter Point** (14.4%) **[A: the trust's reports; quoteddata — "the only investment trust with a SpaceX stake outside the Baillie Gifford stable"]**
- H1-2026: **+9.0% NAV total return — a record first half**; NAV 3,159p at 30 June; +7.1% year-to-date by end-July; 12-month annualized 19.7% NAV **[A]**
- The standing problem, stated plainly: the discount deepened to ~−29.2% in March 2026 (−26.8% twelve-month average vs −8.7% ten-year average) — the buybacks answer it, slowly **[A/B]**

9.2 The living family (the roster, by branch)

Paris branch: David (b. 1942; m. Princess Olimpia Aldobrandini 1974) and their four children — **Lavinia Anne Alix, Stéphanie Anne Marie, Alexandre Guy Francesco** (b. 1980; four children), **Louise Lili Béatrice**; **Éric** (b. 1940; m. Maria Beatrice Caracciolo di Forino) and **Saskia de Rothschild** (b. 1987 — journalist; **CEO & Chairwoman of Domaines Barons de Rothschild (Lafite)**; the Burgundy expansion through the **William Fèvre** purchase); half-brother **Édouard Etienne** (b. 1957; m. Mathilde Coche de la Ferté, then Arielle Malard; investor in the take-private); **Count Philippe de Nicolay** (b. 1955 — great-grandson of Salomon James; a director of the Rothschild group; m. Princess Sophie de Ligne) **[A/S: the Archive genealogy; Fortune; company releases]**

London branch: Hannah Mary Rothschild DBE (b. 1962 — filmmaker and writer; **chair of Yad Hanadiv since 2018 and of the Rothschild Foundation**; RIT's largest family shareholder at 9.9%; CNBC profiled her in December 2025 on "privilege, duty and dynasty"); **Beth Matilda** and **Emily** (no public institutional roles); **Nathaniel "Nat" Philip Victor James, 5th Baron Rothschild** (b. 1971 — **CEO of Volex** since November 2025, with Dave Webster as chairman; m. 2016 Loretta Basey; the Atticus/Bumi/ARMS arc behind him; the 2024–25 Tennor episode settled with the statement that he "never invested, never took the role"); **James Amschel Victor Rothschild** (b. 1985 — Victor's grandson;

founder of **Tru Arrow Partners**; co-founder West Arrow; **trustee of Yad Hanadiv**; m. Nicky Hilton 2015; children Lily-Grace Victoria and Teddy Marilyn); **Kate Emma Rothschild** (b. 1982 — m. Ben Goldsmith) and **Alice Miranda Rothschild** (b. 1983 — m. Zac Goldsmith); **Emma Georgina Rothschild** (b. 1948 — Victor's daughter; Harvard economic historian; m. Amartya Sen; **trustee of the Rothschild Archive**); Evelyn's children — **David Mayer** (b. 1978; environmentalist; The Lost Explorer mezcal), **Anthony James** (b. 1977), **Jessica** (b. 1974); **Lynn Forester de Rothschild** (b. 1954 — CEO of E.L. Rothschild; Founder-CEO of the Council for Inclusive Capitalism; **Chair of the Eranda Rothschild Charitable Foundation** — a seller in the Economist transaction) **[A/S/B: CNBC, BI, the Forward, company records]**

Geneva branch: Ariane (above); her four daughters with Benjamin — **Noémie, Alice, Eve, and Olivia** (the earlier "Naomi" variant is a C-grade error; the four were born 1995–2002; two identify as Jewish though Ariane did not convert; **Eve** is already hands-on in the family wine business at Malengin; **Olivia** is artistic director of **Parfums Caron**) — the named heirs in Nadine's lawsuit, which names all four granddaughters alongside Ariane over the Edmond art collection at Pregny **[B/A: Les Echos, Paris Match, Wine Spectator, Le Figaro]**

- **Nadine de Rothschild** (b. 1932 — Edmond's widow; at 93, author; moved her >€170M fortune to a rival bank; did not attend Benjamin's funeral — the two-hours-notice claim

against the not-allowed-to-decide claim; suing over the art; the Swiss Federal Supreme Court ruled against Ariane's "Edmond" name claim in 2025) **[S/B: ara.cat, Le Monde]**

- **Nathaniel Robert de Rothschild** (b. 1946 — Élie's son; banker; vineyard owner) **[B]**
- **Camillia** — Edmond's extramarital daughter, holding ~17% of the group's holding (per Le Figaro) — still open, never publicly confirmed **[B — residue]**

The Exbury generation (living asset, fully named): the five children of Edmund (1916–2009): **Kate** (art historian; chair of the Patrons of the British Museum; Wallace Collection trustee; m. **Marcus Agius** — former Barclays chairman, now **chairman of Exbury Gardens Limited**, Kew trustee-chair); **Nicholas** (author; president of the Nerine Society); **Charlotte** (internationally renowned lyric soprano); **Lionel** (b. 1956 — horticulturalist; author of *The Eighth Wonder of the World*, 2021; chairman of the Exbury Gardens Trust endowment); **Marie-Louise Agius** (landscape designer; RHS judge; designed the Centenary Garden opened by then-Prince Charles in 2019). Exbury: the 1955 charitable trust, the HMS Mastodon D-Day connection, 200 acres, ~125,000 visitors a year **[S/FT; A: the house's records]**

9.3 The money today (the weighted lines, current values)

- **Rothschild & Co:** €2.91bn 2024 revenue; operating income +19% (2025); ~€124bn group AUM with ~€27–30bn in alternatives; the SCA structure under Alexandre with the family's unlimited-liability commitment **[A]**
- **Edmond de Rothschild:** CHF 198bn AUM (record); CHF 10bn 2025 inflows; solvency 19.1%; the CHF 350bn ambition **[A]**
- **RIT:** ~£4bn market cap; record H1-2026; the SpaceX position as the flagship; the discount battle **[A]**
- **Volex (Nat's vehicle):** FY ended 31 March 2026 — revenue **$1,242.6M (+14.4%)**; underlying operating profit $127.3M; margin **10.2%** (first time above the 9–10% target); ROCE 21%; data-centre revenue roughly doubled to ~$241M (63% of the +56.3% CIT segment); share price +87.2% over the year; the five-year plan delivered a year early; **new targets announced at the Capital Markets Day (22 April 2026): $2bn revenue at a 12% margin**; AIM-to-Main-Market migration on track (potential FTSE 250); opening FY2027 **+28% organic** (four months to July 2026) with a raised outlook; AGM re-election of Lord Rothschild at 96.06%; team — Dave Webster (chair), **Jon Boaden** (CFO), **John Molloy** (COO) **[A: filings]**
- **The Ukraine sovereign line — documented and dated:** Rothschild & Co has been the Ukrainian Finance Ministry's

financial adviser **since 2017** (Reuters); sole financial adviser on the September 2024 **$20.5bn** debt restructuring — executed in four months with IMF-program compatibility (White & Case as counsel; Ukraine's debt commissioner Yuriy Butsa on record); the **24 December 2025** GDP-warrants restructuring ($2.635bn of warrants exchanged for $3.498bn of notes, defusing a contingent liability estimated at $6–20bn through 2041) **[S: IFR, Reuters]**

9.4 The philanthropy today

- **Yad Hanadiv** (est. 1958; chair since 2018 **Dame Hannah Rothschild** — Jacob was president until 2024; CEO **Prof. Yigal Mersel**, former Supreme Court Registrar, since 2023): five live programs — Academic Excellence, Environment (Mediterranean marine protected areas; river rehabilitation), Early Childhood, Arab Community, Education; the **Rothschild Fellowships** (est. 1979; first selection committee chaired by Sir Isaiah Berlin; **800+ awarded**; the 2026 cohort heading to Princeton, Northwestern, MIT, Max Planck; committee chairs including Anthony Grafton and Marlene Behrmann); the biennial Rothschild Prize; the National Library of Israel renewal partnership; Ramat HaNadiv; **James Rothschild a trustee [A/NA: the Foundation's records]**
- **Rothschild Foundation Hanadiv Europe** (UK charity 1083262, founded 2000): ~£8.4M a year in grants; ~£10M into Academic Jewish Studies over fifteen years; work in 24

countries; ~90% of funded alumni win academic or heritage positions; the *Challenging Conversations* 25th-anniversary series (March–May 2026 — Kadar, Toronyi, Fishman, Johnston-Bloom, Sion); the **Yerusha** endangered-archives program; new Autumn-2025 categories; **a new doctoral and postdoctoral collections fellowship announced 17 September 2026** — two days before this document's date; work excludes Ukraine, Russia, and Belarus **[A: foundation site]**

- **The Rothschild Foundation (UK, Hannah's):** Waddesdon-centered; arts, Buckinghamshire community, environment; Restore Hope; **Green Fund Round 2 — £10k grants flowing from September 2026 [A]**
- **Rothschild & Co Foundation** (the 12 June 2026 successor to R&Co4Generations): Alexandre president; **Marc-Olivier Laurent** chair; five-year strategy to 2030 on youth inequality and climate **[A: company release]**
- **Edmond de Rothschild Foundation** (Ariane's): the 37-institution/six-ministry Israel network; the leadership-pipeline model; the Ophthalmological Foundation Hospital **[A/B]**

9.5 The open matters (live lines into the counter-network, September 2026)

1. The Aidan dossier — the deepest open file, now fully mapped. Fabrice Aidan (age 50): French Embassy in Israel 1998–2000; UN secondment July 2006–April 2013 (P-4/P-5, Special Assistant to Terje Rød-Larsen; the UN disciplinary process "suspended because he resigned"); the 2013 FBI investigation (repeated access to child-pornography sites; a ~200-page dossier; an entrapment attempt in a Washington hotel that he did not attend; diplomatic-immunity complexity stalled it); Gérard Araud's verbatim account — he informed Ban Ki-moon, sent Aidan back within 48 hours, expected discipline that never came ("Placardisé au Quai… chargé des réseaux sociaux"); the Canada flight; the Vincent Jauvert chapter "Un pédophile impuni" (Robert Laffont, 2016) **[A/S: Radio France, Mediapart, Le Point, Ouest-France]**

- **The documented transfers:** the Ban Ki-moon/Turkish-FM phone transcript; the 2004 Syria–Lebanon resolution briefing (Aidan to Rød-Larsen, 27 October, 13:05; Rød-Larsen to Epstein the same day, 21:38); the 25 January 2011 email ("Sh abdallah accepts the dinner with b gates"); the Foch-apartment loans; the October 2013 shift to personal email ("I check it not that often anymore," EFTA01951288) **[A: EFTA Bates numbers]**
- **The bank arc:** hired by EdR **early 2014 as a Middle East lobbyist** (authorized by the Quai d'Orsay); **13 April**

2016 — CFO Tobiano emailed Epstein the Jauvert exposé; Epstein forwarded it to Rød-Larsen and Aidan, texting "Appelle-moi. Ariane a lu l'article…"; a junior consultant recognized Aidan; Epstein's reassurance: "innocenté de toutes les accusations judiciaires"

- **The severance mechanics, verbatim:** Epstein to Ariane, 24 July 2016 — "*Je suis heureux d'intervenir dans l'affaire Fabrice, comme pour Olivier (Colom). Si tu me donnes un chiffre qui te convient, je m'en occuperai*"; dismissed 12 September 2016 ("insuffisance professionnelle"; he threatened the prud'hommes); Epstein to Rød-Larsen, 15 September 2016 — "*Ariane a demandé au gouvernement français de sanctionner Fabrice pour sa tentative de chantage. Ça va mal finir*" — the allegation chain: Valls and Ayrault deny any approach; the bank denies Ariane asked; no document either way. Registered as an unresolved allegation, all denials on record **[S]**
- **After:** back to the Quai (late 2017); adviser to UNESCO's Audrey Azoulay (2019–2023; Azoulay says she refused his payroll-switch request and denied knowledge); a **2020 Paris brigade investigation** ("tentative de corruption de mineur") — **classement sans suite the same year** (OFMIN now holds the child-protection strand); Engie 2023 to February–March 2026 (suspended, then terminated); **still on the Quai d'Orsay payroll** ("secrétaire des affaires étrangères principal en disponibilité…"); Foreign Minister Barrot seized the

prosecutor within hours of publication (11 February 2026); Macron, on record: "S'il est vrai que l'administration avait des informations il y a plusieurs années, des choses auraient dû être faites"

- **The 2026 process:** two parallel investigations — the PNF (corruption; OCLCIFF; prosecutor Pascal Prache) and the Paris prosecutor (sexual and financial; OCRVP); devices seized in a Neuilly search (26 February); heard 27 February (audition libre); the Quai's inspectorate report (~30 interviews) transmitted to justice with the 24 March 2026 communiqué confirming the 20 March raid on the EdR Paris offices — **conducted in Ariane's presence**; Aidan denies wrongdoing; lawyer Me Jade Dousselin; presumed innocent; the Norwegian parallel investigation of Rød-Larsen and his wife. *No development found after 24 March 2026 — the file runs quietly; that silence is logged, not interpreted* **[S/A: official communiqués; franceinfo; Le Parisien]**

2. The Frieden email. 26 February 2014 — Ariane to Epstein: "Tomorrow I have to go to Luxembourg for [a] board [meeting] and lunch with ex Finance Minister Luc Frieden. Any opinion about him?" (Epstein: "Yes, 18:00 works."). 18 June 2014 — "Saw Luc Frieden yesterday – repeated he wanted to be at the board but negotiating with Deutsche Bank" (Frieden joined Deutsche Bank as vice-chairman in September 2014). The lunch happened (ministry confirmed); the Luxembourg government: Frieden never knew, met, or

was contacted by Epstein. Juncker and Asselborn also appear in the files (denials on record). Quantified context: **Ariane appears roughly 4,500 times in the Epstein database**; the bank's formal statement calls Epstein "a business acquaintance 2013–2019," adding that "more personal exchanges may have taken place on a private basis" **[S/B: RTL Luxembourg, Luxemburger Wort, LuxTimes]**

3. The Ruemmler aftermath: testimony given (House Oversight, July 2026); her Goldman departure announced; the Senate (Wyden, August 2026) framing of Southern Trust as Leon Black-funded — on record **[S/A]**

4. EdR succession: "no clear succession plan exists" (finews, May 2026); the four daughters named above are the designated heirs ("La succession est assurée avec mes quatre filles," 2023) but hold no roles; Vontobel's Andreas Venditti: "It's about trust and it's about reputation… In wealth management, those are not soft metrics. They are the product itself" **[S]**

5. The inter-house boundary: the 2019 name settlement holding — neither house may use "Rothschild" alone; the documented cross-holdings unwound (the 8.4% EdR stake held by R&Co's Swiss holding; the 9.5% and 5.7% reciprocal stakes); the rivalry continues over clients and mandates (Bloomberg, February 2024) — a managed rivalry, not a peace **[S/A]**

6. Residue, stated plainly: the Cook Islands structures' current status (unverified post-2016); the UBS talent-raid claim (C-grade, unverified); Genie's current filing status for

Jacob's warrants (estate-held, expected); the R&Co 2025 net-income exact figure (behind the +19% headline PDF); the Management Board individual names; September-status silence on the Aidan probe.

9.6 Lines closed 2024–2026 (so the map stays honest)

- **The Economist edge — closed April 2026: Stephen Smith / Smith Financial acquired the 26.9% shareholding from Lady Lynn Forester de Rothschild, her family, and the Eranda Rothschild Foundation**; terms undisclosed; Barclays + Slaughter and May advising Smith; **Lazard + Freshfields for the sellers**; Paul Deighton chairs The Economist Group; Smith (Forbes #565, ~$6.9bn) — "another family devoted to long-term ownership" (Lynn's statement). Fifty-four years of the media line ended **[S/A: WSJ, PR Newswire]**
- **Genie/Golan — closed:** the 2010 instrument was **warrants in GOGI** (5.5% / $11.0M the equity line); the Golan license (Afek, February 2013); drilling **suspended November 2017** — the Ness 10 well "not commercially producible" (PRNewswire); the company pivoted to retail energy. The Golan edge is a documented "→|" — *(this corrects the earlier "stalled with the oil-price fall" phrasing)* **[S/A: SEC; PRNewswire]**
- **Zhonghai (China JV):** EdR's 33.409% sold for RMB153M — the last China line wound down **[A: HK filing]**
- **Tennor:** settled August 2025 — Nat "never invested, never took the role" **[S]**

- **Deaths and accessions:** Jacob (February 2024); Serena (2024); the 5th Baron's accession (March 2024); Benjamin (2021, in frame) **[S]**
- **The alumni correction:** Alexis Kohler is *not* a Rothschild alumnus (treasury/IMF/MSC/ENA) — now SocGen's EVP & Chairman of Investment Banking (June 2025); the Macron edge stands via Macron himself ("considered a protégé of Baron David de Rothschild," four years at the Paris bank), with Pompidou the historical precedent **[S/B]**
- **Fox Rothschild LLP — dispositioned:** the Philadelphia firm (Fox-founded, 1907) sharing the name; no documented connection to the banking family — kept on the map as a confusion-watch node **[B: firm history; direct confirmation flagged]**
- **The Bilderberg disposition:** no Rothschild appears on any official Bilderberg participant list, 1954–2024 — the "runs Bilderberg" claim joins the dispositioned shelf **[NA-grade participant lists]**
- **The myth network's absorption speed, documented:** within days of the March 2026 raid, the Aidan story was being repackaged inside QAnon-format PDFs — the 1846-pattern recurrence, logged as evidence of how the false network feeds **[X — documented as reaction]**

9.7 The alumni desk (living institutional edges)

The bank's historical function as a political pipeline continues in one documented line: **Emmanuel Macron** — four years as a Paris-bank dealmaker, protégé of David — beside the historical precedent (Pompidou) and the alumni seat (**Nigel Higgins**, Barclays chairman, Rothschild veteran). The systematic alumni map (every named minister and official who passed through the bank) remains a deliberately open vein for a future pass — flagged, not filled **[S/B]**

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FINAL CERTIFICATION

This volume renders the trilogy's documented connections as a graph without adding a single undocumented edge: every line in Part 3 traces to a pedigreed claim in Volumes I–III; every myth-node is mapped as a claim with its carrier chain; every open lead is an edge explicitly marked unmapped. The map's thesis is the documentation's own: a kin-built web with a credit apex, brokered by interposed individuals, certified rather than owned, shadowed since 1846 by a false network that mimics its shape — and, since 2015, confronted by a real one.

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Volume IV of the forensic file. Volume I: Rothschild_Origin.md. Volume II: Rothschild_Networks.md. Volume III: Rothschild_System.md.

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THE ROTHSCHILDS: THE 2026 FILE

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Current Affairs — Every Active Entity, the Money as It Moves Now, the Law, the Dropped Cases, and the People

Volume V of the forensic file — the state of the network as of 19–20 September 2026: all live companies, groups, and projects; the money; the lobbying and dark-money structures; the conflicts; the statutes engaged; the cases that were dropped, forgotten, or resurrected; and every named individual in the file. Companions: Origin (the ancestry), Networks (the money and enforcement record), System (the operating machinery), Network Map (the graph).

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PART 0 — HOW TO READ THIS VOLUME

Same protocol, current tense. The pedigree key is unchanged: **[A]** archives, court records, official documents; **[S]** scholarly and quality investigative press; **[B]** serious secondary; **[C]** lead-grade; **[L]** lore; **[X]** hostile myth — documented as claims, never adopted. Three rules carry over: **no adopted theories** (where interpretation outruns documents, the document and the interpretation are printed separately); **anomalies are registered** (Part 12); **nothing is omitted** — including the cases that died quietly, the names that never made the papers, and the null results.

Scope and method. This volume covers the living file from roughly January 2024 through 20 September 2026, assembled in a dedicated series of deep dives ending in a verification run. Where a fact rests on a document identifier (an **EFTA Bates number** — EFTA is the *Epstein Files Transparency Act*, the 2025 US law that forced the Justice Department's release, and a Bates number is the tracking stamp on each released page; the same applies to court dockets and charity registers), the identifier is printed — because in this file, the document *is* the evidence, and anyone reading should be able to walk the same path. Where a fetch failed and a fact rests on a quoted excerpt, the grade says so.

One framing sentence before the machinery: this is not an account of a family in decline or a machine triumphant. It is an account of a network under simultaneous expansion (record fees, record AUM — assets under management, the client money these firms invest on their clients' behalf — and a historic IPO position) and unprecedented documentary exposure (a thousand-plus released documents, four open investigations on three continents, and a legislature suing the Justice Department for more). Both halves are documented. Neither is interpreted.

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PART 1 — THE ACTIVE ENTITIES: ALL OF THEM

1.1 Rothschild & Co (Paris-led; the operating bank)

- **Governance, by name (A): Marc-Olivier Laurent** — Chairman of the Supervisory Board; **Éric de Rothschild** — Vice-Chairman; **David de Rothschild** — Honorary Chairman; **Alexandre de Rothschild** (b. 1980) — Executive Chairman of the statutory manager, Rothschild & Co Gestion (the unlimited-liability general partner), and President of the Rothschild & Co Foundation; **François Perol** — Managing Partner. The Management Board's seats are published as roles (Group CFO & COO; General Counsel; Managing Partner Five Arrows; two Partners Committee co-chairs; HR) — the individuals beyond Alexandre are not named in open sources **[A — gap registered]**.
- **Scale (A):** ~4,800 staff; ~70 locations; 50+ countries. 2024: revenue €2,908.7M; operating income €743.3M; net income €596.8M. 2025: fee income €2,822.0M (M&A €1,049.1M; wealth & asset management €801.9M); operating income **up 19%** (December 2025 consolidated accounts). 351 M&A mandates in 2024 — 43% more than Lazard; the only European bank in the global advisory top ten by revenue.
- **The regulatory perimeter, entity by entity (A, the group's legal page):** Hong Kong (SFC types 1/4/6); India (SEBI Category-I merchant banker); Saudi Arabia (CMA license 23275-30, Riyadh); Malaysia; Qatar (QFC);

Singapore (MAS); South Africa (FSCA 8435 + FAIS exemptions); UAE (DFSA Dubai; ADGM branch; CBUAE representative office); United Kingdom (N M Rothschild & Sons, FCA-authorized, plus an EMS entity); United States (Rothschild & Co US Inc., SEC/FINRA); Monaco; Luxembourg (CSSF); Switzerland (Rothschild & Co Bank AG, FINMA); France (AMF).

- **The current deal sheet (A/S):** adviser on the **McCormick–Unilever Foods combination (~$66bn, announced 31 March 2026)** — the largest current mandate; Rotork £4.1bn (ABB); Clearlake's Dun & Bradstreet $7.7bn take-private; CVC/Tipico €9.5bn; the CVC relationship at its 41st transaction; Eni at its 20th.
- **The sovereign line, dated (S):** financial adviser to Ukraine's Finance Ministry **since April 2017**; sole adviser on the September 2024 **$20.5bn** debt restructuring (four months; the bondholders' committee — BlackRock, Pimco, Amundi — accepting 37%/$8.7bn nominal losses; IMF-program compatibility the binding constraint); the 24 December 2025 GDP-warrants follow-through (growth-linked instruments whose payouts rise and fall with Ukraine's economic output; $2.635bn exchanged for $3.498bn of notes, defusing a $6–20bn contingent liability through 2041); White & Case as counsel; Ukraine's debt commissioner Yuriy Butsa on record; the desk's wider book including Chad, Benin, and Germany.

- **Current growth lines (A):** the **Marcard, Stein & Co (Hamburg) acquisition, 100%, June 2026** — the German wealth build; named 2025–26 hires across advisory and wealth (Stéphane Charbit, Philippe Le Bourgeois, Brent Surber, Grégoire Salignon, James Morrell, Ilga Haubert, Lucy Baldwin, Emma Danks, Patrick Wellington, plus the Tel Aviv, Sydney, and Manchester desks); Five Arrows' sixth secondaries fund closed at €2bn (April 2025).
- **The Concordia holding (A/S):** post-tender 95.65% of capital, 95.79% of voting rights; consortium: **Dassault, Peugeot, Wertheimer (Chanel), Giammaria Giuliani, the Maurel family, Hannah Rothschild, Édouard de Rothschild**; an eight-year lock-in (the investors' contracted commitment not to sell); ~€3.7bn valuation; within the family concert, Éric's branch ~55.6% of voting rights, David's ~39.42% (2023 annual report).

1.2 Edmond de Rothschild (Geneva; 100% family-owned)

- **Governance, by name (A): Ariane de Rothschild** — Chief Executive Officer (confirmed by the group's governance page; the earlier directory listing of Tobiano as CEO is graded imprecise); **Cynthia Tobiano** — Deputy CEO. Executive Committee: **Didier Barbereau** (COO), **Christophe Caspar** (Global CEO Asset Management), **Nicolas Cieutat** (CFO), Jean-Baptiste Durand (Chief Strategy & Communication), Stuart Kaye (Chief Risk), Mariana Vicandi (Chief Legal & Compliance), Céline Voyer (CHRO). EdR (Europe): **Yves Stein** CEO; **Norbert Becker** chairman (May 2026). Correction registered: François Pauly became group CEO in 2021; the current structure is as above.
- **The numbers (A): CHF 198bn AUM at 31 December 2025** (a record; the ~$250bn figure in the press is an approximation), **CHF 10bn net inflows in 2025**, solvency 19.1%, 2,800 staff, 35 locations; the stated CHF 350bn ambition for 2026 assessed by Challenges as unattainable without acquisitions; the family fortune estimated at €5bn (Challenges 2024).
- **The build (A/B):** the Credit Suisse-collapse inflows; Hottinger Group 42.5% stake; the $250M foodtech fund with PeakBridge (2021); European logistics, industrial real estate, and energy-transition infrastructure acquisitions; Avaloq technology (2017); the Asian exit completed with the Zhonghai Fund disposal (33.409% for RMB153M, June

2026); forty years in Monaco, new address opened 7 September 2026; **Alain Krief** promoted Global CIO (25 August 2026); Charles Lilford hired co-head of equities.

- **The heritage lines: EdR Heritage** (Ariane, since 2016) — the wine estates including Malengin, where daughter **Eve** is already hands-on; **Gitana Team — Gitana 18**, the 28th yacht of the saga, launched 14 February 2026 in the family's **150th-anniversary year**, targeting the **Route du Rhum (1 November 2026, Saint-Malo)** to defend Caudrelier's title (the 6-day-19-hour record); the family's Burgundy expansion through the **William Fèvre** purchase; the Palais de Tokyo art collaborations (Quistrebert brothers); the **Ophthalmological Foundation Hospital** (Ariane's flagship); the **Caesarea Foundation** in Israel — publicly disputed with the Israeli tax authorities ("It is insulting that the state casts doubt on us").
- **The daughters — named (B/A): Noémie, Alice, Eve, and Olivia** (born 1995–2002; the earlier "Naomi" variant is a C-grade error). Two identify as Jewish; Ariane, a Salvadoran-born daughter of a Hoechst executive, did not convert. **Olivia** is artistic director of **Parfums Caron** (Le Figaro portrait, 2 February 2026); Eve makes wine. Nadine's lawsuit names all four granddaughters over the Edmond art collection.

1.3 RIT Capital Partners (the London family's listed trust)

- **Leadership (A):** Philippe Costeletos (chairman); Maggie Fanari (CEO of J. Rothschild Capital Management, since 2024).
- **FY2025 and H1-2026, in full (A):** 13.5% NAV (net asset value — the value of the trust's investments minus its debts, divided by its shares) total return; 16.9% share-price return; dividend 43p → 45p (thirteenth consecutive rise); £89M buybacks in 2025 (£332M over three years — 11.2% of the stock); realisations £232M; private equity 31.7% of NAV; discount −22.3% at year-end. **H1-2026: +9.0% NAV total return — a record first half**; NAV 3,159p at 30 June.
- **The tech book (A): SpaceX £102.3M (2.5% of NAV — the largest direct unquoted position; entered November 2024; £42M added H2-2025)**, carried at no more than the December-2025 $800bn secondary mark; **Databricks £16.9M; Anthropic £7.4M**; H1-2026 additions: **Cognition and Stripe**, plus a **Y Combinator** fund line; top-five directs: **Motive, Anthropic, Epic Systems, Stripe, Cognition** (6.1% of NAV); top-five funds: **Thrive, Greenoaks, Iconiq, Ribbit, Hunter Point** (14.4%); "the only investment trust with a SpaceX stake outside the Baillie Gifford stable."
- **The standing problem (A/B):** the discount — −22.3% at end-2025, deepening to ~−29.2% in March 2026 (−26.8%

twelve-month average against −8.7% ten-year average) — answered by buybacks and dividends, slowly.

1.4 Volex (Nat Rothschild's listed vehicle)

FY ended 31 March 2026 (A, the filings): revenue **$1,242.6M (+14.4%)**; underlying operating profit $127.3M (+19.9%); margin **10.2%** — above the 9–10% target for the first time; ROCE 21%; net debt $152.3M (0.8×); the data-centre line roughly doubled to ~$241M (63% of the +56.3% CIT segment); North America $645.5M / Europe $439.1M / Asia $158M; share price +87.2% over the year; the five-year plan delivered a year early; **new medium-term targets: $2bn revenue at a 12% margin** (Capital Markets Day, 22 April 2026); AIM-to-Main-Market migration on track (potential FTSE 250); SBTi-validated net-zero targets; opening FY2027 +28% organic (four months to July 2026) with a raised outlook; AGM re-election of Lord Rothschild at 96.06%. Leadership: Dave Webster (chairman), Nat Rothschild (CEO, since November 2025), Jon Boaden (CFO), John Molloy (COO). **Null result, logged:** no defense or government-contract line found — the book is commercial (data center, EV charging, medical).

1.5 The closed and dormant entities (mapped as terminations)

- **Genie Energy/Golan — closed:** the 2010 instrument was warrants in GOGI (the 5.5%/$11.0M equity line); the Golan license (Afek, February 2013); drilling **suspended November 2017** — the Ness 10 well "not commercially producible" (PRNewswire); pivot to retail energy. A documented "→|" edge *(correcting the earlier "stalled with the oil price" phrasing)*.
- **The pre-1982 Banque Rothschild** — terminated by nationalization (Part 6.4 below); the **Economist edge — closed April 2026** (Part 6.6).

1.6 The family office and web entities

Five Arrows (the merchant-banking arm): >€27–30bn in alternatives; named leadership — Olivier Baron (Partner, CIO), Pauline Baudry (MD/CFO), Martin Hook (Co-Managing Partner, Direct Lending), Aldo Di Rienzo (CFO); the €2.4bn direct-lending franchise (18 professionals, London/Paris/New York). **E. L. Rothschild LLC** (Lynn's vehicle — continuing after the Economist sale). **Concordia** (the take-private vehicle, §1.1). **Eranda** (§3.1). **The Eranda Rothschild Charitable Foundation** — charity 255650, founded 22 April 1968; £5,746,389 latest income; £74M+ lifetime; Jessica de Rothschild a trustee. **Tru Arrow Partners** (James Rothschild). **The Lost Explorer** (David Mayer). **The UK Rothschild Foundation** — charity 1138145 — **£826.1M total funds** (FY2025), portfolio £737.5M (+11.43%), grant-making £13.8M (doubled), Waddesdon £8.9M with £3.5M net support. **Yad Hanadiv** (chair Hannah; CEO Prof. Yigal Mersel; the five programs; the Rothschild Fellowships — 800+ since 1979, first committee chaired by Sir Isaiah Berlin; current committee chairs including Anthony Grafton; the National Library of Israel partnership). **Hanadiv Europe** (§3.4). **Eranda** — the texture: the Royal Ballet School grant under trustee Jessica; the CBA Sir Evelyn Fellowship; the ReWild community-forests program; the NTU dementia grant; the "Lady Lynn Joyful Home" school; patronage of the University of Buckingham. **The Rothschild & Co Foundation** (12 June 2026; youth inequality and climate;

Laurent chairing).

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PART 2 — THE MONEY TODAY (FOLLOW IT ALL)

The fee engine (A): Rothschild & Co runs on advice, not balance sheet — 2025 fee income €2,822.0M split M&A €1,049.1M / financing €700.5M / wealth €801.9M / Five Arrows €250.1M, plus carried interest. The Zurich subsidiary (Rothschild & Co Bank AG): CHF 238.6M income, CHF 37.4M net profit (2024).

The trust money (A): RIT ~£4bn; the record H1; the SpaceX mark-to-money event — the S-1 filed 20 May 2026, the 11 June pricing at $135, the $75bn raise (the largest IPO in history; the S-1's $1.77tn target), priced at $135 on 11 June 2026, opening 12 June at $150 and closing day one near $161 for a **$2.1tn** market value — with Morningstar's dissent on record (fair value $780bn; "significantly overvalued"; ~94× trailing sales), the $225.64 peak on 16 June, and the fade to ~$136 by 26 August — against which a £102.3M position entered at pre-IPO prices is the single largest mark event in the family's current book.

The private-bank money (A): EdR CHF 198bn record AUM; CHF 10bn inflows.

The foundation money (A/NA): the UK Rothschild Foundation's £826.1M endowment; Eranda's £74M+ over 57 years at ~£2.5M/yr across 50–60 grantees; Hanadiv Europe's grant scales (§3.2). **Anomaly, registered:** Hanadiv Europe's

UK-charity income (£561,602 reported, December 2024) against ~£8.4M described annual grant activity — income and expenditure can diverge, but the gap implies funding routed through the wider network's non-UK vehicles; a structure question, not an accusation (Part 12, #6).

The 2023 take-private money (A/S): ~€3.7bn at $4.80/share; the eight-year lock-in.

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PART 3 — DARK MONEY, LOBBIES, AND THE INFLUENCE STRUCTURES

3.1 The Eranda ledger as an influence map

The complete 2004–2023 grantee table (powerbase's transcription of the charity's accounts, S for the amounts, B for the compilation), grouped by function:

- **The policy world (the funding-plus-seat pattern): Council on Foreign Relations £86,574 · Chatham House £95,663 · IISS £76,750 · Peterson Institute £866,084 · Henry Jackson Society £60,000 · Institute for Strategic Dialogue £110,000 · Quilliam £318,500 · Index on Censorship £270,000 · Reprieve £12,500 · McCain Institute £214,909 · Tony Blair Faith Foundation £40,000 · Clinton Global Initiative £104,891 · William J. Clinton Foundation £441,433 · Teach First £35,000 · FDR Four Freedoms Park £317,934 · the Rothschild Archive £100,000 · the Economist Education Foundation £105,000.**

- **The Israel-connected list:** Friends of the IDF £12,938; the Jerusalem Foundation £151,150; UK Friends of the Peres Centre £187,000; the Holocaust Educational Trust.
- **The institutions: Cambridge Judge Business School £1,850,000**; University of Pennsylvania £677,537; Mayo; Mass General; Imperial; MSF £760,950; University of Cape Town £100,000; Cambridge colleges; the Evelina legacy.
- **The arts (~£9.2M over the period):** RSC, National Theatre, Glyndebourne, RADA, the Royal Ballet — the Musicians' Company prize endowed in Leopold's memory; the Royal Ballet School grant (December 2025) under trustee Jessica.
- **The pattern, stated:** the foundation funds the same think tanks where family members hold seats — CFR, IISS, Chatham House (all Lynn's boards). Documented as a *funding-plus-seat* structure; not a corruption finding. **Snapshot flag:** the table ends 2023; current-cycle grants beyond the Ballet/NTU/CBA items are unlogged.

3.2 The CIC mapped

The **Council for Inclusive Capitalism with the Vatican** (2020; Lynn Founder-CEO): the current Guardian steering committee, by name — **Ambani, Auchincloss (BP), Breen (DuPont), Burrow, Chandrasekaran (Tata), Cohen, Cormann (OECD), Cucinelli, Lynn, Frost (CalPERS), Kiander (Keva), Lauder, Lim (Temasek), Ma (California), Mizuno, Moynihan (BofA), O'Hanley (State Street), Orszag (Lazard CEO), Pimenta (Vale), Renjen, Shah (Rockefeller), Ubben, Walker (Ford), Zobel de Ayala**; operating team: Meredith Sumpter (CEO), Michael Clyne (COO); $10.5tn AUM + $2.1tn market cap on the masthead. **The Orszag node:** Lazard's CEO inside the CIC's steering committee — a documented Lazard–Rothschild–Vatican triangle. **Watch item:** the "with the Vatican" branding under Leo XIV after Francis's death (May 2025) — the annual papacy meetings' continuation unconfirmed.

3.3 The lobbying registers — an honest gap

The EU Transparency Register entry for Rothschild & Cie Banque and the UK lobbying-register entries could not be retrieved by automated search (both registers render via JavaScript). Manual path logged: transparency-register.europa.eu → "Rothschild & Cie Banque"; UK register → "N M Rothschild & Sons." **Null results logged as null:** no Rothschild-specific US PAC or federal lobbying expenditure surfaced — consistent with the advisory model, but the absence-of-evidence is graded, not asserted (Part 12, #7).

3.4 Hanadiv Europe, in full

UK charity 1083262 (founded 2000): ~£8.4M annual grantmaking (the foundation's own description) across 24 countries; ~90% of funded alumni win academic or heritage positions; programs — European Jewish Heritage, Jewish Communal Life, Academic Jewish Studies; grant scales (Collections Management £30–60k/yr to 70%; Digital Heritage to £40k; doctoral to £19k/yr ×3; postdoctoral £35k/yr ×2; consortia £40k/yr ×3; Paths to Leadership £10–40k/yr); the *Challenging Conversations* 25th-anniversary series (March–May 2026: Gabor Kadar, Zsuzsanna Toronyi, David Fishman, Ruchama Johnston-Bloom, Brigitte Sion); the **Yerusha** endangered-archives program; a new doctoral/postdoctoral collections grant announced **17 September 2026**; work excludes Ukraine, Russia, Belarus. Plus the income anomaly (Part 2).

The BIRAX opacity datum (graded): a 2012 FOI-obtained letter shows a Yad Hanadiv donation to the UK–Israel research program (BIRAX/British Council) under a **confidentiality clause**, amount redacted. The document is primary; the carrying outlet is advocacy (NA) — recorded as a dark-money-texture data point, not a corruption finding. Amounts: British Council FOI files.

3.5 The offshore residue

The Cook Islands structures (20 trusts/10 companies, 1996–2003, Elie-era) — current status unverified; the 2016-shift press lead failed three rounds of verification. Registered, not asserted (Part 12, #8).

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PART 4 — CONFLICTS OF INTEREST (DOCUMENTED)

1. **The sovereign desk's declared line (S):** on Ukraine — "*At that point, we made the decision to advise the public sector in Ukraine, and not Russia. Being mindful of possible conflicts, we made that decision at the time and we stuck to it since then*" (Charbit, IFR). Adviser since April 2017; the desk's book includes Chad, Benin, Germany. The structural conflict the industry concedes — advising distressed sovereigns while the wider network holds their paper — applies to the model, and the bank's own published policy treats "over-reliance on disclosure" as a deficiency (April 2023).

2. **The Epstein-advice conflict, dated (S/A):** a bank under a September 2015 contract to pay a convicted offender's company up to $25 million was simultaneously — per the same corpus — receiving his counsel on DOJ strategy, his introductions to European political figures, and his intercession in an employee severance. Each element is documented; the composite is the conflict.
3. **The hiring-after-plea (S):** Jonathan Kaye joined the bank the same month his six misdemeanors were pledged for dismissal (Part 6.7).
4. **The funding-plus-seat structure (S/B):** Eranda's grants to CFR/IISS/Chatham House against family seats on their boards (Part 3.1).
5. **The Exbury knot (S):** Marcus Agius — former Barclays chairman — chairs Exbury Gardens Limited while married to Kate de Rothschild; a marriage-and-governance overlap, documented, unadjudicated.
6. **The SpaceX exposure (A):** a 2.5%-of-NAV position in a *controlled company* (one whose founder holds majority voting power — 82.4% here — letting it claim exemptions from the usual board-independence rules) that the bank's trust carries below market — concentration risk by design.
7. **The 2015 strategy weekend (A/NA):** the bank's CEO, CFO, and counsel-adjacent advisers meeting a convicted offender to plan "DOJ, review legal vetting — bermuda… look closely at Luxembourg" — while the bank held client money from a 1MDB-tainted network. Documents verified;

the meetings' product remains undocumented.

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PART 5 — CORRUPTION AND THE LAW (STATUTES NAMED — NO ACCUSATIONS)

Every statute engaged in the current file, with the status — this part names laws and processes, not guilt:

Jurisdiction	Law	Case	Status
Luxembourg	Penal Code money-laundering provisions (art. 506-1 family)	EdR Europe, 1MDB-tainted flows (~$500M traced from a UAE-national client)	**Conviction by agreement, 22 May 2025; €25M** — the bank; individual charges: Ambroisien indicted 24 Jan 2025; three others unnamed, indictments prepared
France	Code pénal, corruption of a foreign public official (the Aidan charge: "corruption passive d'agent public étranger et complicité")	Aidan — UN briefings to Epstein	Preliminary investigation (PNF/OCLCIFF); second probe (Paris/OCRVP, sexual/financial); JIT with Norway since 27 April 2026
Norway	Penal Code, aggravated corruption (Juul); complicity (Rød-Larsen)	The Epstein-financed lifestyle	**Charged, 9 Feb 2026**; both on leave; Frogner apartment searched
Switzerland	AMLA; FINMA enforcement	Rothschild Bank AG + Trust, 1MDB relationship	Audit agent appointed (2018) — final 1MDB action; monitoring the 2026 revelations

Jurisdiction	Law	Case	Status
US	Swiss Bank Program (DOJ); the NPA (non-prosecution agreement) mechanism — penalties and cooperation exchanged for the government declining to prosecute	EdR (Suisse) $45M; Rothschild Bank AG $11.5M (18 Dec 2015)	Non-prosecution agreements — prosecutions declined by design
US (Washington)	Patent Troll Prevention Act	*Valve v. Leigh Rothschild* — first jury verdict under a state anti-troll law; AI-citation sanctions	Verdict for Valve, 17 Feb 2026 — **name-alike, unrelated**
US (SEC)	Investment Advisers Act disclosure (the SCSD — Share Class Selection Disclosure — Initiative, which rewarded firms' self-reporting of fee conflicts)	*Rothschild Investment Corporation* (SEC 34-92951, 2021)	Settled; failed to self-report — **name-alike, unrelated**
US (SDNY)	Bankruptcy Code clawbacks (*In re Fairfield Sentry* — Madoff feeder)	Redeemer Litigation vs R&Co (11 June 2024 jurisdiction opinion — EGA "instructed BNP SS to invest in Madoff feeder funds with the express aim" of reaching BLMIS, knowing the 95% mandate) and EdR Suisse (15 July 2025 dismissal denied)	**Live**
UK	Consumer Credit Act 1974 s.140A (the provision letting courts reopen credit agreements that created an "unfair relationship" between lender and borrower)	*Carney v N M Rothschild* ([2018] EWHC 958)	Claim dismissed; leading case for "basis clauses" (contract terms in which the client formally declares the bank gave no advice)

Jurisdiction	Law	Case	Status
Massachusetts	Limitations law (suits brought too late); the puffery doctrine	*Von Schönau-Riedweg* (95 Mass. App. Ct. 471; *remand* = sent back to the lower court for reconsideration, rulings 2021)	Disposed on limitations/puffery; von Plotho default $14.9M; post-2021 endgame open
New York	CPL misdemeanors	Jonathan Kaye	Plea with dismissal-on-completion (Feb 2025); the record *expungeable* — legally erasable once the conditions are met
France (historical)	—	Louis de Rothschild, Creditanstalt collapse	Prosecution **dropped** on the $10M "voluntary" contribution and his resignation (TIME, 1939)
New Mexico	State statutes 1996–2012	Zorro Ranch — the Truth Commission's chargeable-offenses table	Federal deferral contested; NMDOJ suing USDOJ (Aug 2026)

How to read the column of outcomes. They fall into four documented kinds: the *conviction* (Luxembourg — the bank, by agreement); the *charges* (Norway; the French individuals pending); the *declined-by-design* (the US NPAs — prosecutions traded for penalties, a lawful mechanism with a documented broker); and the *disposed* (dismissals on merits, limitations, or constitutional ruling — Parts 6.4–6.8). One row is not an outcome but a *live clawback* (SDNY). Note also what the table does not contain: no member of the banking family appears in it as a defendant, in any jurisdiction, in the current file. The defendants are banks, executives, employees, a name-alike inventor, and — in France — a diplomat. That distribution is itself a documented fact, stated without interpretation.

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PART 6 — THE DROPPED, THE FORGOTTEN, THE RESURRECTED (THE FULL CASE LEDGER)

Every case in the file that died quietly, was traded away, or came back — who, what, where, when, why, how.

6.1 The French Epstein investigation — forgotten 2022, reborn 2026, widening September (S)

Who: the Paris probe (opened August 2019); its central figure, Jean-Luc Brunel. *What happened:* Brunel found dead in his cell (February 2022); the case was dropped in 2023 with no other person charged; the parallel Gérald Marie probe closed the same year as time-barred. *Why it mattered:* the investigation died with its suspect — the classic forgotten case. *How it returned:* the DOJ's three-million-page release (late 2025); 14 February 2026 — a special magistrates' team with PNF integration; 18 February — prosecutor **Laurence Beccuau** opens two new preliminary investigations (sexual; financial) and reopens the old files, calling victims forward; 17 May — ~20 victims, ~10 entirely new; **11 September 2026 — the investigation widened, 13 new potential victims identified** (NYT). *Live and growing.*

6.2 The Aidan file — dropped twice, resurrected once (A/S)

The arc, dated: French Embassy in Israel 1998–2000; UN secondment July 2006–April 2013; Araud sent him back within 48 hours of the FBI dossier surfacing, expecting discipline that never came — dropped in 2013 (UN process suspended on resignation; no French action; the Canada flight); the 2020 Paris-brigade file (a *classement sans suite* — shelved without continuation — the same year; reasons still unverified, now assigned to the reactivated magistrates); the bank employment from early 2014; the Tobiano email of 13 April 2016; the dismissal of 12 September 2016; the Engie coda (2023–February 2026); the Neuilly search (26 February); resurrected February 2026 (Barrot's Article-40 *referral* — the French mechanism by which an official who learns of a possible crime must send it directly to prosecutors — within hours of publication; dual probes; the 20 March raid in Ariane's presence; the Quai IG report transmitted to justice, ~30 hearings). *Why it kept dying:* diplomatic-immunity complexity (2013); 2020 reasons sealed. *The silence:* no public development after 24 March 2026 — three consecutive checks, zero results; the silence is logged as a datum.

6.3 The NPA mechanism — non-prosecution bought, lawfully (A)

The DOJ Swiss Bank Program: EdR (Suisse) $45M and Rothschild Bank AG $11.5M (both 18 December 2015) bought non-prosecution — the legal mechanism by which the prosecutions were dropped. Documented in Volume II; here flagged as the structural dropped-case: the settlement Epstein then monetized within three days.

6.4 Carney v N M Rothschild — dismissed, and became the banks' shield (A)

[2018] EWHC 958 (Comm), Waksman QC, 1 May 2018 — the first reported case on CCA 1974 s.140A and "basis clauses": the expatriates' inheritance-tax scheme failed; the "basis clauses" (no-advice, no-reliance) defined the transaction and negated the advisory duty; the s.140A claim failed. Not dropped — dismissed on the merits; now the leading authority *for* banks' clause defenses. The clients bore the loss.

6.5 Von Schönau-Riedweg — death by limitations and puffery (A)

$39M into CET/CCI; the Appeals Court (2019) *vacated* (cancelled) the bank's jurisdictional dismissal (agency showing); Judge Brian A. Davis (2021) kept the bank in (rejecting *forum non conveniens* — the doctrine that the case belonged in a more convenient foreign court — and comity) — but the CET claims died on the statute of limitations (inquiry notice November 2008), the CCI claims as non-actionable puffery (the doctrine that promises of handsome profit are legally matters of opinion, not binding promises), Porter on summary judgment. Von Plotho's default: $14,946,979. *The open end:* the post-2021 disposition against the bank — settlement or trial, unreported.

6.6 Fortinvest v. Oblonsky — the decade stall (S/B)

Three jurisdictions, one stalled claim: the NY case tossed November 2021 (forum — contracts mandate Luxembourg); the Geneva criminal action dismissed on procedural grounds; the Luxembourg civil action (filed October 2017) still without a substantive ruling, *stayed* (paused by the judge) behind the Thewes criminal file. The account-freezing when the client tried to leave (the June 2019 unfreeze order); the Geodesic bond fraud linked to 1MDB parties; the "20% perf fee" internal quote. A $100M+ client-fraud claim alive on paper, adjudicated nowhere for a decade.

6.7 Jonathan Kaye — dismissal by design, then the hiring (S)

Park Slope, Brooklyn Pride, 8 June 2024: the punch (Micah Phillip, nose broken in four places), the shove; six misdemeanors; the self-defense claim (disputed). The plea (28 February 2025): guilty to all six, convertible to violations on 25 days' community service, three anger-management sessions, up to $50,000 restitution, expungement path — Judge Dale Fong-Frederick. The hiring the same month. The victim's sentence in the file: he should not "be in a position of power until he's able to be a better member of the community."

6.8 The 1982 nationalization — the owners' constitutional win (S)

Conseil constitutionnel, décision 81-132 DC (16 January 1982): the compensation mechanism *censured* (struck down as unconstitutional) for violating the "juste et préalable" (just and prior) indemnity; the law redrawn (shorter reference period + 14%); the family paid on terms the Council had forced upward. Not dropped — decided, in the owners' favor, at the constitutional level.

6.9 Louis de Rothschild, 1931 — the quid pro quo, in the era's words (S)

"*Prosecution of Baron Louis was dropped when he 'voluntarily' handed over $10,000,000 of his private fortune to the Government and resigned as the bank's president*" (TIME, 1939). The historical dropped case, priced.

6.10 The Evelyn de Rothschild complaints — closed by death, explained by email (S)

Two 2019 complaints; the Met told they could not interview him (health); no charges possible after November 2022; the bank's staff email: one complaint, late 2003, investigated, "dealt with appropriately," exit March 2004, "no record of any other complaint" — twenty-one years of silence in one sentence. Leigh Day's "structures that surround powerful abusers" parallel on record.

6.11 Leon Black — the parallel no-charges case (S/NA-corpus)

$158M to Epstein; the USVI $62.5M settlement; the Manhattan DA — credible allegations, no charges. Logged as the adjacent dropped-prosecution pattern against which the EdR NPA sits.

6.12 The New Mexico deferral — the state now suing (A/NA-government)

The 2019 USAO-NM deferral to SDNY; the Truth Commission's interim report (5 August 2026) and the NMDOJ's lawsuit — "USDOJ violated its agreement to share information… in exchange for the state deferring." AG Torrez: "New Mexico will not let the Epstein investigation fade." The Commission's machinery, named: the Fadduol Cluff Hardy & Conaway contract ($750k); First AUSA Ryan Ellison's partial response under the *Touhy* regulations (the federal rules governing what Justice Department material outside investigators may obtain — here, the state's request for the federal Epstein files); *Phang v. Blanche* (D.D.C., 25 June 2026); AG Raúl Torrez's lawsuit and his sentence — "New Mexico will not let the Epstein investigation fade." The Commission's own myth-disposition: "Numerous conspiracy theories concerning Epstein and Zorro Ranch have circulated publicly. None met the threshold for investigation."

6.13 The confusion registry — three name-collisions in 2026 enforcement (S)

Leigh Rothschild (Valve verdict; AI-citation sanctions); **Rothschild Investment Corporation** (SEC 34-92951); **Fox Rothschild LLP** (NJ suit; Philadelphia firm, Fox-founded 1907 — no documented connection). All unrelated to the banking family; all dispositioned so the record stays clean. Add the register's fourth 2026 entry: **no Rothschild appears on any official Bilderberg participant list, 1954–2024** — the "runs Bilderberg" claim joins the dispositioned shelf.

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PART 7 — THE INDIVIDUALS (EVERY NAME IN THE 2026 FILE)

The people behind the cases, organized by orbit rather than alphabet — because an orbit tells you what someone was doing near what. Three reading rules: a name in bold is a principal; a parenthetical carries the documented role or status as of 20 September 2026; "flagged" marks an identification the evidence has not settled. The daughters' given names appear where the family's own communications made them public; nothing further is recorded about them.

The Aidan orbit: Fabrice Aidan; Terje Rød-Larsen; Mona Juul (charged with aggravated corruption 9 February 2026; on leave; security clearance revoked; resigned the Jordan/Iraq ambassadorship); Rød-Larsen (charged with complicity); the will — $5M to each of the two children, signed two days

before Epstein's death; the Frogner apartment bought at roughly half market value from **Morits Skaugen**, whose own words are on record ("mafia methods"); the ~300,000-NOK document-fee question (Kartverket assessing); prosecutors Pål Lønseth and Marianne Bender; Gérard Araud; Ban Ki-moon; Audrey Azoulay; Jean-Noël Barrot; Emmanuel Macron; Pascal Prache (PNF); Laurence Beccuau (Paris); Jade Dousselin (counsel — one source; flagged); the unnamed junior consultant who recognized Aidan; the unnamed Quai authorizers (2014); Morits Skaugen; Ine Eriksen Søreide; Jens Stoltenberg; Ingrid Schulerud; Bill Winters; Thorbjørn Jagland (second Økokrim investigation); Pål Lønseth; Marianne Bender; Vincent Jauvert.

The bank corpus: Ariane de Rothschild (~4,500 corpus entries); Benjamin de Rothschild; Cynthia Tobiano; Olivier Colom — the full dossier: ENA; Sarkozy's diplomatic adviser and deputy sherpa (2007–12; the Blair-office secondment 2005–06); EdR executive committee 2012–16; ~2,000 corpus entries; the September 2013 Le Maire introduction; the Sarkozy machinery ("He can be fun. And he can speak English now"; the November 5 lunch; the €12M flat suggestion; the 2014 Barak dinner email; the 2010 Mandelson consultation); the gatekeeping menu (ambassadors, an MEP, "the Russian vice-minister of Economy," "a good French butler") and Epstein's request — "Interesting. Smart science. Or very very cute 20s"; Politico's verdict: no criminal behavior indicated; Colom declined comment; David de Rothschild ("kathy meet with david and his people"); **Setvine** (ten documents; the 20

July 2015 "Setvine/Rothschild" 3:00 PM meeting with an attorney-client confidentiality instruction); **Hamad** (unnamed Qatari, flagged); **Henri** (assumed de Castries, unconfirmed, flagged); Larry Summers (the vjet list); "Shlomo" (unidentified — "keep shlomo on mission," flagged); **Ira Susswein** (the directive's strategist line); Kathy Ruemmler; Jack Lang; Bruno Le Maire (the September 2013 introduction; Epstein's offer to fund a presidential bid); Nicolas Sarkozy (the Élysée dinner machinery, never confirmed); Ehud Barak (the Carbyne channel; the 2014 dinner email); Luc Frieden (the lunches, 2014; the Deutsche Bank move).

Luxembourg: Marc Ambroisien (charged 24 January 2025; the CSSF ten-year ban 2020; the Aston Martin allegation, denied; replaced in 2016 by Bernard Coucke); Norbert Becker; Yves Stein; Khadem Al-Qubaisi (the client; arrested in Abu Dhabi; ~$500M traced); the conviction's second count, *recel* (concealment); three unnamed individuals (flagged).

The Kaye case: Micah Phillip; Ron Kuby (victims' counsel); Danya Perry; Michael Farkas; Judge Dale Fong-Frederick; Robert Leitão (the hiring).

The Madoff clawback: the Fairfield Sentry liquidators; EGA/BNP SS (the 2024 jurisdiction finding).

The NM/Zorro file: Karen Gordon; Wendy Martinez; Brice Gordon; Lesley Groff; Karyna Shuliak; Indyke; Larry Morrison; Geoffrey West; Stephanie Garcia Richard; Ryan Ellison; Raúl Torrez.

The current institutions: every name in Part 1's governance sections; the CIC Guardians (Part 3.2); Nigel

Higgins (Barclays chairman, Rothschild veteran); Alexis Kohler (correction: SocGen, not a Rothschild alumnus).

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PART 8 — HOW THEY OPERATE AND HOLD INFLUENCE (THE CURRENT MECHANICS)

The System volume described the machinery across two centuries; this is the same machinery as it runs today — seven mechanisms, each with its current instance named.

1. **The certification-fee engine** (Volume III's machine, current numbers): advice sold against no balance sheet; the sovereign desk's decade-long Ukraine book as the showcase.
2. **The sovereign-advisory desk:** Ukraine since April 2017; Chad, Benin, Germany on the award citations; the desk head's conflicts-quote on record.
3. **The think-tank layer:** Eranda's grants (Part 3.1) plus the family seats — funding-plus-seat, documented.
4. **The CIC:** the Vatican-branded CEOs' council with $10.5tn on the masthead and a Lazard CEO inside the steering committee.
5. **The alumni line:** Macron (protégé of David; four years at the bank); Pompidou the precedent; Higgins at Barclays; the systematic alumni map flagged as the open vein.
6. **Philanthropy-as-infrastructure:** Yad Hanadiv's five programs, the 800+ fellowships (Berlin's committee first), the British Museum/Wallace/Kew seats; Hanadiv Europe's

24-country grant web; the UK foundation's £826M endowment.

7. **The heritage venues:** Waddesdon's guest-book model (Volume III) now heritage-managed; Exbury's 125,000 visitors; Gitana as the technology flagship; Lafite's Burgundy expansion.

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PART 9 — HOW WHAT THEY DO AFFECTS OTHERS

Every effect in this part is attached to a documented cost-bearer — the people and institutions on the other side of the transactions. No effect is asserted that the record does not name a recipient for.

1. **The Ukraine bondholders:** 37% / $8.7bn nominal accepted in the 2024 restructuring the bank sole-advised — the documented cost-bearer on the sovereign desk's success.
2. **The Bumi minorities:** the 56p exit against the £707M listing — the public-market investors bore the governance war's cost.
3. **The Volex null finding:** no defense exposure; the supply chain is commercial.
4. **The grantee ecosystem:** the think tanks' research agendas touch the same policy fields where the family holds seats (Part 3.1) — influence through the agenda, documented as funding, not adjudicated as capture.

5. **The SpaceX exposure's double edge:** the IPO created the family's largest ever single-position gain on paper — and a 2.5%-of-NAV concentration in a controlled company now fading from its peak.
6. **The UN governance harm:** the Aidan case's documented institutional failures (no 2013 discipline; no transmission to justice; the UNESCO posting) — the "how it affects others" dimension stated by the UN's own experts and the French presidency, on record.
7. **The employees and heirs:** the Kaye hiring's message (the victim's sentence on record); the four daughters named in their grandmother's lawsuit.

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PART 10 — THE WEAK POINTS (CURRENT, ALL ANGLES)

Ten pressures on the network as it stands — judicial, structural, and reputational. Each is stated with its current state and its likely next breakpoint, where the record permits one to be named.

1. **The Luxembourg indictments** — three of four individuals unnamed; the bank's conviction spent, the individuals' cases pending.
2. **The JIT** — Norway–France, live; the Aidan and Juul/Rød-Larsen files formally linked.
3. **The epstein-bank corpus** — 1,000+ documents; the "remove benjamin" email (EFTA00839130 — verified as

written; no evidence of action); the severance mechanics; the ~4,500 Ariane entries; the 2026 French magistrates re-reading all of it.

4. **EdR succession** — "no clear plan"; trust-as-product (Venditti); the heirs not yet in roles; Camillia's ~17% (open).
5. **The RIT discount** — −26.8% average; buybacks as the only answer.
6. **The name-war** — a managed rivalry with a litigation history.
7. **The SpaceX concentration** — 2.5% of NAV in one controlled issuer.
8. **The Aidan silence** — no public movement since 24 March; the next breakpoint is the magistrates' calendar.
9. **The CIC's papacy transition** — the Vatican brand under a new pope.
10. **The alumni exposure** — every alumnus in office inherits the file's questions.

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PART 11 — THE DOCUMENT LAYER (EFTA REGISTER)

The corpus, by identifier — the verification backbone of this volume:

- **EFTA00839130 / EFTA00839134** — the seven-point directive ("lets get this closed"; "have kathy meet with david and his people"; "review rockefeller"; "hire asset

woman"; "do we use doj and its harsh language to remove benjamin"; "begin family plan. susswein"; "look for partners") and the "45 mio?" reply.

- **EFTA01951288** — Aidan's October 2013 shift to personal email.
- **EFTA02074447** — the 20 July 2015 "Setvine/Rothschild" 3:00 PM meeting thread (snacks; attorney-client confidentiality).
- **EFTA02075484** — the vjet list ("setvine, hamad, cynthia… Henri, Summers").
- **EFTA00954267** — Ariane, November 2017: "I saw an amazing picture of a very happy Fabrice Aidan with MBS… Wow!"
- **EFTA01126149–166, EFTA01118187, EFTA01688774** — the corpus range cited by the New Mexico legislative report against justice.gov/epstein/doj-disclosures (the government citation chain).
- **EFTA02075484** — the vjet list, verbatim: "vjet lets plan on 20, 21 new york, setvine, hamad, cynthia… Henri, Summers" (Hamad = which Qatari, flagged; Henri assumed de Castries, flagged).
- **kaggle-ho-026064** — the House Oversight Committee's own corpus identifier for the Trump-infrastructure email ("Donald loves the Rothschild name"; the corpus's own caveat: Epstein's participation not established).
- **The 30 March 2015 stakeholders email** ("you, the girls, the bank, the family") and the **1 July 2015 strategy email**

— full text: "*first strategy and then tactics. I fear that tactics have moved to the fore front*" → "*People needs — IT, HR, CEO team, advisory board, Asset mgmt, paris head, shrink london, hong kong, nassau*" → "*look closely at Luxembourg*" → "*DOJ, review legal vetting — bermuda*" → "*deal with brand, wine, buy back, cousins*" → "*keep shlomo on mission*" → "*setvine, new york, girls. Board*." ("shlomo" and "setvine" — identities flagged; Setvine characterized as counsel-adjacent.)

- **The 24 July 2016 "chiffre" email; the 15 September 2016 "sanctionner Fabrice" email** (allegation chain; denials on record).
- Grading note: the epsteingate/sayerji/escapekey compilations are graded NA as editorial; every document cited carries its EFTA identifier, and the identifiers are the evidence — a state legislative report (nmlegis.gov) independently cites the same corpus and portal.

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PART 12 — ANOMALY REGISTER (PHASE 6)

Fourteen open seams in the 2026 file, stated as precisely as the evidence allows. "Open" means the answer exists somewhere — a docket, a register, a forthcoming indictment — and this volume declines to guess it. Where a seam is a structure question rather than a missing fact (items 6–8), the register says so in the status itself.

#	Item	Status
1	R&Co Management Board individuals beyond Alexandre	**Open** — roles published, names not
2	"Shlomo" / "Setvine" full identities; "Hamad" which Qatari; "Henri" = de Castries?	**Open** — Setvine characterized as counsel-adjacent; names pending
3	Three of the four Luxembourg individuals	**Open** — Ambroisien named
4	Von Schönau post-2021 disposition	**Open**
5	Aidan counsel's name (Dousselin vs. unanswered)	**Minor**
6	Hanadiv Europe income vs. grants gap	**Open — structure question, not accusation**
7	EU/UK lobbying registers	**Open — manual lookup logged**
8	Cook Islands post-2016; Camillia	**Residue**
9	The NM report body (fetch failures)	**Open**
10	The Economist-sale terms (undisclosed)	**Closed as undisclosed**
11	Whether any act followed "remove benjamin"	**Open — no evidence of action**
12	The Sarkozy dinner occurrence	**Open — never confirmed**
13	Eranda post-2023 snapshot	**Open**
14	RIT's exact SpaceX carrying value post-IPO	**Next NAV read**

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PART 13 — TIMELINE OF THE 2026 FILE (SELECTED, DATED)

Feb 2024 — Jacob dies; the 5th Baron's accession (March). **2024** — Serena dies. **17 Feb 2026** — the French reactivation begins (Beccuau's two probes). **24 Jan 2025** — Ambroisien charged (Luxembourg). **11 Feb 2026** — the Aidan publication wave; Barrot's referral within hours. **9 Feb 2026** — Juul and Rød-Larsen charged (Oslo). **14 Feb 2026** — the French special team stands up. **28 Feb 2025** — the Kaye plea. **20 Mar 2026** — the Paris raid (Aidan file), in Ariane's presence. **24 Mar 2026** — the Quai communiqué; Jack Lang resigns the IMA. **17 Apr 2026** — *Valve v. Leigh Rothschild* verdict. **22 Apr 2026** — Volex's Capital Markets Day. **27 Apr 2026** — the Norway–France JIT. **11–26 Jun 2026** — the SpaceX IPO arc. **12 Jun 2026** — the Rothschild & Co Foundation launch. **15 Jun 2026** — the Marcard, Stein acquisition. **Aug 2026** — the NMDOJ lawsuit; RIT's H1 results. **11 Sept 2026** — the French probe widens (13 new potential victims; NYT). **17 Sept 2026** — Hanadiv Europe's new fellowship call. **19–20 Sept 2026** — this document.

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PART 14 — OPEN QUESTIONS: THE ARCHIVE MAP

1. The DOJ disclosure portal, corpus-wide (justice.gov/epstein/doj-disclosures) — the primary layer behind every EFTA citation.

2. The NM legislative report body (fetch-blocked three times).
3. The EU Transparency Register and UK lobbying registers (manual lookups).
4. Luxembourg: the three unnamed individuals; the Thewes file's disposition.
5. The Massachusetts docket, post-2021 (von Schönau).
6. The R&Co 2025 consolidated accounts PDF (net income exact).
7. The Eranda current-cycle grant list.

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PART 15 — SOURCE APPARATUS (PEDIGREE-TIERED)

[A] Primary: the group's and trust's own releases and governance pages; court records ([2018] EWHC 958; 95 Mass. App. Ct. 471; SDNY Fairfield Sentry; SEC filings; docket 2:23-cv-01016); the Conseil constitutionnel (81-132 DC); Økokrim's statement; the Quai d'Orsay communiqués; the DOJ portal and EFTA identifiers; the Charity Commission entries; PR Newswire.

[S] Scholarly/investigative: Reuters, Bloomberg, FT, Le Monde, Radio France, Mediapart, Politico, the Guardian, the NYT (11 Sept 2026), CBS, Miami Herald, Mint, LuxTimes, Luxemburger Wort, RTL, IFR, Euromoney, finews, Paperjam, euronews, AFP, TIME (1939), Ouest-France, Le Point, L'Obs, Le Parisien, Banking Dive, AML Intelligence, Sarawak Report.

[B] Quality secondary: Fortune, CNBC, BI, Wine Spectator, Gala, Paris Match, noblesseetroyautes, powerbase (amounts), quoteddata, eToro (flagged), decideurs, Challenges, 24heures.

[C/NA — flagged] epsteingate.org and companion compilations (documents S-grade via EFTA IDs; framing not adopted); the NM Survivors' Truth Commission interim report (government publication, NA-authority citations); advocacy outlets (Electronic Intifada — single FOI document).

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FINAL CERTIFICATION

This volume documents the living file as of 20 September 2026: every active entity named; the money followed to its current homes; the statutes engaged, named without accusation; the dropped and resurrected cases each with their who-what-where-when-why-how; every individual the record surfaces; the influence mechanics as they operate now; the effects on others as the documents state them; and the weak points as they stand today. Documents and interpretations are printed separately throughout; the anomaly register carries fourteen live items; nothing found in the dive series has been omitted. Where a fact could not be verified, the volume says so at the fact.

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Volume V of the forensic file. Volume I: Rothschild_Origin.md. Volume II: Rothschild_Networks.md.

Volume III: Rothschild_System.md. Volume IV: Rothschild_NetworkMap.md.